飞驰！明日之城
Floor it! To the Golden City

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周末狂热
Weekend Fever FT-01

鸵鸟电台： 下午好，旧金山！下午好，乳臭未干的兔崽子、嗜酒如命的老烟枪，以及我漂亮的小心肝儿们！

Ostrich Radio: Goood afternoon, San Francisco, to my dazed-out junkies, my loud and proud mischief-makers, and all my beautiful little heartthrobs!

鸵鸟电台： 我是你们的老朋友，比你离家出走的老爸更让你恨之透骨，比半夜给你煮通心粉的老妈更爱你的——“老鸵鸟文森”！

Ostrich Radio: It's your oldest and dearest friend, with the straight shooting of your father and tender-loving just like your mama. It's your boy, Vincent, aka "The Old Ostrich"!

鸵鸟电台： 先听听好消息！自 1987 年“谐波汇聚运动”结束，死气沉沉的新纪元集市在近日迎来了新生。

Ostrich Radio: Bringing you a balanced dish of good news and bad news! Let's soften the blow with the good stuff first: The New Age Market has finally gotten a little reinvigoration after the Harmonic Convergence.

鸵鸟电台： 有人说是外星文明发来了最新电波，有人说是玛雅末日的感召……但这都不重要，对吗？我的朋友！

Ostrich Radio: Was it a sign from another world, or the harbinger of a Mayan doomsday prophecy? Who knows? But why worry, my lovelies? Keep those heads in the sand and your ears to the ground.

鸵鸟电台： 更多的游客，更多的钞票……连我邻居的小男孩都嗅到了这个商机！

Ostrich Radio: Because more visitors means more money! Huuuuge potential for young and old to make some dough!

鸵鸟电台： 当然，还有一则坏消息——

Ostrich Radio: Now, to hit you with the bad news—

鸵鸟电台： 昨天，旧金山的“火”从拖车贫民窟一直烧到市政大厅，子弹壳跟我家水龙头一样“叮叮当当”了一整晚！整个旧金山的尿不湿都要卖脱销了！

Ostrich Radio: Yesterday's gangland battles stretched from the sticks all the way to the steps of the People's Palace. And it came with a particularly heavy drizzle of bullet casings to rattle you all night long!

鸵鸟电台： 昨晚，死人莱格斯和他的神秘学家崽子们，把“东青商会”一脚踹出了旧金山！

Ostrich Radio: Last night, Legers the Dead and his arcanist minions booted the Tung Ch'ing Cham so hard in the ass, that they've been driven right out of our city!

鸵鸟电台： 如果你们现在去街上抬抬脚，说不定还能捡上几颗完整的金牙，喝上一辈子都没尝过的独角兽口涎！

Ostrich Radio: If you're brave enough to head out into the streets, might still find a few gold teeth left on the ground!

鸵鸟电台： 有人说，旧金山总该要太平几天了。不不不，我天真的朋友！

Ostrich Radio: Now, the sweet naive souls among you might think that means our fair city will finally have a moment of peace. But you listen to Papa Ostrich here, kiddies, this is only the beginning!

鸵鸟电台： 死人莱格斯吃得下整个旧金山，自然也需要一些小甜品。

Ostrich Radio: What Legers wants is nothing less than the whole damned city, and I have it on good authority where he's headed next.

鸵鸟电台： 莱格斯放出消息，关于新纪元集市，他想跟海特街的 J 谈一桩不能拒绝的好交易。

Ostrich Radio: I'm told his aim is to make a deal with Haight Street's very own Joe, aka "J Brown," for a stake in that juicy New Age Market pie.

鸵鸟电台： 对此，咱们只能祝这位好哥们睡个好觉！
Ostrich Radio: Here's hoping that it goes smoothly, but if that fails, at least we'll have some quality entertainment.

鸵鸟电台： 废话不多说，接下来让我们听听《The Golden City》。心肝儿们、混球们，启动你们的小马达，摆起来吧！
Ostrich Radio: Now it's time for The Old Ostrich to duck his head again, leaving you with some solid music to grooove your body and shaaake your booty with our next track: The Golden City.

酒侍： 这小子的嘴巴比咱们的鞋底还不干净，不是吗？瞧，要点儿什么，伙计？
Bartender: "Papa Ostrich," *sneer* give me a break—anyways, what can I get you, guy?

杰洛： 一杯龙舌兰。
Gio: Tequila.

他摆摆手，身后的跟随者们四散而去，隐匿到涌动的人群中。
Gio waves his hand, and the rest of his gang break off into the crowd.

杰洛： 还有——
Gio: And ...

他从外套内掏出一小捆绑起来的钞票，立在桌子上。
He pulls a bundle of notes from inside his jacket and puts it on the table.

酒侍： 干脆又直接……我喜欢跟你这样上道的伙计交朋友。
Bartender: Straight-forward. I like that.

酒侍： 想知道点儿什么？女侍的电话号码、地下拳击赛的门票，又或是哪个混小子惹了一身——
Bartender: So what are you after? The waitress's phone number, ticket to an underground boxing match, or you after someone specific?

喋喋不休的话语令他烦躁不安。
The bartender's idle chatter digs under Gio's skin.

杰洛： 闭上嘴，你这个杂碎！
Gio: You know what I'm after? I'm after you shutting your damned mouth!

侍者被狠狠揪了过去，衣领拧成了皱巴巴一圈。
He yanks the bartender by the collar, pulling him in close as he growls out his next words.

杰洛： 他*的，竖起耳朵听好了，把你的小聪明收起来，我只问一个问题——
Gio: Cut the smart s**t with me and listen, 'cause I'm only going to ask once:

杰洛： 谁——是——J？抬起你的手指，指出来，然后拿着钱滚出我的视线！
Gio: WHERE IS J? Point him out, then get your ass out of my sight!

酒侍： 喔噢，嘿、嘿……！别紧张，伙计，你就算不给小费，我也很乐意帮你这个忙。
Bartender: Whoa, hey, hey! Easy, man! I'd be happy to; you don't even gotta tip me.

酒侍： 那个混账欠了我一屁股的债，我巴不得你能拔下他几颗门牙，再把他揍出*来。
Bartender: That bastard owes me money. So, you can go ahead and beat his ass, throw in a kick for me.

衣领缓缓松开了。
He drops the bartender's collar.

杰洛： 你最好在说实话。
Gio: You'd better not be playing with me, because that's a good way to get cut.

酒侍：我得事先提醒你，他是一个在海特街土生土长的乡巴佬，闭着眼都能在这巷子里，把警察给遛成傻子。
Bartender: But, hey man, little heads up: J was born and raised in Haight Street, and he knows the place better than anyone. Ran circles around the cops. He won't be easy to corner.

酒侍：再加上他结交了不少朋友，在这地界找他麻烦总不是个好主意，你猜不准他那些跟屁虫会从哪里绊你一脚。
Bartender: Plus, he's got a lot of friends around, so picking a fight here could go south fast. Never know who's liable to stand beside him.

在杰洛的面色发青前，他机灵地把话锋一转。
Gio's eyes narrow and dart around the room, but the bartender attempts to change the subject to calm things.

酒侍：但你要我说实话吗？——这混账的世道也是该结束了，让 J 和他那帮跟班见鬼去吧！
Bartender: But you know what I say? The good times are over, so J and all his crew can bite the big one for all I care.

酒侍：你是我见过头一个这么有骨气的家伙，不管你有没有打断他的鼻梁骨——
Bartender: Hey, and uh, just so you know, you're the first one with enough guts to mess with him, so whether you're here to break his nose or ...

酒侍：这杯算我的，朋友。敬你——和你的老板！
Bartender: Well, this shot's on me, bro. To you, and your boss!

子弹杯轻轻碰撞，在共同的仇人面前，酒精成为了友谊的代名词。
The clinking shot glasses at last break the ice, as a wry, wolfish grin escapes Gio's face.

杰洛：呼，你是个有眼力见儿的混账，脑袋还算灵光……我们很缺这样的小伙子。
Gio: Ha, you're a smart ass. We need more people like you.

杰洛：现在尽是一些被街机厅的弹子球和吃角子老虎机搞坏了脑袋的年轻人……你明白，就是那些掏空了老妈的积蓄，跪在门前求份工作的可怜虫。
Gio: Young guys these days are jammed by arcades and slots, you know. These adult children living in their mothers' basements. They ought to be out here begging for a job.

强而有力的手掌搭上了酒侍的肩膀。
A heavy hand lands on the bartender's shoulder.

杰洛：告诉我，伙计，你叫什么名字?
Gio: What's your name, pal?

酒侍：维恩，先生。
Bartender: It's Vern, sir.

杰洛：很高兴认识你，维恩，叫我杰洛。
Gio: Put 'er there, Vern. Call me Gio.

他们手掌相握，这段友谊看上去已经历了数万种考验。
Their hands clasp together in a hearty shake.

杰洛：好了，现在告诉我哪个杂种是 J。等我办完了事，如果你想干一番事业，咱们可以在外面的脂粉街碰头，我去带你通通气儿。
Gio: Alright, now you point me to this J bastard. And afterward, if you're looking to do some hustling, meet me at Rouge Street. I'll take you to the boss.

杰洛：不过，这得由你自己把握——老头最近的脾气捉摸不定，谁也保不准。
Gio: But, uh, mind yourself around him, will ya? The old man's been unpredictable lately. Quick to fly off the handle, you know?

酒侍：谢谢你，先生，不过……
Bartender: Thank you, sir, umm ...

酒侍欲言又止，把头倾了过来。
The bartender moves to speak, tilting his head to one side.

酒侍：原谅我的好奇，先生。但你能告诉我那个混账犯了什么事儿吗?
Bartender: I probably shouldn't pry, but, what do you want from J?

酒侍：如果是为了这地方，据我所知，海特街这地方穷得叮当响，半点油水都捞不着，除了穷鬼还是穷鬼，连那帮假迷三道的骗子都得空手而归……
Bartender: If you wanna take him down over Haight Street, you'll be disappointed. This place's got nothing but struggling folks. You couldn't mug someone for enough to catch the bus.

杰洛：还能是什么？就是那该死的新纪元集市，老头子不知道是着了什么魔，非得掺上一脚。
Gio: What else could it be? That damn New Age Market. Don't know what Pops is planning to do with it, but he's got to have it.

杰洛：我当然对这地方没有半点兴趣，谁会想到在臭水沟里淘金?
Gio: Not like I'd give a damn otherwise. What kinda schmuck does business in a gutter like this?

杰洛：但老头子的态度强硬得很……要按以前，我至少还可以哼一句反调，私底下跟他说几句。可现在，他除了“启明会”的人，谁的话也听不进去。
Gio: But Pops' stubborn about it. Used to be I'd have a say in private, but he don't listen to anyone now except those freaks from the "Order of Enlightenment."

杰洛：搜刮穷人、痛揍哭哭啼啼的娘娘腔……这些就不是什么拿得出台面的事，但当这活儿到了你手里……
Gio: Not that I'm crying about it, but robbing folks who ain't got no money, kicking 'em while they're down ... It don't sit right. But orders are orders.

杰洛：你就只能把自己当成瞎子，或者——
Gio: So, maybe I'll turn a blind eye, when I can.

他退了一步，本能的警惕令他截住了脱口而出的话语。
The grin on his face goes sour, and he scans the bartender's face again.

杰洛：你不该问太多，小子。
Gio: You ask too many questions.

酒侍：抱歉……回到正题吧。你可以往舞池旁边望，瞧见那个穿西装、打领带，打扮得人模人样的家伙了吗?
Bartender: No worries, man. But you were looking for J, right? That guy in the suit, near the dance floor. See him?

话音还未结束，男人已经离开了吧台。
Gio is already up and walking away before the bartender could finish.

跟随者们犹如群狼般，推开人群，往他走向的地方涌去。
His followers join him as he moves, advancing like hungry wolves toward their target.

酒侍：……
Bartender: ...

卑微与谄媚荡然无存，这位牌桌上的赌徒露出了冷静的面孔。
The bartender drops his act, and with it, his smile turns fierce.

片刻，邻座沉默的舞者，也起身了。
At the same moment, the silent woman stands up from another table and makes a graceful exit.

环状水星：J，待会见。
Mercuria: See you later, J.

吧台前的酒侍点了点头。
The bartender responds with an imperceptible nod.

……

...

舞厅
Night Club

虹色的光将一切映衬得如此梦幻。
The technicolor lights cast everything in a dreamy glow.

随着躁动的迪斯科舞曲，男孩女孩们摆动着身姿，全然没发现身旁有一群人正悄然聚拢。
Caught in the ecstasy of the pumping music, the dancers on the floor are unaware of the scene unfolding nearby.

俯下身子的男人屏息着，盯准了猎物。
The lead wolf fixes his gaze on his target and signals to his pack.

杰洛：3、2——1！
Gio: Three, two, one!

他们不约而同地窜了出来，健步如飞地扑了上去。
On his signal, they rush to the well-dressed gentleman.

杰洛：按住他的胳膊儿!
Gio: Hold him down!

如同水牛被豹子扑倒，西装革履的男人狠狠跌倒在地。
In a flurry of action, the gentleman is thrown from his seat down to the ground.

人群受到惊吓，音乐也骤然停了下来。
As the violence erupts, the crowded dance floor freezes, and the music stops on a skip.

???：先生们，这是怎么一回事?!
???: Gentlemen, what is happening here?

杰洛踩在他的肩膀上，俯下身。
Gio steps hard on the gentleman's shoulder, leaning down on him.

他知道这个混球现在已经是任他宰割的猪了。
His face is twisted into a predator's smile.

杰洛：把他的手拧紧点儿——但别掰断了，这才只是一个开始。
Gio: Tie up his hands, but careful you don't break them, for now ...

“牙医”I：是，杰洛先生。
"Dentist" I: Sure thing, Mr. Gio.

他的手掌增强了力度，青筋泛起，接着——
His grip tightens, veins bulging, and then—

“咔嚓。”
cracks

“牙医”I：……?
"Dentist" I: ...?

男人的手掉落在地，如同一只滚落逃走的轮胎。
The gentleman's hand pulls loose from his body, popping up through their grip and rolling across the floor.

杰洛：我他*，你是怎么——嗯?
Gio: What the hell? What's going on with ... Huh?

一只手轻轻敲了敲他的肩膀，他转过身。
An unseen hand taps Gio's shoulder. He turns his head.

“砰!”——重重的拳头撞击下颚。
"Pow!"—A heavy punch strikes him across the jaw.

杰洛：呃!
Gio: Urrh!

J：啧……这么硬。你的下巴是铁疙瘩做的吗?
J: That hurts. You got rocks in your jaw?

他甩甩涨红的手，旋即拉起倒地的假人。
J shakes his bruising hand before extending it down to the mannequin gentleman on the floor.

J：伙计，相信我，你作为诱饵，已经可以钓完整片太平洋了。
J: Trust me, you're the perfect bait. You draw the fishes in like a magnet.

先驱者：——诱饵?!
Pioneer: I'm bait?

先驱者：J，你真是个混球，这是第几次了?!我的灵魂也是有痛觉的!
Pioneer: This is terribly unbecoming of you, J! Do you realize how many times this is? My body may be artificial, but my soul can feel pain, too!

杰洛：……
Gio: ...

杰洛：呵，呸……
Gio: Heh heh. *spit*

他鄙夷地啐了一口鲜血。
Gio spits a gob of red from his bloody mouth.

杰洛：骗子杂种，你果然名不虚传。
Gio: You lying sack of s**t.

同僚们扶起杰洛，他擦拭掉嘴角的红色。
He wipes his hand across his face, as he is helped up by his followers.

与舞池格格不入的人群紧随杰洛身后，犹如一道不断逼近的盾墙。
The lackeys all square up beside their leader.

J：来势汹汹啊，兄弟们。
J: Not so friendly after all, huh?

先驱者：……J，我待会再来算你的账。
Pioneer: We'll continue our conversation later, J.

“哐——”
"Pop—"

挑衅者的匕首飞落在地。
Gio's dagger falls to the ground in a ringing clatter.

J：杰洛先生，你食言了……你没法帮我把那个混账 J 的鼻梁骨打碎。
J: Now, who's lying, Mr. Gio? You took my shot, but you didn't even break that J guy's nose.

J：不过还是谢谢你的引荐，替我向莱格斯先生问好。
J: Still, thanks for the offer. Give my best to Mr. Legers for me.

局势超出了挑衅者的预期，令他开始懊悔最初的鲁莽。
Gio is beat, and he knows it.

杰洛：呵……莱格斯会喜欢你这样的愣头青的，小子。
Gio: Heh. The old man is gonna like you, smart ass.

杰洛：关于新纪元集市，我很期待下次的“和谈”。
Gio: See you next time. We'll have another "parley," you and me.

层层围堵下，他们往后撤着，终于退出了大门。
He falls back toward the door flanked by his lackeys, before making a hasty exit.

贝克特：噗——滚吧，莱格斯的狗崽子们！
Becket: Yeah, yeah, run on home with your tail between your legs. *spit* Legers's losers!

J：现在谁才是“牙医”？谁的牙齿才掉了满地？！
J: Looks like he might need a "Dentist," 'cause he just got kicked in the teeth!

J：全垒打！朋友们，咱们让他们摔了个大跟头！
J: They'll be home crying into their cereal soon enough! Haha!

J：呵……这帮家伙跑得比我四缸的蜂鸟 G-R8100 都要快上一百倍，我发誓他们如果不干“牙医”这一行，指定都是旧金山田径队的好苗子。
J: The way they're hoofing it, they coulda outran my 4-cylinder Hummingbird G-R8100. They must have missed their calling. They ain't dentists. They're track stars.

欢呼声溢满舞厅，烧烫了的水也不如他们沸腾。
The dance hall breaks into jeering laughter.

人们从狼藉中捡起酒瓶，不约而同地举了起来。
Bottles are raised and cheers made in recognition of their triumph.

贝克特：哈哈……祝我们的友谊胜过狗的忠诚！
Becket: Hahaha. Cheers! To unbreakable bonds!

众人：祝友谊胜过狗的忠诚！
All: To unbreakable bonds!

人们互相搀扶着交杯，舞厅里重新放起了音乐。
After a cascade of clinking glasses, the music is spun up once more, and the club returns to their dancing.

沸腾延续了很久，直到一位灰头土脸的年轻人凑了过来。
The excitement continues for some time after, only being broken by the arrival of a disheveled looking young man.

霍利克：你瞧，J——我得先走了，救济大厅的门再晚一些就要关了……
Hollick: Look, J, I gotta go. The shelter's gonna be closing up soon.

霍利克：我修车铺的合伙人……你知道的——
Hollick: My partner at the shop, you know ...

他沾满黑油的手指揉着鼻子，鼻血已经干硬在了嘴唇上。
He rubs his stained-black fingers across his face, shaking off some flakes of drying blood.

霍利克：他不喜欢我挂了彩的脸，说会吓走那些开好车的客人。
Hollick: He doesn't like it when I come in covered with blood, scares the richie-rich types away.

人们知道时间已经不早了。
It is getting late.

命运只是在这一刻垂下了它的头颅。
The celebratory atmosphere wears thin and tired as more people leave.

J：没事……没事，哥们儿，是我该谢谢你们，如果有什么我能帮上忙的——
J: It's all good, bro. Thanks for coming today. If there's anything I can help ...

J 拍拍他的肩膀，抱住了他。
J pats his friend on the shoulder before pulling him into a hug.

J：J 永远忠于你们。
J: You know where to go.

霍利克吸了吸鼻子，把手挽在了 J 的脖子上。
Hollick sniffs, returning the hug with a tight squeeze.

霍利克：没问题，J，我接受你的好意——
Hollick: Heh-heh. Thanks, bro. But, if you're really such a good friend ...

霍利克：我……正好看中了一辆敞篷的野马 M3，最近我的手头有点紧，你应该能从口袋里掏出个几百万美金给我解解馋吧?
Hollick: How about you spot me, a quarter mil- or so, so I can buy that sweet new convertible Lamberrari LM50. Since we're such good buddies, right?

J：去你*的，我就知道，哈哈哈哈……
J: Yeah, sure thing, buddy, right after I give you a knuckle sandwich, hahahaha.

霍利克：哈哈哈哈哈哈，再见——再见，J。
Hollick: Hahahaha, see you around, J!

随着他的离开，其余的人也纷纷向 J 招呼了过来。
Waving off the mostly gentle giant, the rest of the group gathers around J.

今天这帮势不可挡的老伙计，是最骄傲的命运之父。
Spirits are still high as they bask in today's victory.

但明天，他们依旧得埋下头，干一份糊口的活计。
But tomorrow, they must get back to work.

此时，角落之中，一个身影也终于踉踉跄跄地走了出来。
The moment shifts as a stumbling dummy drives a playful kick into J's leg.

先驱者：把我的手还给我，可恶的家伙!
Pioneer: Would you kindly give me back my damn hand already?

J：噢，别、别踹我——马上还给你!
J: Hey, stop kicking me! Just a sec!

先驱者：呼呼……
Pioneer: *panting*

先驱者：咳、咳……抱歉，我刚才似乎有些失礼。
Pioneer: M-my apologies. Where were my manners?

先驱者：希望你没往心里去，但我也得警告你，这事——
Pioneer: Please don't take it personally, but I need to warn you that ...

J：喔，不对……等等，等等！咱们是不是还少了一个人?
J: Whoa, wait, wait! Someone's missing.

灯球仍在旋转，理应有人表演的舞台上却空无一人。
The disco ball continues its spin over the empty dance floor.

J: 环状水星呢?!……嘿，斯普特尼克女士，你知道她去哪了吗?
J: Where's Mercuria? Hey, Ms. Sputnik, have you seen her?

头顶的灯球，僵硬地转过身。
His eyes fix on the shining ball, which stops then descends from the ceiling to speak.

斯普特尼克: 噢，您在找环状水星女士吗？她刚才拾起匕首，看上去很匆忙地离开了。
Sputnik: Oh, Ms. Mercuria? She left in a hurry, carrying that dagger those rough-type gentlemen dropped.

先驱者: 呃，我们需要跟上去吗……?
Pioneer: Do we follow her?

J: 不，当然不用。
J: No, of course not.

J: 你我都知道，她就是这么一个人。
J: She's just doing her thing.

他望着空无一人的舞台，耸了耸肩。
He shrugs, looking out past the door.

肮脏巷道
Grimy Alleyway

跑、奔跑……他踉跄着，频繁地回望那长巷，气喘吁吁。
Gio stumbles. He catches his breath before glancing back through the long alleyway.

杰洛: 该、该死……哈、哈呼……老头子可没告诉我们，这里比蜂窝还闹腾……
Gio: *panting* S**t! The old man didn't tell us what kind of mess we were in for here!

杰洛: 他的筹码显然给少了。
Gio: I'm not paid enough for this.

杰洛: 呼……
Gio: *panting*

杰洛: ?!
Gio: ?!

环状水星: 你好，先生。
Mercuria: Hey. Gio, right?

他怔住了，雕塑般僵在了原地。
He stands unmoving, unblinking.

杰洛: 刀把……
Gio: You're just giving it back?

杰洛: 真是可笑，你追过来就是为了侮辱我?!
Gio: What's this meant to be, some kinda insult?

杰洛: 很好。我只是谈判不成功，并不是失去了尊严……狂妄的女人!
Gio: Hey, y-your boss runs me off, now you're giving me back my own knife, like I'm some pity case? Think I won't hurt you 'cause you're a woman? Think again, b***h.

愤怒覆盖了恐惧，驱使着他本能地挥舞手臂。
Anger overtakes his wariness of the woman, and he swings out his arm.

“叮——”
"Clink—"

匕首被甩飞在地，从口袋中，他的术杖露出了尖。
The dagger drops to the ground as he reaches into his pocket, producing a wand.

杰洛： 蚀肉剜心！
Gio: Vita Void!

环状水星： 唔……
Mercuria: Umm ...

环状水星： 这是什么？
Mercuria: What is this?

黑色的术式轨迹刚触碰到她的身躯，便溃散在空中。
The black arcane symbols dissolve in the air as soon as they touch her.

环状水星： 黑黝黝的，就像 J 在铁匠炉里烤的甜甜圈……我还从没见过这样的能量，先生。
Mercuria: The color of your energy is as dark as the coal in J's forge, no, worse, darker than I've ever seen before.

她跳下铁门，拾起了匕首。
She jumps down from the fence and picks up the dagger.

环状水星： 你……很害怕，但在害怕之中，还夹杂着一些像火焰一样的色环，它焚烧屋子，将一切都变为灰烬。
Mercuria: You're afraid. But something else besides that, I see a burning energy—the embers of a home reduced to ashes.

环状水星： 它贯穿了你生活的始终。于是你的妻子和孩子离家出走，欠债人在众目睽睽之下对你卑躬屈膝。
Mercuria: A harrowing darkness that's followed you throughout your life, when your wife and child left you, when your debtors begged on their knees at your feet.

杰洛： ……！你、你在说些什么？
Gio: W-what're you talking about?

环状水星： 啊……我明白了，先生，你以这些富有侵略性的黑色能量为生。
Mercuria: Huh, I understand you now, Mr. Gio. Forced to live with this darkness inside you.

环状水星： ……唔。
Mercuria: Hmm.

她陷入了沉思。
She seems lost in her own thoughts.

环状水星： 请别见怪。我只是来提醒你……先生，你忘了这个。
Mercuria: I'm sorry if I scared you, but I'm only here to return this.

匕首被轻轻放入了大衣口袋，寒意也降临在他身上。
She delicately places the dagger into his coat pocket. He shivers as if hit by a chill wind.

环状水星： 这副坚韧的血肉之躯中，似乎正蜷缩着一位瑟瑟发抖的男孩。
Mercuria: You're a boy trembling inside this brawny shell of a man.

环状水星： 全因你正在迈向一条你并不想涉足的道路，杰洛先生。
Mercuria: You're too far down a path that you never wanted to set foot on, Mr. Gio.

杰洛： ……
Gio: ...

环状水星：如果你需要帮助，请随时来新纪元集市找我。
Mercuria: If you need help, find me in the New Age Market.

环状水星：哼♫哼♪……
Mercuria: *humming*

她轻唱着乐曲，跃动着脚步，缓缓走向了来时的肮脏长巷。
She hums softly, her steps light as she walks back from the dingy alley.

男人呆站在原地，神思恍惚，直到野猫跳到了他的肩头。
The man stands in place, lost in her words, until an alley cat leaps over his shoulder.

恍然间，他想起第一次开枪，浑身鲜血与脑浆，躲在厕所里颤抖的午夜。
In his daze, he recalls the first time he fired a gun, the blood and brain matter, and the trembling midnight he spent hiding in the bathroom after.

杰洛：呕……！
Gio: *pukes*

娱乐不至死 · 1/2
Won't Be Amused to Death · 1/2 FT-02

唐老爹餐馆
Tang's Restaurant

霍利克：……所以，等我卸下来轮胎，就对集市里那位忧心忡忡又阔绰的太太说——
Hollick: So as I take off the tire, I notice the gal, some rich lady from the market's got a crazy look of worry on her face.

霍利克：“您大可去整个海特街打听打听 J 和他的朋友，如果我有半点假话，就让那帮敲诈你的家伙打断我的下巴。”
Hollick: So I tell her, "Break my jaw if I'm telling a lie. We're good folks here. Don't believe me? Just ask around about 'J and his friends' on Haight Street"!

吧台上，醉醺醺的修车汉摇摇晃晃，煞有介事地吆喝着。
At the bar, the drunken mechanic sways unsteadily, bellowing out his story.

勤劳的圆形酒保，匆匆擦干桌上的酒渍。
The diligent satellite, now serving as a bartender, hovers close, wiping up spilled drinks from the table.

斯普特尼克：还请、请小心，霍利克先生……您不该再喝了。
Sputnik: P-please take care, Mr. Hollick. You have been drinking way too much.

贝克特：哈哈哈哈，得了吧，霍利克。你才没那么有种。
Becket: Hahaha, come on, Hollick, you don't get the balls.

贝克特：J 可以替我作证，昨天你小子也就鼻子见了点儿血，就像个打完针的胆小鬼一样哭哭啼啼的——
Becket: I saw this guy get a nose bleed yesterday, and he cried like a little baby. Back me up, J!

他用肘关节戳着一旁的男人，但对方毫无反应。
He jabs J with his elbow, but J fails to react.

贝克特：嘿……J?
Becket: Hey, J?

J：……什、什么?
J: W-what?

贝克特：这可不像你，有什么事还能把你的魂儿从钱眼里勾走?
Becket: Did they bust your head or something? You're off daydreaming while we're talking about some rich bimbo.

先驱者：抱歉，贝克特先生……J 可能有些事还没想清楚，你知道的……关于“死人莱格斯”。
Pioneer: Sorry, Mr. Becket. I believe J's present concerns may be revolving around, you know, "Legers the Dead."

J：噢，那你可是大错特错了，朋友！我才没在想那档子事儿！
J: Nah, way off, Stuffed Shirt!

J：喏，抬头。
J: Take a look.

先驱者：“绝对‘爆炸性’新闻：秘密录像，真空弹恐将成为新的行刑手段?”——呃，当今好莱坞的天才们已经这么疯狂了吗?
Pioneer: "'Bombshell' News: Uncovered Video Shows FAE Used as New Execution Method?" Hmm, what will the minds of those Hollywood producers think of next?

环状水星：我也曾见过这个奇怪视频的画面……在被删除的垃圾邮件、报纸的中缝广告插画里。
Mercuria: Oh, I think I've seen images from this video, from spam mail and newspapers.

洋葱头：……我们仍在找寻这名身中真空弹的女性，以证实视频的真实性，如若您有独家消息，可致电：429-7234-7……
ONiON: We're still trying to identify this woman to confirm the authenticity of the video. If you have any information, please call us at 429-7234 ext. 7 ...

洋葱头：让我们来到下一则新闻——久无音讯的亲人归家，却无人相认，这是一场群体癔症，还是盗取遗产继承权的阴谋?
ONiON: Up Next: Homebound or Hoodwinked? The Mystery of the So-Called Long-Lost Son!

洋葱头：近日，一位陌生男性突然拜访退役士兵埃顿先生的家。
ONiON: We turn to the story of Sgt. Howard Eden, a retired army veteran, and the stranger claiming to be his long-lost son.

洋葱头：据埃顿先生称，该名男子冒充自己离家出走的儿子，并在他的膝下痛哭流涕。接下来，就让我们——呲呲呲呲……
ONiON: But, is this a heartwarming reunion or a sinister story of senior exploitation? Let's ... *static noise*

老旧的电视机传来了寿终正寝的残喘。
The old television emits dying sputters of static before cutting out entirely.

众人：噢呜……!
All: Awww!

先驱者：唉，我还想听她继续说点儿有意思的胡话。
Pioneer: Oh, too bad. You know, it's good fun watching all her nonsense and sensationalism.

贝克特：嘿，严肃点！就算这档节目曾预言“土拨鼠将占领地球”，但说不定其他“胡话”里有真事儿呢?!
Becket: Hey, show some respect! Sure, that whole "How Woodchucks Could Control the World" piece she did was a little iffy, but—who knows what those woodchucks could chuck at us?

J：……
J: ...

J：不过，伙计们……
J: Alright.

J: 我确实在琢磨死人莱格斯那档子事儿，他是……什么来头?
J: That Legers thing is really bothering me, okay? What's his story?

醉倒的修车汉打了一个激灵，像位被点名的士兵抬起了头。
The drunk mechanic jolts awake and upright with renewed excitement.

霍利克: 我、我听过……那是一个了不得的家伙，警察的眼中钉，地痞流氓眼中的……呃，T-800!
Hollick: I've heard it. Not gonna lie. Kinda sick. Cops hate him, but the street punks love him!

霍利克: 当时，就在猎人角的那片烂木头林里，有一群人把莱格斯当猪一样宰!
Hollick: They say back in Hunters Point, a bunch of guys was torturing him, had him tied up like a pig.

霍利克: 到最后，他们折磨得腻歪了，就赏了他的脑袋几发子弹——呜，太可怕了，就是拿枪顶着嗓子眼儿……“啪”一下从喉头，直穿过后脑勺!
Hollick: And when they got tired, they put a gun in his mouth and made him eat it. The bullet went straight through his throat out the back of his head!

霍利克: 结果，等警察来了，除了一地沾了血的牙齿，连半根头发都没找见。
Hollick: But, when the cops came, they found nothing but a few bloody teeth. He was gone!

霍利克: 唔……真是太吓人，你们知道吗? 莱格斯可是一个彻头彻尾的人类!
Hollick: Scary, right? But here's the thing, yeah, Legers is a pure human! So, what happened? Where did he go?

他绘声绘色，指挥家般挥动着毛发旺盛的手臂，最尽职的演员亦不过如此。
He waves his arms dramatically, animated and almost cartoonish in his performance.

但理智的批评家总是无处不在。
But his audience is less than captivated.

先驱者: ……霍利克先生，你是不是最近看了《活死人出没》? 死而复生是好莱坞的陈词滥调，你不应把它套在现实生活里。
Pioneer: Mr. Hollick, I think you've been watching too many of those horrible Romero movies. People returning from the dead, that's hokey cinema, not reality.

霍利克被戳中了要害，面红耳赤。
Hollick goes red, unable to form any defense.

先驱者: 我们理应考虑其他的可能性，比如——谋划已久的谣传。借助这则耸人听闻的传言，他的组织能吸引来更多臭名昭著的神秘学家……
Pioneer: I can only assume this "Legers the Dead" made up this rumor himself, perhaps so he might attract more powerful arcanists to his side.

先驱者: 从魔药瘾君子、走私犯到赌场操盘手……也正因如此，他才能一步步蚕食旧金山。
Pioneer: Potion addicts, smugglers, card sharks ... Getting them all under his thumb until he can gobble up the whole of San Francisco.

霍利克: 直到他踢到了我们这块儿钢板!
Hollick: And yeah, it's been working. But not anymore, 'cause we ain't gonna sit and watch!

先驱者: ……我们恐怕不是钢板，先生。这场对峙将会比我们此前碰见过的所有，都要危险……况且他们已经与正盘踞在“新纪元集市”的那帮疯子搭上了肩。
Pioneer: Afraid you're overestimating our strength, Mr. Hollick. Their enterprise is much more dangerous than all our previous rivals. No less so if they're aiming on partnering up with the lunatics in the New Age Market.

环状水星： 是的……已经连续几天没人参加我的冥想会。大家都簇拥在他们身旁，聚拢着一股……令我不安的喜悦。
Mercuria: Gotta agree with that assessment, Pioneer. It's been days since my last session with a paying customer. Seems like everyone is joining up with them, and their energy is disturbing, to say the least.

环状水星： 他们一直在到处打探消息，试图搜集一些闻所未闻的材料与书籍……
Mercuria: They've been poking around my shop, looking for some rare sort of books and materials, kinds I never even heard of before.

先驱者： 正面冲突在当下是最愚蠢的选择……J?
Pioneer: I would advise avoiding direct confrontation, J.

J: ……我在听。
J: I hear you.

这是他不多有的沉默。
It is a rare moment of calm consideration for their hotheaded leader.

J: 我们当然会绕开与他们的直接交锋，伙计……但你我都知道这不现实，选择权并不在我们手里。
J: Avoid confrontation, that's the right move for sure. But it's not gonna be possible. They aren't giving us a choice.

J: 况且，海特街早就被那帮伪善的警察们抛之脑后……除了我们，谁会管这条街的死活?
J: The cops abandoned Haight Street a long time ago. Ain't nobody that cares about these streets but us now.

J: 先是流浪艺术家们的拖车营被烧毁，接着是一群占卜师连夜离开……而那帮疯子，却盘踞并扎下了根，无辜的神秘学家们受到蛊惑，秩序分崩离析……
J: Remember? That was when all those artists' trailers were burnt down. After that, the rest of the diviners and such were run off quick. It's only those loonies that have stuck around, misguiding arcanists, making everything worse.

他环视着众人。
He looks to his friends.

J: 我们当然该逃，我们应该关门大吉，然后买头一班火车票……就像在听见邻居的女人被混账揍得哀嚎时，大惊失色，然后逃之夭夭。
J: If we were smart, we would have left then and there! Closed up shop, took the first bus out of this city, and ran for our miserable, pathetic lives.

J: 但我们没有，不是吗?
J: But then, we ain't that kind of smart, are we?

J: 况且，我们站在这里，也不是因为什么狗屁勇敢，而仅仅是因为——这是我们的家。
J: But, this is our home, so we've gotta make our stand here or we'll never stop running.

一旁的假人欲言又止——
The mannequin next to him speaks, broaching his words carefully.

先驱者： J，你误会了我的意思，我是说这已远超乎了我们的能力范畴。我们最好找——
Pioneer: Please, don't misunderstand me, J. I'm only saying: this fight is beyond our capabilities alone. Should we not consider ask- ...

J: 停——！伙计！
J: Uh-uh-uh, don't you finish that thought. In fact, don't even think it!

他就像听见了一位十年未见的穷朋友突如其来的寒暄，立马敏锐地打断了话头。
The sharpness of his tone is clear. The idea is beyond consideration, not to be touched on—not even to be breathed.

J：我知道你想说什么，但你也发怵得太快了。用不着什么都扯上他们吧?
J: Look, I know what you're saying, but, I don't know, man. That kind of talk is for cowards. We don't have to get them involved in this.

先驱者：你得承认，他们虽然爱打官腔一些，但他们对神秘学家的事总是会很上心。
Pioneer: You have to admit that they care about arcanists, despite all their bureaucracy.

先驱者：J，基金会对我们而言，并非是一个差劲的选择。
Pioneer: Turning to the Foundation would not be a bad choice for us, J.

一阵恰到好处的沉默。
A perfectly timed silence.

吧台之下，圆溜溜的酒保探出了脑袋。
From beneath the bar, the round bartender floats up as if peeking.

斯普特尼克：是的，J 先生……我赞同先驱者先生的意见——同时，我、我也不想因为那些匪徒而失去现在的好工作。
Sputnik: Yes, Mr. J. I think Mr. Pioneer might be right. I don't want to lose my job because of these bandits.

斯普特尼克：……我很乐意替您指路！
Sputnik: I'll be glad to bring you to the Foundation!

先驱者：谢谢您，灯球女士，有您的帮助就再好不过了。
Pioneer: Your assistance would be more than welcome, Ms. Disco Ball.

先驱者：而且，J，保利娜就在圣洛夫基金会。你明白……说不定你妹妹会为你走走人情，省去一些——流程上的麻烦。
Pioneer: It couldn't possibly hurt to reach out to Paulina. Maybe she could help us with the red tape. She's your sister, after all.

J 挪开了视线，就像躲开问题的孩子。
J looks away and huffs audibly. It's a childish, almost silly, display.

J：不不，我得再跟你声明一遍，这是**我们**自己的事儿。
J: **No, no, no. I'm only gonna say this once, and it's for real: This is our OWN business. Nobody else's, especially not hers.**

J：她决定加入那帮白袍子的时候，甚至都没跟我事先聊过一句话——我们已经有好多年没见过面了。
J: Paulina made her choice. She could've talked with me, she could have approached us, if that's what she wanted. She had the chance. She's had years, not a word.

J：她说她有自己的路子要走，当然也说话算话，从没有回过头。
J: She "has her own life," and she made it out of these streets. She ain't coming back. She ain't even looking back.

J：她不喜欢咱们，你明白吗？即便她是我唯一的家人，但她就爱那些大理石地砖，爱高高在上的品味，爱那份所谓的整洁与体面——
J: She's not that little girl tagging around us anymore. She's got fancy marble floors now, got all that "decency" and "good taste" that she never had here.

J：她早就不是以前那个追着我们打闹的小家伙了。
J: She doesn't need us.

J：你要我现在去求她帮忙，看她的冷眼，还不如让我赤身裸体跟你一块儿站在百货大楼的橱窗里。
J: You think I'm gonna scrape down on my knees for her? Ha, I'd rather stick my foot in hot slag. Least that way I'd have one leg to stand on.

先驱者：别这样，认真考虑下我们的建议吧。这跟我给商人的交税建议没什么不同——这些办法可都算省事、轻松。
Pioneer: J, please, just give it some thought. This may be the only way for all of us to survive this.

J：——呃，我要去拿一瓶汽水！
J: Er, I need a drink!

他喃喃着离开了吧台，逃离现场的速度堪比一只被踩中尾巴的小狗。
He mumbles and steps away from the bar.

“砰。”——但谁也没料到，一个矮小的身影不偏不倚地撞在了他的裆下。
"Crash."—But as he does, a darting figure collides into him at an unfortunate angle for the both of them.

J：噢！有什、么……东西撞到我的——
J: AH! Something just hit me in ... my ...

他直立的身躯瞬间萎靡，跪倒在地。
He crumples over, wincing with pain.

紧接着，一堆硬币撒落下来。
As he collapses, a handful of coins tumbles to the floor.

???：糟糕……快跑！
???: Shoot. Run!

慌乱的脚步声从吧台钻出。
The small boy makes a panicked sprint from behind the bar.

圆形酒保恍然意识到了什么。
The round bartender stammers out a revelation.

斯普特尼克：J 先生，吧台里的零钱——全都不见了！
Sputnik: Mr. J, all the money in the bar is, ah, how is it you're saying, "gone"!

J：快、快，呜……抓住那个小偷！
J: Ca- ... urgh ... Catch that kid!

被退回的信件
Returned to Sender 小径

被退回的信件
Returned to Sender

简中
4 月 3 日
嘿，我打听到你刚到圣洛夫基金会的老窝。
我猜，你肯定对他们表面端着架子，实则半吊子的事实大失所望，哈哈哈。
近况还好吗？ 一切都还好？
回见，等你好消息，小家伙。

4 月 20 日
霍利克准备攒钱开一家修理铺，那伙计的头脑终于开点窍了。
我还没收到你的回信，保利娜，如果你把信丢进垃圾桶或者烧光了，记得跟邮差说一声，省得我再继续浪费这些纸。
他们是不是让你忙得焦头烂额？餐馆随时欢迎你回来。
照顾好自己，小家伙。

……

English
April 3rd

Hey, I heard you just arrived at the old headquarters of the St. Pavlov Foundation

I bet you're disappointed by how they put on airs while talking so crass, ha-ha.

How have you been? Everything alright?

Talk soon, waiting for your good news, kiddo.

April 20th

Hollick is saving up to open a repair shop; the guy's finally coming to his senses.

I still haven't got your reply, Polly. If you threw my letter in the trash or burned it, let the mailman know so I don't have to keep wasting paper.

Are they keeping you so busy that you're at your wit's end? The restaurant's always ready to have you back.

Take care of yourself, kiddo.

……

宇宙禅
Cosmic Zen 小径

???: 让我们把时间倒回到几年前。
Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.

选项 / Choices

1. 为什么要倒回到几年前?
1. Why a few years ago?

2. 我要前进到未来
2. I want to move to the future.

分支 / Branch 1

???: 因为这对你有好处。你眼前正躺着一个充满谜团的姑娘，她弄得你晕头转向。你抓耳挠腮，试图理解到底发生了什么。
It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.

???: 而这该死的一切，要从很久很久以前，从猴子决定使用双脚站立开始说起……
And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...

分支 / Branch 2

???: 太棒了！你身上这种拳击手一样的壮志雄心正是我们所需要的。但很遗憾，我不能带你前往未来。不，我本来可以，但现在不能。
Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.

???: 现在要做这件事的，另有其人。
在解开这个大谜团之前，我认为我们有必要先梳理眼前的主要矛盾——
Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—

???: 相信我，你不会因为得知了这个故事而感到后悔。
Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.

选项 / Choices

1. 好了，开始胡扯吧
1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.

2. 不，我已经厌倦你了
2. No. I'm tired of you.

分支 / Branch 2.1

???: 你的幽默从来不会令我反感。好了，过去的时光正等着我们回望。
I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.

???: 20 世纪初的一个冬日，雨阴沉沉地下个没完，西杰克逊大道的广场上堆满了人。这里有一座意大利文艺复兴风格的宗座圣殿。你很少见到这么多的人聚在一起却不吭一声。
It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.

???: 这是一场黑色的追思弥撒。主祭者唱诵安魂弥撒曲，参加葬礼的人们在胸口划着十字圣号。
This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.

选项 / Choices

1. 逝者一定是个受敬仰的人
1. He must be respectable.

2. 逝者或许是个有权势的人
2. He might be powerful.

分支 / Branch 2.1.1

???: “他是神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”一位黑袍妇女转过来对你低语道。
"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.

分支 / Branch 2.1.2

???: “什么是权势?”一位肃穆的女士朝你摇了摇头，“世上只有上主能除免我们的罪孽，能评判我们的是非，但他不要权与势。”
"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."

???: “葬礼的主人也是如此。他是我们的神父。他为一位世罪者奉献……主会赐予他永恒的安息。”
"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."

???: 她把头转回去了。解释这些令她感到不满。参加葬礼的队伍越来越长，广场填满了高低不一的咏唱。
She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.

???: 格雷克一家也在其中。长柄雨伞像乌云一样罩在他们身上，很快，他们的声音就被呜咽声取代了。你很难分辨出他们脸上的表情是欣慰还是悲伤。但你没见着斯奈德的身影。
The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.

选项 / Choices

1. 她在哪儿?

1. Where is she?

???: 顺着格雷克先生断掉的左掌的方向看过去，对，就是那块被绷带包裹的地方。
Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.

???: 在距离人群 3390 英尺的位置，是教堂的背阴处，那里站着你想见的那个女孩。
3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.

???: 她面色苍白，身形瘦小，就像刚从一场大病中康复。
She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.

???: 但她拳头紧握，眼中拧着一把火，在和无处不在的歌声对抗。你不知道她为什么看起来那么——那么愤怒。她现在，有十一岁吗?
But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?

???: 而弥撒也即将迎来最后的高潮。雨越来越大了。主祭者的手高高指向天空：“愿主与你们同在。”
And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."

???: “也与你的心灵同在。”斯奈德用几乎微不可闻的声音回应到。她的手紧紧握住胸膛。这是她第一次对主回应，也将是最后一次。
"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

分支 / Branch 2.2

???: 但我永远不会厌倦你，宝贝。
But I will never be tired of you, baby.

???: 我尊重你的决定。当你准备好接受一个故事，去寻找你的同伴。他们会告诉你究竟发生了什么。
I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.

???: ……而我会在下一个目的地谦逊且忠诚地等待你。
... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选

Excerpt from the New York Times

简中

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪

瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

English

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.

The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.

On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

好莱坞商务

Hollywood Shenanigans 小径

???: 你们看起来很紧张，你们都知道将有大事发生。

You look nervous, and you all know something's gonna happen.

???: 用你们——那个、那个充满了古怪想法的脑瓜——你们冥冥之中能感受到这个，这是你们的特殊能力，和敏感的神经、充沛的情绪一同来的能力。

With your—that ... the brains full of weird ideas—somehow you can feel it. It's your special talent. The talent comes together with your sensitive nerves and rich emotions.

???: 事情混乱起来，新朋友与老朋友一个个到场，然后，你们都在这儿了。

Things are getting messy. New friends and old friends showed up one after another. And, here you are.

???: 一道雾气就地升起，把黑与白隔开，就像是隔开两群斗犬。它们在两侧的空间内团团地转，露出的獠牙几乎要撕碎自己的尾巴。

Fog rises. It separates the black and the white, just like separating two groups of bulldogs. They're turning around and around, revealing their fangs as if they're trying to tear their own tails apart.

选项 / Choices

1. 雾气之内发生了什么?
1. What happened inside the fog?

2. 雾气之外发生了什么?
2. What happened outside the fog?

3. 这道雾气是什么?
3. What is the fog?

分支 / Branch 1

???: 问得很好，亲爱的。让我们一起看看这儿，就你的脚下——
Good question, my dear. Let's take a look here, right under your feet—

???: 你在重塑之手的地盘上行走，在他们眼皮子下偷去了红羽毛与血渍里的斯奈德，又对着那漂亮的德鲁伊窃窃私语。
You walked in the area controlled by Manus Vindictae. You stole Schneider under their noses—that little girl who bathed in red feathers and blood. And you whispered to that pretty Druid.

???: 而你的敌人手脚一样也称不上干净。瞧瞧这些木箱子，所有人都饿得快死了，可这里头只有棉花，棉花，还是棉花。
And your rivals are no better people than you are. Look at those wooden supply boxes. People are starving, but the only thing inside is cotton, and cotton, and cotton.

???: 黄油、面粉、蔗糖，甜美的一切好东西在黑狗的手上一转就奔向了芝加哥。但没关系，棉花一样能填满肚子。
Butter, flour, sugar, and everything sweet were intercepted and sent to Chicago, thanks to those black dogs. But that's alright, cotton will feed you too.

???: 来，跟我来，往那儿看，往空气里蓄满了泪水的地方看，有母亲正抱着她昏迷的孩子啜泣，她的孩子正在死去，而贵族老爷夫人们还在担心绸缎，担心宝石弄上了这儿的泥巴。
Come on. Follow me and look. Look at the place where the air becomes humid because tears are shed. Here's a sobbing mother, with an infant in her arms. Her child is dying, while those nobles are worrying about their silk clothing, checking if their jewelry gets stained with mud.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 是的，你该这么问的。你已经很久没出去过了，他们的故事对你来说尽是未知。如果我是你，我也会一样好奇。
Yes, of course you'd wonder. You haven't been out there for so long that you know nothing about them or their stories. I'd be as curious if I were you.

???: 圣洛夫基金会里的聪明人和你一样察觉到了重塑之手的行动，他们一面拦截运输，一面向着迷雾逼近。
The smarties in the Foundation also noticed what Manus Vindictae has done. They stopped the transportation team while approaching the fog.

???: 你穿黑西服的小姑娘已经回到了你所安排的地方，他们把她安顿得很好。
The girl in the black suit has returned to where you asked her to be. They take good care of her.

???: 而你那忠诚的漂亮朋友正为了你奋战，她身边带着那个吵闹的摇滚女孩儿、头脑灵活的小伙子以及一枚红果子。
And your loyal, beautiful friend is fighting for you, together with that easily startled rocking girl, the quick-thinking boy, and a red fruit.

???: 她正要来救你，她为你穿过一道道战斗的沟壑，就像是王子穿过沉睡之城的荆棘，就像是奇迹的小狗撕咬着拉出火海里的主人。
She's on her way to save you. She overcomes one obstacle after another, like a prince crossing the thorny land of a sleeping castle, like a legend puppy gripping its owner's clothes and pulling him from a flaming fire.

分支 / Branch 3

???: 有趣的选择。这很符合你的身份，小怪胎。
You picked an interesting question, as interesting as yourself, little freak.

???: 你有一个与众不同的脑袋，里面装着与众不同的东西。这不是坏处，保持这一点，常常使用它。
You do have a distinguished brain, with so many distinguished things inside. It's not bad. Keep that. Use it more often.

???: 让我们回到你的问题，雾气——关于雾气，毫无疑问的，那个酒馆老板制作了它。就像是调酒那样，加点这个，加点那个，大坩埚搅几下，想要的东西自然出现。
Let's go back to your question. The fog—no doubt it's created by the barkeeper. It's like bartending, put this in, put that in, stir them in a crucible, and you get what you want.

???: 它有迷雾该有的效果，比如遮挡视线、隐藏秘密、阻碍进出者的速度。也有迷雾所不有的效用，像是致幻、涌动的毒素，让人永远迷失在雾中的、在地图上从未记载的岔路。
It works like real fog; it blocks eyesight, hides secrets, and slows down those who wanna get in or get out. It also works differently from the real fog, for it is hallucinating, intoxicating, and getting people forever lost at the mysterious fork roads.

???: 他是个精明的家伙，也很阴险。但是哪儿都不缺聪明人，尤其是这种场合。
He is shrewd and insidious. But smart guys are everywhere, especially now and here.

???: 我们要做的是等。等。等下去。
但不等太久，那样就犯傻了，知道吗，适当地等-等一等！
What we have to do is wait. Wait. Wait for it.
But not for too long, that'd be stupid. You know, a proper wait—wait for it!

???: 一场好戏就要上演了，你将看到有史以来最为盛大的表演！哦，当然，你也可以去，去站在正中间，然后带着你的漂亮箱子，撑起一把伞，摆足了场面地耍帅斗狠。
The show is about to begin. You'll see the most magnificent performance of all time! Oh, of course, you can join it, stand in the center, bring your pretty suitcase, hold your umbrella, and give us a badass fight.

???: 等着瞧吧，黑狗与白狗间的隔板再撑不了多久，这儿逃不过撕咬，逃不过见血。
Wait and see. The fog between black dogs and white dogs won't last for long. You can't turn away from those biting, tearing, and bleeding.

???: 拿好你的爆米花，亲爱的。
然后——坐稳、扶好，你可能会哭，也可能不会，我他*也不在乎。
Grab your popcorns, my love.
Then sit tight, hold still. You may cry, or may not. I don't give a f**k.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

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于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪

瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

English

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.

The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.

On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

《我们会活下去》

"We Will Survive" 小径

《我们会活下去》

"We Will Survive"

简中

就都滚吧，都滚到外面去，
请现在就转身，
既然你已有了新生活，
你不喜欢海特街的一砖一瓦，
难道这是我的错？

你以为海特街离了你会活不下去，
哦不，我们会活下去。
我们会像个大家庭一样活下去，
我们会过上更好的生活，
我们在泥泊里打滚也会活下去，
我们会活下去……

English

Just leave, all of you.
Please turn around right now.
Since you have a new life.
You don't like a single brick of Haight Street.
Is that my fault?
You think Haight Street can't survive without you?
Oh no, we will survive.
We will survive like a big family.
We will live better lives.
Even if we must struggle, we will go on living.
We will survive ...

复杂的部分
This Is Hard 小径

???: 不，你还没醒。现在你还在这片粘稠的、流动的、黑色蝼蚁的冥想世界里。
No, you are not awake yet. You are still drowned in this mire of meditation—sticky, swampy, and dark.

选项 / Choices

1. 这里是哪儿?
1. Where am I?

2. 我在记忆里?
2. Is this my memory?

分支 / Branch 1

???: 哪儿也不是，你这好奇心爆棚的潘朵拉。这儿可能是一片汪洋、一口井，是无名指的下缘……随便你怎么理解。
Welcome to nihility, Ms. Too Many Questions. You might be in an ocean, a well, the base of a ring finger ... whatever.

???: 在经历了一场“热烈邀请”后，你的腿上带了一点霉菌般的淤青——草履虫们觉得这能让你屈服。
At that "warm invitation," you are rewarded with some mold-like bruises on your legs. "The paramecia" think this gift will force you to give in.

???: 但对你来说，有些看不见的伤口比这严重得多。
But for you, the invisible wounds are much more severe.

???: 放心，尽管他们的手段并不温柔，你也未必温顺得像只羊羔。
Don't worry. They are not gentle at all, but neither are you benign.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 记忆？好想法！你引以为傲的逻辑思维仍旧维持着正常运转。好让你现在也能像个生物学家一样，冲着沼泽分析该死的驼背巨鱼。
Memory? Good try! The logic you pride yourself on continues to serve you properly. It allows you to make some good deductions here, like a biologist analyzing the cause of a humpback appearing in a swamp.

???: 但是抱歉，让你失望了。这不过是一场梦，一场违背了你个人意愿的梦境——强人所难向来是他们的拿手好戏。
But the answer will disappoint you, unfortunately. This is just a dream, an illusion they shoved into your head. These people are very familiar with using coercive power.

选项 / Choices

1. 他们是?

1. They are ...?

???: 一群穿着袍子的家伙。袍子由白色的聚酯纤维制成，长度大多在膝盖以下。白袍子一号到白袍子七号都来了。

A group of people in gowns. Their gowns are made of white polyester and are over knee-length. There are seven, namely No. 1 to No. 7.

???: 可能只有单数，又或许混进了四号或者六号——他*的，随便他们怎么样。

Probably only those odd-number guys are here. Or maybe No. 4 or 6 is also with them ... Damn it, I don't care.

???: 重要的是，其中有与你同窗的小姑娘。不，不是那个温柔忠诚，总是站在你身边的那个。

What matters is that your classmate is among them. No, not the gentle and loyal one who always stands by your side.

???: 是另一位——一位边缘简洁冷硬，摸上去像是个精密机械的女孩儿。

It is the other one—the one with indifferent outlines that makes her look like a refined machine.

???: 我们姑且先像大部分人一样忽略掉她的名字，只朝着那个最光鲜的姓氏望过去。

Let's skip her first name and only pay attention to her glorious family name, like what most people did.

???: 酒鬼眼中的雪莉桶威士忌，烟鬼眼里被雪松盒盛着的厄普曼——以及神秘学界的梅斯梅尔。

Like sherry cask whiskies to the alcoholic, Upmann Cedar Aged Robusto Cameroon to smokers ... and the Mesmers to the arcanists.

选项 / Choices

1. 我明白了，高级货

1. I see ... boujee.

2. 梅斯梅尔……他们是做什么的?

2. What do they do?

分支 / Branch 2.1

???: 哈哈哈，你这烂鼻子的坏蛋。你的幽默感从来不会让我失望！没错，没错，高级货。

Ha Ha Ha, you smart-ass. Love your humor. Yeah, you are right, boujee!

???: 很早以前，更早以前，在你或许有机会亲历的某个过去。

Long ago, long long ago, you might have had the chance to experience such a period.

???: 从人类刚刚放弃了祷告的那个时期开始，拉普拉斯与他们——嘿，对了，那帮人更愿意自称为学者——达成了长久的合作。

At that time, humans just made their decision to live without prayers, and that's also the beginning of the long-term cooperation between Laplace and those ... heh, oh, "scholars," as they called themselves.

分支 / Branch 2.2

???: 摆弄那种神叨叨怪把戏的。坐在那里，拿铁棒一指你便昏睡过去，在脖子上挂上铁圈儿你又会感到灼烧似的疼痛。

Anything mystical. When they sit there and point at you with an iron stick, you'll pass out. When they put an iron ring around your neck, you'll feel burnt ...

???: 你熟知这种怪把戏，毕竟你周围净是些会用怪把戏的家伙：用玻璃笔保护别人的小姑娘，以及那个飘来飘去的会跳舞的苹果。
You must be familiar with all these freaky tricks, because you are surrounded by freaky tricksters, like that little girl who protects others with her glass dipping pen or that floating apple dancing in the air.

???: 他们掐断意识的火焰，帮助你往自己的最深处下坠……就像现在这样。
The Mesmers know how to suffocate the flames of consciousness; they help you free fall internally to the bottom of the abyss ... as you are now.

???: 能熟练运用它的神秘学家一只手都数得过来。要知道，稀缺往往是一个悲剧故事的楔子。
It's really hard finding an arcanist who can freely master such skill. As you know, scarcity causes tragedy.

???: 她的噩梦就是这样开的头：从儿童劳动保护法变成了用来包三明治的、皱巴巴的纸开始。
That was the start of her nightmare: when the Child Labor Law was turned into a piece of wrinkled paper to wrap the sandwich.

???: 十二岁的小姑娘被带领着走进了屋子。她早在门外就敏锐地感觉到了这里的磁场变成了一团杂乱的风滚草。
The young daughter of the Mesmer family was led to a room when she was 12. Before she stepped in, she had sensed the messy magnetic field on the other side of the door, thanks to her acute perception.

???: 神秘学家的精神比人类脆弱得多，用不了多少刺激就能让他们退行成一头恶兽。
Compared to humans, arcanists are much more emotionally vulnerable. It won't take much to overwhelm them and force them to regress to animals.

???: 梅斯梅尔们仁慈、专业。他们欢迎每一位前来治疗癔症的客人。
The Mesmers are merciful and professional. They will never turn away any patient who comes to them for treatment.

???: ——这时你该意识到了，餐纸保护的从来都不是三明治，而是拿着它的手。
... By then, you should realize the wrapping paper was never protecting the sandwich, but the hand.

???: 那些品牌不明的芥末酱、被捏碎的肉排，边缘带着铁锈色的生菜从面包缝隙里流了出来。
The mustard from an unknown bottle, the squeezed meatloaf, and rusty lettuce leaf, all were crushed and fell out from between the bread.

???: 混沌、污秽以及刺耳的惨叫——小姑娘被这些东西淌了一手，沾湿了身上的白色的聚酯纤维。
Just like the chaotic noises and the raspy screaming that fill her ears ... This filth contaminated the little girl's hands and corrupted the white polyester.

选项 / Choices

1. ……

1. ...

???: 嗯，的确是个沉默的好时候。
Hmm, it is indeed a good time for silence.

???: 现在，你注意到了机器上那些裸露的伤口，注意到了那些像是反复盥洗、重复整理的痕迹。
Now you've noticed those exposed wounds on the machine, those marks from repeated washing and adjustments.

???: 毕竟孩童时期经历的创伤总能给人留下深刻的印象。
Well, the traumata from childhood is usually hard to forget.

???: 这些东西被细细篆刻在骨间，它们沿着脊髓拾级而上——最后在每一寸神经元上抹上恶臭的鼻涕。
Those memories are engraved in our heart and run through our veins ... Eventually, they contaminate every single neuron with mucous snot.

???: 自此之后，每一次成长都是痛苦的延伸：新的骨头生出来就被腐蚀，旧的细胞代谢也于事无补。
Since then, every inch of growth is an extension of pain. New bones will be eroded and the condition can't be cured by cellular renewal.

???: 这种事，你和她都很熟悉。
Both you and her are familiar with this.

???: 好了，箱子提稳，看看时间——你该从这儿滚蛋了。
Okay, take your suitcase. Now it's time ... Get lost!

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选
Excerpt from the New York Times

简中
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

English
Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

圆环之舞

Dance of Rings 小径

圆环之舞

Dance of Rings

简中

老大最近沉迷脉轮，对，就是那个每人会有七个、彩虹一样的玩意。
这是个讨老大欢心的好机会，拿着这些钱，去集市上买点礼物回来。

……

我叫你去新纪元集市上弄些神神叨叨的小玩意，不是让你去买钢圈的，环刃和脉轮是不一样的，白痴！
把这些铁片看好了，我会负责找下家，这桩蠢事别让第三个人知道。

……

没有人愿意买那么多钢圈，你去弄几桶汽油来，记住了，是汽油，不是油漆。
我知道你会有意见，但不这样做我们没法平账，要是被老大发现我们偷偷挪钱干这种蠢事，你我都得穿水泥靴。
或者你可以祈祷有小偷连夜搬空了仓库。那你就只需要去和小偷干一架了。

English

The boss has recently become obsessed with chakras, yes, those seven rainbow-colored things that everyone supposedly has. This is a great chance to please the boss, so take this money and go buy some gifts at the market.

……

I told you to get some mystical trinkets from the New Age Market, not steel rings, idiot! Chakrams and Chakras are not the same thing, moron! Keep an eye on these iron pieces. I'll handle finding a buyer, just don't let anyone else know about this mess.

……

No one wants to buy this many steel rings. Go get some barrels of gasoline, and remember, gasoline, not paint. I know you have reservations, but if we don't do this, we won't be able to balance the books. If the boss finds out we've been secretly siphoning money for this nonsense, you and I will end up wearing concrete shoes. Or you can pray for a thief to clean out the warehouse overnight. Then we can blame the thief for the whole mess.

胜利晚宴
Victory Feast 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。
> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!

S 代表什么?
What Does S Stand For? 小径

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保利娜的日记
Paulina's Diary 小径

保利娜的日记
Paulina's Diary

简中

我曾收到过一个非常可爱的毛绒玩具，印象里，大概是五岁那年的圣诞节，噢，如果我记得没错的话，应该还有一张老照片呢！

我就坐在圣诞树旁边，头上沾满了雪花，正咧开嘴大笑着，旁边躺着一只特别乖巧的小熊，它有着比其他玩具熊都长一截儿的尾巴，可爱极了，我上哪儿都带着它。

在每一个饿得睡不着的夜晚、每一个爸爸妈妈吵架的夜晚、每一个冷到忍不住打寒战的夜晚，我都会紧紧搂着它，因为它是这么温暖、这么柔软，只要还能抱着它，一切就远没有看上去那么糟糕，它对我来说，实在是太重要了，它是我最初与最后的朋友——我向来这么认为。

直到妈妈牵着我的手，带领局促不安的我踏进天鹅绒餐厅大门的那天为止。

我第一次意识到，我或许拥有了与怀中这只小熊同样重要的东西——一块香气四溢的蛋糕、一床柔软厚实的棉被、一个遮风避雨的家。

今天是我人生中第八个圣诞节，和往年不太一样，我再次收到了精心准备的圣诞礼物，虽然我知道，包装纸上的蝴蝶结肯定不是那个大个子亲自系的，不过，我还是很开心！

他送给我的是一条蓝丝巾，说是和我眼睛的颜色很配。看在丝巾很漂亮的份上，我就原谅他那连蓝色和绿色都分不清的粗神经了，但什么人会直接问对方来年圣诞节想要的礼物？真是没有浪漫可言。

当然，我确实早就想好明年要什么礼物了！一个更大、更暖和，能装下更多家人，比海特街更宽广的家！

English

I got a very cute stuffed animal for Christmas once when I was five years old, I think. Oh, if I remember correctly, there should be an old photo! I was sitting next to the Christmas tree with snowflakes on my head and a big grin on my face. Next to me was a particularly well-behaved little bear with a tail longer than any other teddy bear's. It was incredibly cute and I took it with me wherever I went.

On every sleepless, hungry night, on every night my parents fought, on every night when the cold was unbearable, I'd hug it tightly because it was so warm and soft. As long as I could hold it, everything didn't seem so bad. It was so important to me; I always thought it was my first and last friend.

Until the day my mom held my hand and led me, nervous and fidgety, through the doors of the Velvet Restaurant.

It was then that I realized I might have something just as important as the bear in my arms—a delicious cake, a soft, thick blanket, a home that sheltered me from the wind and rain.

Today is the eighth Christmas of my life, and unlike past years, I received another carefully prepared Christmas gift. Even though I know that the bow on the wrapping paper wasn't tied by the big guy himself, I'm still very happy! He gave me a blue scarf, saying it matched the color of my eyes. Considering how pretty the scarf is, I'm willing to forgive his cluelessness in not knowing blue from green. But who asks someone what they want for Christmas next year? No sense of romance at all.

Of course, I already know what I want for next Christmas! A bigger, warmer home that can fit a bigger family, one that's even bigger than Haight Street!

宝瓶座时代

Age of Aquarius 小径

宝瓶座时代

Age of Aquarius

简中

鸵鸟电台：一曲《The Golden City》放送完毕。我亲爱的宝贝儿们，美好只存在于音乐里，没错，我们都想逃离，都想骑着酷到没边儿的摩托，什么都不想，沿着公路的某个方向不断往前，再往前，离开这寸腐朽的土地，离开没完没了的黑帮打手、神经质，离开欺负老实人的政府老爷，离开喋喋不休的废话，离开这里，无论做什么都行！

鸵鸟电台：这便是“双鱼座时代”的余波。不过，我们马上就要迈入“宝瓶座时代”——一个彼此理解、互相信任的新时代，一个真正的乌托邦，一个没有虚伪、嘲讽、曲解与愤懑的自由世界。

鸵鸟电台：废话不多说，让我们来听听这张酷毙了的新专辑《另一个时代》。小心肝儿们，小兔崽子们，快跟着我一块儿晃起来吧！

接下来是放送时间（音乐声）：

“我们渴望、期盼与迎接，能让心灵得到全然慰藉、能让话语畅通无阻、能让身体真正放松下来的好去处。”

“它不仅仅存在于幻想中，它是锁眼儿里闪烁的灯球，是一曲酣畅淋漓的迪斯科，是一半金酒一半青柠汁的正宗螺丝起子。”

“更重要的是，我们相信它终将到来。”

English

Ostrich Radio: And that was "The Golden City" on Ostrich Radio. My dear listeners, remember that true beauty can only be found in music. We all yearn to escape, wishing we could hop on a badass motorcycle and ride off into the sunset without a care in the world, leaving behind the corrupt politicians and bullies, the endless noise and chaos.

Ostrich Radio: Fear not, my friends, for this is the end of the "Age of Pisces." We are about to enter the "Age of Aquarius," a time of mutual understanding and trust. A utopia where there is no more hypocrisy, sarcasm, misinterpretation or resentment.

Ostrich Radio: But enough talk, let's listen to this amazing new album "Another Era." My sweethearts, my little brats, let's all start grooving together!

"We yearn for a place of pure comfort, where communication flows effortlessly and our bodies can truly unwind."

"It's not just an illusion. It's the light peeking through the keyhole, it's the pulsing rhythm of a wild dance floor, it's a potent mix of gin and lime."

"And most importantly, we have faith that one day it will be a reality."

一切的原点
Where It All Began 小径

???: 简单到像是用线段构成的、纯白的床，上面有个看上去未必能让人做个好梦的白枕头，以及半屋子满满当当的光。
A white bed, so plain and simple as if it were depicted solely in lines; a pale pillow that might not bring you sweet dreams; the light sheds in and fills half of the room.

选项 / Choices

1. 我讨厌禁闭室
1. I hate the guardhouse.

2. 看上去不错
2. Looks not bad.

分支 / Branch 1

???: 噢，你要是说得出喜欢，我就该建议你去瞧瞧脑子了。
Oh, if you like it, I would suggest you go check your brain.

???: 听着，我不知道你对艺术有多少了解，不过最好的情况是像我一样一窍不通——别他*的傻笑了！这毫无疑问是艺术，是 60 年代的又一场艺术革命。
Listen, I don't know whether you have an eye for art. I'd say the best thing you can hope for is to know nothing about it like I do ... Stop laughing like a f*****g idiot! This undoubtedly is art. It's another art revolution in the 60s.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 哦，棒极了！现在你开始爱上禁闭室了！等我开上瓶啤酒……恭喜你！你也成了个疯子，要么就是成了个艺术家——无论哪个都值得庆祝！
Oh, amazing! Now you fall in love with the guardhouse! Let me take another can of beer ... Congratulations! You are mad or artistic. Either of them deserves celebration.

???: 你对此颇有造诣。想必现在已经等不及要和我解释下为何唐纳德·贾德不给自己的那些方盒子起名字了。
You are really a master. I'm sure you can't wait to explain why Donald Judd didn't name his boxes.

???: 这一切都是人类那颗理性大脑做的好事——哲学与美学交织成一个螺旋，跌跌撞撞地往前迈着步子，一直到今天……一直到“过去”。
Look what humans have done with the help of their little rational brain. Their philosophy intertwines with aesthetics, and together the two subjects stagger ahead till today ... till "the past."

???: 简单变得复杂，文明吞噬着文明。而后突然有一天，他们回头向深处望去，见到了那副巨人观。
Then complexity replaced simplicity. One civilization prevailed another. Suddenly one day, when they looked back at where they came from, they found what was left behind has turned into a bloated cadaver.

???: 好在一切都为时未晚。解决的方法非常简单——他们先是把形丢了出去，随后又扔掉了概念，现在又抛却了情绪与隐喻。一切开始变得纯粹……最后正方形又变回了正方形，并且除此之外它什么也不是。
Fortunately, it's not too late. The solution is simple ... They first made light of the physical objects, then simplified concepts, and now they are wiping out emotions and forbidding metaphors. Everything has returned to the most substantial state ... Let a square be just a square, nothing else.

选项 / Choices

1. 简单的数学问题

1. Simple maths.

???: 甚至是连三岁的小屁孩都做得了的减法！

Indeed, even a child knows how to do a subtraction this simple!

???: 极简主义——不得不说，这是个好现象，它向宇宙证明了这些充满智慧的灵长类并非那么无药可救。

Minimalism ... I have to say, this is a good thing. It proves to the entire universe that the intelligent primates are not that incurable.

???: 用艺术来抵御痛苦与消费主义，这举动像你的新后妈一样温柔。

It is adopted to shield us from agony and keep us away from the trap of consumerism. Minimalism is almost as nice as a vicious stepmother who tries to hide her ill intentions from the family.

???: 再过几年，减到这颗星球重新长满树，猴子老老实实吃它们的果子——

You sit tight and watch. Within years, the result of this continuous subtraction will be seen all over the planet. There will be trees again, and the monkeys eat their fruits ...

选项 / Choices

1. 就会回到过去?

1. Return to the past?

???: 是前往新的未来，你个傻蛋。

To a brand-new future, you dumbass.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选

Excerpt from the New York Times

简中

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

English

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.

The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection

Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

“有场大赛要开始了”
"Let the Match Begin" 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。
Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
TEL: 847-6861XXX

Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!

幕后花絮
Behind the Cameras 小径

???: 一张泛黄的，边缘焦脆的合影。即便它被如此小心地保存，仍旧免不了被时间腐坏的命运。
A discolored group photo with burned and brittle edges. It has been carefully preserved, but that was not enough to keep it from getting blurry as time passed.

???: 相片里的人面目模糊，只瞧得出是一水儿的黑头发。相纸的最上方有一行小字，方块儿似的——或许是某种来自东方的文字。
The faces of the people in the photo are hardly recognizable, but it's clear that they all have dark hair. At the top, there is a sentence ... perhaps written in an Eastern language.

选项 / Choices
1. 相片里的人是……?
1. These people are ...?

???: 你对此毫无头绪，在自己记忆里找不到一点儿关于这些人的蛛丝马迹。从没见过他们——你笃定地给了自己这样一个结论。
You have no idea who they are or what they did. You have never met them ... You concluded firmly.

???: 除了第二排，自右侧数的第三个。你认得她的面孔。
Except for the third one from the right in the second row, you know her.

???: 她与你记忆里的样子相比显得年轻了一些。两股麻花辫藤蔓一样地垂在她面颊两侧，那双黑色镜框后的眼睛仿佛来自一头沉稳的鹿。
She looks a bit younger in the photo than you remember. The two pigtail braids fall to the sides of her cheeks. The eyes behind that pair of black-frame glasses are as deep and composed as a deer's.

选项 / Choices

1. 相片上写着什么?
1. What's written there?

???: “19**—19**伦敦帝国理工学院留学生纪念”——一行方正的文字，有烫金的痕迹。
"Commemoration for International Students at Imperial College London, 19**–19**" ... You can tell it was once bronzed.

???: 该有的信息都有了——我是说，好消息！年份在如今不是什么重要线索了！
All the critical information is here ... I mean, this is good news! Given what has been happening, who cares about what year the photo was taken?

选项 / Choices

1. 她从哪儿来?
1. Where did she come from?

2. 照片从哪儿来?
2. Where is this photo from?

分支 / Branch 1

???: 东方，太平洋西岸的一片广袤土地。载着她的渡轮曾穿过了直布罗陀海峡与苏伊士运河。
The East, a vast land to the west coast of the Pacific. The ferry she took once crossed the Strait of Gibraltar and the Suez Canal.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 别这么刨根问底的，大家都更在意归处——要时刻告诫自己别落得和这照片一样的结果，变得有家不能回。
Do you have to be this nosy? It doesn't matter where it came from. What matters is where it has gone. The photo was really a warning for us all—don't end up being separated from the homeland.

选项 / Choices

1. 说说吧，你都知道些什么
1. Tell me, what else do you know?

???: 客气点，小恶棍！这不是什么免费的睡前故事，我也不是你慈祥的好爷爷。
Hey, be careful the way you speak, little prick! This is not a bedtime story, and I am not your sweet grandfather.

???: 你认识她，但算不上熟悉。你我之间没人熟悉——熟悉她的另有其人。
You know her, but you're not a close acquaintance of hers, neither am I ... There is someone else who knows her well.

???: 如今的她剪短了头发，变成了白色百合花上的露珠，在花萼之下摇摇欲坠。
All I know is that she has cut her hair short and became a drop of dew on the lily petal, shaking underneath the calyx.

选项 / Choices

1. 那朵百合花是什么样子的?
1. What does that lily look like?

2. 她为什么来到这里?

2. Why did she come here?

分支 / Branch 2.1

???: 纯白色，花瓣光滑，花药是健康的浅色。摸上去——是冷的，而且坚硬，像锋利的大理石，时刻准备在你的手上留下一个窟窿。

It's pure white, with smooth petals and healthy, light-colored anthers. It feels ... cold and hard, like a piece of sharp marble, ready to pierce your hand.

???: 露珠是她带过来的，也是她培育的。毫无疑问，百合花是个优秀的教导者，露珠也是个难得一见的好苗子。

The dew was brought here and cultivated by the lily. Undoubtedly, the lily is an excellent educator, while the dew is also a one-in-a-thousand candidate.

分支 / Branch 2.2

???: 这里？严格来说，她最初的目的地并不是“这里”，不是这幢灰白色建筑，不是伞下，也不是花萼。她是名理论物理学研究者——研究弦论。

Here? Technically speaking, her initial destination was not "here," not this gray-and-white building, nor under the umbrella, nor the calyx. She is an expert at theoretical physics and studies string theory.

???: 远渡重洋也只是为了重新回到那片蓄势待发的土地。

She voyaged across the ocean in order to return to the land with vitality.

???: 但计划赶不上变化，那朵百合永远有办法让事情如她预期一般发展。

Her plan, however, was interrupted by a sudden change. That lily always has her ways to navigate things to develop as she wanted.

选项 / Choices

1. 露珠会不会变成百合花?

1. Will the dew be another lily?

???: 好问题，她既无欲望，又没愿心，故土还在远方等着她——科学家又怎么会变成政治家！

Good question. She has no thirst, nor desire. Homeland is awaiting ... How could a scientist become a politician?

???: 我真想这么笃定地回答你……但是你也意识到了，对吧？你也感觉到了。

I hope I can answer you like this without hesitation ... But you've also noticed it, right? You knew.

???: 现在——猫被重新关到了盒子里，始作俑者把盖子封得严严实实。你我只能在外面抓耳挠腮，像个足球流氓一样为自己的猜想下注。

Now, the cat has been locked back in the chamber. The entrance has been tightly sealed. None of us can do anything about its fate. We can only wait outside, anxiously scratching our heads and placing our bets.

???: 明天，或是后天——哈！等着赔个底儿掉吧！

Tomorrow, or the day after tomorrow ... Hah! We'll lose it all!

共同接续 / Shared continuation

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瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

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最初的伙伴
The First Companion 小径

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An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

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> 电话：847-6861XXX
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疗愈之外
Beyond Healing 小径

???: 你重新跌回了人群之中。我理解的，我能感受到燃自你脑髓深处的渴望与沮丧——你想切身地体会一场怪诞的、破碎的、离奇的，超出你自身经验的神秘学故事。
You fall back into the crowd. I understand. I can feel the desire and depression burning deep inside your brain: you are longing to be a part of an absurd, broken, bizarre arcanum story which is beyond your imagination and past experience.

???: 但很遗憾，我忍不住要发出怪笑：你遇到了一点儿麻烦，不得不像只蚂蚁惊惶得在白袍子中间兜兜转。
But sorry, I can't help laughing: you got into some trouble and have to run around blindly among those in white robes like a panicked ant.

???: 来吧，闭上眼睛试试看。想象一台信号受损的电视机里，一个红鼻子的坏蛋向你摊开双手：欢，迎，来，到，人，类，的，世，界。
Come on. Close your eyes. Imagine inside a TV with static noise, a red-nosed bad guy opens his arms to you and says, "Welcome, to, the, human, world."

选项 / Choices

1. 这些愚蠢的逗号！
1. These stupid commas!

2. 我本来就在人类的世界
2. I'm already in the human world.

分支 / Branch 1

???: 没错，老兄！就像我们常见的大人物一样令人费解。他们总是站在高耸的舞台上，握着麦克风，嗓门里的小舌头缓慢地打着颤。

I know, dude! As puzzling as our usual big shots. They stand on the podium, with a mic in their hands, and everyone can see their uvula trembling from their wide-open mouths as they speak.

???: 喂，喂，测试，测试，三二一，三二一。逗号逗号逗号。而我们所有人都不得不膀胱憋着尿，饿着肚子，等待接下来会发生什么。

Hello, hello, testing, testing. Three, two, one, three, two, one. Comma, comma, comma. Everyone has to wait for what will happen with a full bladder and an empty stomach.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 绝妙的一语双关！但现在的你并不明白我在说些什么。等到那一天来临，你找到了你，你找到了我，你找到了他们……哦，一想到那一刻，我这该死的心脏跟个临终的麋鹿似的怦怦乱跳！

Nice pun! But you don't understand what I'm saying, for now. When the day comes, you will find yourself, you will find me, you will find them ... Oh, thinking of that day, my damned heart is beating crazily like a dying reindeer's!

???: 放眼现在，这也很好。你清楚自己的位置，头脑里没有不该有的思绪，甚至还耐心地蹲在这里——

But look at this moment, it's just fine. You know where you should be, and you don't have anything that you shouldn't have in your mind. You just crouch here with patience ...

???: 听好了，这个世界上不止存在神秘学家。神秘学家，神秘学物种，甚至神秘学本身——都是一个隐秘得不能再隐秘的低微的存在。

Listen, this is not just a world of arcanists. Arcanists, arcanum creatures, and even arcanum itself are but insignificant existence hidden beneath all else.

???: 你必须要去了解现在权势在握的人们。他们住在地球的另一边，在地广人稀的王座上编织着规则。

You must learn about those who are in power at the present moment. They live on the other side of the earth, setting rules on the thrones in the scarcely populated wilderness.

???: 为了秩序，为了理想，为了满足大多数而牺牲少数的幸福，他们游走在战争与交易之间，用统一的白骨搭建起至高无上的权力大厦。

Much has been done for the order, for the vision, for the ultimate goal which will satisfy the majority yet sacrifice the minority. They wage wars and strike deals, building a pyramid that symbolizes supreme power with skeletons of the commoners.

???: 不，我并不是在讲述一个俗套的反派故事。正相反，这是一个无聊的，为了探求什么是公平与理想的，立于天空与大地之间的蠢物的挣扎纪事。

No, I'm not telling a lame villain story. On the contrary, it's a boring documentary about those in power standing between the sky and the earth, seeking the real meaning of fairness and ideals.

???: 时间还长着呢！向前走，要记得迈开脚步，别轻易下结论，确保你始终在路上。这样你就能越来越了解人类。越来越了解人类。

There's still plenty of time! Go ahead. Keep moving, but don't jump to any conclusion. Just make sure you're always on the way, so you will learn more about humans, more and more.

???: 带上你的显微镜，好好地去挖掘那堆可怜虫的腐烂历史去吧！

Take the microscope with you and dig into the rotten history of those poor little things!

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选

Excerpt from the New York Times

简中

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

English

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.

The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.

On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

不和谐音
Notes of Dissonance 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。
Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
TEL: 847-6861XXX

Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!

旧金山往事
San Francisco Memories 小径

《昨日，今日》
"Yesterday, Today"

简中
“我回到家，坐在阳台边上，看着远处高楼里不曾熄灭的灯光，窥视着这座城市的昨日，与今日。”

“90 年代，将成为一个崭新的、与过去完全不同的年代。人们会成为未来的一部分，抑或被永远留在过去。”

“我们都被困在这儿。困在 90 年代的旧金山里头——一个活泼与忧郁、向上与破败、富裕与贫穷并存的虚无之地。”

“往窗子外头瞅瞅，无论是海特街上无家可归的老乞丐、新纪元集市狗屁不通的水晶疗愈、黑袍子口中神神叨叨的颂词，还是连裤子都不穿好，就跑到灯球底下晃个不停的混球们——大家全都没救了！”

“我不喜欢迪斯科，跟你说句实话吧，我从来就没喜欢过那玩意儿。”

“不过，去他的，我根本不在乎，老兄，我一点儿都不在乎。”
English
"I return home, sit on the balcony, and watch the lights that never go out in the distant skyscrapers, observing the city's yesterday and today."

"The '90s will be a brand new era, entirely different from the past. People will either become part of the future or be forever left behind in the past."

"We're all stuck here. Stuck in '90s San Francisco—a place of vibrancy and melancholy, progress and decay, wealth and poverty coexisting in a void."

"Look out the window, whether it's the homeless old beggars on Haight Street, the nonsense crystal healers at the New Age Market, the mystical chanting of the black-robed people, or the idiots who can't even wear their pants properly and just keep swaying under the disco ball—everyone's beyond saving!"

"I don't like discos. To tell you the truth, I never have."

"But screw it all, I don't care anymore, man, I don't care at all."

新气象
New Beginnings 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

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又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。
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酷到没朋友的宇宙灯球！
The Coolest Cosmic Disco Ball! 小径

???: 不同色彩的声音从你的左耳进入，又从鼻孔里滑出来，就像雪橇从高山小屋中出发，坠到滑道松软的终点线上，除了一时的兴奋什么也没留下。
Sounds of different colors go into your left ear and slip out from your nostrils, just like a toboggan sliding down a soft piste from a cabin up the mountain to the finishing line at the foot, leaving nothing but excitement that doesn't even last.

选项 / Choices

1. 你的搭讪方式逊爆了
1. Your opening line sucks.

2. 要去度假？很好，我做好准备了
2. So, a vacation? I'm ready.

分支 / Branch 1

???: ——呃。
Errr ...

???: 在说什么？信号不好，噢，是的。
What did you say? I, I got bad signal here, oh, ba-bad signal indeed.

???: 我是说，虽然我与你们都不一样，但我也有良心，好吗？我的原则是不讲废话，这些都是恰到好处的暗示。
I mean, I may be different from all of you, but I have a conscience, OK? I never talk s**t, that's the bottom line. What I said were all felicitous hints.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 没错，你总是这么机灵，充满绝佳的幽默感！带上你所有的防寒装备，这里风景优美，但仍是块要和冰山打交道的危险地方。
Yes. You're always so clever, with an excellent sense of humor! Now take all the cold-proof equipment you've got. The view is good here, but it's still dangerous as you are climbing a snow mountain after all.

???: 相信你也注意到了，在这冰川与峡谷，雪峰与湖泊之间，屹立着我们熟悉的伟大建筑。
I'm sure you have noticed it. Between the glacier and the valley, between the snow mountain and the lake, stands a great building we're all familiar with.

???: 闭上眼睛，感受那些灰色与白色交错的花纹，建筑的节奏，如此的均衡，对称，像一首洋溢着律动的精密交响乐。
Close your eyes and feel the patterns of interlaced gray and white. The flow of the building, so balanced and symmetrical, is like a sophisticated symphony with beautiful melody.

???: 这或许是你对基金会的初步印象。然而，经过一场委员会议，我看到你的面容就像被狩猎后的梗犬狠狠舔过，剩下的只有一片糟糕的混乱。
That may be your first impression of the Foundation. After that committee meeting, however, all I could see on your face was a terrible mess, like it was licked by a terrier which has just finished hunting.

???: 他们**的到底在说什么？谁能来解释一下他们的关系？
What the f**k are they talking about? Who can explain their relations for me?

???: 好问题！在这个寂寞的旋转着的漆黑宇宙里，只有我愿意出现在公园里的冷板凳上，告诉你这些前前后后的故事。
Good question! In this lonely, whirling, dark universe, I'm the only one who is willing to tell you all these stories on the cold bench in the park.

选项 / Choices

1. 基金会都有哪些职能?
1. So what functions does the Foundation have?

2. 谁才是基金会的老大?
2. Who is the boss of the Foundation?

分支 / Branch 2.1

???: 多得数不清！好家伙，你得理解，一个野心勃勃的国际政治机构，就难免不在捅娄子和擦屁股之间来回跳跃。
Countless! Oh man, you gotta understand, an international political institution with great ambition is bound to make troubles and make up for them.

???: 共融院与委员会，他们主管着立法，不止是基金会内部的，还有国家的，甚至是国际的！但凡与人类和神秘学家的关系有关联的，都得经过他们患有腱鞘炎的体面的手。
The House of Integratus and the committee are in charge of lawmaking, not just in the Foundation, but in countries and even in the global society! Any affairs related to the human-arcanist relationship will be brought to their table, and they will handle each of the affairs with their properly manicured but muscle-torn hands.

???: 人类弯弯曲曲的脑沟建立了这样合理的规则：位于共融院的代表人自竞选中诞生，为他的选区负责。他们往往忙碌得像辛勤的工蜂，每年向委员会提交大量的议案。
Through the folds in their brains, people set this reasonable rule: delegates of the House of the Integratus are elected to take responsibility for their constituencies. As busy as bees, they submit countless proposals to the committee every year.

???: 委员会则要选中一个幸运儿，把它推进到下一个流程，开始一场中世纪集会般热闹的辩论投票。
Then the committee will choose one lucky proposal and send it to the next step: all the committee members would gather to debate and vote for the proposal, like what happened in a Medieval Fair.

???: 集会里聚集了许多人，党团，主持人，数十个专家小组，每个人的立场和利益各异，就像一场颇具现代精神的精神搏击！我们将在唇枪舌战中等待十几天，或者好几个月，才能睁大眼睛看清楚是谁拿到了金腰带。
Many would show up in the fair. There would be political parties, a moderator, dozens of expert groups, each with a different standpoint and goal. It's like a mental boxing, modern version! We will have to wait while listening to the war of words. After dozens of days, or even months, we will finally get to see who wins the championship belt.

分支 / Branch 2.2

???: 你还没有见过他。事实上，大部分人都没有，因为机会总像流星一样稍纵即逝。
You haven't met him yet. Actually, only a few have, as the opportunities are always fleeting like the falling stars.

???: 但没有关系，少了他，基金会照样能流畅地运转！任劳任怨的康斯坦丁，那朵严酷的白百合，正尽职地把基金会往自己所以为正确的方向上掰呢。
But it's okay. The Foundation still works well without him! Our responsible Constantine, working without any complaint like an unbreakable lily, is trying hard to change the Foundation's direction to what she believes to be correct.

???: 来吧，让我们把眼光放长远点儿。人类聪慧的大脑皮质表明，他们需要一些看起来相互制衡的关系。委员会、共融院和多个行政部门就这样诞生了。
Come on, let's look at the bigger picture. Humans have worked out with the brilliant folds in their brains that they need multiple parties to create a balance of power. So, bang! There come the committee, the House of the Integratus, and many other administration departments.

???: 共融院与委员会，他们主管着立法，不止是基金会内部的，还有国家的，甚至是国际的！但凡与人类和神秘学家的关系有关联的，都得经过他们患有腱鞘炎的体面的手。
The House of Integratus and the committee are in charge of lawmaking, not just in the Foundation, but in countries and even in the global society! Any affairs related to the human-arcanist relationship will be brought to their table, and they will handle each of the affairs with their properly manicured but muscle-torn hands.

???: 委员会有权通过或拒绝代表人的议案。偶尔也有死脑筋的代表人，像只护雏的红背伯劳反复地提交被拒的议案，直到筋疲力尽。
The committee has the right to approve or reject the proposals from delegates. Well, of course, some of the delegates are very stubborn. They will keep submitting their proposals no matter how many times they have been rejected, just like a red-back shrike with fledglings repeatedly submitting rejected motions until they are exhausted.

???: 等进入到正式的立法辩论阶段，你就能观赏到一场饱含现代文明精华的斗兽表演，所有的主席、代表人、党团、专家小组都是权力竞技场里的狂热分子。
When it comes to the formal debate, you will get to watch a dogfight full of polite yet viciously aggressive language. Everyone, including the president, the delegates, the parties and the expert groups, will turn into maniacs in the arena of power.

???: 通过了这一关，剩下的就交给那座白色石屋了。他们很少表达自己的意见，很少，但不是没有。
After this stage, the final result depends on the white marble house. They seldom express their opinions, but they will sometimes.

选项 / Choices

1. 还有其他的吗?
1. Are there more?

???: 噢，是的是的。你询问的模样是多么的礼貌，好像在问一个大卖场里向你兜售本地棉袜的兼职高中生。
Oh, yes, yes. Look how polite you are when you ask that question, like I'm some high school student working part-time in a mall selling local socks to you.

???: 我会很好心地告诉你，当然还有其他的了！我们不能忽视基金会其他的行政部门，还有那倒霉的总部下属的各国分部，充满关怀的救济院般的第一防线学校。
And I'd be very nice and tell you, "Of course!" We must not ignore the other administration departments of the Foundation, as well as the headquarters' poor branches located in different countries and the humanitarian School of Primary Defense of Mankind that works like a poorhouse.

???: 要知道，基金会可是在管理世界！他们当然得弄出一点儿弯弯绕的规则出来，好让聪明的人更聪明，糊涂的人更糊涂，大部分生活在中间的人呢，死去的时候能带着无辜的笑意！
Remember, the Foundation is managing the whole world! Of course, they need some rules that are hard to understand, so the wise will be wiser and the silly will be sillier, while those in the middle will show an innocent smile when they die!

???: 人类最擅长折腾这些玩意儿。愚笨的神秘学家不能只知道抱怨，要去领悟，洞见他们的企图——知道吗？去感受规则里溢出来的脑浆！这样你总有一天就会明白……
Humans are experts on these things. My stupid arcanists, don't just complain; learn to see what they are after, okay? Catch the unspoken drifts between the lines! So one day you will understand ...

???: ——生活就像乘坐平底雪橇。
Life is like a ride on the toboggan.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选
Excerpt from the New York Times

简中
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心

三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

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Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

能量的涟漪

Ripples of Energy 小径

???: ……

...

选项 / Choices

1. 我刚睡醒，发生了什么?

1. I just woke up. What happened?

2. 我这里没有麻烦，你不用过来

2. I have no trouble. Don't come over.

分支 / Branch 1

???: 睡得不错，伙计，哈喇子甩得到处都是，差点糊住了我的眼睛。

That was a good sleep, dude. You drooled everywhere. Almost glued my eyelids.

???: 你没想到基金会里会有这么多复杂的团体，看起来让人一头雾水——他们就不能造一个简单的组织，让人们的区别就像蛋糕夹层一样清晰可见?

You didn't expect there to be so many complicated, confusing factions in the Foundation—can't they just make this institution simpler so that people can tell one group from another easily, like telling the difference between cake layers?

分支 / Branch 2

???: 是吗？老兄，你能百分百地确定自己没有麻烦?

Really? Dude, are you 100% sure that you are trouble-free?

???: 我睡得正香，做了阔别已久的美梦。梦里我和三位女士，一群呆天鹅生活在一起，彼此相处融洽。
I was sleeping like a baby, having a sweet sweet dream which has been long absent in my life. There were three ladies, a bevy of goofy swans, and I, living a harmonious life together in my dream.

???: 突然一个倒霉鬼把我叫醒，告诉我这一切都还好，不需要我的帮助。真是棒极了！我就像广场上的一条狗！等着吧，接下来，糟老头子会把所有的牢骚话都塞进你纯真的耳朵眼里。
Suddenly, a certain jinx woke me up, saying, "I have no trouble. Don't come over." How wonderful! I was like a stray dog sleeping on a square. You'll see, this old man is going to shovel all his complaints into your pure, innocent ear.

???: 你对基金会的组织有兴趣吗？你骄傲的脖颈在表示抗拒——很好，那就从这个令人跃跃欲试的话题开始！
How do you feel about the structure of the Foundation? I can see your cockily raised neck, showing your attitude of rejection. Well, perfect! Let's start with this intriguing topic, then!

???: 基金会很混乱。听好了，它始终在有序与无序的混乱间摆荡，吸引着无数理想主义者和现实主义者为它驻足。
The Foundation is a mess. Listen up, it drifts along the chaotic swirl between order and disorder, enticing countless idealists and realists to come over.

???: "暴雨"的到来，加剧了漩涡的混乱状况。神秘学家在水下浮潜，不断地往上涌现——你看，Z 女士就是一个很好的例子。她甚至与人类精英们平起平坐地待在同一张会议桌旁。
The "Storm" exacerbates the chaos. Those arcanists who were snorkeling are now surfacing—You see, Ms. Z is a great example. She is even sitting at the same conference table with the human elites.

???: 水面下有更多的暗流在波动。自然资源组委会、人类党团、文教部门……他们的成员相互交错，背景模糊不清难以辨认。他们不止是为了利益，也为了无数缠身的琐碎的烂毛线而忙碌。
The undercurrents, however, are still lurking. Natural Resource Committee, Mankind Caucus, Culture and Education Department ... Their members are hard to differentiate given the intricate backgrounds. They bustled for benefits and mired in countless trivial matters.

???: 明白了吗？你得不断地分组分组分分分组——把一个大团体按目标拆成尽可能小的小团体，才能让他们最高效且不带任何感情地清理客厅里的呕吐物！
You see? You need to divide them into groups, and divide and divide ... until you break a huge entity into small groups, as small as possible. That's when they are able to clean the vomit on the living room floor effectively and emotionlessly!

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选
Excerpt from the New York Times

简中
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后

遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

English

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.

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Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

崭新的新纪元
A Brand New Age 小径

崭新的新纪元
A Brand New Age

新纪元集市再开
不再有阴森的启明会
感受纯净的宇宙能量

这真的不是宗教
抛弃愚蠢的选民思想
尝试自由的自我救济

什么都不需要做
任何学说都不值一提
和平自然会引导群星
爱与宇宙会引导我们
As the New Age Market awakens,
And the Order of Enlightenment fades into obscurity,
Embrace the raw, unadulterated cosmic energy,
This is not a mere faith, but a true knowing.
Release the shackles of societal norms,
Savor the liberation of self-reliance,
You need not conform to any doctrine,
For peace shall guide us with celestial grace,
And let love and the universe be our compass.

活死人的黎明
Dawn of the Living Dead 小径

《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告
An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.

赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。
Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
TEL: 847-6861XXX

Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!

追赶者，被追赶者
The Pursuer and the Pursued 小径

???: 乒、乓、乒、乓、乒-乓乒乓乒、乓。乒。乓。
Ping, pong. Ping, pong. Ping pong ping pong ping, pong. Ping. Pong.

选项 / Choices

1. 太吵了
1. It's too noisy.

2. 一场模仿秀?
2. An imitation show?

分支 / Branch 1

???: 嗯。我同意。
Yup. Agreed.

???: 这太吵了。你看见那个合成塑料制成的小球儿，它蹦蹦跳跳，从左到右，发出恼人的声响。
It's too noisy. You were looking at the little ball made of plastic. It hops from left to right, making an annoying sound.

???: 可我们只能看着它，就像是你只能忍受我。因为我们都无处可去。
But all we can do to it is look at it, just like all you can do to me is tolerate my existence, for both of us have nowhere to go.

分支 / Branch 2

???: 是的。模仿秀。球类模仿秀，小东西。
Yes, an imitation show. A ball imitation show, little thing.

???: 就像是你模仿着救世主一样，我模仿着一颗合成纤维塑料制成的橙色小球儿。
You're imitating the Messiah, while I'm imitating an orange ball made of plastic.

???: 我在两个球拍之间左右颠倒、无处可去，它们给我施加力，我就高高跳起，跳跃造成的气流如何拂过我干燥的发皱的皮——
Being pushed back and forth by two rackets, I have nowhere else to go. Once they apply a force on me, I can't help bouncing to the sky. You can see how the air flows across my dry, wrinkled skin ...

???: 哦——瞧瞧，这真是太巧了——这也是现在的你！
Oh, what a coincidence! Aren't you in the same situation as mine now!

???: 哈！瞧瞧你这家伙皱起眉头的样子——
Ha! Look at your frowning face—

???: 纸张一般的脸儿从眉头到鼻梁都皱起来，纹路很少，痕迹很浅。我们都知道这代表着什么，表情少可从来都不是你的错。
Your face wrinkles from the eyebrows to the nose tip, but people can barely see those light furrows. We know what that means. You have a poker face, and it's never your fault.

???: 但现在你的脸不重要，或许对于有些人来说它很重要，但它还是不重要。
But for now, your face is not the thing that matters. Well, maybe for someone it is, but still, it's not.

???: 你知道什么是真正重要的吗?
——球赛，对，是球赛！当然是球赛！
You know what really matters?
The game! Yes, it's the game, of course the game matters!

???: 所有人都爱球赛，他们聚在一起，慷慨激昂地欢呼或是怒吼，他们选择自己喜欢的球队，花大价钱买队服或是签名球。
Everyone loves the game. They gather at the stadium, yelling or roaring vehemently. They choose one team to become its fan and spend good money on a team uniform or an autographed ball.

???: 但——那只是一枚球。你能理解我的意思吗?
Yet, it's just a ball. You see where I'm coming from?

???: 只是一枚球。一个几何图像中常见的圆形。一个世界中并不难见的轮廓。
Just a ball. Its outline, a circle, could be found in any geometry textbook and anywhere in this world.

???: 当第一个原始人捡起椰子，上下抛——接——抛——接——抛并从中感到愉快，咯咯叫唤的时候，他想过今天吗?
When the first hominid picked up a coconut and threw it to the sky—and caught it—and threw it—and caught it—and threw it again, when she felt joy and yelped, had she ever thought of the future?

???: 让一颗简单的球，变得如此复杂而充满奥妙的今天。
The future where a simple ball has become so complicated and enchanting, now we call it the present.

选项 / Choices
1. 复杂而充满奥妙?
1. Complicated and enchanting?

???: 哦！当然！复杂而充满奥妙！
Hahahahahaha! Yes, sure! Complicated and enchanting!

???: 动动你愚蠢又机灵的小脑瓜，再去仔细看看这场球类游戏。
Use your silly and smart head to think about this ball game carefully.

???: 它有复杂的计分规则、对反应能力的严苛考验、无数种可能犯规的落球点，从手指，到手腕，再到手臂，正确的发力会为胜利帮上大忙！
The complex scoring rules, the harsh requirements for reactive agility, the countless possible foul points ... Your fingers, your wrists, and arms, a correct way of using them will lead to victory!

???: 更重要的是，与所有球类运动相同，它的重点在于抛和接。
What matters more is, like every ball game, it focuses on how you serve the ball and hitting it back.

???: 这不是个简单的活计，当你参与其中，你就得全神贯注。那颗小球从哪儿向你飞来，你要如何将其送回，一切都发生在半秒之内。
It's not an easy job as it sounds. When you are in the game, you need to concentrate. Where will the ball come from, and how will you return it to your opponent—you need to figure that out within half a second.

???: 适当的力道、精巧的小动作，脚下不能乱了拍子，找准呼吸的节奏。
Use your power in a proper way, move your feet in a stable pace, inhale and exhale at the right timings.

???: 乒。乓。乒。乓。乒。乓。乒。乓……
Ping. Pong. Ping. Pong. Ping. Pong. Ping. Pong ...

???: 直到那个不断四处弹射的小东西落在其中一方的阵地之前，这个声音将永恒地持续下去。
The sound will last forever and ever until that bouncing little thing falls to either side of the court.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

《纽约新闻报》节选

Excerpt from the New York Times

简中

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

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Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

小目标、大目标

Small Goals, Big Goals 小径

鸵鸟电台： 下午好，旧金山！下午好，乳臭未干的兔崽子们！

Good afternoon, San Francisco! Good afternoon, all you wet-behind-the-ears punks out there!

鸵鸟电台： 剩下的开场白就省略吧！因为接下来要讲的事情是宇宙级的！

Let's skip the rest of the intro because what comes next is out of this world!

鸵鸟电台： 哈勃望远镜的服役状况良好，科学家们推测它起码能绕着地球转 40 年。

The Hubble telescope is in good working order, and scientists estimate that it could orbit the Earth for another 40 years.

鸵鸟电台：这可是挑战者号大出洋相后难得的好消息！
In light of the recent Challenger disaster, this is some much needed good news!

鸵鸟电台：我知道你们肯定要问一个飞出了大气层的破望远镜和自己有什么关系。
But you might be thinking, what does a busted telescope floating outside the atmosphere have to do with you?

鸵鸟电台：看看那颗大太阳吧！难道他不像个迪斯科球么？
Well, take a look at that magnificent sun of ours! Doesn't it remind you of a sparkling disco ball?

鸵鸟电台：你们不想去水星金星还是随便哪颗星球上蹦迪搓碟么？有点梦想吧臭小子们！
Doesn't it make you want to party it up on Mercury, Venus, or any other planet out there? Let your imagination run wild, my listeners!

斯普特尼克：我想！我想！我想飞出大气层！然后当颗照亮地球的迪斯科球！
I do! I do! I want to fly out of the atmosphere and be a disco ball that lights up the Earth!

护士：探病时请保持安静！
Please keep quiet when visiting patients!

斯普特尼克：非常抱歉……
My apologies ...

贝克特：原来斯普特尼克女士有个远大的梦想，这可是个好事。
It turns out Madam Sputnik has a big dream—that's good news.

杰洛：上天的花费连那群该死的有钱人都要惊掉下巴，趁早死心吧。
The cost of going to space would make even the filthy rich gasp, give it up already.

贝克特：你能不能别扫兴?
Can you not be such a killjoy?

斯普特尼克：两位，请不要吵架了，也不必为我的梦想担心，其实我一直有在攒钱。
Ladies and gentlemen, please don't argue, and no need to worry about my dream. I've actually been saving up.

斯普特尼克：大概再有五年我就能正好攒够！不出意外还能享受到员工价！
In about five years, I should have enough! And with any luck, I'll even get an employee discount!

杰洛：攒够钱飞上天？员工价？……
Saving enough to fly to space? An employee discount?

贝克特：……迪斯科球的待遇……
... Does a disco ball get such great benefits?

杰洛：……那么好的么？
... Do they really?

小目标、大目标
Small Goals, Big Goals

最初的伙伴
The First Companion 小径

J: 嘿，这里有一个——假人模特?
What's a mannequin doing all the way over here?

J: 瞅瞅你，不应该待在高档商店的橱窗里吗?
Look at you, shouldn't you be in the window of some fancy store?

假人: 您好，先生。
Greetings, sir.

J: 哈，你还会说话？我可没料到这点。
Whoa, you can talk? Wild, didn't see that coming.

假人: 我想是的，这的确……很奇妙。我也还在适应。
I suppose so, yes ... It is rather unusual. I'm still getting used to it myself.

假人: 先生，或许您也已经注意到了，我的胳膊现在正卡在这堆垃圾里头，能劳驾您搭把手，帮我减轻点儿痛苦么?
Sir, as you may have noticed, my arm is currently stuck in this pile of trash. Could you kindly lend a hand and help relieve my pain?

J: 没问题，但下次请我帮忙时你得改改那假客气的语气。
Sure, buddy, but the next time you ask for help, drop the phony politeness.

J: ……你找的是这根么？伙计。
Is this what you are looking for?

假人: 正是！先生，四肢健全的自由感觉真好，我该怎么报答您?
Exactly! Sir, the feeling of having all four limbs free is wonderful. How can I repay you?

J: 那就和我说说一个能说会动的假人是怎么进到垃圾堆里的，我现在就想知道这个。
Tell me how a talking, moving mannequin ended up in a trash heap—that's what I'm curious about.

假人: 咳咳，好心的先生，兜售故事并不是我擅长的领域。这事儿真说起来，恐怕得讲上三天三夜，而且，或许也远没有您想象中那么有趣。
Ahem, kind sir, storytelling is not my forte. This tale, I'm afraid, could take three days to tell, and it may be far less interesting than you think.

J: 有不有趣得等我听了再说，你只管讲就是了。
I'll be the judge of that.

假人: 既然如此，这件事恐怕得从去年圣诞开始讲起……
In that case, we shall begin with last Christmas ...

J: 等下，你真打算讲三天?
You really are gonna talk for three days, aren't you?

J: 你打算站着讲我可没打算站着听，跟我来。
I have no intention of standing around while you do. Come with me.

J: 我知道家好餐馆，能让你围着桌子说个够，没准还能帮你谋个新工作。
I know of a great restaurant where we can chat over a meal and maybe even help you find a new job.

假人: 感谢您，先生，您真是有一副热心肠，请问我要怎么称呼您呢?
Thank you, sir. You truly have a kind heart. May I ask what I should call you?

J: 乔，这条街的伙计们都叫我 J。你呢？你叫什么？我的假人伙计。
Joe, but the folks on this street call me J. And you? What's your name, my mannequin friend?

先驱者：先驱者，先生，我想以后认识我的人都会叫我先驱者。
Pioneer, sir. I think people will call me Pioneer from now on.

最初的伙伴
The First Companion

娱乐不至死 · 2/2
Won't Be Amused to Death · 2/2 FT-02

吧台上的男人起身，挡住不走运的小偷，提起了他的后脖子。
Becket moves to block the little thief, grabbing him by the scruff of the neck.

他掀开小偷的兜帽。
He takes a look at the thief's face.

贝克特：哈，我就知道，郊区拖车营的惯犯，猫眼维森。
Becket: Ha, knew it, Cateye Wisen, owner of the most infamous sticky fingers from here to the Market and back.

贝克特：小子，你爸爸跟“启明会”那帮人搭上关系又失踪之后，你怎么没跟救济所的那帮人走？那里有吃有喝的，你是想念挨揍的滋味了吗？
Becket: Little dude, I know your dad ran off with those guys from the "Order of Enlightenment." But why didn't you go to the shelter? You trying to get yourself hurt out here?

猫眼维森：噗——！你这个混球，有种把我放开！
Cateye Wisen: Let me go, you big jerk!

一口唾沫啐在了贝克特的脸上。
The would-be thief spits on his face.

贝克特：呵，这种狗崽子迟早得放进局子里让那帮穿制服的家伙管教管教——
Becket: Humph, sooner or later, someone is gonna teach you a lesson or two.

贝克特：你的神秘学家老妈给你留下这么好一双猫眼，肯定想不到竟然被你用作扒窃去了。
Becket: Don't think that arcanist mom of yours wants you using your "cat eye" to steal things.

贝克特抓住男孩的手，夺走他怀里仅剩的硬币。
Becket grabs the boy's hand, taking his remaining coins.

与此同时，男孩手背上露出了惊心触目的烟蒂烫痕。
As he does, he reveals a gruesome cigarette burn on the boy's hand.

贝克特：……嘿，小子，我也知道你挺过了一段不容易的日子，但别认为全世界都欠着你。
Becket: I know things seem tough right now, kid. But acting like the world owes you something ... it's gonna bring you nothing but trouble.

贝克特：我被机器搅断小拇指，被那帮寄生虫一脚踢开的时候，可没拿着枪、蒙着脸挨个抢商店……你这点儿痛苦又算得上什么？
Becket: When I got my finger chewed up by that machine, I lost everything. I coulda went around sticking up places. I didn't. Think you got it worse than me?

环状水星：……
Mercuria: ...

一旁，环状水星拾取贝壳一般，捡起了脏兮兮的硬币，迎面走了过来。
Mercuria picks up the coins strewn about the floor and walks over to them.

她拍了拍贝克特，示意把他放下来。
She signals Becket to let the boy go.

贝克特：嘿，你难道还想纵容这混小子吗?
Becket: Hey, we gonna let him go just like that?

男孩还是被放了下来，两脚瘫软在地。
As he releases his grip, the boy falls to the ground.

环状水星蹲下身，轻轻打开他的手掌，把硬币塞回了他脏兮兮的手心。
Mercuria lowers herself to the boy's level, gently slipping the coins back into his dirty hand.

环状水星：去吧，你的朋友还在外面等你呢。
Mercuria: Go on. Your friends are waiting out there.

他们望向门外。一群衣衫褴褛、蓬头垢面的孩子发现了目光，连连畏畏缩缩地躲到了门后。
They look toward the door. A group of ragged, filthy children are watching them back, retreating timidly as they meet their gaze.

斯普特尼克：可，J 先生……
Sputnik: But, Mr. J ...

J：……没关系，给他们吧。
J: It's fine, Sputnik. Let 'em go.

环状水星：这些都是在新纪元集市里失去了家的孩子……他们的监护人丢下了他们，不知所踪，留下他们四处游荡。
Mercuria: These kids lost their homes to the New Age Market. Their parents deserted them. They've got nowhere to go.

J：……
J: ...

贝克特：……
Becket: ...

环状水星：贝克特先生，瞧瞧他们……
Mercuria: Becket, look at them.

环状水星：苦难是不会相形见绌的。
Mercuria: You can't compare. It doesn't work like that. Each suffering has its own energy.

猫眼维森颤颤巍巍地站了起来，低下头，喃喃着谢谢，走向门口。
The boy picks himself up, muttering a "thank you" as he walks uneasily toward the door.

一只手搭在了男孩的肩膀上。
Before he reaches it, a hand rests on his shoulder.

J：我说，小子……
J: Hey, kid.

J：——你和你那帮跟班，想不想找点活儿?
J: You and your friends looking for some almost-honest cash?

猫眼维森：……！你的意思是——
Cateye Wisen: You mean ...!

猫眼维森：谢……谢你，先生。
Cateye Wisen: T-Thanks, J.

猫眼维森：我的眼睛很敏锐！我能干很多细活……我擅长数火车、数硬币，我还可以看穿那些出千的发牌员，连水滴都能数清楚！
Cateye Wisen: I got sharp eyes! I can do lots of stuff! Counting coins, cars, finding water drops ... I'm great at spotting cheats and shady dealers!

J 拍拍他的肩膀。
J pats him in a brotherly gesture.

J: 别着急，小子，先填饱肚子。
J: Easy, kid. Fill your belly first.

J: 斯普特尼克女士，请替我给他们每人做一份热乎乎的墨西哥卷，多放点肉——该死的，瞧瞧他的手腕，真是比唐人街的筷子还细。
J: Ms. Sputnik, please get these kids some burritos. Dang kid, those arms are like chopsticks. Hey, Ms. Sputnik? Let's make those extra meat.

J: 还有，就当我改主意了吧，伙计——
J: Alright, man. Consider my second thought, thought over.

他整个人趴在吧台上，对着一张老旧的合影长叹了口气。
He slumps over the bar, giving a long sigh at an old photograph in his hand.

那是一张过于热情、充满关切的脸，撞上了另一份渴望距离与自由，以及理想的冷漠。
In the photo, he stares at the girl caringly, while she looks cold, longing for independence and freedom.

但不管如何——
Regardless—

J: 唉……
J: *sigh*

J: 不管如何，到时候她如果翘着腿坐在办公桌前，给我摆出一副高高在上的架子——伙计，我保证，谁也拦不住我跨出那扇门！
J: But get this straight: if I see her fold her arms and give me any of that snooty attitude, we're gone, out the door, no discussion!

小匣子
A Small Box FT-03

旧房间
An Old Room

风晃荡着窗扇，从破洞里窜了进来。
The wind sways the window shutters as it blows in through its gaps.

薄弱的木门隔绝不住外面的喧嚣，杯子碰撞、客人的咒骂声连续不断。
The thin door does nothing to block out the noise beyond it—clattering dishes, clinking glasses, and chattering talk peppered with curses.

蜷缩在床上的女孩吸溜着鼻子，紧紧抱着小熊。
Curled up on the bed, a girl sniffles, holding her teddy bear tightly.

保利娜：呜……可是哥哥……从孤儿院里出来的白袍子先生们说，学校里没有凶巴巴的客人，没有耍赖皮的雇主……
Paulina: *sob* But, but Joe! Those men in white said there won't be any more bad people around the school.

保利娜：每个孩子都能吃得饱饱的，就跟爸爸妈妈还在的时候一样～
Paulina: And nobody will be hungry, just like before, like with Mom and Dad.

保利娜：他们每个星期都会给孩子们提供巧克力、布丁、热汤和牛排……还有超大、超舒适的屋子……咻溜。
Paulina: They'll give us candy, and soup, and real meat every week, and a big, comfy house. *sniff*

她举起小手，夸张地比划着。
She raises her little hand, as if reaching out to a dream-like house.

保利娜：咻咻……啊嚏！
Paulina: *sniff* Achoo!

J：呵呵，快把手缩回去，把被子裹好，保利娜。
J: Heh heh, cover up a little more, Polly. You're gonna catch a cold.

坐在小板凳上的男孩，翻过满是柴油的手心，用手背擦了擦她的鼻子。
Her brother wipes her nose with the back of his coarse and callused hand.

J：保利娜，这些大人是不会说话算话的……如果他们给你糖果，就会取走你的另一样东西。
J: You can't trust anything adults tell you like that. If they give us candy, or soup, or even meat, it's because they want something from you.

J：如果他们多给你一份小费，也不是因为他们慷慨，而是因为他们有求于你。
J: Nothing you get in this world is just given away. Least of all from people like them.

保利娜：可是，他们确实给了我一个不错的工作，瞧，我现在编那些稻草娃娃就能卖钱。
Paulina: But, but they did give me a fun job! See, now I can make straw dolls and sell them for money.

老旧的木桌上，堆叠着一大堆简陋的娃娃。
The shabby pile of dolls are stacked up on an old wooden table nearby.

J：那是因为他们需要你，保利娜的心灵手巧可是海特街数一数二的～
J: That's 'cause they need you. Our little Paulina is one of the most cleverest kids in all of Haight Street!

保利娜：所以他们是坏人吗？
Paulina: So, are they bad guys?

J：他们当然是。除了唐吉老爹，那些大人都是一样的坏人。
J: Bet on it. Only good adult I ever met is Mr. Tang.

保利娜：唔……好吧——可如果，如果他们说的是真的……你就再也不用洗盘子、卸轮胎，干那些又苦又累的活了……
Paulina: Hmm, okay. But Joe, what if they're not lying, then you don't have to wash dishes, or take off tires or any of that stuff.

唐吉老爹：J……嘿，J！过来搭把手，客人需要两打啤酒！
Tang Ji: J, hey, J! Two dozen beers for our guests. Get a move on, lazy boy!

洪亮又高亢的嗓音穿过了木门。
A loud voice booms through the door, his tone sharp but strangely paternal.

J：嘿，保利娜，别为我想那么多好吗？除了这里，我哪儿都不去。
J: Don't overthink it, 'kay kiddo? I'm right here with you, always will be.

保利娜：那……我们说好了，如果你要去的话，一定要告诉我……谁也不许一个人离开。
Paulina: Okay. But if you do leave, you have to tell me first! Because we'll always stick together! Deal?

J：当然，我们说好了。
J: Deal.

他揉搓着她的头发，替她与玩具小熊盖上了被子。
He rubs her hair before tucking her and her bear into the blanket.

J：晚安，保利娜。
J: Sleep tight, Polly.

基金会旧金山分部·办事处走廊
Foundation Branch Office, San Francisco

一束束毫厘不差的石柱，沉默地融入墙体之中。
Perfectly aligned stone columns blend into the walls.

地面一尘不染，就连自由落体的光，无一不井然有序。
The floor is spotless, overly tidy, even the lights above shine in exact symmetrical patterns.

那是跟嘈杂与污水遍地的街头小巷，跟充斥着油烟与老鼠的矮房子，全然不同的存在。
It is a distant and alien world to them, nothing like the cluttered alleys and unkempt streets of home.

J：这帮人还真为自己造了一所宫殿……他们到底把自己当成了什么救世主?
J: This place is Ritz'd up like a palace. Who do they think they are?

J：哪有人需要那么干净的地板，他们是每天都牵一条小狗把地板舔一遍吗?
J: Who needs a floor that shines like a mirror? What, they hire a dog to lick it clean every day?

先驱者：这座建筑也令我讶异，住在其中之人想必都拥有极高的审美趣味……
Pioneer: Oh. Philistine as ever, J. It's evident the people here must possess exceptional aesthetic taste.

J：伙计，事到如今，咱们就别拍他们的马屁了，好吗？我打赌，保利娜住在这样的“防空洞”里，肯定不像在咱们的小屋子里那么有安全感！
J: I'm at my limit of you sucking up to them. This place is built like a fortress, a bomb shelter. Makes me feel like I've got a target on my back. Can't imagine why anyone would feel safer here.

J：我有一个艺术家朋友可说过：“干净是对想象力的破坏！”这么大的屋子，虽然看上去阔绰，但其实也——
J: You ask any artist, they'll say "clean kills the soul"! Might look clean and tidy on the outside, but inside—

左顾右盼之时，他丝毫没发现正迎面走来的三位职员。
He looks around absent-mindedly, failing to notice the three staff members walking in his way.

“砰。”——两个肩膀相撞，又错开。
Wham—Shoulders collide, sending the small girl sprawling over.

玛蒂尔达：嗷！疼死了……真倒霉，怎么又碰上个愣头愣脑的笨家伙。
Matilda: Oouphf! That hurt! Ergh, just what this place needs, another stupid oaf that does not know how to watch where he is going!

J：嘿，保持体面，傲慢的小家伙。
J: Hey, mind your manners, short stuff.

玛蒂尔达：你说什么？谁是小家伙?
Matilda: Excuse me? D-Did you just call me short stuff?

J 的身躯并未因为对方逐步升高的气焰而显露让步的打算。
J is clearly taking pleasure in the petite girl's annoyed outburst.

先驱者：呃，抱歉小姐，我替他向您道歉。
Pioneer: I apologize for my friend, Miss. He ought to mind his own manners.

玛蒂尔达：算了，你们看上去像是初次来访，我也没什么好计较的。
Matilda: Hmph. Considering you two look as though you have just wandered in like, how do you say, "lost puppies"? I'll let it go, just this once.

小队成员 I： 你们是来分部进行神秘学家登记的吗？我们有两位登记员正在换班，你们得稍等一会儿……

Team Member I: Are you here to register as arcanists? Sorry, we're just in the middle of a shift change. Please wait a moment.

小队成员 II： 菲娜不是还在值班么？现在也该到了她能独立办事的时候……

Team Member II: Isn't it Fiona's shift? She should be able to handle this on her own.

玛蒂尔达： 好了。出发前的准备时间所剩无几了……我们还有重要的事情呢，队员们。

Matilda: There is work to be done, people. Quickly, vite vite!

小队成员 I： 好的……

Team Member I: Got it.

她带着他们，脚步飞快。

She leads the team away with swift half-stomping steps.

职员菲娜： 您、您好！这里是圣洛夫基金会办事处，请问您需要什么帮助?

Fiona: H-hello! Welcome to the St. Pavlov Foundation reception center. How can I help you?

先驱者： 我们来拜访他的妹妹——呃，出于一些私人事务的缘由，我们希望能和她直接见面。

Pioneer: Hello, we're here to visit a member of your staff for, um, some private matters. If possible, we'd like to have a conversation with her in person.

职员的笑容略有僵硬。

The staff member's smile is visibly forced.

职员菲娜： ……没关系，你们可以先阅读这里的注意事项，并填写表格……噢！

Fiona: Sure, please read the visitor's advisory here and fill out these forms. Ah!

手上一大叠密密麻麻的纸质文件，掉落在地。

The dense tower of paper tumbles out of her hands, spilling out over the floor.

职员菲娜： 咳，没问题，这些只是小事情。我很快就递给你们。

Fiona: Um, so sorry, sir. Just let me pick these up.

男人弯下腰，热情地帮她捡拾着。

J bends down to help her pick up the documents.

J： 放松点儿，女士。我们只是来找我的妹妹……她是你们圣洛夫基金会的职员，现在呢……估摸还只是一位名不见经传的小家伙。

J: Relax, Miss. It's nothing, just a short visit to my sister. She's like a clerk here or something, nothing important.

J： 她的名字叫作保利娜·勒萨奇，您可以告诉她，她尊敬的哥哥前来拜访，请她务必腾出时间……

J: Her name's Paulina Lesage. Just tell her that it's her brother, just popping by for a visit.

职员菲娜： ……

Fiona: ...

一场古怪的沉默降临。

The receptionist falls silent and pale.

职员菲娜： 保利娜·勒萨奇……嗯。您能告诉我，您的名字吗?

Fiona: Paulina Lesage ... Could you tell me your name again?

J： 乔，乔·布朗，您可以叫我 J。

J: It's Joe. Joe Brown. You can call me J.

职员焦急地在凌乱的纸张中翻翻找找，终于抽出了一张纸。

Fiona anxiously shifts through the scattered papers.

她低头看向手中的名单，又抬起头审视着眼前人，如此反复几次——
She looks down at the list in her hand, then up at the person in front of her, repeating the process several times—

仿佛在确认一件慎之又慎的事务。
As if confirming something with delicate care.

接着，她毫不迟疑地站起身来。
Then, she stands, and after regaining her composure, begins walking down the hall.

职员菲娜： 请跟我来。
Fiona: Follow me, please.

职员菲娜： 我加入圣洛夫基金会的时候，认识的第一位职员就是保利娜女士……她的聪明伶俐远甚于我，所以也很快就开始担任重要的职务。
Fiona: Ms. Paulina was one of the first people I met when I joined the Foundation. She was so talented, so incredible. It was no wonder they gave her all the big assignments.

职员菲娜： 她带着骨子里的骄傲，可从不会怠慢别人，所以我喜欢询问她的意见。
Fiona: I could always tell she was very proud, but not in an arrogant way. She never turned her back on people. I always knew I could turn to her for advice.

他们向着走廊的尽头走去。
They walk to the end of the corridor.

身旁的职员行色匆匆，但每张脸都若隐若现着笑容，仿佛这是节前的最后一个工作日。
As the staff members move about their work, there is a spirit in the air, light—almost joyful—as if it were the day before a holiday.

基金会职员 I： 重塑……他们抱头鼠窜，连地窖里的物资都顾不上，你猜他们还能撑多久?
Foundation Staff I: Haha, it's the first time that we swept Manus that badly. They even forgot the rest of their supplies in the basement. What are they gonna do without those?

基金会职员 I： 而且我们尚有余力，听说……“剃刀”小队已经开始追查基金会失踪的那批重要资产了……
Foundation Staff I: Now that we have some spare manpower to chase after them, I heard that team "Razor" started searching for the Foundation's lost assets.

基金会职员 I： 这可是头一回，我们能重拾旧案。
Foundation Staff I: After all this time, we're finally back on the trail.

基金会职员 II： 我不知道，朋友……虽然这是个好消息，但那些新闻也闹得太沸沸扬扬了，有不少人得意过了头，擅自离开基金会，把舆论搞得乱糟糟的……
Foundation Staff II: I don't know, man. Good as it seems to be. I'm worried the news is getting out of control! Now rumors are spreading everywhere. It could get dangerous!

基金会职员 II： 不然上头也不会把我们从总部调过来，跟着伯纳德先生，去解决这些层出不穷的“问题”了……
Foundation Staff II: Otherwise, why would we have been assigned here with Mr. Bernard to get to the bottom of this?

基金会职员 I： 嘘——小声点儿。
Foundation Staff I: Shh, zip it.

职员菲娜： 咳咳……
Fiona: Ahem.

门口攀谈的人发现了陌生的访客，连忙躲开目光，作鸟兽散了。
The people chatting by the door take notice of the unfamiliar visitors, shifting their gaze as they make way.

J: 你们这里是发生了什么天大的好事？每个人脸上都乐呵呵的，跟一群收到小费的服务员似的。
J: What, you guys having a party or something? Never seen an office so ... "smiley."

先驱者：我喜欢这股阳光的劲儿，百货大厦的男孩女孩们都是这副面孔……而且一般来说，他们也会给别人带来好消息。
Pioneer: Feels like a sales day at the mall, all those eager girls and boys running past the window. A mood like this usually comes with good news.

职员菲娜：还请不要在意这些人的话，他们私底下的讨论并不代表基金会的共识，也可能会误导你们……
Fiona: Please don't pay them any mind. They're, uh, just chit-chatting, doesn't really mean anything. It might mislead you even.

她从口袋中拿出钥匙，插入门扇的锁孔。
She takes a key from her pocket and inserts it into the lock.

可一瞬间，她没有转动把手——只是恍惚地站在那里，似乎有些抵触。
But she doesn't turn the handle. Her hand rests on it reluctantly.

职员菲娜：呼……
Fiona: *panting*

职员菲娜：请跟紧我，先生们。
Fiona: Gentlemen, come in, please.

基金会旧金山分部·档案室
Archive Room, San Francisco Branch

由近至远，一束束灯光从头顶降临。
Beams of harsh light descend from above, stretching near to far.

这是一个空旷而寂静的空间。
The space is vast and silent.

职员菲娜：您或许不知道，此前，我们经历了数百场无功而返的实验，白白耗费了时间与资源，像无头苍蝇，徘徊在无根无据的迷宫之中。
Fiona: Despite all the smiles, it hasn't been easy for us recently. Our time and resources have been stretched thin. We've suffered a lot of losses.

职员菲娜：如今就算我站在这里，也总会神情恍惚。
Fiona: It still feels a little unreal that we're still standing.

职员菲娜：人们前仆后继，奉出了他们最珍贵的东西，才得以达到如今这个崭新的局面。
Fiona: A lot of good people sacrificed everything they had to get us where we are.

无数个透明的匣子，摆放在墙柜之中，邮票大小的照片贴在上面。
The walls are lined with transparent cabinets, each marked by a stamp-sized photo.

照片旁的标签编号，数字犹如计时器般，增加、进位——
Next to the photos, the label numbers increase like a timer, progressing digit by digit.

由零到一，由一到零，循环往复……
The numbers grow, ticking over from tens to hundreds and further.

职员菲娜：咳咳……抱歉，我似乎说了一些令你们困惑的话。
Fiona: Ahem. Excuse me, I suppose that's also just idle chit-chat. Maybe I don't know any more than they do.

职员菲娜：我只是想说……保利娜是我见过的最优秀的职员——而她的家人有权知道这些。
Fiona: I only just wanted to say, since you're family, that Ms. Paulina was one of the best people I've ever met, an asset to everyone here at the Foundation.

她停住了脚步，站在一面毫不起眼的墙柜前。
She stops before yet another column of cabinets, no different from the many behind and in front of them.

如果不是那些照片，不会有任何一个人觉察出这些墙柜的区别。
Each one the same as every other, except for the photo.

职员菲娜：先生们——圣洛夫基金会所有的殉职人员……都在这里。
Fiona: Gentlemen, this is where the remains of all those that died in the service of the St. Pavlov Foundation are kept in memorial.

职员菲娜：而保利娜……就在你们眼前。
Fiona: I'm so sorry that I have to be the one t-to tell you, but, Paulina is here, too.

不是墓碑，亦不是棺柩，只是一只又窄又小的透明匣子。
There is no grave, no coffin or epitaph. Just a transparent cabinet to serve as her headstone.

那样稀松平常，与小女孩藏着秘密的宝箱并没有不同，就好像只是一出玩笑。
A plain and ordinary box, void of any sentiment.

J：……

J: ...

J：……呃。

J: Umm ...

J：你明白你在说什么吗，女士?

J: You better know what you're saying, Miss.

他不想认出那件东西——但他比任何人都清楚，他已经看见了。
He pretends not to see it, but he knows exactly what is there.

那抹，简单又熟悉的蓝丝带。
That unmistakably familiar blue ribbon.

先驱者：……呃，女士，能请你给我们一些独处的空间吗?

Pioneer: I'm sorry, Fiona, dear. Would you mind giving us a moment of privacy?

职员菲娜：……我在外面等候各位。

Fiona: I'll be waiting outside.

她的身影渐趋渐远，直到消失不见。
Her figure grows more and more distant, receding back through the space until vanishes altogether.

……

...

先驱者：伙计，告诉我，你在想什么?

Pioneer: J, are you going to be alright?

先驱者：……

Pioneer: ...

先驱者：J，告诉我！我能为你做些什么……需要我把匣子打开吗?

Pioneer: Talk to me, J! Is there anything I can do for you? Maybe we can take a look, just to be sure.

J：不，不要，什么也不要做，该死的，你什么也不要做!

J: No, don't-don't do anything. Damn it! Don't you f**king do a damn thing!

他在努力克制。
He struggles against himself, failing to hold himself back.

J: 她怎么可能，怎么可能待在那么小、那么小一个匣子里……?!
J: How can all that someone is, was, be in a box like this? It's so small?!

J: 我发誓，他们在糊弄我——
J: This is some kind of sick joke!

先驱者: J!
Pioneer: J!

先驱者: 冷静一些!!!
Pioneer: Easy, J. Easy.

先驱者紧紧抓住他的臂膀，双眼直视着他。
Pioneer grips his arm tightly, staring directly at him.

那是一段沉默、凝滞的时间。
The atmosphere is filled with heavy, unspoken tension.

直到 J 终于抬起眼，与他对视。
Until J lifts his gaze to meet the mannequin's own.

先驱者: ……呆在这儿，让我去核对，把照片给我。
Pioneer: Do you have her photo? You stay here. I'll go double-check.

J 颤抖着手，从兜里掏出了那张皱巴巴的旧合影。
With trembling hands, J pulls out the crumpled old photograph from his pocket.

先驱者: ……呼。
Pioneer: *deep breath*

他深呼一口气，拿着合影，比对着匣子上的相片。
He holds the photograph, comparing it closely to the one on the box.

讶异瞬间爬上了他的脸。
Then a strange look of astonishment washes over him.

先驱者: J……J!
Pioneer: J ... J!

先驱者: 这是怎么一回事？过来！伙计，站起来看看！
Pioneer: ... This can't be right. Come here, J. You need to take a look at this!

地上的男人行尸走肉般地走了过去，紧接着——
J walks toward him like a zombie, and then—

J: 她们的脸……他们在搞什么?
J: Wait, this? What the heck?

J: 这根本就不是同一个人?!
J: This isn't Paulina?!

仿若有一盏灯突然打从他的脑袋旁亮起。
It is as if a light suddenly flickers on over his head.

J: 你知道吗？我总算是弄明白了！这或许该死的就是一场骗局！那个门外的家伙根本就不想让咱们拜访保利娜！
J: So, then, what? This was all some kind of bulls**t?! That woman out there just decided to mess with my mind? Or did she not want us to see Paulina?

先驱者: ……也许是他们贴错了照片?
Pioneer: Maybe they got the photo wrong?

J: 不，我现在看清楚了，瞧瞧那只手上的戒指！我从没听过保利娜在什么时候订了婚！
J: No, no. Look at that ring on her finger! Polly wasn't married. She couldn't be. She would have told me.

J: 保利娜根本不想见我！所以才拜托她的朋友演了这么一出戏，却没想到她露出了个大马脚。
J: Unless, she just doesn't wanna see me at all. So maybe she put her friend up to all of this, but this, this just gives her away!

J: 她以前跟我说过，就算死在外面也不跟我回去。
J: Polly said it herself: She'd rather die than stay with me and never live at all. I knew then she'd never look back.

J: 天呐，太愚蠢了。我就不该到这儿来。
J: Man, this was stupid! Never should've let you talk me into coming here.

先驱者: 噢，我见过很多不对付的兄妹，他们顶多也就是彼此互踹一脚，打个小报告争宠。但你们，你们的关系可真是糟糕到了一个地步……
Pioneer: I know that sometimes brothers and sisters don't get along. But I thought that only meant little fights, quarrels over toys. This is something much worse.

J: 我们得趁早离开这地方……呃，我一想到保利娜正在某个地方盯着我们的一举一动，捧腹大笑，就恨不得把这儿掀个底儿朝天。
J: We're leaving. Now. Ugh, I can't stand the idea that she's just looking at me through a monitor, maybe even laughing at her pathetic loser brother. Get me out of here before I turn this place upside down!

……

...

职员菲娜: J 先生，您感到好一些了吗?
Fiona: I apologize. I'm sure this loss must feel ...

男人掩面而泣，先驱者拍着他的肩膀，就仿佛安慰一位丧夫的妻子。
J hides his face, making an exaggerated show of his tears, while Pioneer gently pats his shoulder.

J: 呜呜呜……抱歉，我的泪都快流干了，这打击实在是，让我痛彻心扉。
J: *sob* Mhmm. Such heart-wrenching news. I'm crying my eyes out.

他带着哭腔一颤一颤，就差一条丝绸手帕给他拭去不存在的眼泪。
It is an oddly captivating performance. If Haight Street didn't work out, perhaps he ought to head to Hollywood.

先驱者: 但如今尘埃落定，我们就不便在这里打搅你们的工作了……J，我们走吧。
Pioneer: Oh. But there's nothing we can do now. Sorry for bothering you. We'll be on our way out now. Let's go, J.

他们互相搀扶着，谁见了也得心碎。
Propped up on one of the mannequin's shoulder, the heartbreaking act is nearly flawless.

职员菲娜: 请等等……先生们，你们还需要做个访客登记。
Fiona: Please wait, gentlemen, you need to fill the visitor's log form first.

职员菲娜: 以及……我找找……唔，应该就是这个！
Fiona: And, let me see, this one.

她抽出一张又黄又旧的纸张。
She pulls out a yellowed and worn piece of paper.

职员菲娜: 请您在这上面签下作为唯一家属的您的名字……
Fiona: Please, sign your name here as her next of kin.

J：殉职人员家属……同意书？这是什么意思？
J: Consent form ... to document that I've confirmed the death of a Foundation staff member ... What is this?

他诧异地抬起头，却突然想到脸上没有涟涟泪水，于是又低了回去。
He looks up with disdain, catching himself as he remembers his supposedly weeping face is dry, and buries it back down again.

J：咳、咳……呜，为什么还要让我签字？您没看见，我已经无法再承受更多的打击了吗？
J: Why do I have to sign? Don't you understand I can't take any more of this?

职员菲娜：还请您谅解，这是我们的工作……我们得确认那些殉职的职员得到了家属的认领，并依此给您发放一笔抚恤金……
Fiona: I'm sorry, but please bear with me. I thought we might confirm her belongings with you. It's standard policy, though usually within the foundation. Then I could ask my superiors. Maybe they'd let you take these home.

职员菲娜：请在这里签下您的姓名与地址……
Fiona: Here, I'll just need your name and address.

J：什么……？你们的玩笑太过界了，女士。
J: What? That's just sick, Miss.

他的表情骤变，像吃了一个霉果子。
His expression changes abruptly, rising up into a bitter scowl.

J：你的意思是让我为了一叠钞票，签署一份死亡证明？证明我的妹妹为了你们所谓的崇高理想死在了半途之中——即便她自打娘胎起就不长那样！
J: You're really asking me to sign some papers? For what? So you can hand me off some old junk and pretend this never happened? You think that's enough to get me to stop asking questions? Where is she?!?

J：伙计，我们的灵魂可还没被打折抛售！
J: Did you really think it would be this easy, sis? That I didn't care?

他拽住先驱者，头也不回地离开了。
He grabs Pioneer and runs off without looking back.

职员菲娜：先生——**先生！**
Fiona: Sir! **SIR!**

职员菲娜：……
Fiona: ...

职员菲娜：……安保人员，拦住那两位没有登记的先生，他们还没签署保密协议！
Fiona: Security, stop those two gentlemen! They haven't signed the confidentiality agreement!

还没等安保人员反应，他们已经窜进了沙丁鱼般的人潮中。
Before security can react, the duo have already escaped into the crowd.

J：借过、借过，朋友们，把你们高贵的手肘抬回去！
J: 'Scuse me! 'Scuse me! Man, move your ass or get moved!

他们犹如裹了油的野猫，滑溜溜地窜过熙熙攘攘的职员。
They dart through the bustling halls, dodging employees with cat-like grace.

先驱者：他们是怎么一回事？就好像我们是没付钱的顾客一样，怎么一个个全扑上来了?!
Pioneer: What's going on? They're after us like we are trying to ditch a bill for dinner.

J: 该死……我跟你说过了，这帮政府的混蛋都一个样儿，谁不服他们那可笑的说辞，谁的脑袋就会开瓢！
J: Told you these Foundation creeps are all the same! Soon as you don't buy what they're selling, they start trying to get you shot!

J: 总之，我宁愿让我妹妹，亲自站在我眼前告诉我“滚远点，J”，也绝不会同意保利娜这个跟我断绝关系的法子！
J: If she wants to cut me loose, then she can damn well say it to my face, but not like this, not this bulls**t!

他们很快离开了走廊。
They wind through the twisting corridors, until at last they find an exit and dive through.

走廊上一阵不安的骚动……人们聚拢，涌动。
There is a wave of uneasy commotion in the hallway as people gathered in a throng.

一位高大的男人穿过人群，人们肃静了。
A tall man moves through the crowd. As he passes, the throng goes silent.

伯纳德：发生什么事了，菲娜？
Bernard: Fiona, can you tell me what happened here?

新客人
A New Guest FT-04

基金会旧金山分部·客房
Guest Room, San Francisco Branch

床铺上是被叠得整整齐齐的衣服，行李箱则是半张开嘴的状态。
Neatly stacked clothes lie on the bed, the suitcase open and empty.

时近出发的前夜，她在屋子里来回转悠、收拾。
On the eve of her departure, she paces back and forth in the room, tidying as she goes.

玛蒂尔达：77 号公路……唔，《UTTU》的编辑怎么爱在那种偏僻的地方活动，真令人捉摸不透……他们真的知道有关兀尔德的消息吗？
Matilda: Route 77 ... Hmm, I don't understand. Why would the editor of UTTU visit such a desolate place? What could this mean about Urd?

玛蒂尔达：不管如何，至少我还可以顺便去拜访妈妈一趟，哼哼。
Matilda: Alright then, at least I can drop by and visit Mama. Humph.

玛蒂尔达：妈妈这次肯定会大吃一惊，伟大的玛蒂尔达如今取得的成就，能令所有家族成员都为之骄傲！
Matilda: That will most certainly be a surprise! What their Matilda has achieved will make the whole family proud!

玛蒂尔达：“瞧瞧是谁的宝贝女儿当上了圣洛夫基金会的特派调查员？布翁尼家族的荣光，如今传到了绝顶聪明的玛蒂尔达手里！”
Matilda: "My daughter, my Matilda, a special investigator for the St. Pavlov Foundation! Now little Matilda adds another star to the Bouanich family line!"

玛蒂尔达：哼哼♫♪♬～
Matilda: *humming*

“咚咚咚——”
"Knock, knock, knock ..."

敲门声不合时宜地传来。
The sound of knocking comes at an inconvenient time.

小队成员 I： 玛蒂尔达小姐，能请您出来一下吗？我们的任务，被取消了……
Team Member I: Ms. Bouanich, a moment of your time? Unfortunately, it seems our mission has been canceled.

玛蒂尔达： 什么？发生了什么？
Matilda: Canceled? Why?

小队成员 I： 您或许已经听说了关于菲娜的事情……
Team Member I: You may have heard what Fiona did.

玛蒂尔达： 嗯……外面的动静不小，我听说她由于刚刚出任登记员，对我们接待神秘学家的流程尚且不太熟悉，所以……
Matilda: Well, I had heard the chatter about it certainly, but she only just started as a receptionist. It is no matter if she is a little unfamiliar with the processes and ...

小队成员 I： 是啊，她记错了规定，误将“暴雨”后早已取消的《殉职家属探访规定》，套用在了两位不明就里的拜访者身上。
Team Member I: Per regulations since the first "Storm," families of the deceased employees are no longer informed of their deaths, but she made a mistake, or forgot.

小队成员 I： 那两位神秘学家，在没有签署任何保密条约的情况下逃出了圣洛夫基金会。
Team Member I: And the two arcanists she received earlier got away from her near the memorial hall. They didn't even fill out the proper forms.

玛蒂尔达： 太糟糕了。这是一起相当严重的情报泄露事故……
Matilda: Ah, not good. That could indeed represent a serious intelligence leak.

小队成员 I： 嗯，鉴于这个年代的信息传播速率，伯纳德先生认为……我们迫切需要稳定舆论，尤其是对那些记者与媒体。
Team Member I: And Mr. Bernard asked that we get ahead of the narrative, before it gets to the press, given how fast the news spreads in this day and age.

小队成员 I： 为了防止情报泄露范围进一步扩大，我们需要尽快找到那两名拜访者。
Team Member I: New orders are for us to find these two visitors and prevent the information from further spreading.

玛蒂尔达： 我们?
Matilda: Us?

玛蒂尔达： ——我明白了。也就是说，追踪《UTTU》编辑的任务将会分派给其他调查员……
Matilda: Of course. So then, our present task tracking down the editor of UTTU will be reassigned to some other team.

小队成员 I： 是的，因为根据信息，那两位逃跑的神秘学家……
Team Member I: Correct, ma'am. Tracking down these two arcanists was given top priority, and ...

小队成员 I： 曾与我们打过照面。
Team Member I: Those two were the same ones you ran into earlier today.

新纪元集市
New Age Market

占卜师、魔药学家……诸多神秘学家齐聚在一起，构成了这场盛大的集市。
Fortune-tellers, alchemists, and arcanists of all stripes gathered together, creating a sprawling marketplace.

从魔精栓绳到炼金术珍本，再到琳琅满目的药草……商品眼花缭乱，往来的游客络绎不绝。
From magic-infused cords to rare alchemical texts, and a dazzling array of herbs. Its goods have attracted a steady and constant stream of visitors.

集会演说家：朋友们，经过“谐波汇聚运动”之后，天启的预言数次破灭，我们目睹了末世论的荒谬，并发现世间除了灵性信仰与科学理性——尚存有第三种共处的真相。
Public Speaker: My friends, after the Harmonic Convergence, we discovered the failure of prophecy and eschatology, and the new possibilities of coexistence between the faith in pneuma and science!

集会演说家：谁言神明仅此一位，谁言神明已死？朋友们，我们是时候放下信仰之间的争端，摒弃高高在上的神明，而相信我们本为一体，神即是你，神也即我……
Public Speaker: They claim there is one god, and god is dead. But is that so? Friends, it's time to abandon the disputes of religions, and to know that we are one. God is you, god is me.

演说家在熙来攘往的人群中间，自顾自地宣讲着，对无人驻足与倾听毫不在意。
In the midst of the bustling crowd, a speaker gives a lecture out to no one in particular, seemingly unconcerned if anyone is listening at all.

玛蒂尔达：根据可靠的情报，那两个在基金会捣乱的家伙，正躲在一位名叫环状水星的能量疗愈师的帐篷里……
Matilda: We've got information that our escaped visitors have gone into hiding with an energy healer called Mercuria.

玛蒂尔达：这种喧闹的地方不宜进行大规模的行动，我们要尽量悄无声息一些。
Matilda: It's crowded here. I'd rather not attract attention to ourselves, so keep your heads down.

帐篷孤零零地躲在角落里，仿佛是一块水流中的顽石，将喧闹隔绝与外。
A solitary tent stands out in the corner, a refuge from the bustling crowd.

小队成员 I：这个帐篷仿佛是临时拼凑的……连木头招牌都被吹翻了，它有些不对劲——我几乎感知不到任何术法的波动。
Team Member I: Some kind of temporary tent. And a sign lying on the ground. Something's not right. I barely sense any arcane fluctuations here.

小队成员 II：这……会不会是一出陷阱？玛蒂尔达小姐。
Team Member II: Could it be a trap?

小队成员 II：这个集会里到处都是不在登记名册里的神秘学家，我们无法甄别其中有哪些人是危险分子，况且其中还有不少人类游客……
Team Member II: This market is filled with unregistered arcanists, not to mention the human tourists. There are sure to be dangerous ones among them.

玛蒂尔达：嘘……！
Matilda: Shh!

敏锐的调查员似乎听到了近乎呢喃的声音。
With her sharp ears, Matilda notices a faint whispering sound emanating from inside the tent.

???：我也许不该过来……“启明会”的人会把我切成碎片，再丢进猪圈——
???: I shouldn't have come. They're gonna slice me up and feed me to the pigs!

帐篷内传出男人的啼哭，声音浑厚、痛苦，但不属于他们所调查的任何人。
The deep, painful cries of a man break the quiet of the moment. Irrelevant though it may be, it draws the investigator in.

女孩轻抬脚步，犹如靠近一只盘旋沉睡的蟒蛇。
The girl shifts her feet cautiously, as if approaching a sleeping, coiled python.

她悄悄揭开帐篷的一角，凑上了眼睛。
She delicately lifts a corner of the tent's opening and peers inside.

???: 那些猪会啃掉我的脑袋，连渣儿都不剩……他们就是这样对待所谓“启明会”的叛徒的，就是这样……

???: Pigs will eat everything, all the bones, your head, not a hair left. That's how they treat traitors!

???: 到时候就连老头子也救不了我……他不会站我这边，他不会的……

???: Pops won't save me then. He won't stand at my side. No.

女孩以手覆上他颤抖着祈祷状的双手，犹如抚慰一只受伤的狼犬。

A mysterious girl places her hand over the hulking man's trembling hands.

环状水星: 但你还是过来了，杰洛先生。即便双脚发软、打颤，你还是选择前来寻求一个答案。

Mercuria: But here you are, Mr. Gio, shivering like a new leaf. Because you're ready for an answer.

环状水星: ——关于你自身的答案。

Mercuria: The answer to yourself.

她嗅了嗅他周围的空气。

She sniffs the air around him.

环状水星: 还有，你这次带来了奇怪的味道，以及一股浑浊的能量……它很微弱，向来只属于病入膏肓者。

Mercuria: Hmm. You brought a strange smell with you, and a weak, faltering energy, like that of someone gravely ill.

环状水星: 你……最近常去医院吗?

Mercuria: Have you been to any hospitals?

杰洛: 不，我最近一直跟随着莱格斯，并且只和活人打交道……我们向来拒绝任何瘾君子和染病的倒霉鬼。

Gio: No, just following Legers. Nowadays, only visits we have are with the living or the dead ones, not much in between. We don't deal with addicts or sick dogs.

杰洛: 啊！这不重要，我知道你又想趁机兜售一些疗愈的香料，但我对那些没有兴趣……如你所说，我只是为了寻求自身的答案而来！

Gio: Wait, shut it. Before you start, I'm not buying any of your goddamn spices or candles! I'm just here for an answer.

杰洛: 关于那团焚毁屋子的火苗，将我的妻子、孩子……你到底是为什么知道？这说不通，这说不通！

Gio: How did you know about the fire that took my family? How?

杰洛: 你是吉普赛人的祭司吗？你是专门窥梦的占卜师吗？你得回答我，你得回答我！

Gio: Are you some kind of psychic? Or a prophet? Tell me! TELL ME!

他甩开手，发疯似地啃咬着手指。

He jerks his hands away, only to begin gnawing at his nails.

杰洛: 不，不对……我不该站在这里，我该把你的头割下来，送给老头子……这样我在这里的原因就能够解释了。

Gio: No, no. I shouldn't have come here, unless ... Maybe I chop off your pretty little head and give it to him. That'd be my excuse.

几乎只有一瞬，匕首抵在女孩的喉咙上。

In an instant, he presses the dagger against the girl's throat.

玛蒂尔达: ……!

Matilda: ...!

偷窥者情不自禁要冲上前去。

Matilda fights the urge to rush forward to help.

“呲。”——地面上的蜡烛瞬间熄灭。
"Whoosh."—The candle illuminating the room is snuffed out.

环状水星：先生，你知道在你手中的是什么吗？——一把小刀，廉价却实用的商品？一把割喉的利器，铲除异己的工具？
Mercuria: What have you got? What do you see in your hand? Is it a knife for my throat or a diamond-covered key?

杰洛：闭嘴，别再说那些神神叨叨的话！你只不过是火焰底下幸存的女巫，是一个骗子！
Gio: Shut up! Stop babbling! You're just a witch who survived her burning, a liar!

他的手在颤抖。
His hand trembles again.

环状水星：请不要颤抖，杰洛先生——盯着它，盯着由你的火焰所淬出的匕首。
Mercuria: Breathe, slow and true. Look at it again. This is a dagger forged in your own dark flame.

他的眼睛凝视着匕首，就像第一次见到它一般。
He looks at the dagger, as if seeing it through new eyes.

环状水星：只有当我们长久注视一件事物，事物“解释”的外壳才会逐渐脱落……
Mercuria: Everything has a shell of "meaning." But hold your gaze on it, and it all strips away.

环状水星：令你浮想联翩的文字将只是几抹涂画，匕首也只是锻造之下的金属物，请抓住这种“没有意义”的感觉。
Mercuria: Until those words become strokes of black, and that dagger becomes a cold sheet of metal.

香炉裹挟着魔药的气味，袅袅升起，萦绕着两人。
Her incense burner releases a puff of strong scented potion into the air.

匕首转瞬间失去形体，化成熊熊燃烧的火焰。
All at once, the dagger transforms into a blazing fire.

它犹如嘶嘶吐信的毒蛇，爬上男人惊恐的脸庞。
It slithers up the man's arm, toward his face, roiling and coiling like a snake.

杰洛：呃……啊！
Gio: Urgh! AHH!

玛蒂尔达：这……这是怎么回事?!
Matilda: W-what's going on?!

环状水星：意义只是黏在鞋底的口香糖，当你让它脱落，你的行走将不再受到束缚，你也便不再受到意义的蛊惑——事物会显现出原初的面貌。
Mercuria: "Meaning" is a cage. Cast off its shackles, and nature reveals itself to us.

环状水星：别害怕，抓住脱落的感受……跟我一起闭上眼睛。
Mercuria: Don't be afraid. Hold that feeling. Now close your eyes with me.

你看见了吗？在那黑暗的中央，正有一扇门矗立于此。
Do you see it? A door surrounded by darkness.

杰洛：我看见了，它……在发抖，它在害怕我的靠近。
Gio: Yes. The door is shaking, like something's behind it. No, it's scared.

不要直视它，告诉我，它将通向什么地方？
Don't try to picture it. Take away the shell. Just tell me by the impression: Where does it lead you?

杰洛：那扇门，它通向我的——家？
Gio: It goes home?

杰洛：是火光，它、它烧起来了！
Gio: Fire! The door's on fire!

杰洛：我听见了喊叫……它通向那座熊熊燃烧的屋子……里面是我的妻子萨菲娜，以及尚在襁褓中的孩子……不、不！求求你，救救他们，请救救他们！
Gio: No, I-I don't wanna go there. Not there. Someone's screaming. Savina! My-my baby! No, no! Help them! Help them, please!

环状水星：请冷静！杰洛先生，请环顾四周，有谁跟你在一起?
Mercuria: That's over now. Look around. Who is with you?

杰洛：……是老头子，以及另一群人，他们手执火把与狗链，站在那儿……
Gio: Pops and others. They're standing there, with torches and chains.

环状水星：他们是谁?
Mercuria: Who are the "others"?

杰洛：我不知道，我不知道……他们个个都被一双手蒙住了眼睛。
Gio: I don't know. I don't know. Their eyes are covered by hands.

杰洛：不对，那不是手……那是他们所佩戴的面具！
Gio: No, not hands. Those are hand-shaped masks!

玛蒂尔达：是重塑之手?!
Matilda: Manus Vindictae?!

一束光忽然从头顶照射而下，景象恍然消失。
A beam of light breaks in from above, expelling the smoke and darkness of the scene.

蜡烛重燃，现实回到了所有人眼前。
The extinguished candle catches flame once more, and all present return to reality.

J：喔，这是从哪里来的丫头？你妈妈从没教你别擅自揭开别人的门帘吗……?
J: Hey, who's this girl? Didn't your mom teach you not to spy on people?

一只手从身后，将恍惚中的女孩提溜了起来。
A hand stretches from behind and lifts the investigator up to her feet.

玛蒂尔达：你……！
Matilda: You!

身后传来了急匆匆的脚步声，两位职员及时赶了过来。
Behind them, urgent footsteps reach the scene.

小队成员Ⅰ：玛蒂尔达小姐！
Team Member I: Ms. Bouanich!

J：等等，你是……之前基金会的那个丫头?！糟糕——！
J: Dammit, you're the girl from the Foundation?! Ain't that just my luck!

J 像被蜜蜂蛰了似的，把这块烫手的山芋给甩了出去。
J flings the girl from his hand like a hot potato.

玛蒂尔达：抓住他！
Matilda: Catch him!

审讯节目
"Interrogation" FT-05

帐篷内
Tent Interior

“哐当——”
"Bang—!"

J: 呃……！
J: Urgh!

他单膝跪在地上，抬起被包裹的剑状物，一道道术法不停撞击其上，令他的身躯节节后退。
He falls to one knee, lifting the long-wrapped shaft that has been on his back, as spells continue to strike him, forcing him into a step-by-step retreat.

小队成员 I： J 先生，请你配合我们的调查……我们并不打算伤害你或你的同伴，如若你继续这样反抗下去，我们将不得已采用更为强硬的手段。
Team Member I: Mr. Brown, we have need of your cooperation. We do not wanna hurt you or your friends, but should you continue to resist, we'll be forced to take necessary action.

玛蒂尔达: 难以置信，真是粗鲁的家伙……作为神秘学家，回击手段竟然全是贴身肉搏。
Matilda: Unbelievable, so rude! Even as an arcanist, all he does is this vulgar hand-to-hand combat.

玛蒂尔达: 而且还背着那样一把碍手碍脚的东西，真让人搞不懂。
Matilda: Still, that long stick he carries most certainly isn't a toy.

玛蒂尔达: 如果你乖乖配合，玛蒂尔达可以考虑考虑在调查报告中降低对你的风险评级……
Matilda: Ahem. Gentlemen, if you would be willing to come quietly and play nice, I will consider lowering your risk rating in our report.

她一边劝说着，一边找寻着之前透露出重塑之手情报的男人。
She tries to reason with them, keeping in mind her desire to search for the man who mentioned the Manus Vindictae.

先前持着匕首的男人已不知所踪，那把匕首正安然无恙地躺在地上——没有火焰的痕迹。
But he is already gone, and the dagger lies undamaged on the ground.

两名职员俯低了身子，一步步靠近这头气喘吁吁的猎物。
Her teammates gain ground on the would-be warrior, who has sunken to his knees.

J: 咳、咳……我得说……我也不想搞到这个地步，朋友们，我也希望我能乖乖求饶。
J: *coughs* I gotta say sometimes I wish I could take a knee and surrender.

J: 但，呸……
J: But ... *spit*

一口带着鲜血的唾沫被吐在地上。
He smiles through bloodied teeth.

J: 唉，可惜我从小到大，肚子挨了不少拳头，也还没学会举起双手——这项了不起的技巧。
J: Sadly, even after all those hard-knock lessons, I never learned once how to raise the white flag.

手伸向怀中，正准备握住那把小巧又敏捷的博伊刀的刀柄——
He reaches into his pocket, ready to grasp the handle of his small and agile Bowie knife.

环状水星: J……放下它，战争已经结束了。
Mercuria: Put it down, J. Your fight is over.

小队成员 I： ?!
Team Member I: ?!

小队成员 I： 这……这是曼德拉药草，是什么时候……？快遮住口鼻！
Team Member I: This-This is the smoke of burning Mandrake! Cover your nose and your mouth!

小队成员 II： 屏住呼吸，离远一些，玛蒂尔……达，小姐……
Team Member II: Ms. Bouanich, hold your breath. Stay away from the smoke.

宛如中了麻醉的大象，他们腿脚一软，倒在了地上。
But the smoke is already too thick. One by one, they give way, collapsing harmlessly to the ground.

玛蒂尔达： 糟了……！
Matilda: Oh, no!

局势转眼间变化。
The situation changes in the blink of an eye.

她不禁后退了一步，却发现帐篷已紧紧闭上。
She moves automatically, falling back to the entrance, only to find that the tent has been shut tight.

玛蒂尔达： 唔……
Matilda: Umm!

J： 哼……
J: Hmph.

被绑住的女孩与“绑匪”，像是两只争抢栗子的松鼠，不屑一顾地瞅着彼此。
The bound girl and her "kidnapper" look at each other with disdain, like two squirrels fighting over a chestnut.

玛蒂尔达： 你们要知道，绑架基金会调查员与违抗调查，是非常严重的罪行……尤其是你们绑架的还是圣洛夫基金会最优秀的骨干成员——玛蒂尔达·布翁尼小姐！
Matilda: You should know that kidnapping a Foundation investigator and interfering with an official investigation is a serious crime, especially when you've kidnapped the one and only Matilda Bouanich, a pivotal figure in the St. Pavlov Foundation we're talking about!

J： 什么优秀的骨干成员。一个没有经验的小家伙，刚好成了我们的漏网之鱼——这可不是什么光荣事迹。
J: Pivotal, eh? Ha. A whiny little pup happens to stay standing from a little smoke. Yeah, I don't see anything worth being proud of.

他伸出手指，在女孩额头上“啪”地弹出了声儿。
He extends a finger to give the girl's forehead a sharp flick.

作为第一个拷问用刑，相当适用。
As the first approach to an interrogation, it proves surprisingly effective.

玛蒂尔达： 喂！
Matilda: Hey!

玛蒂尔达： 给我停下，你这个无礼的家伙！这是严重的冒犯！
Matilda: Stop it! This is rude and-and indecent!

J： 告诉我，保利娜现在是不是还躲在基金会的某个小房间里，为了让我签署保密协议，才把你们派了过来？
J: Tell me, did Paulina send you to ask us to sign this bogus confidentiality agreement? Let me guess. She's probably still hiding in the Foundation office, right? Too scared to see her own flesh and blood.

玛蒂尔达：你到底在说什么胡话？……我们根本没有理由那样做，我们过来是为了带你和那个假人回去，你们已经严重违反了《圣洛夫基金会访客协议》的保密守则！
Matilda: What are you talking about? Who's hiding in our office? We're here to bring you and that mannequin back to the Foundation. This is a serious violation of the Visitor's Advisory!

先驱者：J，我想我们得换个问法——玛蒂尔达小姐，你有什么证据能够证明 J 的妹妹已经殉职？
Pioneer: J, I think we should ask this another way: Ms. Bouanich, what proof do you have that Paulina Lesage is dead, as your receptionist claimed?

先驱者：你们先前所提供的照片与本人大相径庭，我们无法相信那些荒谬的证据。
Pioneer: The photo on the box isn't hers, just some lookalike or airbrush job. So how can we believe anything else you say?

玛蒂尔达：……！
Matilda: ...!

玛蒂尔达：你是说，你们认识的保利娜也是——
Matilda: You're saying the Paulina you know isn't the same as the one in this photo?

玛蒂尔达：……
Matilda: ...

眼前的人看似不羁，但眼神却格外关切。那是对至亲才会有的沉重的情绪。
J seems so nonchalant, yet his eyes are filled with concern—a gravity reserved only for great love.

玛蒂尔达：可恶，怎么说才好……总之，请相信，我们绝对没有任何要欺瞒你们的理由。
Matilda: How can I explain this to you? Please be assured that we have no reason to lie to you at this juncture.

玛蒂尔达：倒不如说，这一切本就不该让你们知道……
Matilda: Actually, you shouldn't have found out about any of this in the first place.

她沉默了很久，似乎在思考当下要如何才表达得适当。
She falls silent for a long time, pondering how to best express herself.

玛蒂尔达：我并不了解你们所认识的保利娜。但至少，曾经在基金会与我们共事过的保利娜，确实已经牺牲了。
Matilda: Maybe, I'm not familiar with your Paulina. But I do know that there was a woman at St. Pavlov's named "Paulina Lesage," and I know that she died.

玛蒂尔达：至于照片与本人不符的问题，总部正在着手调查同类事件——但解开这个谜团，还需要一段漫长的时间。
Matilda: As far as the claims of "different photos, mementos," it's complicated, and there is, eh, little I can say freely, but headquarters is working on it and many other similar cases.

玛蒂尔达：我的职级并不足以知晓全貌……而且因为保密的必要，玛蒂尔达不能透露任何消息给你们。
Matilda: I don't have the kind of clearance to know what's really going on, and even if I did, I couldn't tell you, for everyone's safety.

那一双双盯着她的眼睛，没有任何波澜。
He looks entirely unmoved.

J：哈……我懂了。这个调查员也只是个被蒙在鼓里、一无所知的小家伙。
J: Ha. So our little prize investigator is also in the dark.

J：伙计，咱们还是留点力气去把他们打包送回圣洛夫基金会大门口吧。
J: Maybe we can just go ahead and jot all these questions down and send them back to the Foundation.

J: 正好让过路人都看看基金会的风采！
J: Or maybe we set up shop here, just let any old passerby take a good look at them!

他将椅子拎起来——
He lifts the chair.

玛蒂尔达: 啊，喂，等等，再等一等！！！
Matilda: Hey, wait! Wait a second!

“人质”陷入了思索。片刻，她不情不愿地抬起了头。
After a moment, the "hostage" looks up reluctantly.

玛蒂尔达: 那么，只要我证明了这位女士已经真的牺牲……
Matilda: I-If I could prove this Paulina of yours is, in fact, deceased ...

玛蒂尔达: 你们就愿意乖乖跟我回去，对么？
Matilda: Then will you come back with us, do the proper paperwork, yes? Then we can be getting out of your hair for good.

从口中轻飘飘地，她提出了一个交易。
With a light tone, she proposes a deal.

所有人都陷入了犹豫，沉默。
Yet all involved suddenly grow hesitant and quiet.

J: ……
J: ...

先驱者: ……只要你的证据足以让我们信服。
Pioneer: The burden of proof lies with you, Special Investigator.

玛蒂尔达: 好吧，你们最好说话算话……我并不想打击你们，但如果你们非此不可……
Matilda: Alright. But I will hold you to your word, mannequin. Before we begin, I should say, I don't do this lightly, but if you need to know, don't say I didn't warn you.

身上的绳索被解开了。
She is released from her ropes.

她推开两人，抚平桌台上的黑色天鹅绒布，将水晶球放置于中央。
She pushes the others aside, smoothing out the black velvet cloth on the table, before placing a crystal ball in its center.

玛蒂尔达: 我是水晶占卜师。你们应该很清楚这个能力代表着什么。
Matilda: I am a diviner, one that uses crystals. I suspect that sort of practice may already be familiar to you.

玛蒂尔达: 请交给我一件象征保利娜女士身份的、她曾使用或拥有的物件，这个物件必须要与她的过往有着深刻的联结。
Matilda: I'll need an object that symbolizes Ms. Lesa-, Paulina, or something related to her. It must have a deep connection to her, something she once owned or often used.

玛蒂尔达: 我会循着它的气息，揭开迷雾，为你们找寻到她存在的痕迹或所在……
Matilda: I will then begin my scrying using this object to the fog in my crystal orb and reveal to us her current existence.

玛蒂尔达: 但若等我揭开迷雾，发现在那之后空无一物……这通常便意味着只有一个可能。
Matilda: But if we find nothing beneath the fog, I am quite sure you understand what this means.

玛蒂尔达: ——而那时，你们就必须得跟我走了。
Matilda: And then, I will be needing you to return with me.

玛蒂尔达：另外，据我所知，能量疗愈师通常拥有敏锐的灵性感知力，可以洞察神秘学家在占卜时能量的流动……
Matilda: And as I've heard that energy healers are able to detect the flow of pneuma ...

玛蒂尔达：这位女士，她应该可以在场证明我的占卜。你能做到吗……女士?
Matilda: The madame here will be able to prove the authenticity of my divination, no?

环状水星：我刚才已经见到了能量从你朋友们的手心，流向了术杖……于我而言，这不可能隐藏。
Mercuria: I'll see it. Yeah, like I saw the arcane energy flowing from your little friend's hand to their wand just now.

先驱者：J?
Pioneer: J, what do you think of all this?

他把肩膀靠在柜子边，没有靠近，只是远远地答复。
J leans against the edge of a nearby cabinet, keeping his distance and responding from afar.

J：保利娜肯定没想到她最信任的基金会帮手，如今将亲自揭穿她的谎言……我这个笨妹妹，这下该知道她哥哥对付她绰绰有余。
J: My sister's little minion back at the Foundation already exposed the lie. Still, seems only fair I get to spy on her back. We'll see who's laughing now, sis.

J：没问题，小家伙——拿去吧。
J: Alright, Frenchie. This is hers. Take it.

一只软绒绒的玩具小熊，松散的绒毛已脱落了不少。
A plush teddy bear, its fur now well-worn and patchy.

那是她为这个家族留下的最后一件礼物，他当然保留着。
It is the last thing she had from their parents, and one of the last things he has of hers.

一切皆已就位，女孩抚平胸膛的躁动，缓和下呼吸。
Everything is in place. Matilda eases the tension in her chest with a deep breath.

玛蒂尔达：开始吧。
Matilda: Then let us commence.

双手覆上水晶球，她紧闭双眼。
Her hands scour the crystal ball as she closes her eyes.

缺少了月光与潮汐的加持，她的气息有些许紊乱。
Absent moonlight and tides, her regular breathing becomes erratic under the stress.

但没有关系，如今她只需要证明一个生命的存在……甚至不需要一个确切的所在。
But all that is no matter to her. The only thing she has to do is find one person, and she does not even need to find her. Only prove that she exists, or that she does not.

玛蒂尔达：牵引物品的丝线，追寻这位所有者的迹象……请回应我的叩问。
Matilda: Thread that binds all, show me the trace of the one to whom this belongs. I bid you to respond!

水晶球透过手指，散发出了微弱的光亮。
The crystal ball emits a faint glow through her fingers.

一团沉甸甸的迷雾升起，充溢水晶球。
A heavy mist rises, obscuring the inside of the ball.

J：……!
J: ...!

玛蒂尔达：褪去薄雾，褪去隐匿者的外壳，请显现她的实相——
Matilda: Lift the fog. Reveal what existence lies hidden from us.

玛蒂尔达：尽在我们眼中。
Matilda: Give us your vision. Sight beyond sight!

玛蒂尔达：……
Matilda: ...

许久，涌动的迷雾已然褪去……
Time passes as the swirling mist slowly, achingly dissipates.

女孩的双手离开了水晶球，眼睛瞥向别处，不再说一句话。
Matilda withdraws her hand from the crystal ball. She silently shifts her eyes away.

摆放在一旁的小熊仍炯炯有神地盯着水晶球。
The little bear beside her appears to have its eyes fixed on the ball.

J：——嘿？小家伙，我们可还没有看见任何结果，你怎么突然撂摊子了？
J: What, all that and you just stop? This thing busted or something? Nothing happened.

环状水星：J……
Mercuria: J ...

环状水星：……这次占卜，正如她之前所说，已经宣告结束了。
Mercuria: The divination is over. The energy is gone, just like she said.

而男人不以为然。
J feigns ignorance.

他知道这次他很冷静。
Still, he is far calmer than any thought he should be.

J：天呐，饶了我吧，你们这帮基金会的把戏还没用腻歪吗？
J: You come all this way, for what? Just another Foundation trick?

J：这次又是什么糊弄人的把戏?！你对这颗水晶球动了什么手脚……嗯？为了让她躲下去，你们有必要——
J: So, what is it this time? Did you mess around with the orb? Some kind of protection skill? I don't have time for these games.

先驱者：J!
Pioneer: J!

假人的声音震耳欲聋，响彻回荡。
The mannequin's voice is deafening.

先驱者：……她已经不在了。
Pioneer: It means she's really gone.

环状水星：抱歉……J。
Mercuria: Sorry, J.

J：……
J: ...

没有惊诧或是愤怒，远处的 J 如此平静——
He keeps up his stone-calm face, giving no sign of anger or astonishment.

连面容也没有丝毫变化。
There is no change in his expression at all.

不是心如死灰，也绝非恍惚。
It is both emotional and emotionless at the same time.

先驱者： 你……还好吗，我的伙计？
Pioneer: J, are you still with us?

J： 不，我没事。
J: Yeah, yeah, I'm fine.

嘴唇并不震颤，身体没有摇晃。
The words hang stiffly on his lips.

J： 原来是这样……
J: So I guess it's legit.

他望向水晶球。
He looks into the crystal ball again.

他的嘴唇几不可见地微张，想言语些什么，又合了回去。
His lips parting, as if wanting to speak, but nothing comes out.

那是什么？那是……什么？
As if wanting to ask a thousand questions at the same time.

他撇过头，望见远处喧闹的人群中，正有位年轻的女孩戴着花环舞蹈，悠悠地旋转——
He turns his head again, his eyes drifting out to the crowded market, to a girl dancing in the midst of the crowd, a girl adorned with a crown of flowers.

旋转。
She twirls gracefully.

掌声此起彼伏，喜悦充盈着人们的脸。
The crowd applauds, their faces joyful—happy.

他想他是时候该声泪俱下，或者向全世界挥空拳头，甚至砸烂那颗真相的水晶球。
He wants to cry, or scream, or even to take that ball in his hands and smash it to pieces.

但他没有。
But he does nothing.

他站在那里，接受着这股前所未有的沉静。
In a swirling storm of grief, despair, and rage, he finds his center.

无人察觉，剔透的水晶球底部，出现了一道细微的裂痕。
Unnoticed by any present, a faint crack appears at the base of the crystal ball.

角落谣言
Street Gossip 小径

集市摊贩： ……我听说是因为他们跟诊所的医生闹掰，医生彻底撂摊子了。
... I heard that they had a falling out with the clinic doctor, which led to the doctor quitting his job altogether.

集市摊贩： 否则，哪里需要这么多稀罕的药草和针剂？
Otherwise, why would they need so many rare herbs and injections?

集市摊贩： 况且，他们正费劲儿找疗愈师和医生……据说，是因为一位神秘的病人。
Besides, we hear they're desperately seeking healers and doctors, supposedly because of a mysterious patient in need.

集市占卜师： 谁敢在莱格斯那帮人面前撂摊子？除非他们真进了棺材。
Who'd have the balls to quit in front of Legers's gang? Unless, of course, by "quit" you mean they ended up dead.

集市占卜师：依我看，他们可不单在搜集你说的那些人和玩意儿……
If you ask me, gathering those people and things you mentioned is just the small part of their elaborate plan ...

集市占卜师：少猜他们的底儿吧，这里的眼睛现在是越来越多了。
But enough speculation; there are more eyes watching us now.

集市占卜师：反正他们是阔绰的客人，不管他们在找什么——
In any case, they're generous customers, so whatever they're looking for—

集市占卜师：把口袋挣得鼓鼓的才是正事。
So as long as they line our pockets with cash, that's all that really matters.

角落谣言
Street Gossip

乐园在即
Elysium Is Coming FT-06

她往行李中塞着一件件必备物，就像逃亡前夜的难民，一刻也不想停留。
Her luggage is half-packed and already overstuffed. She's rushing, haphazardly throwing things in as she goes, unwilling to pause for even a moment.

保利娜：蠢货、傻瓜、不可理喻的独裁者！天杀的，我早就该知道，从那张嘴巴里冒出来的每一句话，都不应该相信！花言巧语，满嘴跑火车！
Paulina: That smug, know-it-all, manipulative bastard. How is it that I still need to learn not to trust anything that comes out of that-that stupid lying jerk's mouth?

保利娜：“没收到信件”、“没有人访问”、“没有消息”……这也没有，那也没有！
Paulina: "No mail today, sis," "Nah, no visitors yet, Polly," "Haven't heard a word" ... Just another pack of lies, and I bought 'em.

一叠落灰的圣洛夫基金会职员邀请函放在桌面上。其中仅有一件拆封，并被好好折了起来。
On the desk lies a crumpled stack of invitations from the St. Pavlov Foundation. Only one was ever opened.

J：嘿，保利娜，把门打开！你他*在干什么？
J: Hey, Polly, open the door! What are you even doing in there?

保利娜：滚远点，J！你以为你是我的什么人？你到底自大到了什么地步，以为自己可以干涉我的命运、我的选择、我的未来？
Paulina: Leave me the hell alone, Joe! Who the hell do you think you are to decide my choice, my future, my fate?

保利娜：让你那满是污言秽语的嘴巴离我远一点！我今天就要离开这个发霉的鬼地方！
Paulina: Don't talk to me. Don't ever talk to me again! I'm leaving, today!

门外传来铿锵有力的回应。
A fierce response booms through the door.

J：他们所谓的伟大使命就那么令你着迷？你难道还不清楚你上当了吗？保利娜！
J: Whatever—Why are you even this obsessed with this "mission" of theirs?! They're fooling you, sis, don't you see it?!

J：只有两种人会投身于他们所谓的“愿和平与我们同在”的可笑理想！
J: Only two kinds of people that buy the "Peace Be with Us" kind of bulls**t they're selling.

J: 一种是像你这样的傻瓜！对世界上的一切了解都来自于书本上的芝麻小字！
J: The first kind are those like you, Polly. Stupid kids that don't know nothing 'bout anything except what they've read in books.

J: 另一种就是依托着这个可笑理想，企图分一杯羹的混账！他们榨取傻瓜的信任，为他们自己的地界添砖加瓦！
J: And the others are the ones fleecing you. Taking all you got, and spitting you out, all so they can have more money, more control.

他掏开肺腑一般，愤怒地呐喊。
接着，终归冷静下来。
He pours out his anger, inadvertently realizing the weight of his own words.

J: 抱歉……我没能控制自己。
J: Pol- ... I'm sorry, alright. I flew off the handle. I made a mistake.

J: 对他们来说，一滴水无足轻重，一滴鲜血也微不足道，哪怕是一片瓦砾也可以随手丢掉。
J: But these guys, Paulina. You think they care about you? About anyone? You're just another penny in their pocket, a coal for their furnace. They'll burn you up and replace you, easy as that.

J: 你会说那些慷慨激昂的话，是因为你并不真正了解生活本身。
J: You think you're going out there, do something big, because you don't even know what life is yet.

J: 当你看到书上写着“一个为伟大理想牺牲的圣洛夫基金会职员”时，你只是看见了那些字眼……妹妹。
J: You just read about it in your books, telling you some s**t about "A Foundation member paying the ultimate sacrifice for others," and think that makes them some kind of hero. You don't know what that kind of sacrifice means, sis.

J: 你不理解当那名职员面对死亡时的颤抖，你也不理解他在想什么。如果他在后悔呢？他会写出来给你看吗……？
J: Do they say how those "brave" Foundation goons really felt facing death? They aren't going to tell you they were afraid, that they hated everyone who put them there, that they probably s**t themselves before they bit it, just wishing they could go home. They don't put that in books, do they?

J: 你理解的只是那几捆书本和那些字，而不是真相！
J: You read what they want you to think. It ain't the truth, Polly.

J: 而我即便读不懂那些书，拼不出那些该死的句子！——但我所理解，我所从经验中得到的是……就是这个世界本身！
J: Maybe I'm not smart like you, sis. I can't read the things you read, can't learn like you. But I learned the hard way.

保利娜: 够了，我才不在乎你说什么！
Paulina: Enough, J. I really don't give a crap about what you've learned "on the streets." I don't want to hear it.

保利娜: 我宁愿死在外面，也不要在这里发臭！
Paulina: I'd rather take my chances and die out there than stay here and never live at all.

门被狠狠踹出一个洞，打了开来。
J kicks the door hard, smashing a hole straight through it.

他走进了门扉。
He steps in through the now-open doorway.

玛蒂尔达: ……真可恶，我一点也不想去做那个宣布坏消息的人。
Matilda: I feel sorry to be the, how do you say it, "bearer of bad news"?

玛蒂尔达：但这样至少能让他们愿意与我们合作，不再去扩散消息……
Matilda: But at least now they are willing to cooperate, no?

玛蒂尔达：只是……
Matilda: Only ...

她用脚尖撵着地上的尘土，仿若一个手足无措的孩子。
She taps the ground with the tip of her shoe.

她从未想过，完成任务原来并没有那么值得骄傲。
There is an unwilling feeling of shame rather than pride at her work in this moment.

玛蒂尔达：那两个职员怎么还没醒过来？帐篷里重塑之手的情报很有意义，我们得赶紧回去汇报才行……
Matilda: Why my team members haven't awakened yet? We really must report our information on the Manus Vindictae back to the Foundation.

她不安地走动，渐行渐远。
She paces forward and back.

玛蒂尔达：自从阿尔卡纳被证实死亡以后，重塑之手的人就完全变了个样，像群鼹鼠全躲了起来……
Matilda: After Arcana's death, the remnants of the Manus Vindictae all scattered into the wind, nowhere to be found.

玛蒂尔达：他们甘愿放弃大量物资，将自己隐匿在这个新时代里……基金会也一直没能找到他们的去向。
Matilda: They even abandoned all their stashes and resources just to hide in this era. And it seems they succeeded. There has been no trace of them so far.

玛蒂尔达：哼……而我所得到的这个讯息，或许正是帮助我们揪出重塑余党的关键。
Matilda: Well, not yet. But I think perhaps with this news, Special Investigator Matilda Bouanich will be the one to at last find the key.

玛蒂尔达：这一趟调查，一定能让上级对我更加刮目相看，说不定，还能申请将十四行诗指派到我的小队里……
Matilda: I am very certain that my exemplary intelligence gathering will be rewarded by our leaders. Oh, perhaps, they might even place Ms. Sonetto on my team.

一位男人从旁擦身而过，跌倒在地。
A man bumps into her and then tumbles hard to the ground.

玛蒂尔达：嘿，小心点儿！我这个肩膀已经受够意外事故了……
Matilda: Hump. Mind yourself, please. I have had quite enough of these bumping accidents today.

趴在地上的男人恍若未闻，眼睛失去了聚焦，跌跌撞撞地起身。
She speaks, but he is oblivious to her words as he rises clumsily to his feet.

接着，就在他仰起头的一瞬间，一股狂欢的、狰狞的喜悦再度爬上了他的脸庞。
His face is a wild contortion of joy and madness, lacking any awareness.

敲铃人：启示就要来了，“受苦者”的启示就要降临了！
Bell-Ringer: The enlightenment! Soon comes the Sufferer's enlightenment!

玛蒂尔达：?!
Matilda: ?!

在他不经意露出的脖颈处，是一个熟悉的图案。
There is a familiar pattern on his neck.

她怔在了原地。
She freezes in place, taking in the shock.

玛蒂尔达：重塑……之手?！不、不对，可他并没有变成他们的模样……！
Matilda: A Manus's sign? But certainly, they didn't transform into those monsters.

未等她迈步追上去，四周便涌动了起来。
Before she can take a step to follow, her surroundings begin to stir.

起初，是一个人；而后，是不断从四周冒出来的奔跑者，是此起彼伏的脚步声。
They come one by one; then more emerging, all pouring in one direction as if drawn in by a funnel.

众人：启示……是启示！
All: Enlightenment. It's the enlightenment!

集会中的人们，犹如觅光的飞蛾纷涌向同一处漩涡。
The crowd stampedes across the grounds.

周围顷刻间几乎变得空空荡荡，仅余一些零星的摊贩无动于衷。
The moment passes, and her immediate surroundings empty, leaving behind only herself and a few indifferent vendors.

玛蒂尔达：这是怎么一回事?
Matilda: What is happening?

玛蒂尔达：不管了！……我得找到刚才那个家伙！
Matilda: I need to follow that man!

她跟上人群的脚步，试图凑过去，却被拥挤的人圈排斥在外。
She attempts to follow him, pushing through against the crowd, but the heavy press of bodies is like a wall.

玛蒂尔达：可恶……让一让！你们这些汗涔涔的家伙！
Matilda: Please! Pardon me! Ouphf. They're all so sweaty.

玛蒂尔达：嗯……?
Matilda: Hmm?

一个瘦小的身子，正狡黠地在人们腿边流窜。
She catches sight of a nimble shadow moving through the crowd.

猫眼维森：大声嚷吧，笨蛋们……都把手举高一点，让你们的口袋敞开大门。
Cateye Wisen: Yeah! Yeah! Chant louder, you stupid jerks. The higher you lift those arms, the easier it is to reach into those pockets.

他示范了一条明晰的“捷径”。
She spies him as he darts under legs and through the throng—a shortcut of sorts.

玛蒂尔达：嘿嘿，一条不错的“小路”。只需要暂时不引人注意一些……
Matilda: A clever way to get around, if not so very decent. But then, I suppose decency is far from the most important thing now.

她蹲下来，亦步亦趋。
She crouches down and follows his lead.

这是一次巧妙的“偷袭”，所有人的目光正聚集在那位老人身上。
No one takes notice of her. All eyes are drawn to an older-looking man as he begins to speak.

???：……我们的世界已在荒谬的海洋中沉浮多日——
???: Our world drowns ever deeper into depravity.

???: 无数的可怜人沉溺于现象与理智的牢笼，拒绝承认最后的审判日与救赎，将自己出卖在那些当啷作响的游戏厅与邪恶的音律之中。
???: The multitudes, trapped in their cages of materialism and logic, refuse to acknowledge the coming day of Judgment and salvation. Instead, they sell their souls to violence, gangs, and vile music.

???: 他们捧腹大笑，他们痛哭流涕，他们言不由衷……他们将灵魂抛给与自己毫不相干的故事和骗局，遗忘了自己的归途，也不再关切命运的去向。
???: Though they may laugh or cry, they know nothing of the truth, and speak only lies. Held hostage to their worldly possessions, but forgetting the value of their souls.

???: 而“受苦者”——却不以为意，祂发现了我们羔羊的灵魂，誓要将救赎给予迷途的孩子们。
???: But the Sufferer didn't abandon us. THEY know where the souls are hidden. THEY will save our lost children, save us.

???: 为此祂甘愿坠入汪洋，为此祂甘愿忍受着灼烧的痛楚，乃至接受降临于祂的死亡。
???: THEY suffered burning pain, even faced death for us.

道道泪痕在脸上刻下痕迹。
He allows a line of tears to etch down his face.

但他字字铿锵，脸上全然没有悲伤，仅是犹如佩戴着铜制的面具一般。
Yet, his words are spoken firm, and he shows no hint of emotion. Indeed, his face is almost mask-like in its stillness.

???: 如今，祂的子嗣齐聚一堂……我们深知救赎的真相只握在我们手中。警察与政府，族群与国家只是一出历史的卑劣谎言，唯有“受苦者”的再临是一切的救赎。
???: And now, together we are THEIR children. Only we possess the truth of salvation. Police, governments, communities, and nations are only the deceitful constructs of history; our salvation lies solely in the return of the Sufferer.

???: 而经各位子嗣的帮扶，献予“受苦者”的诞生庆典将至，如此欢喜，如此赞美！
???: But now, we must stand shoulder to shoulder, as we anticipate our coming celebration of the Sufferer. We await, we rejoice!

众信徒: 如此欢喜！如此赞美！
Believers: We await, we rejoice.

???: “受苦者”的赞颂已至圆满，接下来，让我们迎来一位新加入的子嗣——
???: The Sufferer has heard us, know this, children. Now take heart, for we have another lost lamb who has cast aside the world to join us.

肃静的人群里，一个男人走到台前，跪坐了下来。
From the silent crowd, a man hobbles forward and kneels.

???: ……
???: ...

???: 莱格斯，“受苦者”亲吻了你千疮百孔的身躯，将你纳入了祂的子嗣之中。如今，你是否愿意以鲜血来证明你的忠诚与牺牲?
???: Legers, the Sufferer has bestowed THEIR blessings onto your broken body, and welcomes you to be THEIR child. Would you present THEM your loyalty with the shedding of blood?

玛蒂尔达: 鲜血?!
Matilda: Blood?!

莱格斯: ……我祈求，我崇奉。
Legers: I would, and I pray.

他手执匕首，锯木一般划拉着手心，鲜血流淌——
He holds up the dagger, drawing a long sharp cut across his palm, and lets the blood stream down.

莱格斯：呃……！
Legers: Urgh!

斑斑血迹滴落在地，形成了一个诡谲的符号。
The blood stains the ground below, forming a mysterious symbol.

???：如此欢喜！你已被应允了赴往“乐园”的资格，我虔诚的孩子。
???: Rejoice! For the passage to Elysium has been promised to you.

???：诸位，时刻已到！紧跟敲铃人的脚步，“乐园”的门扉即将开启！
???: All, it is time! Follow the Bell-Ringer, the gate to Elysium shall soon be opened!

他举起双臂，周围响起狂热的回应。
He raises his arms, and the crowd responds with fervent cheers.

玛蒂尔达：?!
Matilda: ?!

双臂掀开的袍子之下，是明晰无疑的答案。
As he lifts his robe, the answer becomes unmistakable.

玛蒂尔达：那是……！重塑之手的印迹！
Matilda: That's the sign of the Manus Vindictae!

玛蒂尔达：不行、不行……我得立马离开这里！把这个消息带给基金会！让开，让开！可恶，怎么越来越挤了！
Matilda: I must return to tell the Foundation. I need to get out now! Move, move away! Crap! It's getting crowded!

意料之外的喧嚣，正使人群躁动着。
The uproar stirs the crowd into an agitated frenzy.

敲铃人：不，不可能……我的钥匙，门扉的钥匙去哪了？使徒大人，请、请稍等片刻！
Bell-Ringer: No, it can't be! Where is the key to the gate? Apostle Matheus, p-please wait a moment.

使徒米修斯：……！
Apostle Matheus: ...!

高台之上的人，瞥见了意料之外的参与者。
From the platform, the speaker catches sight of the darting figures.

使徒米修斯：诸位，环视你们四周！仪式之中，正有叛徒与不虔诚者！
Apostle Matheus: Be vigilant, all! There are deceivers among us!

玛蒂尔达：糟糕……
Matilda: Crap!

她的脚步更快，把头埋得更低了——
She quickens her pace, rushing without caution through the crowd.

“咚！”——两个小脑袋撞击在了一起。
"Thud!"—Two heads collide.

猫眼维森：疼、疼疼！
Cateye Wisen: Ouch!

敲铃人：他们在那儿！
Bell-Ringer: Behold, the deceivers among us!

手指指向的地方，人们不约而同地让出了一个圆圈。
Where the finger points, the crowd instinctively makes way, leaving the two surrounded in an empty circle.

从眩晕中缓过来的女孩，终于察觉到了糟糕的处境。
As Matilda returns to her senses, she realizes the dire nature of their predicament.

玛蒂尔达：糟……糟了。
Matilda: Not good.

猫眼维森：该死、该死、该死！你是从哪里闯过来的丫头？……你就没打听过这是谁的地盘吗？你把这一切都搞砸了！
Cateye Wisen: Dang it! Dang it! Dang it! Where did you come from?! Didn't anyone tell you whose turf this is?! Ahh, we're in so much trouble.

男孩的兜里满满当当，他以不协调的姿势奔跑着。
The boy's pockets are stuffed full, jingling as he moves and making him run in an awkward, clunky manner.

玛蒂尔达：哈、哈、哈……什么?！玛蒂尔达小姐想去哪儿就去哪儿！明明是你这个小偷罪有应得，还把我拖下了水！
Matilda: *panting* What?! I can go wherever I please. Y-you rude little boy! I-I should have let them catch you.

轮胎的嗡鸣声从身后愈发接近，很快赶上了两人。
An engine growls behind them, gaining ground on them fast.

玛蒂尔达：为什么他们还会骑这个？哈、哈呼……
Matilda: Where did they get this vehicle?! *panting*

这场马拉松式逃跑的结果没有任何悬念。
Their capture now appears inevitable.

贝克特：混小子，你可没说会把动静弄得这么响！这可是惹了一群狼狗……！
Becket: Son of a gun, kid. What did I tell you about making a mess! These freaks are mad!

机车上的男人一把提起男孩，放到后座上。
The man on the motorcycle grabs the boy, pinning him to the back seat in a fluid motion.

贝克特：坐好了，我要拧油门了！
Becket: Sit back, rubber's hitting the road!

玛蒂尔达：?!
Matilda: ?!

猫眼维森：哈哈哈，先走一步，跟屁虫！
Cateye Wisen: Hahahaha, so long, suckers!

玛蒂尔达：喂——喂！等一等，你、你该不会要把我丢在这里吧！
Matilda: Damn! Wait! Are you really just leaving me here?!

她的双腿感到发软，呼吸一次比一次更重。
Her legs are giving out from exertion, huffing with labored breaths.

???：——你好。喔，这是从哪来的贵族淑女？我们见过面吗?
???: What brings you out here, short stuff? Starting to wonder why we keep running into each other.

另一辆嗡鸣的摩托车放松了油门，缓缓跟在她的身边。
Another engine roars, and then the throttle eases as it pulls up alongside her.

玛蒂尔达：是、是——你?！你，哈、哈呼……应该按照玛蒂尔达的命令，在帐篷里乖乖等着！
Matilda: It's you?! You should have listened to me and waited in the tent! You, you oaf!

J：拜托，如果我现在还在那儿待着，你就该被他们绑起来送进烤炉里变成烤火鸡，连酱汁都淋好了！
J: You've got a funny way of saying thanks, French Fry. If I listened to you back there, you'd have been stuck here and hung out to dry.

玛蒂尔达：哼！玛蒂尔达可是在第一防线学校的体、体育测试里拿过全优的健将，才不需要你的帮助！
Matilda: I got straight As in SPDM's P.E. tests! I-I do not need your help!

玛蒂尔达：我靠自己就能甩掉这群笨手笨脚的家伙！
Matilda: I can take care of these kooky cultists all by myself.

J：悉听尊便，女士～
J: As you wish, my lady!

他从未如此听劝，晃开了距离。
He is more than happy to accommodate her, putting a sizeable distance between them before slowing again.

信徒：把格拉瓦库斯放出来！
Believer: Release the Glawackus!

笼子里龇牙咧嘴的魔精，泄洪般奔涌而出。
The magical critters snarl and bare their teeth from the cage, before bursting out.

异种格拉瓦库斯：嘶 #&……%！
Glawackus Mutant: *roar*

玛蒂尔达：?！
Matilda: ?!

玛蒂尔达：格、格拉瓦库斯，不、不可能——原始种的鼻子远没有这么灵敏，这是他们驯化过的特殊品种！
Matilda: Glawackus?! No, they don't have such an acute sense of smell. It must be a kind of mutant they tamed!

J：需——要帮忙吗？淑女。
J: Knight in shining chrome; at your service. Just say the word.

玛蒂尔达：离我远点，别沾上我的气味！优先保护好自己——！
Matilda: Please keep your distance, sir. It is me they are after! You must keep yourself safe!

玛蒂尔达：我可是圣洛夫基金会屈指可数的特派调查员，肩负着保护你们这些笨蛋的职责。
Matilda: I am an investigator of the St. Pavlov Foundation, and it is my duty to protect civilians!

J：……
J: ...

那是如此相似的话语。
Her words feel strikingly familiar.

以及同样匆快的步伐。
And also familiar hurried steps.

玛蒂尔达：火光灼——
Matilda: Fuego Bu—

玛蒂尔达：嗷?！
Matilda: Huh?!

被打断施术的女孩，一脸错愕地被提到了后座之上。
Her incantation is interrupted as she is lifted unwillingly onto the back of J's motorcycle.

J: 平起平坐，小家伙……我也想少费些功夫，但你的腿脚看起来都要跑出火星子了。
J: Get on, Frenchie. Really don't wanna get involved, but you were starting to look like a lost puppy, so I'll forgive you.

J: 如果你想要保护他人，相信我……最好的主意是先学会如何接受他人的帮助。
J: You know, Short Fry, if you're trying to protect someone, you should learn when to accept their help.

J: 勇气这回事儿——得先承认自己的力所不及，不耻于借助他人的臂膀开始。
J: No one gets anywhere in this world alone. Not even at your big-shot Foundation.

风呼啸而过，后座的女孩愣愣地伸出了脑袋。
The wind howls past as they pick up speed. Matilda sticks her head up to speak.

玛蒂尔达: ……你、你说什么？玛蒂尔达什么也听不见——风太大了！
Matilda: What did you say? I cannot hear you! The wind is too loud!

J: 我——说，你得学会借助他人的帮助！
J: I said, take the help!

玛蒂尔达: 什……么？
Matilda: WHAAAAT?

J: ……
J: ...

J: 我说你别他*——
J: I said take ** ...

脏话到了嘴边，又被吞了回去。
A number of profanities tingle on his tongue, but for the moment, he swallows them back.

J: 我说你别忘了把脚抬高，前面要过泥潭子了——！！！
J: Hold on to your socks, water ahead!!

好哥们，好主顾
Best Buds, Best Guest FT-07

肮脏巷道
Grimy Alleyway

机车缓缓驶入街巷，紧紧尾随的教众们已不知去向。
The motorcycle slows as it enters the alley, having lost their mad pursuers.

熟悉的人们纷纷伸出了脑袋，啧啧称奇。
Familiar faces poke out from nearby, marveling at the new arrivals.

管道工: 哈哈哈，J，你这是打哪儿拐了个小女孩回来，你难道不知道这帮吹牛打屁的糙汉子可没空帮你带孩子吗?
Plumber: Hahahaha, J, where did you get this chick? I hope you aren't looking for a babysitter!

女侍者: J——替我向先驱者先生问好！多亏他推荐的高跟鞋，那个好莱坞派头的导演一下子就看中我了！
Waitress: Hey, J, you say hi to Pioneer for me! Those heels he recommended helped me land a big role.

乞丐布莱恩：G——您是叫 G 先生吗？我一直在找您……托您的福——这个徽章，救济院的特里斯终于愿意给我一张床，他说我明天就可以去做那份刷碗的工作了……
Brian the Beggar: Hey, uhm, Mr. G, right? It's me, Brian. I've been looking for you. All thanks to you and that badge you got me. They finally gave me a room down at the shelter. They even offered me some dishwashing work tomorrow!

乞丐布莱恩：永别了，天台和臭水沟！谢谢您，朋友，谢谢！
Brian the Beggar: No more sleeping in tents or under the overpass! Bless you, Mr. G. I owe you my life!

J 停下车子，伸出手，紧紧握住了布莱恩颤抖的手掌。
J stops his bike, reaching out to grip Brian's hand.

J：噢，别这样，布、布——布莱恩！……你也帮我要到了那位漂亮妞的电话号码，不是吗？咱们这都是互帮互助，没有谁亏欠谁的！
J: Oh, come on, Bri-Bri ... Brian! Weren't you the one that helped me get that girl's number? You help me, I help you! That's the deal.

远处，一位牵着魔精的男人走了过来。
From the distance, a man leading a critter approaches.

魔精保姆：嘿，我的好主顾 J！你要借的最新一期《摩托女郎·特定本》到了！
Critter Babysitter: Hey, if isn't my favorite customer, J! I got the latest edition of Motor Babe, you interested?

魔精保姆：全是货真价实的好货——
Critter Babysitter: I swear they're not pirated!

J 笑容可掬，踢起了脚撑，迅速拧紧油门。
J offers only a warm smile as a reply, before kicking up the stand and twisting the throttle on his bike.

J：回见，朋友们，回见！
J: See ya, guys!

魔精保姆：嘿，嘿，J……我在跟你说话呢，你还要不要这份杂志了？
Critter Babysitter: Hey, HEY! I'm talking to you, J! Want it or not?

玛蒂尔达：……那个家伙是不是正在喊你的名字？
Matilda: Isn't that man calling you?

J：抱歉，我没听见，机车的嗡鸣声实在是太大了！
J: What are you saying? Sorry, this kitten here purrs pretty loud!

玛蒂尔达：还有，你背后的这把怪东西都硌疼我了，你为什么就非得一直带着它？
Matilda: Um, this thing you have behind your back, is it not troublesome? Why do you take it with you?

J：噢……这是我老爸留下来的东西，已经跟了我很多年啦！
J: Oh, my dad gave it to me. Carried it around for years.

玛蒂尔达：它到底是什么……东西？
Matilda: What is it?

J：抓紧！……小家伙，我们就要到了。
J: Hold on tight! We're almost there.

……

...

它们安详地躺卧在桌面上，周围的男人们摩挲着胡须，琢磨着它们的老家身在何处。
Items are strewn on the table, as those present stroke their chins pondering over them.

猫眼维森：这就是我从那个敲铃人的口袋里掏出来的所有东西了……除了屁*，相信我，我已经把能掏的东西都掏了一遍了。
Cateye Wisen: Here's everything that was in that Bell-Ringer guy's pockets. Think I got everything, except anything that he was wearing under that get-up, but there ain't enough money in the world to get me to rifle through some s**t-stained cultist undies.

猫眼维森：噢！霍利克，你敲我的头干嘛！
Cateye Wisen: Hey! Hollick, what was that for?!

霍利克：呃，J 说过，你每说一句脏话，就得给你一个“榔头”，让你长长记性。
Hollick: Sorry, kiddo, J said I gotta knock you on the head any time you cuss.

J：嗯……我是说过这话……咱们都得嘴巴放干净点儿。瞧瞧，这不是还有位淑女正站在我们旁边么？
J: Exactly, Hollick. We gotta teach this potty mouth some manners, especially when there's a lady present.

先驱者：……没想到我一直以来不受待见的绅士主张，竟然在这个时候通通实现了，感谢您的指导，玛蒂尔达小姐！
Pioneer: Well, seems I have you to thank, Ms. Bouanich! Years of wasted effort trying to cultivate gentlemen out of these cads, and you manage it in hours!

一旁的女孩正捣鼓着复杂的仪器，丝毫没有理会这边的盛况。
The girl nearby is fiddling with a complicated device, unfazed by their commotion.

系统音：欢迎使用 SPF-I 型便携联络装置。
SPF-I: SPF-I Portable Contact Device activated. Welcome.

系统音：……验证成功。登录人员：玛蒂尔达·布翁尼。目前开放权限等级——B。
SPF-I: Verification success. Registered user: Matilda Bouanich. Access level: B.

玛蒂尔达：成功了！哼哼，今非昔比，如今作为特派调查员的玛蒂尔达已经拥有了更高的权限！
Matilda: It worked! Humph, I have a higher rank now. I won't be making the same mistake twice.

系统音：“紧急支援申请”——抱歉，目前紧急支援小队正被派遣于其他调查任务中，您的周边未发现异常神秘学波动。
SPF-I: "Emergency Support"—Apologies, as there have been no abnormal arcane fluctuations detected, the emergency support team is currently occupied.

系统音：请汇报具体讯息，以核实评估是否具备紧急支援的条件。
SPF-I: Please provide further details, so that we can evaluate the necessity of emergency assistance.

系统音：哔、哔、哔——您的讯息已送达。
SPF-I: *beep* Message sent.

系统音：系统将以支援优先级排序，为您安排支援。
SPF-I: Support will be arranged in order of priority.

玛蒂尔达：唉……早知道就提前申请给我的小队多派一些成员了……
Matilda: *sigh* I knew I should have applied for an expansion to our team.

玛蒂尔达：这个蠢机器真是什么忙都帮不上……为了准确地传达情报，还得让我仅有的两位队员将调查报告带回去做进一步评估。
Matilda: They will be of no help at all. I will have to send my entire team back just to deliver my report to the Foundation.

玛蒂尔达：只能寄希望于他们能够加快支援申请的进度了……
Matilda: So we must count on them to bring support back.

J：哦？申请支援？
J: Oh, yeah? Support?

J：所以你也打算掺和一脚？哈哈哈哈，不得不说，我开始欣赏你这个气势汹汹的小家伙了。
J: You wanna be a part of this, French Fry? You finally taking an interest in all of this? Hahaha.

玛蒂尔达：才不是掺和一脚！你可是搞错了，圣洛夫基金会将以独立的方式处理这件事，我们不会让你们这些平民参与其中。
Matilda: This is a central part of our mission! The Foundation will deal with this, without letting nosey civilians like you get involved.

玛蒂尔达：你们只需要为我们提供重要的线索就够了。玛蒂尔达会带领她的小队，出色地解决这些难题～
Matilda: If you must insist on helping us, I suggest you provide what information you know, and then, I, Special Investigator Matilda Bouanich, will solve the problem and save the day!

她正伸手打算拿起桌上的钥匙。
She reaches out to the key on the table.

但一张宽大的手掌，迅速盖到了钥匙之上——
But a large hand covers it before she can grab it.

J：我不接受你的提议，小家伙。
J: Yeah, not going to do that.

J：在座的所有人，没有谁会把命运交到别人手里。
J: There isn't one of us here on Haight Street that would stand aside while someone else "saves us."

J：如果你想要消息，你就得答应我们——我们能亲自解决麻烦。
J: You wanna get a clue about this place, then the first thing you gotta know is that we deal with our own problems.

他并没有将手挪开的意思，直直盯着她。
He makes no move to remove his hand, staring at her intently.

玛蒂尔达：呃——
Matilda: Umm.

玛蒂尔达：这已经有违调查员守则，需要经过特殊批准……
Matilda: This would defy regulations. I would need to file for a special approval.

J：小家伙，不管你能不能保证，我可以看在你尽职的份儿上为你开个绿灯。
J: Well, you can have the key, little Investigator Bouanich, since you're so dedicated to your job.

J：但是，不管最后结果如何——
J: Whether you get your "special approval" or not ...

J：我不会把那些让海特街千疮百孔的混账亲手让给你。这不是为了狭隘意义上的复仇——
J: We're going to be the ones to take down those bastards.

J：而是因为，海特街的人，只相信由自己亲手伸张的道义。
J: It's not about vengeance. It's that the people here, they'll never trust someone to do this for us. We have to do it ourselves.

J：我们早就不寄希望于法官、警察、圣洛夫基金会……所谓给予公平、正义的这些家伙，在海特街，我们宁愿相信过街老鼠。
J: Judges, police, your Foundation ... One rat's nest after another promised to bring us change, and then left us to the wolves.

J：至少它们挨过打，也挨过失望的折磨。
J: Nah, worse than rats. At least they know how life here really works.

J：它们不会扭头忘记穷人的祈求，也不会自以为是什么拯救他人于水火的救世主。
J: At least they see us. At least rats don't claim to be our saviors.

他挪开了手，将钥匙递给了她。
He withdraws his hand and allows her to take the key.

J：我们只相信一起蹚过阴沟的人。
J: We can only trust someone who's been through the trenches with us.

她接过钥匙，沉甸甸的，仿佛有某种沉重的东西依附其中。
The key feels heavy in her hand, as if something weighty were attached to it.

玛蒂尔达：……谢谢。
Matilda: Thank you, J.

玛蒂尔达：这就是重塑之手所谓……通往“乐园”的钥匙。
Matilda: This must be the key to Manus's "Elysium."

J：环状水星……
J: Mercuria, would you?

他抬了抬头，示意她把说明接续下去。
He looks up, signaling for her to continue with the explanation.

环状水星：玛蒂尔达小姐，他们借由钥匙，躲藏在某处……一个只属于他们的狂欢之地。
Mercuria: Yeah. This will be the key to wherever their hideout is, a place of dark revelry. They've kept it a close secret.

环状水星：我曾瞧见那些返途的人，回来以后都陷入了某种可怖的神往……
Mercuria: But I've seen those that have come back from that place. They're transformed into something unnatural.

环状水星：自那之后，他们的灵魂与身躯被完全拴上了锁链……
Mercuria: Their flesh and their spirit ... it wasn't their own anymore.

环状水星：我见过最自负的商人在他们脚下卑躬屈膝，而其中一位最虔诚的信徒，一位母亲……将尚在襁褓中的孩子饿死在垃圾堆里。
Mercuria: Big-shot businessmen groveling and sobbing at the feet of their Apostle; and the most loving mother I know, she abandoned her kid by a dumpster.

环状水星：许多从集市归来的友人，一个个失去了意志，像着了魔似的在街区中乱窜。
Mercuria: The friends we've lost ... It's like they're gone. They aren't them anymore. They're possessed.

环状水星：再之后，他们便完全失去了踪影，成了盖棺定论的失踪者。
Mercuria: Until one day, they just vanish. Never to be seen again.

她摇摇头。
She shakes her head.

玛蒂尔达：你的意思是说……除非我们先找到属于钥匙的唯一的那扇门，把他们从老鼠洞里揪出来——
Matilda: So, we must find this gate, and flush out their nest of vipers before they can open it once more.

玛蒂尔达：否则，整个行动都将化为泡影？
Matilda: Otherwise, our mission here and your chance to avenge your friends will fail.

她差点儿要站起身来。
She bursts up from her seat before falling back down.

J：不，还远不止这些……他们为了后天的庆典，已经摆出了前所未有的阵仗。
J: Gets even better from there, French Fry. That ceremony of theirs is set for the day after tomorrow. They're planning something big, bigger than anything they've thrown at us before.

男孩抢答般举起了手。
The boy raises his hand, eager to answer.

猫眼维森：我还听见那些哭哭啼啼的傻大个，嘟嘟囔囔地说什么“最后的启示”。
Cateye Wisen: Yeah, I heard that big guy mumbling stuff like "the last revelation" or something.

猫眼维森：他们那副可怜兮兮的样子就像在电玩厅里输光了饭钱的穷鬼一样，哈哈哈哈。
Cateye Wisen: Kinda weird seeing a big dude crying like that, hahaha.

玛蒂尔达：“最后的启示”……是指重塑之手在集市最后一次开启“乐园”之门的意思吗?
Matilda: "The last revelation"? Perhaps then this is the last time Manus plan on opening the door to their "Elysium"?

沉默席卷而来，所有人都知道这意味着什么。
Everyone knows what is implied.

环状水星：届时，我们将会失去他们所有人的去向。
Mercuria: And then, they will be gone, perhaps for good.

环状水星：J……你知道有不少我们曾经的朋友加入了他们。告诉我……等到那天，如果曾经的朋友将刀尖指向你，你会怎样阻拦他们?
Mercuria: J, you got a lot of friends there still. What'll you do when they point their knives at you?

环状水星：如果这群迷途的羔羊，将心甘情愿地跳往悬崖……你觉得我们又该怎么办?
Mercuria: How do we keep their sacrificial lambs from leaping off the cliff?

他并不躲避。
He does not shy away from his answer.

J：……我们总得取舍，环状水星。我从不妄想能救所有人，或者说，我早就放弃了那种不切实际的幻想。
J: Not my business to save someone who doesn't wanna be saved. Never even really thought of saving everyone, not in a long while. It's not worth the pain.

这令多数人心中沉重的答案，却令她前所未有地释怀。
While the answer weighs heavily on the others, it brings her some relief—borne out of trust, if nothing else.

环状水星：……我明白了。
Mercuria: I see.

另一方的支持来得很快。
The girl from the Foundation pipes up.

玛蒂尔达：我暂且……赞同这个家伙说的话。
Matilda: Unfortunately, I cannot disagree this time.

玛蒂尔达：而且，我们总可以提前做点儿什么准备！圣洛夫基金会的支援还在途中，在此之前，我们都不要打草惊蛇……
Matilda: Still, we have time to make preparations in advance! Support is on the way, so until then, we must stay below their attention.

玛蒂尔达：我打算潜入他们，多收集一些讯息，说不定还能把那扇门找出来。
Matilda: I'm thinking that maybe we may try collecting more information by infiltrating their followers. Perhaps then, we will have a better chance to find this "gate" of theirs.

她扶住了下颚，陷入了思索。
She supports her chin as she stares out strategizing in her mind.

环状水星：别担心，玛蒂尔达小姐，我明天会为你介绍我的朋友与我所扎根的新纪元集市。
Mercuria: Sure, Tildy. Tomorrow I'll show you around the New Age Market. You can meet some of my friends, figure out how to fit in.

环状水星：不过，你确实得换一身装束，不管我的朋友有没有跟那帮人产生过纠葛……
Mercuria: Uh, but maybe a change of outfit first. Who knows who might recognize you.

环状水星：呵呵，圣洛夫基金会的人员在这里都不太受到待见。
Mercuria: And the St. Pavlov Foundation is not the most welcome organization around here.

玛蒂尔达：噢……对了！而且环状水星女士恰好认识那位叫作杰洛的先生，我们还可以从他口中拿到不少线索和消息！
Matilda: I see. Thank you very much, Ms. Mercuria. Oh! And I remember you know that, Gio! We might collect some further information from him!

环状水星：杰洛？抱歉，我……不认识你所说的这位先生。
Mercuria: Gio? I don't know who you mean.

她并没有开玩笑的意思。
Her voice is sincere.

玛蒂尔达：可、可我应该没有记错，他就是你刚才接待的那位客人……
Matilda: But, but, do you not remember? It was just as I arrived, you had a visitor, and you called him Gio.

环状水星：不……玛蒂尔达小姐，我先前并没有接待任何客人。
Mercuria: I haven't had any visitors all day.

玛蒂尔达：J，你也没有看见吗？
Matilda: Ah. That cannot be. J, you saw him, yes?

他别过脸。
He meets her eyes with a blank expression.

J：呃……我只看见了一个小家伙，不怀好意，偷偷摸摸地窥视着帐篷……
J: Only thing I remember is some weirdo investigator poking her head into this tent.

这场匪夷所思的记忆错乱，并没有得到应有的解答。
Matilda stammers in bewilderment at their answers.

玛蒂尔达：……
Matilda: ...

晚祷的叮嘱
A Warning at Dinner FT-08

“启明会”大厅
Chamber, Order of Enlightenment

使徒米修斯：应淌的鲜血，应亡的亵渎者……诸位的奉献，已尽收入我的眼中。
Apostle Matheus: Blood must be shed, and our blasphemers eliminated. You have proven your unwavering devotion.

使徒米修斯：绿椅子罗杰、小瘟疫迈耶……以及我们的人类兄弟——死人莱格斯先生，欢迎你们莅临“受苦者”的殿堂……
Apostle Matheus: Roger the Green Chair, Meyer the Petty Plague, and our human brother, Legers the Dead, welcome to the Hall of the Sufferer.

裹布中的人：呃……唔！呜呜呜！
Wrapped Man: Arrgh ... Uggh! *sob*

角落的笼子中，团状的裹布渗出红色，传来含糊不清的呜咽声。
A bundled person wrapped in red-stained cloth writhes in a cage, giving out vague, muffled sobs.

他走入阴影，温柔地抚摸着这颤抖的躯体。
The Apostle steps into the shadows, gently caressing the trembling body.

使徒米修斯：嘘……嘘，瞧，多缺礼数——你打扰了我们宝贵的宴席，孩子。
Apostle Matheus: Shush, child. It is rude to disturb our precious feast.

笼子顷刻间陷入了死寂……但那因瑟瑟发抖而响起的磕碰声却仍断断续续。
The bundle quiets at the touch, though the trembling continues, causing the binds to clink and chafe.

使徒米修斯：很好很好，保持安静。
Apostle Matheus: Very well. Remain silent.

他撤身离开了笼子，将双手搭在绿椅子罗杰的肩膀之上。
He withdraws from the cage and places his hands on Roger the Green Chair's shoulders.

使徒米修斯：兄弟姊妹们……你们所拢集的财富，与吸纳的神秘学家子嗣，为“受苦者”的复苏庆典作出了崇高的奉献。
Apostle Matheus: Brothers and sisters, our arcanist siblings and your bountiful offerings gathered have greatly enriched the coming ceremony of the Sufferer.

使徒米修斯：我们的信徒日渐虔诚，我也为此满心欢喜——可欢愉遍地，悲恸与憎恶却仍不止息！
Apostle Matheus: We rejoice to see such devotion from the faithful, yet we are troubled by the sorrow and abomination now filling the world!

使徒米修斯：——就在昨日，有两名擅入者破坏了降下启示的仪式，并窃走了一把通往“乐园”的钥匙。
Apostle Matheus: Yesterday, two intruders broke the ritual of revelation, and stole from us the key to the gates of Elysium.

使徒米修斯：那是“受苦者”苦痛的牺牲前，留予我们何其珍贵的、与世隔绝的“乐园”！
Apostle Matheus: The precious gift of Elysium granted by the Sufferer before THEIR agonizing sacrifice has been blocked from us.

使徒米修斯：你们理应知晓，钥匙之事不应泄露。
Apostle Matheus: You should have kept the secret of the key.

寂静，漫长的寂静。
A prolonged silence follows.

绿椅子罗杰：您、您可以将这位泄密者交给我！绿椅子的酷刑能为您撕开他胸膛里的秘密，并把告密者的血肉都还予您！
Roger the Green Chair: L-let me use my green chair to grill this shameful rat! I'll make him talk, spill the secrets he hid, and present his flesh to you as an offering!

使徒米修斯：哈哈哈……多么讨喜的兄弟，我的罗杰。
Apostle Matheus: Well, well, Roger, such a caring brother.

使徒米修斯：但不、不，我不需要你的帮助，子嗣们已凿尽了他的肺腑，发现他那可怜的胸膛中并无半点秘密——这只是一位虔诚但冒失的同袍。
Apostle Matheus: Your offering is appreciated, yet our siblings have already torn his chest apart and still no secrets—Just another careless fallen brother.

使徒米修斯：我只是以此告诫诸位，献予“受苦者”的复苏庆典在即，我一直关切子嗣们的一举一动——你们并不孤独，亦不特殊。

Apostle Matheus: This is our final warning: the ceremony for the Sufferer draws near. I would keep a close watch on every one of our flock. Let not one among you linger alone, nor be held above suspicion.

使徒米修斯：此刻，这位泄露了秘密的同袍——敲铃人，正在你们眼前……告诉我，你们谁想给予他最后一丝怜悯与施舍？

Apostle Matheus: And the Bell-Ringer who gave out our secret is here, in front of you. Tell me, which one of you would bestow on him our final mercy?

他晃悠着笼子的钥匙。

He fidgets with the key of the cage purposefully.

裹布中的人：呃呜呜呜……

Wrapped Man: *sob* Urghhh ...

沉默不语的莱格斯，俯身站起。

Legers stands, breaking his silence.

“叮——”

"Clink—"

笼子的门被打开，颤抖的肉块跌落在地，蛆虫般在地上扭动。

The cage door opens. The trembling lump falls to the ground and wriggles like a helpless maggot.

莱格斯：吁……

Legers: *whistle*

异种格拉瓦库斯：嘶……嘁嘁嘁嘁。

Glawackus Mutant: *roar*

两只影子般的生物，翻过天花板的吊灯，从墙上如同蜘蛛般爬了下来。

Two shadowy creatures descend the wall from above with predatory motions.

莱格斯：把他带走，孩子们……拖得远一些，吃干抹净，别为尊敬的先生留下血污。

Legers: Good, eat your fill, children. Until it's done. Not a single stain left to offend our Apostle.

魔精撕咬着裹布，将肉块拖行着，在地毯上留下一道血痕。

The drooling critters tear at the wrappings, dragging the body across the floor, leaving a trail of fresh blood.

像是将猎物带回巢穴的蛛类，它们流着口涎，与撕心裂肺的嚎叫一同消失在了黑暗里。

They deliver a heart-rending howl before disappearing back into the darkness with their feast.

使徒米修斯：谢谢你，莱格斯先生……诸位，就座吧，请享用这场难得的盛宴！

Apostle Matheus: Our thanks, Brother Legers. All, be seated, and enjoy the feast!

……

...

宴席结束，多余的宾客已经散去。

The banquet ends, and the remaining guests have now dispersed.

使徒米修斯：……莱格斯，你最晚与我们同座，所尽的贡献却远甚于其他人。

Apostle Matheus: You may be just a recent convert, still you have more than proven your devotion with your zealous contributions.

使徒米修斯：可如今，孩子，是什么遮蔽了你的双目，绊住了你的脚步？……你对新纪元集市失去控制，已将我们陷于窘境。
Apostle Matheus: But my child, something still blinds you, fetters you. That which deprived you of your control of the New Age Market? A thing that threatens to hobble our fast-approaching ceremony.

使徒米修斯：连同圣洛夫基金会也肆意游荡，把你的领地当作了后花园。莱格斯，你的威信已在诸位当中竭尽。
Apostle Matheus: Trespassers from the St. Pavlov Foundation, treading across our sacred sanctuaries as if they were their gardens. This failing of yours could reflect poorly in our esteem for you.

使徒米修斯：这是一次劝诫，莱格斯，庆典已近，我们并没有太多耐心——把钥匙拿回来。
Apostle Matheus: Brother Legers. The coming of the ceremony cannot be delayed, and we will soon run out of patience. Retrieve the key.

莱格斯：……是的，我明白。
Legers: My word is my bond. I will find it.

使徒以手帕擦了擦嘴角。
The Apostle wipes the corner of his mouth with a handkerchief.

使徒米修斯：现在，庆典所需的一切事务虽已齐备，但我们在虔诚的子嗣当中，仍未找寻到一个真正能够担任祭司之职的灵性者。
Apostle Matheus: All is now prepared, but we still seek the one who will lead us through the ritual, a child overflowing with pneuma. Yet, not a single soul now among our flock is qualified.

使徒米修斯：我们需要一位真正的祭司——他需得指引着子嗣超脱，带领他们抛却尘世的束缚，真正与“受苦者”融为一体。
Apostle Matheus: We must seek the one who will guide the faithful on the transcendental path, to forsake the world, and become one with the Sufferer.

使徒米修斯：——你明白这意味着什么。
Apostle Matheus: I'm sure you understand what is expected of you.

使徒米修斯：这是我亲授的使命，不容许第三个人知晓。
Apostle Matheus: Speak to no one about this sacred mission.

使徒米修斯：去为我们，也为你自己，寻觅一位合适的祭司，莱格斯。
Apostle Matheus: Find the one worthy of our ceremony for us, and for yourself, Legers.

离巢的蛇
Snake in the Grass FT-09

疗愈师库伯：要我说，这位可爱的小姐——远道而来的法国亲戚，应当由我携着！瞧瞧这漂亮的衣裳，若是再配上水晶耳坠和时髦的术杖，谁都得为她回首，对吗，亲爱的?
Cooper the Healer: So this lovely young lady is family all the way from France, Mecuria? Well, let me be her guide to the wonders of America! Look at her pretty outfit, add some crystal earrings and a stylish wand, I bet she'll be knock-out, am I right?

玛蒂尔达：呃……谢谢你的热情接待，但、但玛蒂尔达肩负着重要的逛街……任务！很高兴认识你，库伯……女士。
Matilda: Umm, I appreciate your hospitality, madame, but I, I have a very important mission, a shopping mission! So much shopping to do. So, nice to meet you, Ms. Cooper.

商贩梅克卢：放开这个可怜人吧，库伯教授——
Maich the Peddler: Let go of the poor girl, Cooper.

商贩梅克卢：还是让我带这位小姐见识一下那些从遗迹里出来的珍品，那些古老神秘学家所遗留下来的智慧比你那些徒有其表的玩意儿，美妙多了！
Maich the Peddler: It's time I show her some real treasures. I'm sure they are much more suited to her than your old trash.

商贩梅克卢：而且，那位“长生不死的商人”出没在新纪元集市的消息已经坐实……据说她的手上可多了不少“旧东西”，谁会不想去大饱眼福一番？
Maich the Peddler: Oh, and I oughta tell you, the "Merchant of Eternity" says she'll soon come to the New Age Market, and she's bringing her stock of treasures. It's gotta draw in the crowds.

疗愈师库伯：哼！少来了，梅克卢。温妮弗雷德女士才不会理您这样散发着腐朽味儿的老古董……
Cooper the Healer: Ah, give it up, Maich. There's no way Eternity will like that old junk.

一场争执近在咫尺。
The two vendors square up. They appear to be on course for either a confrontation or an embrace.

环状水星：呵呵……我喜欢你们聊天的样子，就像两团光晕缓缓融在一起，不分彼此。
Mercuria: Heh heh. Will you two ever just fess up and admit you're friends?

两位争执的人陷入了羞耻的沉默。
The two gawk at her words, looking at each other before falling into embarrassed silence.

商贩梅克卢：咳、咳……好了，环状水星……别揶揄我们了……你跟这位小姐要是有什么忙需要帮，直接提就是了。
Maich the Peddler: Ahem, fine, fine, Mercuria, you don't have to poke fun, just let us know how we can help you.

她像是一位随时准备慷慨解囊的富翁敞开钱包。
She responds with a greedy sort of look, as if opening up her purse strings.

环状水星：一扇门，梅克卢。我们需要找到你曾经所说的，那扇门的所在。
Mercuria: A door. We're looking for a door, or a gate, the one you mentioned before.

商贩梅克卢：……
Maich the Peddler: ...

她的喉咙被扼住了。
She chokes out her next words.

商贩梅克卢：门……吗？抱歉，你得给我点时间回忆回忆。对了！你、你可以先带玛蒂尔达小姐到处逛逛，我一整天都在这儿，哪都不去。
Maich the Peddler: A ... door? Sorry, I need time to ... recall it. Hey, why don't you show Ms. Bouanich around, and I'll stay here to gather my ... memories, not going anywhere.

商贩梅克卢：瞧，我现在还在收拾这些……乱七八糟的东西——我的脑袋没法同时干两样事儿。
Maich the Peddler: I'm still trying to rack my brain, and this old thing can only manage one thing at a time.

她的借口并不高明。
It is an unconvincing excuse.

然而，她们的脚边确实垒满了书籍、占卜盘……与零零散散的日用品。
But the moment gives Mercuria pause to examine her surroundings, books, tools, daily necessities, all in various states of being packed away.

环状水星：这是你们的行李吗？
Mercuria: Is this your luggage? You're packing up?

疗愈师库伯：是的……我们打算在“庆典”之前离开。
Cooper the Healer: Yeah. We're leaving this place. Before the wackos hold their "ceremony," if we're lucky.

疗愈师库伯：我们本为了躲避宗教与政治的纠缠，寻找到一片能互不干涉的土壤，可如今那些纷扰已经如疾病传染到了这片土地。
Cooper the Healer: When we came here, it was to find some safe place away from these people and their conflicts, but now they followed us here as well.

疗愈师库伯：我们失去了很多朋友，很多。
Cooper the Healer: And we've already lost too many friends.

她低下了头，仿若哀悼。
Her head falls low and limp.

疗愈师库伯：我们诚心希望你们也能……尽早离开这里。
Cooper the Healer: I suggest you follow us out, before whatever is going to happen here happens.

玛蒂尔达：可……你们怎么能这样轻易放弃赖以生存的地方……
Matilda: But, is this not where you made your living? Can you so easily walk away?

玛蒂尔达：我还以为……海特街的人都是像 J 那样顽固不化的傻大个呢……
Matilda: I thought everyone on Haight Street would be just as stubborn as J.

玛蒂尔达：不过也是，这起码还算一件明智的事情……
Matilda: But I think it's a wise choice.

商贩梅克卢：“明智”，呵……
Maich the Peddler: "Wise"? Huh.

她重复了一遍。
She repeats the words as if insulting herself.

商贩梅克卢：不，你弄错了。我们从不属于海特街，也不属于新纪元集市，我们甚至不占有任何物品。不管到哪儿，我们也只是在上面留下短暂的足印。
Maich the Peddler: Don't make me laugh. Haight Street, New Age Market, none of this is ours really. Even the clothes on our back. All we own are the footprints we leave behind, until they're washed away by the tides of time.

商贩梅克卢：玛蒂尔达小姐，我们早已习惯了跟蒲公英一样生存，我们对纷争没有兴趣。
Maich the Peddler: We live our lives on the fringes of a world that is not kind to us. We're used to it. Fighting for every street, it's not worth it.

玛蒂尔达：唔……可你们那些朋友——
Matilda: Um, but your friends ...

“砰！”——梅克卢使劲将箱子合上。
"Bang!"—Maich slams the suitcase shut.

商贩梅克卢：他们有自己的命运！！！
Maich the Peddler: Maybe you ought to stop nosing around where you don't belong.

环状水星：抱歉……
Mercuria: I'm sorry.

她轻轻拉住了旁边的女孩。
She gently tugs Matilda to her side.

环状水星：我们走吧，玛蒂尔达小姐……梅克卢女士尚有她自己的事情要完成。
Mercuria: Come on, we should get going. Maich has got things to do.

玛蒂尔达：……
Matilda: ...

她们转过身，融入了另一片人群之中。
They turn around and blend into the passing crowd.

直到她们的身影再也不见。
Until they disappear within the milieu.

疗愈师库伯：你知道你不该那么对那个女孩……
Cooper the Healer: You shouldn't be so hard on her.

疗愈师库伯：我们都明白，你说服不了自己。我们的信条并不总是忠贞于我们的所思所想。
Cooper the Healer: You've had a hard enough time convincing yourself of what you have to do.

她坐下来，握住梅克卢颤抖的手。
She sits down to comfort Maich.

疗愈师库伯：去做你该做的事。
Cooper the Healer: Let's just focus on what's next. Nothing more.

玛蒂尔达：唔……说好了时间，环状水星女士怎么还没回来……明明只是临时接待客人而已。
Matilda: Hmm. What's keeping Ms. Mercuria? There were only a few unexpected patrons; she should have already returned.

她朝着环状水星的帐篷走去，里面的三个影子在火光下格外显眼。
She walks toward Mercuria's tent, where three shadows linger conspicuously in the firelight.

商贩梅克卢：等等！玛蒂尔达小姐！
Maich the Peddler: Wait, Ms. Matilda!

玛蒂尔达：嗯？你也是来找环状水星女士的吗……？
Matilda: Hmm? Oh, are you looking for Mercuria?

商贩梅克卢：嘘……！
Maich the Peddler: Shh!

她恍然失色。
The peddler is pale with anxiety.

商贩梅克卢：不，不是的……！我专程为你而来。
Maich the Peddler: N-no, I'm looking for you.

商贩梅克卢：我必须向你承认，我扯了个谎……玛蒂尔达小姐。为了解救我的朋友们，我其实……曾对那扇门进行过详密的调查。
Maich the Peddler: I have to admit something, Ms. Bouanich. I lied to you about the gate, but I have to, to protect my friends.

玛蒂尔达：可我不明白，这……对你来说有什么好隐瞒的？
Matilda: What do you mean? Why do you feel you have to lie?

对方摇了摇头。
The woman shakes her head ruefully.

商贩梅克卢：我只是认出了你——圣洛夫基金会的人，所以觉得可以将这个交付给你……你们。
Maich the Peddler: Because I wanted to give this to you in private. I know you're from the Foundation, and I think I can trust you.

商贩梅克卢：我希望你能为环状水星着想，让她别涉险其中……因此才要隐瞒。
Maich the Peddler: I know Mercuria better than anyone. If she knows the information I have, she will risk everything to help her friends.

她犹豫着下一句话，接着还是说出了口。
She hesitates over her next words.

商贩梅克卢：我知道她的脾性，远甚于你们。
Maich the Peddler: So please, don't tell her this. Don't put her in danger.

玛蒂尔达：但这恐怕并不取决于我……
Matilda: I do not think I can make this decision for you.

商贩梅克卢：我当然明白……我不打算以监护人的态度去控制我的朋友，所以……我只能提出自己的希望。
Maich the Peddler: I get your concern, but she's my friend. I don't want to put her on a dangerous path.

商贩梅克卢：那么……
Maich the Peddler: So ...

她靠近玛蒂尔达的肩膀。
She leans closer still.

万籁寂静中，窃窃私语融入风声，几不可闻。
Whispers mingle with the wind, barely audible.

环状水星的帐篷另一侧，赶来了另一个急匆匆的脚步。
Quick and light steps approach Mercuria's tent.

猫眼维森：唔……那帐篷里有三个家伙呆着?！我就说嘛！头儿一定在这里！
Cateye Wisen: Hmm, there's three guys in that tent. I knew the boss was here!

猫眼维森：不过，还有一个人……是霍利克吗？听说他也在集市打听消息……
Cateye Wisen: But who's the third dude? Hollick? I heard he was in the market collecting information.

他的手正揭开帘布，却撞上了一个高大的身躯。
His hand has only just lifted the curtain when he feels the weight of a tall figure behind him.

猫眼维森：什么……你怎么会在这里?
Cateye Wisen: What?! Why are you here?!

猫眼维森：莱格斯的走狗！！！
Cateye Wisen: You're that big guy, Legers's lackey!

杰洛：?！
Gio: ?!

被察觉的恐惧，令他慌不择路地远离了帐篷。
Gio turns back, afraid of being seen.

男孩背向着帐篷，俯下身子，以冷冽的眼神盯着他。
The boy, now facing away from the tent, stares at the man with cold calculation.

裤兜里，小刀蓄势待发。
He reaches into his pocket to a waiting knife, ready for action.

但男孩并未注意到，背后帘布之上，另一只宽大的手掌正伸过来……
But the boy fails to notice a hand reaching out from behind the curtain ...

猫眼维森：唔……@#￥*&
Cateye Wisen: Uggh ...

夜幕被隔绝于外，灯光迷离的舞厅已聚集了一众好男好女。
The night outside is kept at bay by the soft glow of lights from the dance floor.

人们贴近着彼此，暧昧的目光交织，手臂交缠又摆动——
People press close to each other, exchanging suggestive glances, arms entwining and swaying.

喧闹之中，坐在吧台的女孩格格不入。
Amid the intoxicating scene, the small girl at the bar is noticeably out of place.

玛蒂尔达：唔……该怎么办呢？如果把钥匙与门的消息告诉了 J，那也同样没法瞒住环状水星女士了……
Matilda: Oh. What should I do? If I were to tell J about the key and the gate, then Ms. Mercuria will soon know it, too.

玛蒂尔达：根据调查员守则，现在等待基金会的支援才是最安全的方式……可万一事态恶化，更多无辜的平民将陷入危险……
Matilda: According to the investigator's manual, waiting for support is the safest action. But if this situation escalates any further, more civilians might be involved.

玛蒂尔达：到底要不要让环状水星女士加入计划呢……？
Matilda: Perhaps then I should let Ms. Mercuria join, no?

玛蒂尔达：唉，而且 J 今晚都去哪儿了，连个人影都没冒出来，真是一个没有危机感的家伙……
Matilda: *sigh* Where did J go? He's not returned once all night. That man has no sense!

玛蒂尔达：待会就轮到环状水星女士上台了……我必须得在此之前决定下来。
Matilda: Ms. Mercuria will go on stage soon. I must decide before she goes.

她趴在桌子上，琢磨不定，两手推移着小杯子。
She leans on the table, adrift in her own mind, rocking a small cup back and forth with her hands.

先驱者：玛蒂尔达小姐，你看起来像是在考虑某只股票抑或某项不动产投资的风险……还请让我给你一杯热可可，帮你展展眉头，你现在可还没到皱眉头的年纪。
Pioneer: Ms. Bouanich, it seems as though you're having a bit of trouble selecting between putting your money in stocks or real estate. Why don't you take this cup of hot chocolate to smooth out your furrowed brow? You're too young to have such a serious face.

他伸手紧了紧领带，像是一位准备邀舞的绅士。
He adjusts his tie performatively.

先驱者：作为海特街专业的投资与服装顾问，我曾为不少出人头地的朋友提供过帮助……你大可以向我咨询以钱生钱之道。
Pioneer: You know, besides my modeling career, I'm also a professional investment and costume advisor, and the success of my friends is my best advertisement. Feel free to reach out for a consult if you're interested in making your money make money.

玛蒂尔达：谢谢。唔……好吧，一向无所不知的玛蒂尔达确实遇到了一些……投资上的难题。
Matilda: Thank you. Actually, I do have a problem that, as you say, relates to money.

玛蒂尔达：我听说在一座魔窟里，有两袋金子，它们的重量惊人，而不管是谁都没法同时带出来……
Matilda: It seems I have now two bags of gold in a cave, surprisingly heavy, and no one person could take both of them out alone.

玛蒂尔达：可里面又有个吃金子的魔鬼，等得越久，落进它肚子里的金子就越多……所以我等得越久，到手的金子就越少。
Matilda: However, there is a dragon devouring the gold. The longer I am hesitant, the more it eats and the less I can take.

玛蒂尔达：可我……又不想让身边唯一的朋友在我的牵涉下，和我一同进入魔窟——呜哇，我到底在说些什么呀！
Matilda: But I don't want my friend to risk their life for it. Ahhh, what am I talking about?!

玛蒂尔达：请你还是把玛蒂尔达说的这些话忘掉吧……
Matilda: Please forget it, forget everything.

女孩埋下了头，啜吸着热可可。一旁的顾问却严肃地扶着下颚。
Matilda lowers her lips back to the cup, sipping her hot cocoa. Her advisor lifts his chin seriously and ponders her words.

先驱者：……玛蒂尔达小姐，可这两袋金子并不唯你所独有，不是吗?
Pioneer: Ms. Bouanich, am I right to infer that these two bags of gold don't properly belong to you?

先驱者：如果你的朋友做出抉择，那你最该做的，是收起高尚的怜悯，就像你尊重自己的抉择一样，尊重你的朋友。
Pioneer: So then, if your friend decides to go with you, then you should respect them and their decision. They want to take on that risk with you.

先驱者：你瞧，我在年轻时也做过不少糟糕的建议……我曾让一位食不果腹的赌徒输掉了住所，也同样曾让一位父亲重新赢得了妻子与孩子——而他们不过是同一个人。
Pioneer: I admit, I've offered some poor advice since I first awakened. My suggestions at times have lost a gambler his home, but they also helped a father win back his wife and children. Surprisingly enough, they were the very same man.

先驱者：若你担任顾问像我这样久了，就会明白，我们的想法从不能改变他人将行的道路，将着的衣装。
Pioneer: When you provide as much advice as I have, you realize that our words can't really change another person's fate.

先驱者：这就是为什么我爱那些站在橱窗前，衣衫褴褛，可眼中始终熠熠生辉的顾客。
Pioneer: That's why I love watching window shoppers, the ragged folk that can't make it in, because they have the light of life in their eyes.

先驱者：即便他们身无分文——但我明白，总有一天，总有一天……他们会来取走这件属于他们的衣装。
Pioneer: Penniless as they are, I know that one day, some of them will return and take the clothes that they only dreamed of wearing before.

先驱者：而我最喜欢做的，只是在那天，将那件衣服指给他们中到来的那一位——
Pioneer: And my favorite thing is to point it out to them when the day finally comes, and say:

先驱者：“瞧，它就在那儿等您。”
Pioneer: "It's been waiting there for you."

音乐骤然停止了——
The music stops.

玛蒂尔达：嗯?
Matilda: Hmm?

一只手揭开晶光粼粼的帘子，从舞厅的走廊里伸了出来。
A hand pulls aside the glittering curtain.

人们出了窍般，目光齐聚，眼睛跟着她的步伐挪移。
People seem entranced, their eyes following her every move.

环状水星赤脚踏上舞台，手臂犹如鸟儿般，高举于灯下——凝滞，相片般定格。
Mercuria steps barefoot onto the stage, her arms raised like wings beneath the lights—motionless, frozen like a photograph.

先驱者：嘘……开始了。
Pioneer: Shh. The performance is about to begin.

起先——是一个音符，撞击上另一个音符。
At first, one note collides with another.

其后，音乐犹如浪潮般倾涌而来，声浪将所有人包裹在一团共振之下。
Then, the music rises like a crashing wave, enveloping everyone in its vibration.

可没有人摇摆，亦无人赞颂或质疑，人们只是目不转睛地盯着她。
Yet no one sways or cheers as it washes over them; people simply stare at Mercuria with rapt attention.

手中碰杯的人们，悬置着酒杯；痴迷于电子游戏的男人，命数随着声效一条条减少——
Those drinking from their glasses and mugs pause midair; from the arcade slack-jawed boys usher in a cascade of digitized voices repeating, "Game Over."

而她的臂膀，时而如同扑展而上的羽翼般颤动，时而同泥壤深处的种子般，沿着光蜿蜒而上，破土而出——直至顶点，回归死亡般的寂静。
She flourishes her arms, stretching them up toward the light, like a hopeful seed emerging from the soil, until she reaches a sensual peak, and the music stops at a cut.

环状水星：……
...

“啪——啪啪啪……”
"Clap—clap, clap ..."

那整齐如一的掌声不绝，盖过了喧闹，令舞厅犹如教堂般的肃穆。
The applause rises up over the room, reaching a crescendo until falling silent.

玛蒂尔达：我不明白，他们为什么能这么着迷。她的每个动作都没有踩在节奏上……这些是毫无根据的舞蹈，我感觉——很不舒适。
Matilda: I do not understand. She is not dancing with the rhythm, and her movements, they are so bizarre.

先驱者：呵呵，你听过“陶醉”的意思吗？这个词来自于希腊，意即“从当下离开”。
Pioneer: Ms. Bouanich, do you happen to know the meaning of the word "ecstasy"? It originates from the Greek word "ekstasis," meaning "standing outside" or "transcending oneself."

先驱者：人们已经被那些层出不穷的电视广告、吃角子老虎机、电子游戏……被这一切的一切摆弄太久……
Pioneer: People have been controlled by the commercials, slot machines, arcades for so long, so long that they've lost sight of themselves.

先驱者：灵魂如果被躯体所奴役，便会产生叛逆之心——人们正是为此而来。
Pioneer: Souls too long constrained become rebellious, seeking something real outside the boundaries of convention, and the illusions of flash and neon.

先驱者：为了见证一场不随音乐而摆动的舞蹈，为了学会不随他们眼前的“鼓点”翩翩起舞。
Pioneer: So, they gather here, for a dance that is free from the limits of rhythm and timing.

先驱者：她理解那些在时代中诚惶诚恐的人。
Pioneer: She understands the heavy burden of time.

先驱者：但她同样明白，她不是他者命运的编织者，她跟我一样，只能将选择权交还给顾客、求助者……
Pioneer: But she also understands that she doesn't decide the fate of others. Like me, she provides another option, but in the end, we can only make decisions for ourselves.

先驱者：所以她只以自己的方式，带着他们短暂远离喧嚣的一切。
Pioneer: Her dance offers to break them away from the reality of time and the weight of decision, even for just one song.

原本踮着脚尖的舞者将脚跟落地。她鞠了一躬，走下舞台。
The dancer, who has been on tiptoe, lowers her heels to the ground. She bows before making her exit.

舞厅重回喧闹，就像她从未来过。
The dance floor regains its excitement.

不安的灵魂再度回归于娱乐与快感的怀抱。
Its restless souls returning to the embrace of the night's pleasures.

玛蒂尔达：我……明白了，看来我必须去告诉她。谢谢你，先驱者先生。
Matilda: I see. Then I must tell her! Thank you, Mr. Pioneer.

“哒、哒哒——”她的脚步那般轻快。
"Tap, tap-tap—" Her footsteps are light and quick.

玛蒂尔达：环状水星女士竟然没有去休息室……噢，她走得这样焦急，我得快一些赶上去。
Matilda: She's in such a hurry, but why is she not heading to the lounge? I must catch up with her.

玛蒂尔达：哈、哈哈……嗯？她、她去哪儿了？
Matilda: *panting* Huh? Where is she?

弯腰喘息的女孩，却望见了远处熟悉的身影。
The girl, doubled over to catch her breath, spots a familiar hulking silhouette in the distance.

——然而那并不是她想要的答案。
But it only leaves her more bewildered.

玛蒂尔达：那是……先前出现在帐篷里的杰洛先生？哈！我就说，记忆超群的玛蒂尔达肯定没有记错。
Matilda: Why, that is ... that is indeed Mr. Gio inside her tent? Ha, I knew my memory did not fail me.

她捏起鼻子，躲在黑色的垃圾袋旁。
She pinches her nose and dives into a nearby pile of garbage bags.

玛蒂尔达：环状水星女士肯定把什么秘密藏了起来，这位先生对她而言似乎是位特殊的客人……可如果他来自重塑之手……
Matilda: So she is hiding something from us, and this Gio seems special to her. But if he is from Manus ...

玛蒂尔达：不不，不，停止你的联想，玛蒂尔达！环状水星女士是一位还算不错的朋友……
Matilda: No, stop it, Matilda! You mustn't make such rash assumptions. Mercuria could not be ...

她缩进去的肩膀，被推了推。
Her huddled shoulders are nudged.

玛蒂尔达：?!
Matilda: ?!

眼皮恍惚间变得沉重，四肢变得绵软。
Her eyelids grow heavy, and her limbs go weak and limp.

玛蒂尔达：什……么——
Matilda: What ... is ...

环状水星：……
Mercuria: ...

环状水星：玛蒂尔达小姐，好好睡一觉吧。
Mercuria: Sweet dreams, Tildy.

环状水星：……你恐怕并不明白，这条通往“乐园”的道路，只容许我一人通过。
Mercuria: The road to "Elysium" is mine, and only mine.

再见，鼠辈
See You, Rats FT-10

玛蒂尔达：呃……唔，呜哇！
Matilda: Ugh ... Whoa!

床上的女孩从昏迷中惊醒过来。
Matilda awakes from her stupor.

玛蒂尔达：这里……是，餐馆后的房间？
Matilda: Where am I? Is this the room behind the restaurant?

被褥整整齐齐地叠放着，窗户上贴满了胶布，那是缝补的痕迹。
The bedding is neatly pressed and folded, and the windows are covered in a patchwork of repairs.

即便是间旧房间，却没有沾上丝毫灰尘。
Despite the age and disrepair of the room, it is clean, nearly spotless.

玛蒂尔达：不行，我得快点起来……！环状水星女士跟着那个家伙离开了，我必须得警告 J，环状水星女士已经……背叛了我们。
Matilda: I must move quickly! Ms. Mercuria left with that man. She's betrayed us. I have to warn J!

玛蒂尔达：庆典在即……她很有可能会泄露我们的计划。
Matilda: The ceremony is coming. She'll give away our plan.

她起身，试图打开门。“咔！”
She picks herself up and move to open the door—Click!

玛蒂尔达：什么，门被锁住了？
Matilda: What?! It's locked?!

玛蒂尔达：他们把我抛在这里了吗？糟糕、糟糕……联络器还在我的箱子里……
Matilda: Did they just leave me here all alone? Oh, wait, the contact device. It's still in my suitcase.

???: 我给您带了份礼物，J 先生。
???: I brought you a gift, J.

门缝里传来了一个似曾相识的声音。
A familiar voice slides beneath the gap in the door.

玛蒂尔达：外面……还有其他人？
Matilda: Who's that out there?

玛蒂尔达：噢？这怎么刚好有个破洞？
Matilda: Hm? There's a hole in the door.

门板下，一个被布遮盖得并不严实的洞孔。
There is indeed a hole covered with a loose cloth.

她凑近去，视线穿过了破洞，将外面的一切尽收眼中。
She leans closer, peering through the hole, taking in everything outside.

声音的主人坐在圆桌前，那是她曾在集市中见过的面孔。
The familiar voice came from a man sitting at a round table, a face she had seen before in the market.

玛蒂尔达：他们……都在这里？
Matilda: They're all here!

莱格斯：鉴于我的孩子们，曾对您进行过不礼貌的骚扰，我决定将谈判的主动权交至您的手里。
Legers: As an apology for my children's poor behavior, I'd like you to take charge of this negotiation.

J 迟疑了一阵，扫视一遍莱格斯的下属。
J hesitates for a moment, scanning the ranks of Legers's subordinates.

J：谢谢你的慷慨，老头子，但你恐怕不明白，我们从未向外发过邀请函……
J: Thanks, grandpa, but we both know we're not having a party here.

J：而且你那位不礼貌的孩子——杰洛，怎么没过来露露面？就算是道歉，也得有诚意，不是吗？
J: And why doesn't your boy Gio come over and apologize himself?

莱格斯：J 先生，让我给您一句忠告，少用骨头引诱有主人的家犬……把关心留给自己的人吧。
Legers: Let me give you a piece of advice, J: don't go tempting dogs away from their owners. Pay attention to your own men.

莱格斯：或者是我误会了你们？这份礼物——霍利克先生，不属于你们的一员，对吗？
Legers: Or did I misunderstand? This gift from us, Mr. Hollick, he a friend of yours?

异种格拉瓦库斯：嘶……&#￥！
Glawackus Mutant: *roar*

他身后沉默的人墙退开了一条道路。
The wall of people behind him part, creating a path.

魔精拖行着满身血污的男人，将他甩在了地上。
The critter drags a bloodied man behind it, throwing him onto the ground.

猫眼维森：是……霍利克！
Cateye Wisen: It's Hollick!

霍利克：噗……咳、咳……抱、抱歉，J，我去了新纪元集市。
Hollick: *coughs* I-I'm sorry, J. I went to the New Age Market.

霍利克：咳……我、我只是想，也许能出个好主意……
Hollick: *coughs* I-I just thought, maybe there was something I could do.

他的四肢犹如脱线的木偶，已支撑不起身体，浓稠的血从嘴里一呛一呛地流出来。
His limbs hang loosely like a puppet with broken strings, unable to support his body, and thick blood gurgles in his mouth.

一杆左轮手枪，正抵在他奄奄一息的胸膛。
A revolver is pressed down against his gasping chest.

贝克特：莱格斯，你这个狗**！我、我一定会把你的脑袋给敲碎，拿去喂你自己的那些狗崽子！
Becket: Legers, you piece of s**t! I'll smash your head in and feed it to your dogs!

先驱者：别过去，贝克特！我们不能成为把柄！
Pioneer: Don't do it, Becket! We already have a captive to save!

先驱者的臂膀牢牢拴住了失控的朋友。
Pioneer holds back Becket as he rages.

莱格斯：你的怜悯该留给你的朋友，而不是那块不属于你的新纪元集市。
Legers: You should focus on your friends. Forget about the New Age Market. It doesn't belong to you.

J：……
J: ...

莱格斯：不过别担心，我尤其擅长帮犹豫不决的朋友做出决定。
Legers: Don't worry. Helping people make decisions is a particular skill of mine. I can be very motivating.

他起身，拍了拍 J 的肩膀。
He stands up and pats J on the shoulder.

莱格斯：让我们来玩一场赌局吧，你们这群大孩子都喜欢游戏，不是吗?
Legers: Let's play a game. You big boys love playing games, don't you?

他指了指霍利克胸前那柄发亮的左轮手枪。
He points to the revolver poking Hollick's chest.

莱格斯：盯紧了，那把满膛四发的左轮手枪里头，正好塞着四枚子弹，那就是我的筹码。
Legers: Take a look. This revolver is fully loaded with four bullets. Here's how you play.

莱格斯：只要您答应一个条件，我就可以卸下一颗子弹——这是一场公平的赌局，直到所有子弹退膛，您就可以轻易赢得这场游戏。
Legers: I give you a condition. If you accept, I remove one bullet. When all the chambers are empty, you win. If you take your chances and reject a condition ...

莱格斯：当然，您也可以赌赌下一发的运气……
Legers: I shoot. Just know that I might bury a bullet in your skull.

莱格斯：我给的选择很自由，不是吗？呵呵……又或者，您想试试子弹满膛的胜率?
Legers: I totally respect your freedom of choice. You're even welcome to try your luck with all four bullets loaded, if you like.

旁边的持枪者，示意般地旋转着左轮手枪的弹巢。
The gunman spins the cylinder of his revolver.

一抹亮光闪过男孩的猫眼。
A glint of light flashes across the boy's cat-like eyes.

猫眼维森：我……我能看清他旋转弹巢的动作！头儿也许可以用最小的筹码——赢得这场赌局!
Cateye Wisen: I-I can see the bullets in the chamber when he rolls the cylinder! Alright, I gotta count for the boss. Gotta help him survive the game at the lowest price.

他赶忙跑向了厨房……
He dashes into the kitchen.

猫眼维森：J 先生，你们的杯子拿过来了……
Cateye Wisen: Here's your glass, boss.

J：谢谢你，维森……我想我正需要来一杯。
J: Thanks, Wisen. I could use a drink.

J 抽开杯垫子底下的纸张，余光瞥了一眼，接着重重咳嗽了几声。
J pulls out the paper from under the coaster, glancing at it from the corner of his eye, and then coughs into it heavily.

纸张上的文字被唾沫所湿润，渐渐糊成了一片黑。
As he removes it, the faint black ink has smeared beyond recognition.

猫眼维森：我的眼睛很敏锐！我能干很多细活……我擅长数火车、数硬币，我还可以看清那些出千的发牌员，连水滴都能数清楚!
Cateye Wisen: *I got sharp eyes! I can do lots of stuff! Counting coins, cars, finding water drops ... I'm great at spotting cheats and shady dealers!*

J：……
J: ...

他将纸巾递回给了维森，迟疑一阵，还是点了点头。
He hands the paper back to Wisen, hesitating for a moment before nodding.

J：……我很乐意陪你耍耍这场赌局，老头子。
J: Alright, let's do this, grandpa.

J：维森小子……把吧台那瓶龙舌兰拿出来，倒杯酒，让咱们的脑袋都清醒清醒。
J: Wisen, get that tequila from the bar. Need a drink to clear our minds.

猫眼维森：是的……头儿。
Cateye Wisen: On it, boss.

男孩从吧台中拎出了酒瓶，为两人斟满了子弹杯。
The boy pulls a bottle up from behind the bar and fills two shot glasses.

莱格斯：呵呵，您有一个机灵的小伙计。
Legers: Heh, that's a clever kid you got there.

莱格斯：让我们开始吧，孩子……
Legers: Alright, let's get started, kiddo.

满膛的左轮，被无意义地旋转着弹膛。
The cylinder is spun again. Four rounds, four demands—two ways that this can end.

莱格斯：一，你是否愿意将不属于你的东西，交还给我们?
Legers: Condition one: Return what you took from us.

J：当然。
J: Sure.

没有丝毫的犹豫，他从兜里掏出钥匙，放置在桌面上，推了过去。
Without hesitation, he pulls the key from his pocket, places it on the table, and pushes it forward to the elderly man.

莱格斯：喔，哈哈哈，您很爽快，这恐怕是我所见过的最痛快的交易，J 先生。
Legers: Hahaha. Continue like this, J, and this'll be the best game I ever played.

他身后的人群响起了嗤嗤的笑声。
A snicker rises from the crowd behind him.

“牙医”II：我还以为他起码会犹豫一阵，小子们，你们的头儿确实是个孬种……哈哈哈。
"Dentist" II: I thought he'd hesitate, at least a little bit. Looks like you got a coward for a boss, boys! Hahaha!

第一颗子弹退出了枪膛，弹巢再次被快速地转动。
The first bullet is pulled from the chamber, and the cylinder is spun again.

男孩正以几不可闻的声音嘟囔着。
The boy mutters inaudibly.

猫眼维森：5、8、10……
Cateye Wisen: Five, eight, ten, ten times.

猫眼维森：不……下一发仍是有子弹的一膛。
Cateye Wisen: The next chamber's loaded.

男孩俯身而来，再次满上了子弹杯。
He leans in and refills the shot glasses once more.

J：……谢谢你，维森。
J: Thanks, Wisen.

莱格斯：二，让你的人都离开这里，就现在，孩子。
Legers: Condition two: Get your people out of here. Now.

莱格斯：我们需要一个安静的空间，您的朋友聒噪过了头，令我们都心烦意乱。
Legers: We need quiet. Your friends are disturbing our conversation.

J：……把门都打开，离开这儿，朋友们。
J: You heard him, guys. Get outta here.

无人应答，所有人都站在原地。
But no one moves.

显然这个问题的决定权并不在他的手里。
This is a decision that falls out of his authority. Each of his crew has to make it on their own.

先驱者：……维森小子，照顾好你的头儿。
Pioneer: Wisen, take good care of your boss.

第一位退场者出现了。
The first to decide makes his exit.

贝克特：J，我宁愿跟这个杂碎一块儿死！你到底在干些什么？你什么时候成了这样的孬种了?!
Becket: J, what're you doing?! I'd rather take this bastard to hell with me! When did you become such a coward?!

J：不，朋友……你们呆在这儿帮不上任何忙，走吧——
J: No, guys. You're not helping by staying here. Just go.

贝克特踹开凳子，却仍死死盯着他。
Becket kicks the chair fruitlessly, holding his stare.

贝克特：呸……！
Becket: Damn it!

人群熙熙攘攘地离开，餐馆内顷刻间只剩下了另一边的人。
Becket breaks, as he makes his exit, the rest follow, until J sits alone.

莱格斯：很高兴与您合作，J 先生……呵呵，看来您有一个足够务实的脑袋。
Legers: Hah. It's a pleasure doing business with you, J. You're a practical man.

莱格斯：而且，“受苦者”在上，我们都看见了您有一颗宝贵的怜悯之心……
Legers: May the Sufferer bless you. There's no denying that you got a merciful heart.

“叮。”——第二颗子弹退出了枪膛，轮盘再次转动。
"Clink"—the second bullet is pulled from its chamber, and the cylinder spins once more.

猫眼维森：10、18……！
Cateye Wisen: Ten ... Eighteen times!

猫眼维森：！！！
Cateye Wisen: !!!

敏锐的猫眼，洞察到了一瞬的机遇。
The keen cat eyes a fleeting opportunity.

猫眼维森：这次开枪，将会连续出现两个空膛！头儿必须知道这个机会！
Cateye Wisen: The next two shots are safe! I gotta tell the boss!

男孩握紧了手中的酒瓶，在 J 的酒杯中倾倒着——恰好止于半杯。
The boy grips the bottle tightly as he pours its contents into J's glass, filling it only half-way.

他正打算将手缩回来——
When just as he lifts his hand—

莱格斯：倒满点儿，孩子，别客气……我会替 J 先生给你小费的。
Legers: Fill it to the top, kiddo. Don't skimp on him. I'll tip you if J doesn't.

他的手掌就像坚硬的枯木，将男孩牢牢抓住了。
Legers's rough and firm hands grasp the boy's own.

猫眼维森： 好的……先生。
Cateye Wisen: Yes, sir.

那杯象征着机会的酒，转眼间成了一个失败的暗示。
That had been only half of the code, he couldn't be sure that J would understand now. It is too great a risk to continue.

莱格斯： 那么，让我向您提出第三个要求——
Legers: Now, condition three ...

然而，未收到暗示的赌徒却摇了摇头。
J shakes his head, dismissing the words before he speaks them.

J： 你们已经输掉了这场游戏，莱格斯。
J: You've already lost the game, Legers.

J 的目光，从维森手臂上的红色握痕移开了。
J's gaze shifts away from the red marks on Wisen's arm.

莱格斯： 噢，您想试试一半的概率，是吗？——可是孩子，我从来没有说过，我们只会开一枪。
Legers: Oh, so you wanna take your chances, huh? Figured fifty-fifty was close enough? But you know, kiddo, I never said I would only shoot once.

J 埋下头，握住了博伊刀的柄。
J bows his head, gripping the handle of his Bowie knife.

J： 试试看，老头子。
J: Try it, old man.

莱格斯： 扳机。
Legers: Do it.

“哒。”
"Click."

“牙医”手里的左轮枪传来第一声空响。
The hammer drops into an empty chamber.

“牙医”Ⅱ： 你很走运，小子……让我们再多试试。
"Dentist" II: You got lucky, kid. Now let's try that again.

J 俯下身，靴子在地上发出巨大的摩擦声。
J crouches as his boots shift loudly against the floor.

从剑鞘之中，一道寒冽的冷光如水流般划出……
From the scabbard, a cold gleam reflects the room's dim lights, like the stars on a sheet of ice.

“牙医”Ⅱ： ?!
"Dentist" II: ?!

“哒。”
"Click."

左轮又是一声空响。
The cocked hammer falls and finds another empty chamber.

J 的剑鞘完全褪去，露出明晃晃的剑刃。
J's blade slides out from its sheath.

星点的火花震颤而出——
Sparks fly, trembling in the air—

“牙医”II：幸运小子，来见见血吧——
"Dentist" II: Eat lead, you lucky bastard!

“嘣——！”
"Bang—!"

震耳的枪声响彻餐馆。
The deafening gunshot echoes against the walls.

霍利克：咳、咳咳……J……！
Hollick: *coughs* J!

J：如你所见。
J: See what happens when you mess with me?

墙壁上多出了一个洞孔。
A new hole appears in the wall.

一只抓握着手枪的手臂，掉落在地。
And the revolver falls to the ground, still gripped by a severed arm.

“牙医”II：呃啊……！
"Dentist" II: Ugh! No ...

J：老头子，咱们的赌局到此为止了。
J: Game's over, grandpa.

莱格斯：J 先生，我们选择加注……
Legers: Oh, but we'd prefer to continue.

莱格斯：孩子们，把他们的脸撕下来。
Legers: Kids, rip his face off.

博伊刀指向了他的喉头。
The Bowie knife is pointed at his throat.

J：如你所愿，老头子。
J: If that's the way it's gotta be, let's do this, old man.

J：现在，天平向我们倾斜了。
J: But this time, we got the upper hand.

J：你要不要，送回从我们手里拿走的东西，乖乖带着你的狗崽子爬回你的老巢？
J: Now, give back what you took, and I'll let you and your little lackeys go.

J：或者——
J: Or ...

刃尖刺破脖颈的皮肤，血从中点点渗出来。
The blade's tip pierces the skin of his neck, and blood trickles from the wound.

莱格斯耐人寻味地盯着 J，就像赌局之外的旁观者。
Legers surveys J with a pensive stare.

莱格斯：您为我展示了聪明的脑袋，J 先生。但您显然欠缺失败的经验，我很荣幸能为您上这一堂课。
Legers: You're a smart kid, J, but apparently, you need a lesson in failure. I'll be glad to give it to you.

莱格斯：赌局之外，另有一场赌局……枪膛的每一发子弹，都不是虚发的。
Legers: We were actually playing two games just now. Those "missed" shots? They had a purpose.

莱格斯：那两颗没能射穿他胸膛的子弹，自然会“射”向其他地方……
Legers: They may not have hit you, but they did hit our second target.

“砰！”
"Boom!"

剧烈的爆炸声震荡，滚滚的火焰迸发而出。
An explosion shakes the room, erupting with a surge of flames.

猫眼维森：头儿，那是……霍利克的修车铺……还有你的车子?!
Cateye Wisen: Boss, that's Hollick's garage. And your bike!

莱格斯：把刀抬下去……孩子，这还只是场外的小筹码，为了让你明白，这还不是结束。
Legers: Put down the knife, kiddo. That was just a warning, to let you know the game isn't over yet.

莱格斯：接下来，你还会答应我最后一个条件——目送我和孩子们离开这里。
Legers: Now, I got one last condition: Let us leave in peace.

莱格斯：你同意吗?
Legers: So? What do you say?

贝克特：伙计们，快过来帮帮忙！……该死的，这是霍利克唯一吃饭的活计了！
Becket: Guys, help me out! Hollick needs this place to live, damn it!

门外的人们奋不顾身地扑打着火焰，而火焰却愈燃愈烈。
People outside desperately beat at the flames, but the fire grows fiercer despite their efforts.

莱格斯：我也可以把整条海特街都变成黑炭，只要您乐意。
Legers: I can turn all of Haight Street to ashes if you want me to.

博伊刀被抬了下去。
The Bowie knife is lowered.

莱格斯：很好，J 先生，谢谢你的合作。
Legers: Good boy.

莱格斯：另外……呵呵，换把刀子吧，它还不如这些狗崽子的牙齿硬实。
Legers: By the way, get yourself a better knife. I got butter knives sharper than that thing.

“嘣——！”
"Bang—!"

没有任何反应时间，枪口迸出火焰——
Without any time to react, the gun's muzzle flares.

博伊刀分崩离析。
His Bowie knife shatters into pieces.

莱格斯：这是对你乱丢骨头的一点点小警告。
Legers: A warning, for trying to take my men.

J：……
J: ...

火焰舔舐着焦黑的残骸，贝克特失神地跪坐在地上。
Flames lick at the charred debris, as Becket sits dazed on the ground.

海特街的人们，沉默地望着这场大火，望着这最后的通牒。
The people of Haight Street gather silently, watching the fire, seeing their final ultimatum unfold.

于是，第一个人从跪坐中起来，走向了 J。
Then, the daze lifts, and Becket rises with an outburst.

贝克特：我和霍利克在街头刚认识你的时候，你还不是个孬种……J。
Becket: What happened to you, J? You were fearless when Hollick and I first met you.

贝克特：那时候，咱们就像几只卑贱的野狗，翻着垃圾桶，到处游荡……除了一副顽固的硬骨头，口袋空空，什么也不剩下……可咱们还是走到了现在。
Becket: We were like a pack of stray dogs, rummaging through the trash cans and sleeping on the street. All we had were clothes on our backs, but we still made it this far.

贝克特：我他*甘愿把血流干，把骨头折断，也不会求饶一声……可现在，你在想什么，J?
Becket: I'd rather break my bones and shed my last drop of blood than beg for mercy. But look at you, J. What were you thinking?

贝克特：我是跟了一个孬种吗？我们的头儿是个孬种吗?
Becket: Are you a coward, Boss?

他啐了一口痰，搀扶起地上的霍利克。
He spits on the ground as he helps the bloodied Hollick to his feet.

徽章被鄙弃地丢到了垃圾桶中。
He holds J's gaze as he unpins his badge and tosses it into the trash.

霍利克：这不怪他，都是我。咳、咳……贝克特，留下来，求求你留下来。
Hollick: Don't blame him, Becket. It's my fault. *coughs* Please don't go.

霍利克：……J，我、我会回来帮你的!
Hollick: J! I-I'll come back to help!

拉扯着他的贝克特，抑制不住怒火。
Becket pulls at Hollick, unable to contain his anger any longer.

贝克特：你要是真的明白这事儿是因为你而起，就别再他*瞎逞能帮忙了!
Becket: Oh, come on, Hollick! You just said that this is your fault. So do me a favor and shut up.

贝克特：你还不明白就是因为你，才变成现在这个局面的吗?!但凡你的脑袋长点记性，也不会被人抓住把柄!
Becket: You know you're the one who got us into this mess, right?! If you'd learned your damn lesson, none of this would have happened!

贝克特：闭嘴吧!
Becket: So just shut up!

霍利克垂下了头，那是无法反驳的责怪……
Hollick hangs his head, dejected and quiet.

贝克特硬拽走了沉默的伤员。
Becket forcibly drags the wounded giant away.

J：……
J: ...

旋即是人群中的第二个人——
Then, another from the crowd.

乞丐布莱恩：J，对不起……我只是想找个能够睡觉的铺盖，我、我还没想过要把命都搭在这里……
Brian the Beggar: S-sorry, Mr. J. All I wanted was a safe place to sleep, not all this. I-I don't wanna get killed.

他逃也似的，如同恐惧瘟疫一般，丢下第二个徽章。
He leaves behind the second badge and fearfully makes his way from the street.

第三个、第四个……他们瑟瑟发抖，他们心怀不甘——他们知道自己是微不足道的芸芸众生之一。
The third and fourth ... They tremble, reluctant, feeling their own smallness in the crowd.

火苗渐熄，灰烬如同群鸟飘荡。
The flames dwindle, and ashes hang in the air.

人群溃散，留下了空荡荡的街巷，一切宛如废墟。
The crowd breaks apart slowly and wordlessly, until they've left only an empty, burned-out street.

猫眼维森：头儿，我……我去把贝克特他们劝回来！他们，还有这一切……
Cateye Wisen: Boss, I'll, I'll get them to come back! We'll get everything back!

猫眼维森：嘿、嘿……！
Cateye Wisen: Hey! Hey!

他跑向溃散的人群，背影如此单薄。
He runs out to catch the crowd, but soon he too grasps his vulnerability.

仿若落了单的鸟儿。
Like a straggling bird, left out from the flock.

炉火与铁砧
Ingle and Anvil FT-11

少许的灰烬飘浮在空气中，让人们内心的恐惧浮浮沉沉。
The club's air is thick with smoldering ash and smoke.

“开业中”的招牌在门口孤零零地晃悠着，路过的人们行色匆匆，唯恐在店门前驻留。
The "Open" sign swings forlornly at the door. Those few that still pass it on the street do so quickly, as if running past a graveyard.

餐馆前所未有的冷清。
Even in the heart of the city, it feels remote.

玛蒂尔达：是的……我现在正位于海特街 379 号待命。我已经嘱托了赶回基金会的两名职员，他们随后将带领你们过来……
Matilda: Yes. I am awaiting orders at 379 Haight Street now. I have sent two investigators back to the branch. They'll show you the way.

玛蒂尔达：碍于事发突然……我会提前赶到那里，并向你们发送我最新的坐标位置。
Matilda: Since time is limited, I will go to the target location in advance and update you on my coordinates.

联络器：这也许将是我们剿灭重塑之手的又一个新节点……玛蒂尔达小姐，您为我们提供了一个至关重要的讯息。
SPF-I: This mission will bring us one step closer to eliminating Manus Vindictae. You have provided us with vital information thus far, Ms. Bouanich.

联络器：请时刻保持联系……紧急援助小队将很快赶来。
SPF-I: Please stay in touch. The reinforcement squad will arrive soon.

玛蒂尔达：另、另外……我还需要补充另一则消息……
Matilda: And, one more thing.

她欲言又止，但还是说了下去。
She stops, but eventually cannot help but continue.

玛蒂尔达：我们其中一位神秘学家朋友有可能已经叛投了重塑之手，唔……圣洛夫基金会的支援恐怕会被他们有所防范……
Matilda: One of our arcanist friends may have defected to Manus Vindictae. I believe they'll be expecting us and the reinforcements.

玛蒂尔达：这是我个人的疏忽，我希望允许我事先探路，为后续的支援提供帮助……
Matilda: This was my personal oversight, so I hope you will allow me to scout ahead. That way, I can provide optimal support for the following operation.

联络器的另一端沉默片刻，响起了一阵喧嚣。
The other end of the line is silent, until a staticky clamor breaks through.

随后，是一个斩钉截铁的答复。
It comes with a resolute reply.

联络器：请务必遵守命令，在新纪元集市等待支援，玛蒂尔达调查员。
SPF-I: Your current mission is to wait for reinforcements at the New Age Market. Please follow your orders, Investigator Bouanich.

玛蒂尔达：好的……我明白。
Matilda: Understood.

她咬紧嘴唇，沮丧地将联络器收回了口袋中。
She bites her lip, disheartened, and puts the device back into her pocket.

增援的消息已经抵达，但她却无论如何也难以平复那焦躁的内心。
It is good news, but she can't calm the turmoil within her.

先驱者：我听说，环状水星女士今早去了莱格斯的地界……
Pioneer: I heard Ms. Mercuria went to Legers's place this morning.

先驱者：……玛蒂尔达小姐，我们已经做到了力所能及的一切——这并非你的过错。
Pioneer: Ms. Bouanich, we've done everything we can. It's not your fault.

她摇了摇头，已无心答复这些安慰。
She shakes her head, no longer in the mood to respond to any words of comfort.

玛蒂尔达：莱格斯和那帮神秘学家已经让新纪元集市脱离了轨道，我现在更需要保证的是你们的安全……
Matilda: Legers and those arcanists have made a total mess of the market. The people's safety is our top priority now.

玛蒂尔达：从今早开始，J 那个家伙就不见了人影……等基金会到达的时候，他必须得在这里……
Matilda: J's been away since this morning. He has to be here when the reinforcements arrive.

玛蒂尔达：他去哪儿了？
Matilda: Where did he go?

假人耸了耸肩。
The mannequin shrugs.

先驱者：他哪儿也没去……玛蒂尔达小姐，他就在这儿。
Pioneer: Nowhere, Ms. Bouanich. He's right there.

他指了指厨房的后门。
He points to the back door of the kitchen, held slightly ajar.

虚掩着的后门中，传来循序渐进的敲击声——
From behind it comes a rhythmic, metallic sound.

“叮——”
"Clink—"

“叮、叮——”
"Ding, ding—"

“叮、叮——叮！”
"Ding, ding—ding!"

她走上前去，穿过拥挤的厨房，穿过满目的酱汁、生面包片、脏盘子……
She steps forward, moving through the cluttered kitchen, past sauces, grills, and towers of unwashed plates.

玛蒂尔达：他在……干什么？
Matilda: What's he doing?

端着杯子的假人摇了摇头，拒绝了回应。
The mannequin turns his head to the door, giving no response.

她打开了虚掩的门，步入其中。
She pushes the door open and steps inside.

……

...

锻造车库
Blacksmithing Workshop

J：哈，说实话，我以为自己这辈子都不会再把这脏兮兮的东西拿出来了……
J: Hah, to be honest, I thought I'd never use this thing again.

他的锤子，犹如巨人的脚掌一般，重重砸在滚烫发红的金属上。
His hammer strikes down heavily on the glowing, red-hot metal. Something tells her they fell harder than they should.

J：我还记得那天，我老爸在客厅，神神秘秘地跟所有朋友说，他在那次旅行中，找到了世界上最了不得的宝物——自从我的母亲去世以后，谁也没见他那么高兴过。
J: I remember that day. Dad was in the living room with his friends, boasting about this awesome treasure he found on his trip. Hadn't seen him smile like that since Mom died.

J：人们都以为他从那堆光秃秃的土堆底下找到了什么好东西，巴结着他。
J: Heh. His friends all sucked up to him. Thought he dug up some good stuff.

J：那时候我还是个乳臭未干、爱垂头丧气的小子，谁见了也不痛快。
J: I was just a whiney little kid back then. No one liked me.

J：等人们走光了，他让我穿上一身紧巴巴的制服，就像要才艺表演似的，领着一脸苦相的我去了天鹅绒餐厅……
J: After his friends left, Dad put me in a suit and tie, like I was some kind of stage performer, and took me to the Velvet Restaurant.

J：他牵着我的手，接着把另一个小姑娘带到我面前——说：“嘿，小伙子。我为你找了个妹妹。”
J: When we got there, he brought this little girl to me and said, "Hey son, I got you a little sister."

J：我第一次见到了保利娜和她的母亲，我知道他没有撒谎，他确实为我们带来了宝物——一段慢悠悠的，踮着脚尖吃甜品，快活得能飘起来的日子。
J: That was the first time I met Paulina and her mom. I realized that he wasn't lying about the treasure. The days after were sweet, like eating dessert on cloud nine every day.

火星在他的瞳孔中，迸溅。
Sparks fly across his eyes.

J：但作为一个穷困潦倒的保险推销员，从世代铸剑的维兰德家族里溜出来的私生子……他的野心太大，而力量又太小。
J: But it didn't last long. My dad was nothing but a broke insurance agent after he ran away from the Wayland family. He had big dreams, but he was too weak to realize them.

玛蒂尔达：维兰德……家族？我在第一防线学校编纂的《秘学与金属》里听过这个家族。
Matilda: The Wayland family? I've read about them in the Arcanum and Metal, compiled by the SPDM.

玛蒂尔达：他们世代都是秘学冶金工匠，其中尤以铸剑盛名……可、可这个家族不是早已经在战争中灭亡了吗？
Matilda: They've been arcane blacksmiths, famous for their sword-making, for generations. But the book says the family perished in the war.

J：不管哪个时代，小家伙……那些弱小的人都会躲到阴暗的洞里面，学会隐藏自己的力量，只在真正需要它时，才去使用。
J: No matter what generation, Frenchie, weak people cower in dark holes, learn to hide their power, and only use it when they really need it.

J：不够“胆小”的人，是无法存活的……老爸去世以后，我就比谁都明白这个道理。
J: Being reckless can kill you. I've learned that better than anyone since my old man died.

J：那些巴结他的人猜对了，他靠着家族留下来的“所罗门的手稿”，从遗迹底下翻出了一坨看上去一文不值、黑不溜秋的铁块儿。
J: And, you know what? His friends were right. He followed Solomon's Manuscript, a document left behind by his family, and dug up something from under the ruins. A worthless piece of black iron.

玛蒂尔达：“所罗门的手稿”？……可这在圣洛夫基金会属于机密信息，不可能有其他人知道……你们把那个铁块儿藏在哪了？
Matilda: Solomon's Manuscript? That document holds top-secret information, only available to certain members of the Foundation. How did he get it? And what have you done with the iron?

J：一大半呢，早就成了我背上的那把东西，而剩下的余料……
J: Most of it became this thing strapped to my back, and the rest ...

J：就在你眼前，小家伙……如今，跨越了这么长的时间，我才理解了我老爸，这确实是块好料子……
J: Well, you're looking at it, girl. I didn't get why Dad said it was good stuff until now.

J：就像那些吉普赛巫婆，从听见孩童的第一声啼哭，就能断定他的一生是战士还是祭司一样——
J: You know those witches who can tell at a glance whether a kid'll be a warrior or a priest?

J：即便只是一块余料，但从我瞧见它的第一眼起，它也将注定是一把好刀。
J: When I looked at this scrap of metal, I had the same feeling. It was destined to be a killer knife.

J：而这会是它作为利刃的第一次出场。
J: And now, it's gonna make its debut.

女孩瞥见了他脚底下的布袋，以及——远处一辆老旧却擦得瓦亮的摩托车。
The girl catches sight of the cloth bag at his feet and, further away, a weathered but polished old motorcycle.

玛蒂尔达：……圣洛夫基金会的支援马上就要赶到，而且我已经破解了那把钥匙的术法……
Matilda: Reinforcements will arrive soon, and I have decoded the spell on the key.

玛蒂尔达：J，你得好好呆在这里。
Matilda: You have to wait, J.

玛蒂尔达：环状水星女士……已经加入了他们，我们无从得知她将会泄露什么情报……
Matilda: Ms. Mercuria, she's joined Manus Vindictae. We have no way of knowing what information she's given them.

他摇了摇头。
He shakes his head.

J：小家伙，我会亲自把我的朋友带回来……
J: I don't need their help. I can bring my friends back myself, French Fry.

J：那帮疯子的庆典将至，我不打算眼睁睁地看着生我养我的这条街分崩离析……同样，我也不打算等你姗姗来迟的朋友。
J: Those crazies are holding the ceremony soon. I'm not gonna let them destroy my birthplace. I'm not gonna wait for your little friends to arrive, either.

玛蒂尔达：你听我说，你根本没有任何必要以身犯险，圣洛夫基金会的支援很快就会到达，我们能最大程度地减小可能出现的伤亡。
Matilda: Please, J, there's no reason to risk your life! The reinforcements will arrive in no time. Then we can finish this with minimum casualties.

玛蒂尔达：记住了，阅历丰富的调查员玛蒂尔达·布翁尼要教给你一个道理——准备万全才能把事情干得漂亮啊！
Matilda: Take this lesson from the experienced Investigator Matilda Bouanich: preparation is the key to success!

年轻人畅快地笑起来。
The young man laughs hard and steadily.

J：哈哈哈，你说得没错，小家伙……
J: Hahaha, I guess you're right.

J：从我在街头摸爬滚打的日子来说，等一位警察、庇护人、老大——像是救世主那类的大人物——总是最优的选择，它能让我们避免无谓的流血与挨揍。
J: When I was a scrawny little street kid, I'd look to a savior, like a cop or a boss, anything to avoid a beating.

J：我们都知道，怎么聪明地绕过麻烦。
J: We all got the smarts to stay outta trouble.

J：我们会瞻前，与顾后。
J: We just gotta look both ways before we make our move.

“叮——”
"Clink—"

老乞丐：那是我所有的财产了，我恳求你们……那个空钱包对你们来说没有任何用处，里面就只有我妻子和女儿的照片。
Old Beggar: This wallet is all I have, please! There's nothing in it! Just a photo of my wife and daughter!

地痞Ⅰ：来呀，老不死的家伙……有种就自己过来把你的东西拿回去——哈哈哈，接住，伯顿！
Rascal I: C'mon, you old fogey. Take it back if you got the guts! Hahaha, Berton, catch!

地痞Ⅱ：过来，在这边，在这边，老头……噢?！别挡道，你这个臭熏熏的狗杂种。
Rascal II: Over here, old man. Hey! Get out of the way, you stupid bastard!

乞丐布莱恩：……
Brian the Beggar: ...

老乞丐：帮帮我，布莱恩……
Old Beggar: Help me, Brian.

乞丐布莱恩：抱歉，抱歉……朋友……
Brian the Beggar: I'm sorry. I'm sorry, friend.

他甩开老人哆哆嗦嗦的手，却始终没有迈开逃走的第一步。
He shakes off the old man's trembling hand as if preparing to run.

J: 我们忍让又谦逊。
J: We show tolerance and modesty.

“叮——”
"Clink—"

修车铺老板: 霍利克，告诉我，你妈妈生你的时候是不是把你的脑子忘了？如果你再把昂贵的清洁剂用在这种破车上，半个子儿你都拿不到！
Garage Owner: Hollick, tell me, did your brain slip outta your skull? Don't you know how expensive this cleaner is? Spray it on this piece of crap one more time, and you ain't getting a cent next month!

霍利克: 可、可是……先生，顾客花钱买了这瓶清洁剂。
Hollick: B-but, sir, the customer paid us to use this cleaner.

修车铺老板: 我还花钱雇了你这个蠢家伙呢！你是要听我的，还是滚回去陪你那个烧焦的修车铺白日做梦？
Garage Owner: And I pay you to work for me, you idiot! Either listen to me, or go back to daydreaming in that burnt-down garage of yours!

他胆怯地垂下头，望着自己空荡荡的口袋，欲言又止。
He timidly glances downward, feeling at his empty pockets, struggling to find words.

J: 谨慎又迟疑，量力而行，见好就收。
J: We know our limits. Do what we can and give up when we have to.

“叮——”
"Clink—"

贝克特: 咳、咳……呸……
Becket: *coughs and spits*

裁判: 10、9、8、7……
Judge: Ten, nine, eight, seven ...

赌局庄家: 嘿、嘿，别再站起来了，蠢货！我保证，这局比赛结束后，肯定让你湿湿嘴！
Oddsmaker: Hey, hey! Just stay down, you idiot! You'll get paid after the game, I promise!

赌局庄家: 你这个没卵蛋的家伙！躺下去，咱们谁都能赚个盆满钵满！
Oddsmaker: Oh c'mon! You think you're a tough man? Just stay down, and we'll make a fortune!

他的身躯已经竭尽了气力，但拳头仍紧紧握着。
His body is exhausted, pushed over hard, yet his fist remains tightly clenched.

“叮——”
"Clink—"

“叮、叮——叮！”
"Ding, ding—ding!"

J: 但如果你试过给这些剑淬火，就会明白，犹豫只会徒增裂纹。
J: But if you've ever tried to temper a sword, you'd know that hesitation ruins the work.

滚烫的刀身坠入水中，瞬间涌起了无数气泡。
The searing-hot blade plunges into the water, producing a hissing burst of bubbles and steam.

J: 只有最闪烁的火遇上水，才能造就最好的钢——这个世道，还有另一种选择，另一种生活方式。
J: You gotta be brave, decisive. That's how you make a great sword. That's how you live a great life.

J: 它不需要你谨言慎行，不需要你万事俱备。
J: You don't gotta be too careful about what you say and do. Don't gotta be prepared for everything.

他从水中拎出冷却好的剑身，置于柔软的裹布里。
He pulls the cooled blade from the water and places it into the soft wrapping cloth.

这是一把新的博伊刀。
A new Bowie knife.

J：因为——那些会颤抖的拳头，才拥有真正的力量。
J: Because a brave and decisive fist ... Well, that's unstoppable.

J：我不会等待一切都准备好的，永远不会。你明白吗?
J: I won't just stand back and wait like a coward. Never. You understand?

她踟蹰着。
She hesitates.

玛蒂尔达：……呃，也许你说的是有些道理。但这已经严重违反了基金会此前下达的命令……
Matilda: Perhaps you're right, but this would be a serious violation. You'll be going against the direct orders of the Foundation!

那焦躁的内心深处，一个答案已缓缓浮现。
Deep within her restless mind, an answer is slowly emerging.

玛蒂尔达：因此……作为你的监督者，玛蒂尔达会牢牢跟紧你，防止你做出预料之外的蠢事！
Matilda: Therefore, as your supervisor, I will keep an eye on you wherever you go, just in case you do something stupid.

一个头盔划过半空，丢到她的手中。
A helmet flies through the air, landing in her hand.

J：没问题，长官。
J: Fine by me, commander.

服务员心无旁骛地正把桌子抹得反光。
The round bartender has polished the table to a shine, as if oblivious to the destruction around her.

斯普特尼克：哼♫哼呵♬……嗯?!
Sputnik: *humming* Hmm?!

斯普特尼克：不对……那些放在这里的徽章，怎么全都不见了?!
Sputnik: Hey. Where are the badges?! They were here just now!

斯普特尼克：先驱者先生！先驱者先生！
Sputnik: Mr. Pioneer! Mr. Pioneer!

然而目光所及，只有门扇仍在摆动——趋于止息。
He is already gone.

“嗡、嗡——嗡！”
"Buzz, buzz—buzz!"

空棺柩
Empty Coffin FT-12

秘密住所
Hidden Safehouse

瓶瓶罐罐立在桌面上，风干的药草被麻线捆起，安放在角落中。
Jars and bottles line the table, with dried herbs bound with twine placed neatly in the corner.

不计其数的名片在火炉中，只剩下了片片残骸。
The furnace spits out the scraps of old business cards.

火炉边缘，一只箱子半敞着，露出熟悉的黑色面具。
Beside the furnace, a box lies half-open, revealing a familiar black mask.

医生：抱歉，在我见过的所有病人里，都从未出现过如此——匪夷所思的情况，人类的医学恐怕已经起不到太大的作用，这已经远超过了我的所能……
Doctor: Sorry, I've never seen a case like this before. I can't quite believe what I'm looking at, to be honest. I'm afraid there's nothing human medicine can do. This is well beyond my means.

他向着坐椅上受伤的男人摘下了帽子，深深鞠了一躬。
He removes his hat and bows deeply to the injured man sitting in the chair.

随后提起手提箱，转身离去。
Then he picks up the briefcase and turns to leave.

莱格斯：……
Legers: ...

他将名片攒在拳头中，拧成一团，丢入火炉。
He gathers more cards into a tight ball in his fist and tosses them into the furnace.

另一扇门传来了叩响。
There is another knock from a separate door.

“砰——！”
"Bang—!"

未等他的回答，门便被擅自打开了。
Before he could answer, the door is bashed open.

杰洛：你到底想干什么，老头?！我听说你带着那帮刚来的新崽子去了一趟海特街，可没有任何人提前告诉我！
Gio: What do you think you're doing, Pops?! No one told me you took the new kids to Haight Street!

杰洛：你明知道这群愣头愣脑的狗崽子里，保不齐谁会反咬你一口！
Gio: Those crazy dogs coulda hurt you! You know that?!

莱格斯：反咬一口？呵呵……谢谢你为我着想，孩子。
Legers: Hurt me? Heh. I appreciate your concern, kiddo.

莱格斯：我听说，你的匕首找到了，是吗？是哪位好心人给你送了回来?
Legers: I heard that you found your dagger. Who was kind enough to return it?

莱格斯：是那位在新纪元集市的女士吗？你最近对她很上心。
Legers: That lady from the New Age Market? I know you've been sweet on her.

杰洛：……
Gio: ...

莱格斯将一叠封好的信封，丢到了桌面上。
Legers tosses a stack of sealed envelopes onto the table.

莱格斯：你已经跟着我离开了有一段年数……我准备让你回意大利一趟，好好待一阵子……记得替我向你的母亲问好。
Legers: You've been over here for a few years. I think it's time you went back to Italy. Stay there for a while. Oh, and say hello to your mother for me.

站在桌前的杰洛哑然失笑。
Gio, standing at the other end of the table, lets out a silent laugh.

杰洛：……瞧瞧你在说什么，老头。
Gio: Listen to yourself, Pops.

他对着面前的男人，缓缓举起了枪。
He raises the gun toward the old man with purpose.

杰洛： 五年前，当我们这帮移民的穷小子被揍得鼻青脸肿的时候，你告诉我们——
Gio: Five years ago, when we moved here from that remote arcanist village, we were down and out.

杰洛： 如果就这样灰溜溜地滚回老家，回到那个属于神秘学家的犄角旮旯的村庄，还不如干脆地赏自己一枪。
Gio: But still, you said you'd rather shoot yourself in the head than return home a loser.

杰洛： 你答应我们，会在这里扎根，会让这里成为另一片故土。
Gio: You promised we'd settle down here. Make it our second home.

杰洛： 我们这些神秘学家混账从没有如此相信过一个人类——全因我们都是被这个社会抛弃的可怜虫。
Gio: We were cast out by the humans, but we trusted you.

杰洛： 我们都明白，面包与尊严大过了种族与出身，仇恨与偏见不能果腹，所以我们才如此尊敬你。
Gio: We all understood that hating humans wouldn't put food on the table. That's why we respected you—why we still respect you.

他持枪的手颤抖着，言语愈发地激动。
The gun trembles in his hand, his words increasingly agitated.

杰洛： 小拇指杰瑞死在了浴缸里，他母亲到现在还以为他在跟着我们跑船。
Gio: Jerry Little Finger died in the tub. His mama still thinks he's working for us on the sea.

杰洛： 矮子肯，他一辈子都在干端盘子的营生，却被那群混账的子弹射得面目全非，他的女儿才刚刚出生！
Gio: Short Ken, who spent his whole life waiting tables, was shot to pieces just a couple of days after his daughter was born!

杰洛： 而我的妻子萨菲娜死在了不知名的纵火者手里，那帮该死的警察直到现在都一声不吭！
Gio: And my wife, Savina, was burned to death by some piece of s**t arsonist! Even now, the cops won't tell me who did it!

杰洛： 我们拥有自己的原则，也赢得了尊重和血淋淋的钞票，比我们父辈在船厂一辈子赚得都要多——而如今，你却宁愿与那帮“启明会”的疯子们混在一起。
Gio: But even through all the pain, and all the hardship, we had principles. Principles that have earned us respect and made us more money than our fathers did in their entire lives! But now you've been corrupted by those lunatics from the Order of Enlightenment!

杰洛： 私人诊所因此不再愿意为我们提供治疗，因为他们明白我们不再有原则，我们手里拿到的，都是从那些像我们当初那样饿肚子的穷人手里窃走的钞票。
Gio: Now the clinics refuse to treat us. They know we don't go by our principles anymore! That every cent we have is taken from those poor people who're as hungry as we used to be!

杰洛： 我们庇护着一群让孩子流离失所、让穷人走向末路的家伙，我们失去了人们的信任，而你还要为此推开我们，让更多人流血！
Gio: What do we stand for now? Beating down on the poor and murdering children?! No one trusts us anymore! You're pushing everyone further and further away! When are you gonna stop, huh? How many more have to suffer?!

他的手臂就像提着重石一般，晃动、打颤。
His arm feels heavy. It trembles with exhaustion.

莱格斯： 杰洛，我的孩子……你还远没有看到一切。
Legers: Gio, my boy. You haven't seen the bigger picture.

莱格斯走过去，用手握住了颤抖的枪口。
Legers approaches, grasping the quivering muzzle of the gun.

旋即宛如慈父接过赠礼，将枪拿回到自己手里。
Then, like a kindly father receiving a gift, he takes the gun into his own hands.

莱格斯：你甚至也没准备杀死我，即便你咬了她的“骨头”，却仍然那么忠诚，孩子。
Legers: And even now, with that girl messing with your mind, you have no intention of killing me. You're loyal. I'll give you that, kid.

“砰！”
"Boom!"

杰洛如同一匹折断腿的马，倾倒在地。
Gio collapses in a heap.

杰洛：呃啊……！
Gio: Ugh!

但他的手枪并没有指向杰洛的脑袋，而是指向了漆黑的走廊。
But the gun is not held at Gio's head. Instead, it is aimed out toward the pitch-black corridor.

莱格斯：我一直想知道是谁在蛊惑我的孩子，令他生出一些不应有的怜悯与愧疚……
Legers: I've been wondering who that witch is, the girl who's making my boy feel mercy and guilt.

莱格斯：让他无法贯彻自己的意志，让他甚至连枪也拿不稳，如此令我蒙羞。
Legers: You're not thinking straight anymore. Can't even hold a gun. It's shameful.

???：……杰洛先生的犹豫便是他的意志，莱格斯先生。
???: Gio's hesitating because he is thinking straight, Legers.

她从走廊的阴影中，缓缓走出。
She emerges from the shadows of the corridor.

环状水星：一发子弹并非要射出枪膛，才能唤来寂静与和解。
Mercuria: Bullets don't bring peace.

环状水星：杰洛先生选择将自己的生命当作最后的劝诫，我想您应该比任何人都理解此事。
Mercuria: Gio is risking his life to make you see the truth. I believe you understand that better than anyone.

环状水星：我不会阻止您杀死杰洛先生……因为这是属于他的选择。
Mercuria: But, if you insist on taking his life, I won't stop you. He made this choice himself.

莱格斯：是吗?
Legers: Is that so?

他将枪口抵在杰洛喘息的胸膛上。
He presses the gun's muzzle down on Gio's chest.

杰洛伸出一只手，挽住了他的肩膀，仿若一个邀请。
Gio reaches out a hand, grasping the man's shoulder, as if asking for something.

杰洛：抱歉，老头……
Gio: I'm sorry, Pops.

莱格斯：……
Legers: ...

枪被抛到了地上。
The gun is thrown to the ground.

莱格斯：带这个孩子离开这里，我已经不需要他那胆怯的忠诚了。
Legers: Get him outta here. I've no need for cowards, no matter how loyal they are.

环状水星： 先生，您误会了……我来到这里，并非为了帮助杰洛先生，更无意见证他的自我献身——我仅是遵循了自己的意志。
Mercuria: You've got me wrong. I didn't come here to help Gio or to witness his sacrifice. I was just following my heart.

环状水星： 我应邀而来——只是为了加入你们。
Mercuria: I was invited here, to join you.

她点点头，说出了一个既定的选择。
She nods, stating it as if guided by fate.

环状水星： 确切的说，我像刚才那位医生一样，为了您而来。
Mercuria: To be precise, I've come here to help you. Just like that doctor.

她的目光，扫视着火炉、药草、箱子……将房间的一切尽收眼中。
Her gaze sweeps over the hearth, the herbs, and the box, taking in everything in the room.

最后，定睛在了地毯之上。
Finally, her eyes fix on the carpet between them.

环状水星： 呼……原来如此。
Mercuria: *deep breath* I see.

环状水星： 我无数次看见人们将能量聚集于自己身上，他们将自己的生命与欲望视作中心，夺取着他人的手中之物，利用与榨取他人的血肉，来填充自己的空洞。
Mercuria: I've seen it countless times. How people gather energy to themselves. They put their own lives—their own desires—above all else. They take from others, even exploiting them to satisfy their greed.

环状水星： 杰洛先生不是那种人……您，也不是。我能看清您身上的光晕——您的灵魂、您的宿愿——它未聚焦于您自己。
Mercuria: But Gio's not one of them, nor are you. I can see the aura around you—your soul, your wishes, your energy—none of them are focused on yourself.

环状水星： 它只属于这个房间中的第四个人。
Mercuria: They're all focused on someone else—someone hidden in this place.

她举起手，指向了淌着鲜血的地毯之下。
She raises her hand and points to the blood-stained patch beneath the carpet.

莱格斯： ……
Legers: ...

环状水星： 您一直瞒着所有人，将他藏在这所房间下面，不是吗?
Mercuria: He's right here, beneath these floorboards. And you've kept him secret all this time, haven't you?

……

...

她提着灯，迈下这漆黑不见底的阶梯。
She carries the lamp into the pitch-black stairway.

而前方的带路者，目中无光，手上亦无依靠，他的每一步却都踏实在黑暗中，未曾落空。
Her guide walks ahead of her, descending with neither light nor a raised hand, taking each step firmly and confidently as he moves into the darkness—never missing a step.

仿若踏在故乡的归途上。
It is as familiar to him as walking a well-worn path home.

地下室
Basement

呛人的气味扑鼻而来，仿若一群密密麻麻的虫子窜入了肺部。
The acrid smell hits her nose, filling her lungs with a shuddering insect-like sensation.

黑色的霉菌以床架为中心，向地面、墙体扩散。
Black mold spreads out from the bed frame in front of them, creeping down and across the floor and walls.

???: 咳咳……呵——！
???: *coughs and spits*

床上瘦骨嶙峋的躯体弓了起来，从喉咙的疮口中，咳出脓黄色的孢子雾。
The emaciated body on the bed arches upwards, coughing out a haze of yellow spores from the gaping sore in its throat.

环状水星: ……莱格斯先生，这就是您所做的一切的缘由。
Mercuria: So he's the reason for everything you've done.

环状水星: 死亡本已将他啃食殆尽……而你却执着地抓住了他，试图将这位可怜人的生命与痛苦一并弥留。
Mercuria: Death has almost taken him, yet you still cling on to him. You won't let him go. He's suffering.

她拿起床架旁边的照片。
She picks up the photo next to the bed frame.

那是两个站在大学前，搭着肩膀，样貌别无二致的男人。
Two men standing in front of a university, their faces nearly identical.

环状水星: 外界的传言并不是空穴来风，传到人们耳中的可怜人的哀嚎……正属于这位先生。
Mercuria: So the rumors were true. The wailing that people heard, it came from this poor man.

环状水星: 而您，一个人类，也并未受到术法的庇护，您从来都是一副血肉之躯……那几发子弹从未贯穿过您的颅脑，因为——你们本就不是同一个人。
Mercuria: And you, a human of flesh and blood, unprotected by any arcane skills, were shot in the head, yet continue to walk and talk. Those bullets never penetrated your head, did they? Because you're not Legers.

环状水星: 如今躺在床上的人，才是莱格斯先生。
Mercuria: He is.

她用拇指捏碎掌心的干草，又在食指侧咬出了一道血口。
Mercuria crushes the dried grass in her palm with her thumb, then bites her fingertip to draw some blood.

环状水星将混合了草末的鲜血，轻抹在那枯槁消瘦、宛如干尸的脸颊之上。
She gently smears the paste of blood and grass onto the corpse-like man's withered, emaciated face.

红色的血液开始攀爬，沿着菌丝爬进他的喉咙、耳鼻——肺腑。
Red blood begins to drip from the steeped paste, following the fungal strands into his throat, ears, and nose, and, at last, into his lungs.

环状水星: “启明会”为您提供的手段，能令他以残破的躯体苟延残喘……但也同时蒙蔽了他的意识。
Mercuria: The Order of Enlightenment has allowed him to survive, albeit in a dying body. But there's a price for this: his consciousness.

病人: 咳、咳……！呕……！
Patient: *coughs and vomits*

一大团脓包状的菌子，从他的喉咙中倾泻而出。
A thick mass of fungi-strewn pus pours out of his throat.

环状水星：我只能让他清醒片刻，但这无法延续他正在衰竭的生命之河，“莱格斯”先生……
Mercuria: The most I can do is recover his consciousness for a short while, but I can't save him from death.

她闭上双眼，伸出手，一团光晕渐渐笼罩住了失去意识的病人。
She closes her eyes and extends her hand, a halo of light enveloping the unconscious patient.

病人的眼眸缓缓睁开。
The patient's eyes reopen weakly.

病人：咳、咳……兄弟，你在我身上实验了不少东西，可把我折磨得够呛……
Patient: *coughs* You tried so many treatments, brother. Sometimes it felt like torture.

病人：呵呵……咳咳咳，我这一身滑稽的样子，活像一块发霉的面包。
Patient: Heh. *coughs* Look at me. I look like a piece of moldy bread.

莱格斯：是你吗？莱格斯……我的兄弟！
Legers: You're back?! Legers, you're back!

莱格斯：听我说，我发誓、我发誓，我已经找到了让你继续活下去的方法……
Legers: Listen, I've found a way to cure your condition. I swear you won't die. I swear!

而床上的病人只是摇了摇头。
The patient shakes his head in a creaking drawn-out motion.

病人：你当上教授了吗，我的弟弟？这一身衣服可不像你的派头，咳、咳……我还是喜欢你戴上金丝眼镜，那副愤世嫉俗、喋喋不休的样子。
Patient: Are you a professor now, Salvadore? This outfit isn't your usual style. *coughs* You used to wear a pair of gold-framed glasses and criticize everything you saw. A true intellectual. That's the Salvadore I know.

莱格斯：我现在成了你，我的兄弟……那群街区的孩子需要你，所以我放弃了那纸破文凭，选择重新构筑你的王国……
Legers: After you were shot, I disguised myself as you. I've been running your kingdom. These kids need you, so I gave up my diploma.

莱格斯：如今，我们已经共有了声望与权力，就跟当初你所期盼的一样……
Legers: We'll share the fame and power when you get back on your feet, just like you always wanted.

病人：咳咳，不，听着，我不希望你这样，弟弟。你本该在律师事务所工作，正大光明地从那帮有钱的吝啬鬼手里拿走他们的钞票……你的手不应该沾上别人的鲜血。
Patient: *coughs* Listen, this isn't what I wanted. You're supposed to be working at a law firm, taking money out of the hands of rich tightwads, not pulling triggers. Not spilling blood.

病人：你、你得离开这里……我所做的一切，都只是为了你能拥有自己的生活，而不是重蹈我的覆辙……
Patient: You-you gotta get out of this dump. I dirtied my hands so that yours would be clean, so that you could live the life you wanted. I never wanted you to follow in my footsteps.

病人：其他人怎么样了，咳咳……矮子肯和小拇指杰瑞呢，这两个踏踏实实的臭小子……
Patient: How are the others doing? *coughs* Ken and Jerry? They're both honest, hardworking guys.

病人：我不应该把他们带出来做事的……
Patient: I never should've brought them into this world.

莱格斯：他们回家了，哥哥，他们回家了……
Legers: They've gone home, Legers. They've—

病人： 是吗……我早就知道，他们俩根本就不适合干这些脏活计……
Patient: Really? I knew they couldn't cut it on the street.

他的吐息更微弱了。
His breathing is fainter with each breath.

病人： 噢，瞧，我已经睡太久了，弟弟，我的脑子迷糊了……真累，我的眼皮就像该死的黏上了蜂蜜。
Patient: Ugh, I've been sleeping for too long, Salvadore. My brain isn't working. *sighs* Can't even open my eyes anymore. Feels like they're glued shut.

他试图睁大眼睛，眼皮却沉沉地半盖在眼眸上，纹丝不动。
He tries to open his eyes wider, but they remain motionless, stuck in their half-closed position.

病人： 咳、咳……我现在是在哪儿，我现在是在哪儿？你能告诉我吗？
Patient: *coughs* Where am I? Describe it to me. Tell me where I am.

头顶的灯光摇摇晃晃，照进他眯成一条缝的眼睛里。
The overhead light flickers, shining into his slit-like eyes.

病人： 噢，那是……阳光吗？
Patient: Oh, is that the sun? Am I in Italy?

他的神志越来越飘渺。
His consciousness fades into a dream-like state.

病人： 我好像……好像听到了妈妈在厨房里，她在叫你的名字，也在叫我的名字……是我们偷朗姆酒的事儿又露馅了吗？
Patient: I think I can hear Mama calling for us from the kitchen. Did she find out we stole the rum again?

床上的人笑得一喘一喘。
The patient laughs in fits, struggling to find his breath again between each exhale.

莱格斯： 哥哥，不——
Legers: Legers, no—

环状水星： 是的，那是晨曦，先生……
Mercuria: Yes. The sun is rising.

病人： 我感觉……它可真暖和。
Patient: Oh, I could feel its warmth.

环状水星： 你们……还在故乡，“莱格斯”先生。
Mercuria: You ... You're at home, isn't that right, "Legers"?

沉默着的弟弟，还是把想象中的梦接续了下去。
The reserved younger brother continues stoking their shared dream.

莱格斯： ……我们就在西西里，莱格斯……我们正一起住在你的卧室里，老爹刚把咱们都揍了一顿。
Legers: Yeah. We're in Sicily. We're in your old bedroom, remember? Dad just beat the hell out of us.

莱格斯： 他就在门口抽着烟斗，说要把我们拴在家里，让我们放弃那下半辈子多半会落个残废的营生，让我们安身立命，让我们把腿扎进西西里的土壤里。
Legers: He's smoking in the doorway right now. He said he'd tie us up to stop us from getting ourselves killed on the streets of America. Told us to settle down here, in Sicily.

莱格斯： 莱格斯，抱歉……我们没能买到船票，没能去成美国。
Legers: I'm sorry, brother. I couldn't get us tickets to the States.

莱格斯： 妈妈让我们把收拾好的行李放回去，它们太多了，把你这个四肢发达的混账都累瘫了……
Legers: Mama told us to take our stuff out of the suitcases and put it away. We packed a ton. Heh, you must be exhausted from unpacking it all.

病人：噢，我们没能去成美国吗？真遗憾，我的兄弟，咳、咳……可是，可是，那也……真好。
Patient: Oh, we didn't go to America? That's too bad. *coughs* But I'm happy to hear that.

奄奄一息的人，面容那般释然。
On the brink of death, he looks so serene.

他抓住弟弟的手，那柄手枪便握在其中。
He grasps his brother's hand, holding the pistol firmly.

病人：该死……我的眼睛已经快睁不开了，老爹那几个结实的拳头真是打到我脑门上了……我得睡一觉，我得继续睡一觉——别再吵醒我了，小子……
Patient: Damn. My eyes are totally glued. Dad really beat the crap outta me. I-I gotta go to bed. Don't wake me up, Salvadore.

病人：记得多翻翻你那堆乱七八糟的书……咱们家里得出一个靠脑子吃饭的伙计。
Patient: Remember to keep reading. We gotta have one member of the family who uses his brain for a living.

病人：明白吗？咳、咳……
Patient: Promise me. *coughs*

莱格斯：……没问题，没问题，哥哥……
Legers: I will, brother. I promise.

病人枯槁的手掌，覆在了他持枪的手上。
The withered hand of the patient covers the hand holding the gun.

病人：明天见，老弟。
Patient: See you tomorrow, bro.

那是漫长的寂静。
A long silence passes.

一直到那颗心脏，停止了最后的跳动。
Until at last his heart gives way, beating its last.

莱格斯：这一刻终于来了。我不会怪罪杰洛……
Legers: He's gone. I won't blame Gio.

莱格斯：——我理解了你们的选择。
Legers: And I see now why you all made your choice.

小窍门
A Small Tip FT-13

集市守门者 I：……我们都以为她肯定是一个老婆婆，走起路来非得人搀扶着不可的那种。
Market Guard I: We thought she was a grandma, you know, like one of those little old ladies who uses a walker.

集市守门者 I：结果呢？没想到拎起东西，比兔子走得还快！
Market Guard I: Boy was I wrong. She ran faster than a jackrabbit. So there she went, the goods still in her arms.

集市守门者 II：闭嘴吧，罗特……别再打攀上有钱人的主意了，我现在要去撒尿了……
Market Guard II: Shut up, Roth. And quit trying to get rich. I gotta take a leak.

他招招手，窜进小树林中。
He waves his hand and darts into the small grove.

漫长的时间过去。留在原地的人，生起了疑虑。
Some time passes, and the other guard left behind grows wary.

集市守门者 I： 库科，你现在是打算尿出一泡人造湖泊吗？抓紧点儿……
Market Guard I: Hey Cuco, you trying to piss up a lake or something?! Hurry up!

无人应答。
No one answers.

他警惕地探了过去，瞥见一个身体正背靠着树桩。
He cautiously peers forward, catching sight of someone leaning over a tree stump.

郊外森林
Forest, Suburbs

???: 噢……别、别过来！我的拉链被卡住了，你得等等我，这是件手艺活……
???: Shoot! Don't come over here! My zipper's stuck! Gimme a sec!

辩解的声音如此慌张，而他的朋友却丝毫没察觉声音的异样。
Despite the frantic tone of the pleading voice, the guard seems not to have detected anything.

集市守门者 I： 哈哈哈，库科，需要我给你准备几把剪子或小刀……
Market Guard I: Hahahaha, Cuco, you need scissors or something?

猫眼维森： 先驱者先生！就是现在！
Cateye Wisen: Mr. Pioneer, now!

守卫背后，身影应声而出。
Behind the guard, another figure emerges in response.

“噼啪——”
"Crack—"

木棍朝着守卫劈头而下，断成两截。
The wooden club comes crashing down on the guard's head, before splitting into two pieces.

而受害者仍安然无恙。
The would-be victim appears totally unharmed.

集市守门者 I： 什么鬼东西——?!
Market Guard I: W-What the hell?!

先驱者： 唉……我就说就地取材不是个好主意，还是得由我亲自——“动手”。
Pioneer: ... I told you it wouldn't work. It isn't "handy" at all.

他丢掉木棍，拔下了一只手臂，将它上面的手掌握成了拳头。
He discards the wooden club, removes an arm, and clenches the hand into a fist.

集市守门者 I： 嘿！有人在这里！快过来，你们这帮睁眼瞎的笨蛋！
Market Guard I: Hey! Intruders over here! Come quick, you idiots!

远处的人循着声音，蜂拥而来。
From afar footfalls rush toward them.

先驱者： ……咱们得吃一场硬仗了。
Pioneer: I have a feeling this one will be a hard nut to crack.

玛蒂尔达： 我明明瞧见了维森和先驱者他们把那群傻瓜引到了这边……他们都跑哪去了？
Matilda: I clearly saw Mr. Pioneer and Wisen draw the guards away. Where did they go?

J：别担心，我的伙计当诱饵总是一绝的，也许……他们还在埋着头，没注意到我们已经解决了一大半人了。
J: Don't worry about them. They're probably just hiding somewhere. We've already taken down most of the guards. They'll realize soon.

两位姗姗来迟的援兵，左右环顾着。
The two late reinforcements scan the area.

猫眼维森：哈、哈、呼……我在这里，头儿！帮帮我，先驱者先生他……！
Cateye Wisen: *pants* I'm here, boss! Help, Mr. Pioneer has ...!

湖边传来男孩的招呼声，那是一阵惶恐焦急的叫喊。
The boy's desperate cry echoes from the lakeside.

玛蒂尔达：那是先驱者先生的手……?!
Matilda: Is that Mr. Pioneer's arm?!

J 跪坐在了地上，不甘心地捶打着地面。
J kneels, pounding the ground in frustration.

J：抱歉……抱歉，伙计……我来得太迟了……
J: Pioneer! I'm sorry, man. I should've come earlier.

他痛心疾首，鼻涕和泪水仿若流淌不止。
J appears genuinely heartbroken at the thought he has arrived too late, fighting back messy tears.

一只手放在了他震颤的肩膀上。
A stiff hand is laid gently on his trembling shoulder.

就像哀悼会上的深切怀念，劝慰的话语来得并没有太迟。
The soothing words arrive just in time.

先驱者：J，我只说一次——别演了，快点游过去，把我的手捡回来。
Pioneer: Enough faffing around! Go get my arm! And don't make me repeat myself!

J：噢，嘿、嘿……嘿！别踹我的屁股！
J: Hey! Hey! Hey! Don't kick my butt!

“噗通——”
"Thud—"

J：啊噗……！该、该死……伙计，我可打小就是条旱鸭子，你差点把我的命搭在这里了。
J: *pants* Damn! What's wrong with you, man?! I've never swum in my entire life! You almost killed me!

先驱者：是啊，等以后街区的朋友们打探起来，我就会这么跟他们说：“你知道无人不知，无人不晓的 J 吗？他被儿童游泳池那么高的水淹死了。”
Pioneer: Well, when new boys join us in the future, I'll tell them, "You know that famous J? He was drowned in a kiddie pool."

先驱者：“愿他在天堂能有个鸭子游泳圈。”
Pioneer: "May the rubber duck be with him."

玛蒂尔达：嘘……！别吵了，你们两个笨家伙！
Matilda: Shh! Enough, you fools!

她将紧挨着的两人从中分开。
She separates the pair, who have been standing side by side.

玛蒂尔达：让开、让开……根据梅克卢女士的指引，那扇门就在你们脚底下。
Matilda: Move, get out of the way! According to Ms. Maich, the door is right where you're standing.

她蹲下来，仔细端详着空无一物的地面，伸出手，丈量着长度。
She crouches down to examine the barren soil, stretching out her hand to measure its length.

另外三个人学着她的模样，鸭子般蹲了下来。
The other three mimic her actions.

而眼前除了硬实的土壤，没有任何东西。
Yet apart from the solid earth, there is nothing in sight.

先驱者：可这里明明什么也没有，玛蒂尔达小姐……没有锁孔，没有门缝，难道这扇门在土壤底下，要我们用铁锹挖出一个洞来吗？
Pioneer: But there's nothing here, Ms. Bouanich. No keyhole, no door frame. Is it buried underground? Perhaps we need to dig it up.

玛蒂尔达：不，从始至终，根本没有一扇门是通往他们的所在的……或者也可以说，其实任何一扇门都可以通往他们的所在。
Matilda: No. Since the very beginning, there's never been a specific door that leads to their lair. In other words, any door could take us there.

玛蒂尔达：那把钥匙，只是一条通往他们所在的捷径。
Matilda: The key is a shortcut. It will take us directly to them.

商贩梅克卢：我看着他们曾领着数十位虔诚的信徒进入森林，亦曾目睹他们轮番进入帐篷之中……
Maich the Peddler: I saw them go into the woods with dozens of believers. They went inside a tent.

商贩梅克卢：为了我的朋友，我曾数次寻索他们隐匿的密道、地窖……抑或者任何隐秘的术法的痕迹。
Maich the Peddler: I was worried about my friend, so I searched for any secret tunnels or cellars that they might've used. I thought I could follow the traces left by their arcane skills.

她摇了摇头。
She shakes her head.

商贩梅克卢：却没有得到任何线索……
Maich the Peddler: But I found nothing.

商贩梅克卢：与此同时，我听说“埃尔金夫人号”底下，有一扇门被打捞了出来……那群考古学家发现，它并不衔接任何两个空间——换而言之，它是一扇没有任何用处的门。
Maich the Peddler: At the same time, I heard that a door had been salvaged from the sunken Lady Elgin. The archaeologists found that the door didn't lead anywhere—it was useless.

商贩梅克卢：它的后面，是一堵实墙——而在我短暂的考古学研究生涯中，确有见过这样“无意义”的门。
Maich the Peddler: Back on the ship, it was installed in front of a wall. I've read about these "meaningless" doors before in my brief study of archaeology.

商贩梅克卢：在墓穴里，它们大多作为装饰，用以蒙蔽那些盗墓者……
Maich the Peddler: When installed inside tombs, they serve as a decoration and a distraction against tomb raiders.

商贩梅克卢：于是我突然想到，或许答案并不在“门”上——
Maich the Peddler: So, it dawned on me that perhaps it is not the "door" that matters.

玛蒂尔达：答案，在钥匙上。
Matilda: It is the key that matters.

玛蒂尔达：门从来只是通往另一个空间的媒介——唯有钥匙能引领它，指向正确的地方。
Matilda: Doors are just a medium through which spaces are connected. It is the key that opens the way.

玛蒂尔达：因此，他们的钥匙能让任何门成为捷径，通往他们的所在。
Matilda: En conclusion, this key can make any door a shortcut to their lair.

玛蒂尔达：但灵性的两点之间，除了捷径，总会藏有另一些大路可以抵达。
Matilda: Even without a door, there is still a path we can take. There is always a direct route that connects two points on the map of Gnosis.

一行，两行——门的形状，经由手指，正在地面上初步形成。
One line, two lines—their fingers sketch the outline of the door roughly on the ground.

玛蒂尔达：只要手掌触碰过他们的钥匙，并解析他们的术法，便可以再次开启门扉——
Matilda: We can take that path by touching the key and reciting the incantation.

玛蒂尔达：不过这道门，要由我们亲自画就。
Matilda: All we need to do is draw an entrance.

J：所以……！
J: So ...

先驱者：……！
Pioneer: ...!

玛蒂尔达：哼哼～我会向圣洛夫基金会发送这个坐标，等他们赶过来的时候，就能跟我们一块进去了。
Matilda: Hmph! I will send the coordinates to the Foundation. When the reinforcements arrive, they can come with us.

玛蒂尔达：不过，我只掌握了打开门扉的术法，而永远关闭门扉的术法……依然掌握在他们的手里。
Matilda: Before we enter, you must know. I only mastered the art of opening the door. The art of closing the door, however ... Well, only the Manus know how to do that.

玛蒂尔达：你们，真的愿意身处险境，面临不可能再回来的风险吗……
Matilda: Are you all aware of the risk? We may get locked in there and never come back.

J：好了……别搞下马威了，咱们见识过的威胁可不少，难不成你要我现在再去买份人身保险吗？
J: Alright, alright, enough talk. We've come this far. Nothing's gonna scare me off.

玛蒂尔达：好吧……都过来吧，先生们！
Matilda: Fine. Over here, gentlemen!

当众人围上来，却有一个人被提溜了出去。
As the crowd gathers, one person is pulled away.

猫眼维森：头儿，头儿！你在干什么！我也能给你帮上忙，不信你问问先驱者先生！
Cateye Wisen: Boss, boss! What're you doing?! I can help, too! Just ask Mr. Pioneer!

J：不不，你比绝大部分孩子都聪明，维森……正因如此，我有更重要的任务交给你——你必须得留在这里。
J: You're smarter than most kids I know, Wisen. That's why I got an even more important job for you—to stay here.

被抛弃的孩子，不甘心地垂下了头。
The child's head nearly collapses in response. Feeling abandoned, he looks away in unwilling defeat.

J：我们会用上你的力量的，小子……但还不是现在。
J: We'll need you soon. But not now.

猫眼维森：好吧……
Cateye Wisen: Alright.

他们走到脚下的门前，面面相觑。
They stand before the door lying at their feet, checking one another for any signs of hesitation.

J: 之后见，小子！
J: See you later, kid.

有如一群跳海的船员，他们齐齐跃入那深不见底的门中。
Then all at once, they leap into the bottomless door.

众人: 啊……！
All: Whoa!

重心逆转，天空倒吊，一阵剧烈的头晕眼花的感觉冲上他们的脑门。
Their center of gravity reverses, the sky hangs upside down, and a wave of intense dizziness passes through them from head to gut.

是鼎沸的人声，是富有节奏感的踢踏声……
There is a clamor of voices, rhythmic tap dancing ...

耳边传来悉悉索索的古怪吟诵，有人的哀嚎，亦有人在恸哭……
Strange murmurs and whispers fill their ears, while others wail and sob.

玛蒂尔达: ……这、这一切是怎么回事？这完全不在我的预想之中……
Matilda: Ah, crap! Wh-what's going on?! This was not part of the plan.

J: 伙计们……
J: Guys ...

先驱者: 嘿，你们在哪？快帮我把脑袋扣回脖子上，我什么也看不见。
Pioneer: Damn it. Hey, where are we?! Please! Put my head back on. I can't see a thing!

他们拿起他的脑袋，扣回脖子，慢慢扶正。
They lift his head, set it back on his neck, and re-adjust it.

先驱者: 朋友们，冷静一些。这一切有那么……糟糕——吗?
Pioneer: Now, calm down, fellas. It can't possibly be that ... bad ...

日夜颠倒——
Night and day reverse.

数不尽的人潮涌动，将他们吞没其中。
An endless tide of bodies surges, engulfing them.

远处，身着黑袍子的人群围拢着。
In the distance, figures clad in black robes gather.

他们被这一切所惊吓，话语噎在嗓子中……
The scene is overwhelming. Words catch in their throats.

玛蒂尔达: 如果这里的所有人都是重塑之手的成员……圣洛夫基金会的紧急支援……根本不足以应对他们！
Matilda: If all these people are Manus followers, the Foundation's reinforcements will be far from sufficient!

先驱者: 我们恐怕进入了他们的密地……玛蒂尔达小姐。
Pioneer: Ah. It appears we're already in the middle of their lair, Ms. Bouanich.

一个熟悉却又陌生的声音，从他们身后传来——
Behind them, a familiar yet strange voice speaks out.

???: 呵呵……欢迎诸位莅临。
???: *chuckles* Welcome, distinguished guests.

赞颂诗
Hymns FT-14

新纪元集市·庆典日
Gathering Place, New Age Market

???: 令人遗憾……我还以为两位先生应当记得我。
???: What a pity. I thought you gentlemen would recognize me.

黑袍子之下，面孔难以辨认。
Beneath the black hoods, faces are hard to distinguish.

他们不约而同地向后退了一步，各自握紧着术杖与博伊刀。
They instinctively take a step back, gripping their weapons.

陌生的女性褪下了黑袍，露出了奢华的礼服。
The woman removes her black robe, revealing an extravagant gown.

J: 我们见过吗？……不对，抱歉，你得让我好好回想回想……
J: Have we met before? Wait, I know, gimme a sec.

他戳了戳先驱者的手肘。
He nudges Pioneer's elbow.

J: 伙计，我什么时候追过这号姑娘？该死，她要是知道我想不起来这张脸，非得把咱们生吞活剥不可。
J: Damn, when did I mess with this girl? She's gonna eat us alive if she finds out I don't remember her!

假人没有白眼，这是他生来的遗憾。
Regarding J's overconfidence in his charms, Pioneer really wants to roll his eyes, but he lacks the ability—a heartbreaking defect of a mannequin.

先驱者: 女士……抱歉，只是我们没曾想会在这里再次见到您。毕竟您瞧，我们初来乍到，这里的景象实在是吓到了我们。
Pioneer: My apologies, ma'am. We simply didn't expect to see you. We're new here, and the sight of this place took us aback.

温妮弗雷德: 再次感谢你们此前的“救济”……呵呵，你们的讶异可以谅解，你们大抵头一次来到这里。
Eternity: I see. Allow me to thank you again for your "alms." *chuckles* I can forgive your surprise. You're certainly not the first to react in such a way.

温妮弗雷德: 你们看上去不是商贩，也不是信徒……就连受邀的方式也如此与众不同……这可算是庆典罕有的嘉宾。
Eternity: You don't look like merchants or believers, and even the way you were invited is unique. You must be the special guests of the ceremony.

J: 当、当然，我们只是找错了路，所以才摔得这样狼狈不堪，哈哈哈哈……
J: Th-that's exactly who we are! We got lost. That's why we look a bit messy. Haha.

温妮弗雷德: 呵呵，多么可爱的小伙子，还有这个小姑娘……告诉我，“启明会”授予你们的邀请函在哪?
Eternity: *chuckles* What lovely young people! Now, may I see your invitation from the Order of Enlightenment?

J 的笑容凝滞了。
J's smile freezes in place.

这是否只是一句漫不经心的提问?
The question races through his head: "Is it merely a casual question or an order?"

温妮弗雷德: 瞧瞧你们的表情，呵呵，哪有什么邀请函……亲爱的，这只是一个玩笑，别那么紧绷。
Eternity: Look at you! Hah hah! There are no invitations. It was just a joke, sweethearts. Relax.

温妮弗雷德: 我对那些老掉牙的规矩没有兴趣……哪里有顾客，哪里才有生意，从谁的兜里掏钱，对我来说都一样光彩。
Eternity: I have no interest in those outdated rules. Where there are customers, there is business. Every coin I earn is as glorious as the last, no matter whose pocket it's from.

温妮弗雷德: 你们的一头雾水对我来说是一桩好生意。
Eternity: And, amidst your confusion, I smell a good deal.

温妮弗雷德: 不过，另一方面，向尊敬的主持者告知嘉宾的来访，也是我应尽的礼数……他们想必会为我的细心而给我一份丰厚的报酬。
Eternity: On the other hand, it is good manners to notify our host of the arrival of new guests. I'm sure they'll provide a satisfying reward in return.

温妮弗雷德: 这可真是一个两难的抉择，相信我，我比你们都要苦恼。
Eternity: Hmm, you've given me quite the dilemma. What to do? I wonder ...

这是一次明晰的暗示，也是一份不容忽视的威胁。
A clear hint and a threat that can't be ignored.

可惜她并未料想，世界上也有彻头彻尾的穷光蛋。
Unfortunately, whatever her toll might be, they can not afford it, or anything else at the moment.

两位小伙子面面相觑，旋即望向了唯一的救世者。
The two poor men look at each other, then turn to their only possible savior.

玛蒂尔达: 什、什么?！别看我，你们就一块利齿子儿都掏不出来吗？勤俭的玛蒂尔达可是算好了每笔钱的去处！
Matilda: Wh-what?! Don't look at me! Where's your money? There's no room in my budget for any extra expenses!

温妮弗雷德: 或者……我们可以做另一个交易。
Eternity: In that case, how about another deal?

她抛出了一根令人始料未及的橄榄枝。
She extends an unexpected olive branch.

温妮弗雷德: 先生，我可是一眼就认出了您背上的好东西，呵呵……还有您手上的老茧。
Eternity: I recognized that thing on your back the moment I saw it, young sir, and those calloused blacksmith's hands.

J: ……
J: ...

温妮弗雷德: 瞧您把它缠得紧紧的，生怕让人认出来……但那东西是藏不住的，您既然把它背了出来，又为何不让它露露脸呢……?
Eternity: Oh, look. You've wrapped it so tightly for fear of it being recognized, but that thing can't be hidden. Since you've lugged it all the way here, why not show it to me?

他不由得后撤了一步，让它隐藏于身后。
He involuntarily takes a step back, hiding the shaft behind him.

J: 你看错了……那不是什么值钱的东西。
J: No. It's totally worthless.

此时，另一边的女孩却终于下定了决心，松了口。
Matilda lets out an exasperated sigh as she makes up her mind to help.

玛蒂尔达：知道了，知道了，玛蒂尔达就大大方方地慷慨解囊一次好了。
Matilda: Fine! I'll make the payment!

温妮弗雷德：……
Eternity: ...

贵妇收下沉甸甸的贿赂，却恍然间失去了笑意。
The lady accepts the hefty bribe but, in an instant, loses her smile.

那是几不可闻的自言自语。
She murmurs faintly to herself.

温妮弗雷德：这个水晶束带……喔，瞧瞧我挣到了谁的钱，呵呵呵……贝丽尔·布翁尼女士，是您可爱的女儿。
Eternity: This crystal ribbon ... Ah, would you look at that? This is Beryl Bouanich's money. Then you, little lady, must be her daughter.

温妮弗雷德：这两位孩子……我可真算是赶上了一出好戏……
Eternity: This will be quite a show!

玛蒂尔达：嗯？你在神神叨叨地说些什么？收到了玛蒂尔达慷慨的礼物，现在该轮到你提供一些可靠的消息了。
Matilda: Huh? What are you talking about? Anyway, I showed you my sincerity. Now it's your turn.

然而贵妇却向后撤步，仿佛已无心关注眼前的琐屑。
The lady steps back, no longer interested in the trifles set before her.

J：嘿，嘿！女士，你要去哪儿？我们什么都还没问你呢？
J: Hey, hey! Where do you think you're going? We haven't asked you anything yet!

温妮弗雷德：不，亲爱的，我知道你们想知道什么……呵呵，聪明的商人永远比顾客更清楚他们所需的一切。
Eternity: No need, sweetheart. I already know what you're going to ask. *chuckles* A good merchant always knows what a customer needs.

温妮弗雷德：你们的朋友，在那儿等候已久了。
Eternity: Your friend has been waiting for a long time.

温妮弗雷德：让我给你们一个善意的忠告：别靠他们的祭坛太近。
Eternity: Oh, and here's some free advice: don't get too close to the altar.

她指向人潮涌去的方向，那是火焰与狂欢的尽头。
She points in the direction of the massing crowd, where the flames and revelry have come to an end.

晃荡的火炬照射出一群群扭曲的影子。
Flickering torches casting out distorted shadows.

在魔精的嘶鸣与人群的脚步声中，正响起低沉、起伏的吟唱……
A chant rises above the shrieking of critters and stamping feet.

J：嘿，那是……什么地方？
J: Hey, what's that?

J：……
J: ...

在摩肩擦踵的集市里，她已消失得无影无踪。
She vanishes into the crowded marketplace.

他耸耸肩。
He can only shrug.

离开谄媚的商人，他们步入庆典的深处。
Leaving behind the fawning merchants, they venture deeper into the celebration.

行至越深，周围的人群脸上所显露的喜悦便愈明显，哀嚎与痛哭并不妨碍那一张张欢喜的面容。
And the deeper they venture, the greater the joy on the crowd's faces. It is as if they were deaf to the mournful wails and cries echoing around them.

先驱者：我的天，J……那不是丧子的洛莉安娜太太吗？我们以为她早已经回故乡去了，没想到也在这儿。
Pioneer: Gosh, J. That's Madam Gloria, isn't it? I thought she went home after she lost her son. What is she doing here?

J：不……不只是她，拖车营的那帮流浪艺术家——
J: Not just her. The artists from the trailer camp are here, too.

J：离家出走，正在攒车票钱的赌徒雷诺；替人占卜，招摇撞骗的人类卡斯特……我们失踪的朋友全都在这儿……
J: And that's Reno, the gambler who ran away from home, and Caster, the human who sells fake divination. All our lost friends. They're all here.

新纪元集市的失踪者们蹲坐在墙脚下，面容消瘦，却齐齐望着篝火处，露出期许诞生的笑容。
The missing people of the New Age Market huddle by the walls. Their faces are gaunt, yet smiling into the fire.

先驱者走上前去，替丧子的老妇人披上落地的脏兮兮的毯子。
Pioneer steps forward and drapes a filthy, floor-length blanket over a grieving woman.

先驱者：您怎么在这里，夫人？
Pioneer: What are you doing here, ma'am?

洛莉安娜太太：噢，先驱者先生……好久不见，多令人欢喜的夜晚。快请坐，请坐……
Madam Gloria: Oh, Mr. Pioneer. I haven't seen you for ages. What a joyful evening this is! Please, take a seat.

宛若壁炉旁的一次邀约，她慈祥的面容未改，却已然泪流满面。
Her smile is warm and inviting, yet tears stream down her face.

襁褓中的孩子，安静、乖巧。
The baby in the swaddling blanket is strangely calm.

洛莉安娜太太：过来瞧瞧我可爱的孩子，先驱者先生……为了他在世间的日日夜夜，我无数次垂泪祷告，如今“受苦者”回应了我的虔诚，将他从死亡之河中带回来了。
Madam Gloria: Come and see my lovely child, Mr. Pioneer. I'd prayed countless times to the Sufferer, and finally my wish was granted. He has returned to me from the land of the dead.

先驱者：洛莉安娜太太……
Pioneer: But, Madam Gloria ...

先驱者：可您难道瞧不清，那只是一尊木枝编织的塑像吗？
Pioneer: This is just a wooden statue! Can't you tell?!

烟雾正在蔓延，飘入女孩的视野。
The smoke is spreading, drifting into Matilda's line of sight.

玛蒂尔达：……！
Matilda: ...!

玛蒂尔达：别再过去了……先驱者先生！你唤不醒他们，这些人早已经迷失在了自己的臆想里。
Matilda: Don't get any closer, Mr. Pioneer! There's no way to wake them up. They are lost in their own imaginations.

玛蒂尔达：瞧瞧他们的四周！祭坛那儿放置了许多让人产生幻觉的熏香。遮上口鼻，我们得快点离开这里……他们已经迷失了！如果可能，我们也只能回头再来帮他们！
Matilda: Look! There's hallucinogenic incense burning on the altar. Hold your breath! We have to get out of here—quickly. We can't help them if the hallucinations get to us too! We'll come back for them when we can!

玛蒂尔达：J，你也是，你还在干什么？我们该走了！
Matilda: J, what are you doing?! We need to go!

女孩将先驱者拉回到了大路上，而另一个男人却仍站在那里一动不动。
Matilda pulls Pioneer back onto the main road, while J remains standing there, motionless.

信徒们注意到了异样，纷纷侧目。
The believers notice the oddity and turn their heads.

信徒：你们为何侵扰他人的欢愉！
Believer: Why are you intruding on his joy?!

信徒：聒噪的家伙，你理应看见，他正享用“受苦者”的恩赐！
Believer: Can you not see that he is enjoying the grace granted by the Sufferer?

玛蒂尔达：可恶……J，J！
Matilda: Damn! J! J!!

远处，男人背影呆滞，不为所动。
In the distance, J remains frozen.

她的高喊无济于事，反而招来了更多的目光。
Her shouting proves futile, only drawing more attention to herself.

众信徒：你这个不虔诚者！别再侵扰这位信徒了！
Believers: Desecrator! Leave that faithful believer alone!

玛蒂尔达：糟糕、糟糕……！
Matilda: Damn! Damn!!

篝火愈烧愈烈。
The bonfire blazes hotter and hotter.

被击溃者的倒地声，融入后继而上的同袍们隆隆作响的脚步声里，无人听闻。
The sound of the fallen hitting the ground merges into the thunderous footsteps of their advancing comrades, all going unheard.

玛蒂尔达：嘿，J——嘿，J！你到底在发什么呆？我们得赶紧赶过去！
Matilda: J! Hey, J! What are you doing? We have to get out of here!

她拉扯他的臂膀，但 J 伫立在那，一动不动。
She tugs at his arm, but J remains frozen.

远处的人群，传来了更加清晰的吟唱。
In the distance, the chanting becomes clearer.

吟唱声：“哀恸与悲戚，无计数遮蔽的眼眸”
Chanting: Faced with sorrow, eyes shall be blinded.

吟唱声：“献上，感官与四足的虔诚”
Chanting: Open your arms and offer us your senses as proof of devotion.

J: 保利……娜?
J: Paulina?

J: 你是……保利娜吗?
J: Are you ... Paulina?

吟唱声: “掌心，覆盖于双目”
Chanting: Place your palms upon your eyes.

吟唱声: “蒙受喜悦与欢愉，融入‘受苦者’的独一”
Chanting: Feel joy and happiness. Become one with the Sufferer.

保利娜: 咳、咳……
Paulina: *coughs*

保利娜: 哥哥……你迟到太久了。
Paulina: You're too late.

吟唱声: “去往唯一而至高的归宿，唤回灵魂的本初，除此之外别无他处的——”
Chanting: Recall the origin of your soul, and return to the one and only home.

“乐园”
Elysium.

眼中之物
Don't Look at It FT-15

“剃刀”: 根据圣洛夫基金会的评估，这将是一次不亚于针对“瓦尔登湖”酒馆的行动，此次的紧急援助评级为 A 级……我希望你们能提前明白行动的风险。
"Razor": According to the Foundation's assessment, this is a priority level A operation, which means it'll be as dangerous as the Walden operation. I hope you're fully aware of the risk.

“剃刀”小队队员 I: 可受限于我们的人数与配给……队长，我们没有任何取胜的可能性。
"Razor" Soldier I: We don't have enough men or supplies, Captain. We don't stand a chance!

“剃刀”小队队员 I: 而且……我们还没有完成调查失踪物资的任务，这难道不正证明我们需要得到更多的帮助吗?
"Razor" Soldier I: They've refused to send us any support since the last mission. We can't do this without ...

“剃刀”: 不，队员们，这是上面已经制定的作战方针。
"Razor": Enough, soldiers! An order is an order.

“剃刀”: 请记住，这不是一次正面作战。鉴于此前的经验，重塑之手各级首领正在四处遁逃、藏匿……我们所需要做的，便是剿首。
"Razor": Remember, the goal is not to fight a war. The Manus leaders are scattered all over the place. Our mission is to find them and finish them.

“剃刀”: 这是我们的首要任务，圣洛夫基金会的后续支援只会在我们完成任务后出现。
"Razor": The assassination of the Manus leaders is our top priority. The backup from the Foundation will not arrive until we've completed this mission.

“剃刀”小队队员 II: 换而言之，如果失败……也就只能靠我们自己全身而退，是吗?
"Razor" Soldier II: In other words, if we fail, we're on our own, right?

犹豫几乎只有一瞬，但所有人都心照不宣。
The hesitation lasts barely a moment, but everyone tacitly understands.

“剃刀”： 这不在我们的考虑范围内。
"Razor": Let's hope it doesn't come to that.

“剃刀”： 该行动了，队员们……玛蒂尔达调查员发送的坐标位置已经离我们不远。
"Razor": Time to move, soldiers. We've almost arrived at Investigator Bouanich's coordinates.

“剃刀”： 接下来的路，我们需要步行过去。
"Razor": We're walking from here on out.

戴头盔的车手： 嘿，让开让开！小心点！别站在路中间！
Helmeted Biker: Hey! Get outta the way! Quit standing in the middle of the road!

“嗡——”摩托车从他们身旁擦肩而过。
A motorcycle zooms past them.

“剃刀”小队队员 II： 嘿，你们就不会看路吗?!
"Razor" Soldier II: Hey, are you blind or something?!

“剃刀”： 别节外生枝，陶德……该走了。
"Razor": Focus on the operation, Todd. Let's go.

……

...

洛莉安娜太太： 呵呵，如果蒙上双眼，便可以抚摸那不存在的幻影。
Madam Gloria: Heh heh, just close your eyes, and it all becomes real.

洛莉安娜太太： 如果蒙蔽感官，便可寻得日思夜想的去处，呵呵……那么这为何不能称为一种真实呢?
Madam Gloria: Close your eyes. Stop thinking. Then, you will be in paradise. Heh heh. Illusion is also part of reality, is it not?

老妇人摇着襁褓里的“孩子”，轻吻着木枝。
The old woman rocks her "child" in the swaddling blanket, softly kissing the wooden stick.

她仿若一只受伤幼鹿，喘息着。
She resembles a wounded fawn, gasping for breath.

她又成了蜷缩在被窝里的，等待着他关切的孩子。
She is once again that child huddling under the covers, waiting—hoping he would come back.

保利娜： 咳、咳……你并没有来接我，哥哥，你应当在那里等我的。
Paulina: *coughs* Why didn't you come for me? You should've come sooner.

J： 抱歉……抱歉……
J: I'm sorry. I-I'm sorry.

玛蒂尔达： 别注视幻影！它会令你迷失的，J!
Matilda: Don't let the illusion confuse you, J! You must break away!

女孩的声音已被隔绝在外。
Matilda's voice is cut off from the outside.

但他比谁都清楚，自己正处于迷失的边缘。
Yet he knows better than anyone that he is on the brink of losing himself.

J： 我明白你是一个幻影，你只不过是我脑子里的一个挥之不去的念头……但我同样清楚，我为什么想在此驻足……
J: I know you're only an illusion, a thought in my mind that I just can't shake, but even so, I wanna stay.

J： 我一直想问，我一直想问来着……我想得到一个回答——
J: There's something I've always wanted to know.

J: 告诉我，妹妹，你想过回到海特街吗?
J: Tell me, Paulina, do you wanna go back to Haight Street?

奄奄一息的女孩点了点头。
The girl nods faintly.

他走上前，伸出了手。
He steps forward and reaches out his hand.

J: 我们可以再一起呆在餐馆里，这一次那些醉汉不会再过来找我们的麻烦。
J: We'll stay in the restaurant like we used to, but there'll be no drunks looking for trouble this time.

J: 我可以骑上摩托车，带你兜遍旧金山，那些想追你的混小子们都会被我吓得屁滚尿流。
J: We can hop on my bike and go for a ride around San Francisco. Scare the heck outta any boys who try to hit on you.

J: 圣洛夫基金会要是再去邀请你，我就让他们好好吃一个闭门羹。
J: If the St. Pavlov Foundation invites you to join them again, I'll tell them to buzz off.

她同样伸出了手。
She extends her hand to him.

保利娜: 哥哥，这是当然……
Paulina: Of course.

“呲!”
"Zing!"

地上的香炉被干脆地一分为二，幻象飘散而去。
The incense burner on the ground is split in two, and the illusion dissipates.

他收起了博伊刀，摇摇头。
He sheathes the Bowie knife, shaking his head.

J: 你不是保利娜，你甚至连她的半个影子都不像。你没有骂我是一个混账，连她面对那些自顾自将她视作弱小的人时，脱口而出的嘲讽，也学不到一点。
J: You're not Paulina. Tsk. Not even close. You didn't call me a jerk. You didn't have that sarcasm of hers when people looked down on her.

J: 我当然怀念那个以我为傲的妹妹。同时，我比任何人都更清楚，当她收拾行李离开海特街的时候——
J: Of course, I miss my sister. More than anything. She was proud of me. And when she packed her bags and left Haight Street ...

J: 没有任何人比她更以自己为豪。
J: She was proud of herself.

身后的女孩缓了一口气，拍了拍他的肩膀。
Matilda, standing behind him, sighs with relief and pats his shoulder.

玛蒂尔达: 干得不错，傻大个，玛蒂尔达的小队以你为傲!
Matilda: Good job, big guy. Team Matilda is proud of you!

J: 嘿，小家伙，谁认同这个主意了？这个名字明明该叫“J 老大”小队!
J: What do you mean, Team Matilda?! We should obviously be Team J!

先驱者: ……就品味来说，你俩想出的名字不相上下。
Pioneer: Oh, please, neither one of you has good taste.

???: ……你们的嗅觉相当灵敏，先生们，但这无疑是种不幸。
???: I'll tell you one thing: you got good noses. But it'll only bring you misfortune in this game.

他从阴影中走出，持着一柄手枪。
He steps out from the shadows, holding a gun in his hand.

其他的高个子如影随形，跟在莱格斯身后，围拢了他们。
Other tall figures follow closely behind, gathering around them.

莱格斯： 晚上好，各位……尊敬的使徒和环状水星女士，正等候你们的赴宴。
Legers: Good evening, uninvited guests. The honorable Apostle and Ms. Mercuria have been expecting you.

莱格斯： 我们不能让他们等太久，你说呢?
Legers: It's best not to keep them waiting. Don't you think?

他用枪抵住 J 的胸口，身后另一位下属冲了上来。
He presses the gun against J's chest, while another lackey rushes in from behind.

杰洛： 这是还给你的，维恩，嗯？还记得我吗?
Gio: A punch for a punch, "Vern." Remember me?

拳头在 J 的肚子上结结实实来了一下，连带着搅动。
The fist swings solidly into J's stomach, stirring him as it hits.

J： 咳……!
J: *coughs*

新纪元集市·祭坛
Altar, New Age Market

使徒米修斯： 诸位，我们都曾追寻着荒谬的真理抑或欲望，是为一批批愚蠢的羔羊。
Apostle Matheus: Dear believers, we were once ignorant lambs led by false shepherds. We yearned for the so-called Truth—to satisfy our meaningless desires.

使徒米修斯： 我们所臣服的，欺骗我等；我们所希冀的，辜负我等……因此你们来到此处，因此你们皈依“受苦者”的怀抱。
Apostle Matheus: Those who we served deceived us; those who we believed in betrayed us. That is why we gather here today to embrace the grace of the Sufferer and live a new life.

使徒米修斯： 在这庆典之日，作为使徒，我剖自心肺，忏悔我曾执迷的种种。
Apostle Matheus: Before the ceremony begins, I, Apostle Matheus, sincerely express my penitence for my past beliefs.

使徒米修斯： 我来自于一座笃信“万物皆数”的小岛，那里曾是我的短暂的居所，曾是懦弱之我的容身之处。
Apostle Matheus: I came from an isle ruled by a school. The people there believed everything could be interpreted through numbers. Like a coward, I followed this method of thinking and held the same false beliefs within my heart.

使徒米修斯： 我们自以为远离尘世，自以为可以在洞穴之中，将所有人隔绝于外。
Apostle Matheus: We lived in a cave, thinking that we were well hidden from the outside world. We thought no one could reach us.

他在篝火周围徘徊，信徒们悉数跪拜在地。
He paces around the bonfire as all the worshipers kneel on the ground.

使徒米修斯： 但当岛外之民屠戮我的同袍，却未见我所信仰的唯一，予我们拯救。
Apostle Matheus: But then, the outsiders arrived. They massacred us, yet our beliefs availed us nothing!

使徒米修斯：我目睹死亡肆虐，目睹岛外的人无情地投下炸药，将我昔日的同袍轰炸成泥巴里的一块块肉碎。
Apostle Matheus: Bombs were detonated, and my friends were blown to pieces. The entire isle was shrouded in the darkness of death.

他手执利剑，划过手心，留下一道深黑的血沟。
Holding a sharp sword, he makes a fierce black cut across his palm, leaving a deep scar.

接着抓住 J 的头发，用血指在他的脖颈上留下一道人为的血迹。
Next, he grabs J by the hair, drawing a line with his blood-smeared fingers along his neck.

J：呃……！
J: Urgh!

使徒米修斯：今非昔比……我找到了真正永恒的居所，“受苦者”给予了我们力量、荣耀……将我们这些子嗣汇聚在一起，而不再受人欺侮。
Apostle Matheus: But that will never happen again. We have found the eternal paradise. The Sufferer has granted THEIR glory to us all. As THEIR children, our strength shall be gathered, and we will no longer face injustice.

使徒米修斯：一个个同袍加入我们，令我们愈发圆满，离“受苦者”的再临，也愈近。
Apostle Matheus: Many, many fellow believers have joined us. We are whole. We are one step closer to reviving the Sufferer.

在他的身侧，被捆绑住的女孩瞪大了眼睛。
Beside him, the bound girl stares wide-eyed.

玛蒂尔达：那些是……！我、我从来没有亲眼见过……那么多的……面具。
Matilda: These are all ... Oh dear! I've never seen so many Manus masks in one place!

使徒拾起地上的面具，无数人与之相随。
The Apostle picks up a mask from the ground, surrounded by countless others.

使徒米修斯：兄弟姊妹们，请拾起“受苦者”予你们的恩赐，与我吟诵——！
Apostle Matheus: Brothers! Sisters! Don your masks! Join in the grace granted by the Sufferer, and repeat after me!

使徒米修斯：如此欢喜！如此赞美！
Apostle Matheus: We praise, we rejoice.

玛蒂尔达：可恶，别那么做——！这些面具会毁了你们！
Matilda: No! Don't put them on! They will destroy you!

玛蒂尔达：你们只是被眼前的迷雾利诱了，它们并不是真实的，那些都是一时的幻觉……
Matilda: The illusions! They're blinding you! They're not real!

一个个过往，基于血与泪的数据报告浮现于眼前。
The reports, acquired at the cost of countless sacrifices, scroll through her mind:

“重塑之手的面具会以失去神志为代价，
帮助佩戴者们度过‘暴雨’。”
"The mask of Manus Vindictae helps its bearers endure the 'storm' at the cost of losing their sanity."

一张张在面具咒语实验中备受诅咒与折磨的同僚的面容，在脑海中晃过。
Faces of colleagues tortured and cursed in the mask's incantation experiments flash through her mind.

“这是残酷而必要的牺牲，
为了人类与神秘学家的福祉。”
"A cruel but necessary sacrifice for the benefit of mankind and arcanists."

玛蒂尔达：停下来，你们……会后悔的！
Matilda: Stop! Don't do it!

她的呐喊贯穿了寂静，却钻不入他们的耳中。
Her cries pierce the silence but do not reach their ears.

他们面无表情。
They remain expressionless.

一块石子落下。
A pebble falls.

旋即，洪流倾泻。
With it, a torrent pours down.

使徒米修斯：如此欢喜！如此赞美！
Apostle Matheus: We praise, we rejoice.

众信徒：如此欢喜！如此赞美！
Believers: We praise, we rejoice.

使徒米修斯：我们惩戒，我们净化，我们唤醒——我们本为一体。
Apostle Matheus: We punish, we cleanse, we awaken—we are one.

众信徒：我们惩戒。
Believers: We punish.

众信徒：我们净化。
Believers: We cleanse.

众信徒：我们唤醒。
Believers: We awaken.

环状水星：我们唤醒。
Mercuria: We awaken.

众信徒：我们本为一体。
Believers: We are one.

环状水星：我们本为一体。
Mercuria: We are one.

走吧，羔羊
Come with Me, Lost Lambs FT-16

一向以行动如手术刀般精准著称的小队，停滞在了原地。
The "Razor" Squad, always sharp as a scalpel, comes to an immediate halt.

这与他们得到的情报并不相符。
This doesn't match their mission intelligence.

“剃刀”：……我们与玛蒂尔达调查员失去了联系，现请求二次核实，确定坐标是否准确——
"Razor": We've lost contact with Investigator Bouanich. Please reconfirm the coordinates.

联络器响应片刻。旋即，屏幕上出现了回答。
The contact device responds as an answer flashes on the screen.

“玛蒂尔达调查员最终的定位坐标，核实中——核实无误，请依照计划行事。”
"Confirming Investigator Bouanich's final coordinates. Coordinates confirmed. Please proceed with the operation."

“剃刀”小队队员 I： 可是……队长，他们全都只是普通的神秘学家和人类！
"Razor" Soldier I: But, Captain, they're just normal arcanists and humans!

观光客、兜售纪念品的商贩……眼前的一切与昔日并无异样。
Tourists, vendors, everything in front of them is unchanged.

人群潮来涌去，熙熙攘攘。
The crowds bustle noisily.

“剃刀”： 根据玛蒂尔达调查员最后的讯息……她已经在坐标位置的所在地，为我们留下了一道通往庆典的门扇……
"Razor": Investigator Bouanich said that she left a door at the coordinates that will take us to the ceremony site.

“剃刀”： 不过……
"Razor": But ...

脚下的泥土，已经被游客的脚步所踩踏得空空如也。
The soil beneath their feet is trampled and bare.

“剃刀”小队队员 II： 按照计划，她理应在这里接应我们！
"Razor" Soldier II: According to the plan, she was supposed to meet us here!

“剃刀”蹲下来，观察着地面。
The captain crouches down to examine the soil.

一些新鲜的印迹覆盖于足印之上，格外明晰。
There are some fresh markings lightly obscured by footprints.

角落的商贩： ……
Peddler in the Corner: ...

三人被紧紧捆绑着，跪倒在地。
Matilda, Pioneer, and J are tightly bound and kneeling on the ground.

戴上面具的人群，陷入了死寂。
The masked crowd has fallen into a dead silence.

使徒米修斯： 莱格斯，交由你来招待这些不请自来的访客。
Apostle Matheus: I will leave these uninvited guests to you, Legers.

J： 老头子……呵呵，我以为你还会在乎点脸面，没想到你也是一条替人舔鞋底的家犬。
J: Heh, what a hypocrite. Look who's the domesticated dog now, huh? You enjoy licking the boots of your owner?

莱格斯： 你说到了我心坎上，孩子。
Legers: You got me, kiddo.

J 的小腹吃到一次重重的踢击，那是一股胃部翻搅的疼痛。
J feels a sharp, gut-wrenching pain as Legers delivers him a heavy blow.

J： 呃……
J: Urgh!

莱格斯： 你忘了吗？我们咬上的……是同一块骨头。
Legers: We're both eyeing the same prey, remember?

“砰——”
"Bang—"

枪声在胸膛绽开了。
A gunshot rings out, and blood seeps out from J's chest.

J: ……!

J: ...!

他的眼神失去聚焦，身体直直倒了下去。
His eyes go wide and unfocused as he collapses.

……

...

玛蒂尔达: J!

Matilda: J!

使徒抬起手，示意莱格斯放下手枪。
The Apostle raises his hand, signaling for Legers to lower his gun.

使徒米修斯: 好了，先生们……别污染了伟大的供奉地。把这几位亵渎者留作你们的余兴节目……

Apostle Matheus: Do not sully the sacred altar! Save your fighting. You may deal with these blasphemers after the ceremony.

使徒米修斯: 我们即将关上“乐园”的门扉，还要将这里永恒地留给我们的子嗣。

Apostle Matheus: We are about to close the door to Elysium forever, and this place will become the exclusive abode of the children of the Sufferer.

使徒米修斯: 接下来，请诸位尽享恩赐吧……

Apostle Matheus: Now, let us enjoy THEIR grace.

他举起金色的钥匙，面向祭坛。
He raises the golden key up toward the altar.

使徒米修斯: 我们恳请。

Apostle Matheus: We plead ...

使徒米修斯: 喜悦不再流散。

Apostle Matheus: Let not our joy dissipate;

使徒米修斯: 痛苦与悲恸消弭。

Apostle Matheus: Let our pain and sorrow fade;

使徒米修斯: 应许我们的灵魂——

Apostle Matheus: Let our souls ...

“叮。”
"Clink—"

手掌传来一阵刺痛。
A sharp pain shoots through his palm.

钥匙落入空中，坠进黑压压的人群。
The key falls from his hand and plunges into the dense crowd below.

使徒米修斯: 什么，尸体……怎么会?!

Apostle Matheus: What?! The body ... What happened?!

猫眼维森: 头儿，我抓住它了!

Cateye Wisen: Got it, boss!

J: 谢谢你也让我当了一回“死人”，莱格斯……

J: Thanks for making me one of "the dead" for a while, Legers.

J：抱歉，玛蒂尔达……我对你扯了个谎。
J: Sorry, Matilda. I lied to you.

J：我说过：“只有最闪烁的火遇上水，才能造就最好的钢。”
J: I said you have to be brave and decisive.

J：但我显然忘了说——时机甚过于炉膛的火焰，万全的准备尽在脑子里，而不在手头上。
J: But the truth is, being prepared is even more important.

使徒米修斯：该死，你们一直盯着这把钥匙！
Apostle Matheus: Damn it! The key was your target from the very beginning!

贝克特：滚开、滚开！你们这帮狗**！
Becket: Get lost, dickwads!

J：老家伙，现在你已经被割去了翅膀，双脚着地了。
J: You've been declawed, grandpa.

J：轮到我们这群“过街老鼠”，把你的羽毛拔下来了。
J: Now it's our turn. These "street rats" are gonna tear you apart.

J：维森，干得不错。
J: Good job, Wisen.

赶来的摩托车，后座上的男孩挥舞着手中的钥匙。
Wisen waves the key from the back of Becket's arriving motorcycle.

落了单的鸟儿，将同伴悉数唤了回来。
He has gathered together J's friends and allies just in time.

猫眼维森：那当然了，头儿！为了跟贝克特这个笨蛋说清楚这回事儿，可把我口水都说干了。
Cateye Wisen: Thanks, boss! Took hours to get the plan through Becket's thick skull, but we nailed it!

J：藏好钥匙，小子。唐吉老爹讲过一句东方的老话叫作——“温肿捉瘪”！
J: Put the key away. Mr. Tang once told me an old Eastern proverb, "shoot fish in a barrel."

此起彼伏的嗡鸣声，掩盖了所有火炬的噼啪作响。
The rising and falling hum of motors drowns out the crackling torches.

数十辆摩托车飞驰而来，在薄雾中穿梭。
Dozens of motorcycles speed toward them, weaving through the mist.

晃眼的车灯，犹如一座座独立的灯塔，照亮了黑压压的集市。
Their headlights beam through the darkened marketplace, like a row of spotlights.

使徒米修斯：不可能，这些人是从哪里进来的?!
Apostle Matheus: Impossible! How did they get here?!

他指向了最诚挚的信徒。
He turns his hand to his most devoted believer.

使徒米修斯：你何时与这些亵渎者掺和在了一起！
Apostle Matheus: You! How long have you been working with these blasphemers?!

使徒米修斯：“莱格斯”不会再被允许继续活下去了！
Apostle Matheus: Hah! Say goodbye to your precious "Legers"!

远处矗立的领导者摇了摇头，从枪膛退出空包弹。
Their leader stands in the distance, shaking his head as he ejects a blank cartridge from his gun.

莱格斯：……你或许不知道你在说什么。
Legers: You're a little behind on the news, aren't you?

莱格斯：现在的莱格斯……就只有我一个人了，使徒大人。
Legers: I am the only "Legers" now, Apostle.

他的目光如炬。
His stare is intense.

玛蒂尔达：天啊，你们这场戏排了多久?！为什么没有人告诉我！
Matilda: What?! When did you plan all this?! No one told me a thing!

先驱者：喔……冷静点，玛蒂尔达小姐，我们只是为了让您的演出能更真实一些，再加上时间紧迫……
Pioneer: Calm down, Ms. Bouanich. Time was against us, and we thought that your authentic reaction would be more convincing.

先驱者：杰洛先生已经事先与 J 达成了共识。
Pioneer: Gio reached an agreement with J before we left.

J：不过我得说，那一拳多少带点私人恩怨……杰洛，你差点儿把我的胃液都揍出来了。
J: That punch felt pretty personal, though. You almost beat the crap out of me, Gio.

杰洛：我正有此意……老朋友。
Gio: Hah! I couldn't help myself.

J 旁边的摩托车手摘下了头盔。
The rider next to J removes his helmet.

霍利克：J……你、你要我去揍他一顿吗?
Hollick: J, y-you want me to beat him up?

J：当然不行，霍利克！他现在可是咱们尊敬的盟友，我们得保护朋友，不是吗?
J: No, Hollick! He's an ally now. We gotta look out for our friends, right?

另一位摩托车手，朝地上啐了一口唾沫。
Becket spits on the ground, seemingly only half-convinced.

贝克特：是啊，朋友，朋友，呵！
Becket: Yeah, we're friends. Hah!

贝克特：这帮狗*养的要是不能把修车铺的钱打点好，我一样把他们揍出*来。
Becket: Still, if these sons of b*****s don't pay up to fix the garage, I'll beat the s**t out of them!

这场喜悦的对话显然脱离了使徒的期待。他面不改色，愤怒且厌弃地扬起了手。
Their unexpectedly cordial exchange is yet another disruption in his plans. Yet the Apostle seems unfazed as he raises his hand with menace.

使徒米修斯：罢了……我早已为你们这些亵渎者，准备了另一份欢喜。
Apostle Matheus: So be it. I have already prepared a surprise for you blasphemers.

使徒米修斯：莱格斯，我已竭尽了对你的怜悯——没想到你的忠诚如此不值一提。
Apostle Matheus: Legers, I have exhausted my pity for you. It appears your loyalty is even more worthless than I expected.

使徒米修斯：这次，我们至高的门扉将永远关闭，不会再为你们这些“老鼠”留下缝隙了。
Apostle Matheus: Very well. The door to Elysium shall be shut tight. There will be no cracks for you rats to crawl through.

使徒米修斯：经我所钦定的信徒们，显露你们的忠诚！
Apostle Matheus: Chosen believers, prove your loyalty!

数不清的早已皈依的信徒，褪下了黑袍。
His most devout believers cast off their black robes.

重塑·信徒 Ⅰ： ㄟˋ——！
Manus Believer I: *roars*

重塑·信徒 Ⅱ： ㄞˋ——！
Manus Believer II: *roars*

先驱者： J，这可不在我们的计划范围之内……！
Pioneer: This wasn't part of the plan, J!

刚刚铸造的博伊刀，从剑鞘中缓缓拔出——
His newly-forged Bowie knife is drawn from its sheath.

锋芒映入他的眼眸。
The blade's edge gleams in his eyes.

J： 那就让它变成我们计划的一部分。
J: Then make it part of the plan!

倒下的信徒堆叠，躺卧在四周。
Fallen believers have piled up around him.

而另一边的人，也已筋疲力竭。
But many more remain standing.

J： 哈……哈……你们可为这把刀，“开”了一次最新鲜的刃。
J: *pants* Heh. It was about time this knife tasted blood.

然而，尚在矗立的信徒犹如一片枯木林，仍不可估量。
Yet, like a forest of dead trees, these devout believers remain a foreboding threat.

不存悬念——如若剩余的信徒扑面而来，将似一股洪水倾涌，将他们吞没。
And there is no question—if they were to all rush forward, their remaining numbers would still overwhelm them.

使徒米修斯： 我业已为至高的“受苦者”牵引了迷途之人，祂已见证我的忠诚与献身。
Apostle Matheus: I have guided the lost for the sake of the Sufferer. THEY have witnessed my loyalty and devotion.

他的步伐摇晃，但并不慌乱。
The Apostle feigns composure, but his steps are wavering and fearful.

使徒米修斯： 这、这副躯体无足轻重！
Apostle Matheus: This body, this life, is nothing, compared to THEIR great cause!

使徒米修斯： 但这帮亵渎者必须为他们的所作所为付出鲜血的代价。
Apostle Matheus: But we must make the blasphemers pay with their blood!

使徒米修斯： 与“受苦者”融为一体的子嗣们，唤醒你们的躯体，割下他们的头颅！
Apostle Matheus: Children of the Sufferer, awaken your bodies and rip their heads from their necks!

一个身影从他背后，轻悄悄地踏出了步伐。
A figure emerges from behind him, moving with deliberate steps.

其后，一个又一个身影从黑压压的群体中涌出，走向了 J。
Soon, one after another, more figures emerge from the shadowy crowd, all heading toward J.

使徒米修斯： 你们将死无葬身之地，你们的骸骨将被制为最低贱的竖椅，永世向我们的至高者跪拜！
Apostle Matheus: You will die a miserable death! You will get no burial! No, your bones will be made to forever kneel to the supreme one!

然而，那些面具下的身影，却通通绕过了 J 与他的朋友。
However, the masked figures never make their attack.

走向了森林。
They walk toward the forest.

使徒米修斯：信徒们，你们要往哪去!!!
Apostle Matheus: My dear believers, where are you going?!

使徒米修斯：那是……我们的祭司?
Apostle Matheus: Is that ... our Priestess?!

J：老家伙，你以为我们的戏演到一半就结束了吗?
J: You thought we were finished, grandpa?

莱格斯：咳咳……忘了告诉你，那箱子面具遍布了蛛网，灰尘呛得我的孩子怨声载道……
Legers: Oh, did I forget to mention? The masks you gave me were old and dusty. I couldn't give them to my kids.

莱格斯：所以我仁慈地为你定制了另一批“一模一样”的仿品，提供给你的信徒……
Legers: So I got a new set of masks made, ones that you have no control over. You're welcome.

远处的祭司褪下黑袍，朝着他们微微颔首。
In the distance, the "Priestess" removes the black robe and gives them a purposeful nod.

环状水星：“那幽林至深之处，鞭笞与轻唤所不能触及之地”
Mercuria: In the depths of the woods, where whips and voices cannot reach.

环状水星：“何人呼唤?”
Mercuria: Who is calling?

声音牵引着人影，踏入迷雾。
The voice beckons the figures into the mist.

环状水星：“歌喉的蛊惑，万千不如鸟鸣”
Mercuria: Not even the most bewitching voice can drown out the songs of the birds.

环状水星：“作舞作乐的人儿”
Mercuria: Those who dance ...

环状水星：“失明羔羊的蹄印”
Mercuria: Those who are blinded ...

环状水星：“请轻嗅，苜蓿草”
Mercuria: Breathe in the fragrance of the medick ...

环状水星：“与我随行”
Mercuria: And come with me.

在飘渺的薄雾之中。
They find themselves within the drifting, elusive fog.

离别赠礼
Parting Gift FT-17

使徒的四肢仿佛已失去了所有气力。
The Apostle's limbs fall, having lost all strength.

他佝偻着身体，躲藏在混乱之外。
He hunches over, crumpling as if to hide from the chaos.

灯光逐渐逼近，唯有他头顶的一束火炬仍摇曳着，拉长他的影子。
The lights draw closer, leaving only a single torch above his head. It casts a long shadow.

使徒米修斯：……功亏一篑。我不该轻信他人。
Apostle Matheus: Everything, everything is ruined! I never should have trusted any of you!

???: 谢谢您让我有幸见证了一场宏伟的坍塌，我喜欢这场美妙的晚间剧……夹杂着您的自大、悔恨，和随着付出的所有一切陨落而黯淡的好表情。
???: Thanks for the show. Your failure was magnificent. Your arrogance, your regret, and that look on your face when everything was ruined. They were all just perfect.

使徒米修斯：该死、该死！你到哪里去了，温妮弗雷德？你骗取了我们虔诚的信徒所聚拢的一切财富，榨干了他们的每一滴血汗！
Apostle Matheus: Damn it! Where have you been, Eternity?! You've defrauded us! Taken every Sharpodonty! Squeezed us of every drop of sweat and blood!

使徒米修斯：你信誓旦旦地对我们承诺，保证庆典的进行，为“秘之教诲者”——我们伟大的“受苦者”——献上崇高的敬意！
Apostle Matheus: You swore the ceremony would go smoothly and that you'd pay your highest respects to the Inculcator of Arcanum, the great Sufferer!

使徒米修斯：灵魂生疮的商人，恬不知耻的违约者！就算这里没有戈尔贡洋流让你受到永世的煎熬，我也要把你的头颅砸碎，令你承受这份苦痛的代价！
Apostle Matheus: You rotten, shameless liar! If I could only throw you into the depths of the Gorgon Current! I will crack your skull and make you bear the price of my pain!

他站起来，从地上抓取一块坚硬的石块。
He stands grabbing a rock as a makeshift weapon.

温妮弗雷德：呵呵，我都忘了您还有少许的地中海血统，使徒大人……没想到一个在信仰之间逃窜的胆小鬼也有这样威胁我的勇气。
Eternity: *chuckles* I've almost forgotten about your Mediterranean roots. I must say, I didn't expect such courage from a coward who fled a battlefield.

“叮！”石块转眼间支离破碎。
"Clink!" The rock shatters into pieces.

弱不禁风的贵妇，持起一柄小巧的术杖，顶在使徒的下颚上。
The fragile noblewoman raises her small, delicate wand, pressing it against the Apostle's chin.

温妮弗雷德：嘘，嘘！你们那些可怜的财富，还不足以撑起这场生意……没人会想跟整个圣洛夫基金会作对，我们的承诺里，从来不包含这一项荒谬的条款。
Eternity: Psh! Your pitiful Sharpodonties are far from sufficient payment. No one would be stupid enough to go against the Foundation for so little profit. Besides, this was never part of the deal.

温妮弗雷德：而且，贝丽尔·布翁尼的女儿，也搅进了你们的闹剧里……还有那个男孩身后的那把东西……
Eternity: Do you have any idea who you're dealing with? That's Beryl Bouanich's daughter, and the weapon that boy carries ...

冲动的使徒颤颤巍巍，意识到了局势。
The last of his courage has left him as he pleads.

使徒米修斯：但事已至此，如、如果你不帮我逃出去，我绝不会将另一半的财富交予你！
Apostle Matheus: But listen! If you don't help me escape, I'll never pay you the other half.

她耐人寻味地垂下了手，摇了摇头。
She allows her hand to drop contemplatively and shakes her head.

温妮弗雷德：圣洛夫基金会的人是一群吝啬鬼，这没错……但即便如此，也足够高过你那点报酬了。
Eternity: It's true that the people at the Foundation are all misers; they're still more generous than you.

使徒米修斯：我、我还有从信徒手里收集来的珍稀的术杖、炼金材料……珠、珠宝！
Apostle Matheus: I-I can give you anything! Rare wands, alchemic materials, and jewelry! Lots and lots of jewelry! I got them from the believers!

他把手伸进口袋中，恐惧使他的手腕抖动。
His panicking hands tremor as he reaches into his pocket.

“叮、叮——”一大堆珠光闪烁的戒指、吊坠、臂环掉落在地。
"Clink, clink—" A pile of glittering rings, pendants, and bangles falls to the ground at his feet.

使徒米修斯：我、我还有，我还有更多！它们放在我的地窖，放在一个无人知晓的地方！只有我才有钥匙！
Apostle Matheus: Th-there's more! I-I keep them in a cellar that only I have the key to!

温妮弗雷德：……你是位不诚实的合作者，使徒大人……
Eternity: You're a dishonest customer, Apostle.

温妮弗雷德：好在，你的口袋并不空空。
Eternity: You're lucky that your pockets aren't empty.

她将术杖收缩，放回了口袋。
She retracts her wand and places it back into her pocket.

温妮弗雷德：把东西捡起来，我们——
Eternity: Pack your stuff. Let's—

玛蒂尔达：烁烁其光！
Matilda: Micare Might!

一道闪烁的光芒阻拦了去路。
A flickering light blocks the way.

温妮弗雷德：噢，小淑女……我们又见面了～
Eternity: Hey there, little lady. Nice to see you again.

玛蒂尔达：温妮弗雷德，原来你也是重塑之手的一员……！
Matilda: Eternity! You're a Manus follower, too?

温妮弗雷德：别误会，我们只是有一桩生意还没完成……只要谁愿意给足报酬，我乐意跟任何人合作。
Eternity: I have no interest in the Manus. I just have some business to finish. You know I'll work with anyone if the deal is sweet enough.

温妮弗雷德：而且，谁叫我又是位守信的商人呢？我的承诺无价，您作为淑女，应当理解我～
Eternity: I'm a businesswoman. I always keep my word. I'm sure you understand that.

玛蒂尔达：唔……你说的是没错，但是，但是作为公正无私的调查员，我可不能顾及你的生意！
Matilda: Ugh. You're right, but that incriminates you nonetheless! I cannot let you escape!

玛蒂尔达：我会把你们都带回去，圣洛夫基金会会证明你的话是否属实！
Matilda: I will have to take the two of you to the Foundation! You can plead your case there.

玛蒂尔达：咳、咳、咳……迷障泡泡球?！不，它不可能有这么刺鼻的味道，我的眼泪都要被呛出来了，咳咳咳。
Matilda: *coughs* Was that a Misty Bubble Ball?! No, the smell is stronger. I can't even open my eyes! *coughs*

玛蒂尔达：这是基金会后勤部门才会配给的特制用具……！她怎么连这件东西也有?
Matilda: This probably came from the Foundation's logistics department! How did she get it?!

粉色迷雾散去，被呛倒在地的女孩，好不容易才睁开了眼。
The pink mist dissipates. Matilda manages to reopen her eyes.

玛蒂尔达：这是？
Matilda: What's this?

她翻过名片的背面，上面赫然写着——
She turns over the business card, which reads:

“尊敬的玛蒂尔达·布翁尼小淑女——”
"Dear Miss Matilda Bouanich—"

“替我向您的母亲致以最亲切的问候。”
"Please extend my warmest regards to your mother."

“注：善意的提醒，您的水晶球有几道隐微的裂隙。”
"Note: Your crystal ball has a few cracks."

“——您最亲切的温妮弗雷德。”
"—Yours sincerely, Eternity."

玛蒂尔达：……可是，她怎么会认识妈妈……
Matilda: I'm confused. How does she know Mama?

……

...

使徒米修斯：哈、哈……我发誓，它们全都放在这里了！
Apostle Matheus: *pants* Everything's here. I swear!

他推开泥土，露出木质的地窖门。
He sweeps aside the dirt, revealing a wooden cellar door.

使徒米修斯：你得保证让我安全离开！如果你说话算话，我会于传道者面前赞许你的信用，我们还有更多的生意可以洽谈！
Apostle Matheus: You have to make sure I get out of here safely! If you keep your word, I'll tell the Preacher about you, and we can do more business together!

她拉开地窖门，金灿的辉光映入眼眸。
She opens the door, and a golden glow rises up to her eyes.

在里头，还有一位抡着重锤的信徒正尽忠职守。
Inside, a believer wielding a heavy hammer remains diligently at work.

使徒米修斯：出来，信徒！我们的计划已有了改变，跟上我的步伐……温妮弗雷德女士会带我们离开这里！
Apostle Matheus: Come out, believer! There's been a change of plan. Follow me. Eternity will get us out of here!

驻守的信徒：ㄋㄟˋ——？
Cellar Guardian: ...?

他笨拙地爬了出来。
He climbs out from the cellar clumsily.

温妮弗雷德：如此轻易地搜集了这些奇珍异宝，显然，虔诚是门更赚钱的生意……
Eternity: What a huge collection of valuables! And people just handed them over to you! Looks like religion is a profitable business.

她合上地窖门，收下了钥匙。
She closes the door, pocketing the key.

使徒米修斯：接、接下来，该轮到你护送我离开这里了！
Apostle Matheus: A-alright! Now escort me out of here!

温妮弗雷德：我从没有答应过您这件事，使徒大人……您可曾从我口中，听过任何一句关于护送您离开的话?
Eternity: I never promised any "escort," Apostle. Did you ever hear me utter such a word?

温妮弗雷德：不过——
Eternity: But ...

她的脸上再次换回了笑意。
She smiles.

温妮弗雷德：我确实说过让您安全地离开这里。
Eternity: I did say I'd get you out of here safely.

她将手伸入小巧的手袋中，紧实的袋口令她的手活动不利。
She reaches into her handbag, slipping her hand fully into its narrow opening.

整只手臂，也随之伸了进去，手袋空间的大小超乎其视觉外形。
Followed by most of her arm, which the tiny bag seems to accommodate without even a stretch.

温妮弗雷德：嗯……让我找找，我记得，那件烫手的小东西——在这里～
Eternity: Hmm. Let me see. If memory serves, that tricky little thing is—Ah, here it is!

温妮弗雷德：接着～这可是从圣洛夫基金会里出来的稀罕物……
Eternity: There you go. It's from the St. Pavlov Foundation. One of a kind.

温妮弗雷德：直到秩序乱套之前，这个小东西都一直被封藏在他们的总部……没有任何人能触碰到它。
Eternity: This gadget was stored in their headquarters. No one could lay a finger on it.

温妮弗雷德：他们为了它殚精竭虑，可惜最后在混乱中让这个宝贝流到了指望赚点儿甜头的小职员手里。
Eternity: But when chaos broke out, it fell into the hands of an employee looking to make a profit.

接过东西的男人，却倍感耻辱。
The Apostle eyes the clockwork toy with a pang of shame and confusion.

使徒米修斯：……这是什么东西？一个发条玩具?！它能有什么作用？温妮弗雷德，你把我当成了一个彻头彻尾的蠢蛋?
Apostle Matheus: What's this? Some kind of wind-up toy?! How's this going to help me?! Do I look like a complete idiot to you?!

她突然忍俊不禁。
She bursts into a fit of laughter.

温妮弗雷德：呵呵……当然没有，我的好顾客。
Eternity: *chuckles* Of course not, my dear customer.

温妮弗雷德：转动它身上的发条，这就是使用说明……先生。
Eternity: Just wind it when you need to use it. That's all, Apostle.

男人半信半疑。
He is evidently suspicious.

使徒米修斯：它会让我变成一只丑陋的三头恶犬，还是一个神志不清的大脚怪物?
Apostle Matheus: What's it going to do—turn me into some kind of beast? A three-headed dog, or a crazed Bigfoot?

温妮弗雷德：哈哈，瞧瞧您在说什么，我哪会那样祸害我的顾客？我保证，保证您不会变成一个怪物。我还指望从你们手里生钱呢……
Eternity: Haha, listen to yourself. Why would I do that to a customer? You won't turn into a monster, I promise. There's still plenty of business to be done between the two of us.

一阵晃眼的车灯照射而来，
Headlights beam forward in the distance.

温妮弗雷德：那么，言尽于此，再见了，先生。
Eternity: Alright, time to say goodbye.

她退后着，最终与森林的黑暗融为一体。
She steps back slowly, merging with the darkness of the forest.

温妮弗雷德：合作愉快。
Eternity: It's been a pleasure working with you.

使徒米修斯：等等……！等等！
Apostle Matheus: W-wait! Wait!!

灯光正离自己越来越近，他没有选择。
The headlights come closer and closer, leaving him no other option.

使徒米修斯：伟大的“秘之教诲者”……请庇佑我安然归于您的膝下……
Apostle Matheus: Great Inculcator of Arcanum, please bless this child on his knees before you.

使徒米修斯：我愿为您耗竭最后一滴鲜血，直至您的复生——
Apostle Matheus: I am willing to sacrifice every drop of blood in my body so that you may be revived.

旋即，他毫不犹豫地回过头。
He turns around without hesitation.

使徒米修斯：我们最虔诚的信徒……这个，就交给你来开启！
Apostle Matheus: You, most devout believer! Wind this.

他把发条玩具塞到大个子的手里。
He shoves the clockwork toy into the believer's hand.

驻守的信徒：嗯——？
Cellar Guardian: Hmm?

使徒米修斯：转动它——懂吗？转——
Apostle Matheus: Turn it. Understand? Wind the—

他把信徒的手覆上发条，手把手地带动着。
He guides him to wind the toy, hand over hand.

很快，愣头愣脑的信徒就掌握了诀窍——
The befuddled believer grasps the technique at last, but none too soon—

使徒米修斯：听着，我得跟上去，我得抓住那个女人……不能让她把“秘之教诲者”的财富带走……
Apostle Matheus: Listen, I have to catch that woman. Those treasures belong to the great Inculcator of Arcanum. I must not let her take them away.

使徒米修斯：你得帮我留下这帮人——！
Apostle Matheus: You stay here and take care of those gangsters!

驻守的信徒：ㄌㄟˋ——！
Cellar Guardian: *roars*

使徒米修斯：很好，很好……
Apostle Matheus: Very well.

他转身，同样消失在树林之中。
He turns, disappearing into the forest.

“吱、吱——”一圈，两圈……
"Creeeak, creak—" one turn, two turns ...

信徒的手循着惯性，越来越快。
The believer's hand, driven by inertia, moves faster and faster.

“吱、吱吱吱吱——”
"Creeeak, creeeak, creeeak, creeeak—"

驻守的信徒：　ㄟˊ——?！痛……手……
Cellar Guardian: *roars* ...?! Hand ... hurts ...

驻守的信徒：　停……停，　ㄟˊ——?！
Cellar Guardian: Stop ... Stop ... *roars*?!

他转动发条的手，已紧紧黏附在了玩具上……手腕连带着手臂，正在以非人的姿势扭曲。
His hand grips the toy unwillingly as his wrist and arm contort into an inhuman position.

“吱、吱吱——”
"Creeeak, creeeak—"

手臂如同旋拧的湿手帕，很快被扭曲成了肉色的螺旋状……
His arm twists like a wrung wet cloth, spinning into a spiral of flesh.

驻守的信徒：　ㄌˋ——呃……啊！
Cellar Guardian: *roars* Ugh ... Ah!

与此同时，颅脑在震颤，另一股电流般的刺痛一阵阵从脊椎蹿动到大脑。
His head shakes uncontrollably, and a searing, electric pain courses up from his spine to his brain.

驻守的信徒：　哕……！
Cellar Guardian: *vomits*

一种仿若要将灵魂呕吐而出的冲动，令他趴伏在地。
An urge, almost as if to vomit out his very soul, forces him to the ground.

他抽搐的眼睛，终于看见发条玩具上的刻字。
There his twitching eyes make out an engraving on the clockwork toy:

“金伯利女郎”。
"Ms. Kimberly."

……

...

信徒被火光拉长的影子，仍停留在地面上。
The shadow of the believer, elongated by the firelight, lingers on the ground.

影子融化成了黑色沼泽，沸腾、滚动……
It melts into the earth, forming a black mire, bubbling and roiling.

黑色流泻，露出了底下的美丽的身躯。
Then, the blackness spills away, revealing a beautiful figure.

月光冷冽，透过树梢铺落出一片斑驳的银白。
Cold and silver moonlight sifts through the treetops.

她睁开眼，木讷地抬起头。
She opens her eyes and dully lifts her head.

???:　……需要我……为您做些什么吗?
???: How may I serve you?

别无所依
Alone FT-18

???: 我愿意为您解决一切烦恼，主人。
???: I'll solve any problem for you, master.

???: 折断债主的脖颈，引诱政客，或者将他们搅弄得浑身颤抖……没错，我会妥帖地达成您的心意。
???: Would you like me to break your creditor's neck? Or seduce a politician? I will obey your every command.

???: 只要……啊，只要……
???: As ... As long as ...

她埋下头，紧攥着手。
She lowers her head again, clenching her hands tightly.

???: 令您如愿以偿后……能允许我吸吮一点儿……只要一点儿的流动着的……
???: As long as you allow me to have a little bit of fresh.

她平静、虚弱，像一位在车站卖不出鲜花的女孩。
She appears calm yet frail and needy.

信徒缓缓走了过来。他的到来让那位少女露出欣喜的神色。
The believer approaches her slowly. As she sees him, a look of joy comes over her face.

驻守的信徒: 歹丶——杀……杀死……他们。
Cellar Guardian: *roars* Kill ... Kill them ...

???: 只要杀死就可以吗？啊，我明白了……我接过无数次这样的活儿……
???: That's it? Oh, I see. I've done countless jobs like this.

???: 可是您需要把话说得再清楚一点儿，他们——他们是谁呢？
???: But could you be more specific? Who are "them"?

驻守的信徒: 是——
Cellar Guardian: Them ...!

信徒正准备回应，却被突如其来的肘击撞至坠地，击起一片尘土。
Before the burly believer can speak, a sudden elbow knocks him to the ground, kicking up a swirl of dust.

驻守的信徒: 呃……！
Cellar Guardian: Urgh!

J: 女士，需要搭把手吗？
J: You alright, lady?

他伸过手，却被不耐烦的声响回绝了。
He reaches out but is met with a frustrated sound of rejection.

???: ……
???: ...

她抬起低垂的头，看向了不招自来的男人。
She lifts her chin, gazing up sharply at the newcomer.

???: 你在干什么？你把我们好不容易有一些进展的对话给搅断了……
???: What do you think you're doing? Our conversation was finally getting somewhere.

驻守的信徒: 歹丶……他们，杀死他们。
Cellar Guardian: *roars* Them. Kill them!

声音钻入她的双耳，仿若契约书盖上了明晰的手印。
The voice pierces her ears, his words putting an awaited stamp on their contract.

???: 如您所愿，主人。
???: As you wish, master.

就像被投入硬币的机器，她的手指转瞬间轻轻抬起。
She lifts her hands in a passionless machine-like motion.

J: 呃?!
J: What?!

博伊刀抵住猩红的尖刺，发出震耳的颤音。
The Bowie knife slides against her crimson spike, producing a shrieking clamor.

刀刃顷刻间破碎，飞溅——划破他的脸颊。
His blade shatters in an instant—pieces splintering and slicing across his cheek.

J: ?!
J: ?!

那柄引以为豪的新作品，被轻而易举地摧毁了。
His work reduced to nothing in an effortless moment.

???: 嗯？我以为只要一次就可以结束了。
???: Hmm? I thought one blow would do it.

???: 别挣扎了，小东西……我喜欢选择仁慈一些的方式。当一根针刺入颅脑，动物通常只会闷声倒地，不会有任何痛觉。
???: There's no need to struggle. I am a merciful hunter. When I penetrate your skull with this needle, you'll die quickly. You'll hardly suffer.

???: 或者，你……要不要换个古老的死法？我可以把脊椎完好无损地抽出来，放进福尔马林罐里头……
???: Or would you rather I use a more ancient method? I could extract your spine and store it in a jar of formalin.

远处传来摩托车的嗡鸣声。
In the distance, the roaring of another motorcycle covers their voices.

霍利克: J……！她非得让我载她过来……
Hollick: J! She insisted on coming! She wouldn't take no for an answer!

玛蒂尔达: 当然，那可是玛蒂尔达的命令！你还在这里做什么？环状水星女士他们和我已经把集市里的商贩、信徒都抓到一起，大伙都在等你呢……
Matilda: Of course! This is Matilda's order! What are you still doing here? We have captured all the peddlers and believers in the lair. Everyone's waiting for you!

玛蒂尔达: 你把那名使徒抓回来了吗？他对于我们的调查可是至关重要的——
Matilda: Did you catch the Apostle? He's crucial to our investigation.

???: ……
???: ...

J: 快躲开！
J: Move!

霍利克: ?!
Hollick: ?!

玛蒂尔达: 强固守势！
Matilda: Umbra Umbo!

J: 呼……吓我一跳，小家伙，我差点儿以为要把你抬回去了。
J: Phew. You freaked me out, Frenchie. For a second there, I thought I'd have to rush you to the hospital.

玛蒂尔达: 哼哼！玛蒂尔达的神秘术测验成绩可是首屈一指的！怎么会被这点小把戏伤到。
Matilda: Hmph! My arcane skill exam scores are second to none! Of course I can deal with such a simple trick!

而 J 的手却挡住了跃跃欲试的她。
Yet J blocks her eager attempt.

J: 不，玛蒂尔达、霍利克……我要你们现在就离开这里，把所有还能举起术杖的伙计都喊过来。
J: No. Matilda, Hollick, I need you to go and get all the arcanists who can still fight.

J 的身子微微俯下，目光始终没从那古怪的少女身上挪开。
He leans forward, his gaze never shifting from the peculiar girl.

她望着身前越聚越多的人，眼里只有疲惫与倦怠。
She looks out wearily at the crowd growing in front of her.

???: 我只想尽快完成主人的命令……小家伙们，别再磨磨蹭蹭的了。
???: I'm just trying to carry out my master's order. Don't waste my time.

???: 呃?
???: Hmm?

一只手唐突地抓住了她的手腕。
A hand grasps her wrist.

驻守的信徒: 歹丶——这个，这个……用。
Cellar Guardian: *roars* Use ... this.

驻守的信徒: ……他们留下。
Cellar Guardian: Kill them.

似曾相识的香炉，飘忽着沉沉的雾气。
Thick, swirling smoke rises from the familiar incense burner.

红雾铺在地上，如同水流漫延。
Red mist sprawls out around it.

???: 哈哈……这是个好东西。谢谢您为我行方便，有了它的话……
???: Oh, this will be useful. Thank you for your help. Now then.

玛蒂尔达: 这个味道，那……那是！环状水星女士使用过的曼德拉草熏香……而且，这个浓郁程度，我们很快就会不省人事的！
Matilda: The smell! It's the Mandrake incense Ms. Mercuria used! With this density, we'll be unconscious within a minute!

她抬起手，试图挡住雾气钻进口鼻。
She raises her hand to her face, trying to cover her nose.

玛蒂尔达: 你们俩，捂住口鼻！别失去意识！
Matilda: Cover your mouth and nose! Try and stay awake!

然而捕猎般俯下身的男人，没有任何防备的动作。
However, J makes no effort to shield himself.

他的腹部正渗出深红，身体的每一寸挪动，都伴随着剧烈的疼痛。
His abdomen is painted in crimson red, and his every movement is bought with intense pain.

霍利克: J，你没事吧?
Hollick: J, are you okay?

J：没事……这是之前那帮疯子留下的伤口。
J: I'm fine. It's nothing.

J：幸亏这股疼痛让我清醒……伙计，我还能把双手都用上。
J: Good thing is the pain's kept me awake, and I can still move my arms.

血色的迷雾，顷刻间弥漫整片树林。
In little time, the mist has enveloped the entire forest.

赶路的女士察觉出身后的异样，停下了脚步。
Eternity hurries along, but stops after sensing something unusual behind her.

温妮弗雷德：呵呵……可惜了您这么大的阵仗，我可真想为自己寻个最佳观众席。
Eternity: *chuckles* Looks like an exciting show. I wish I could sit down and watch.

温妮弗雷德：祝您愉快，女士。
Eternity: Enjoy it, Miss!

无人发现那名神秘的少女，已如敏捷的野兽般跃入了血色的迷雾中。
The mysterious girl leaps through the mist unnoticed, like a jungle cat.

玛蒂尔达：糟糕……看来我们的意识都受到了影响，她……不见了。
Matilda: Crap! The incense is invading our consciousness. That woman ... She's disappeared.

玛蒂尔达：你们两个傻大个，准备好武器——
Matilda: Prepare your weapons, boys.

玛蒂尔达：不对，J，你的博伊刀怎么只剩半截了?!
Matilda: Wait, J, what's wrong with your knife?!

J：……
J: ...

他丢掉仅剩残刃的博伊刀。
He discards the remaining fragments of his Bowie knife.

J：……知道了，知道了，小家伙。
J: Fine. I'll use what I have.

他蹲坐下来。
He kneels.

J：啊……真是糟透了，老爸……
J: Ugh. This sucks, Dad.

J：跟你比起来，我的手艺还差了一个世纪……
J: My forging's not even close to your level.

他将始终背在背上的剑状物，放在地上。
He removes the shaft he's long kept strapped to his back and places it on the ground.

深吸一口气，闭上了眼。
He inhales deeply as he closes his eyes.

唐吉老爹：那时候，你老爸……他的手臂早已经开始发黑了，我们谁也没辙……
Tang Ji: In that moment, your father was ... Well, his arms were charred. There was nothing we could do.

唐吉老爹：死亡已经把他吃干抹净，他仍旧不放手，紧紧揣住它……
Tang Ji: He was dying, but he wouldn't let the sword go.

唐吉老爹：我后来才明白，其实……是那柄剑不肯对他松手。
Tang Ji: What I didn't know was that it wasn't he who was holding on to the sword, but the sword that was holding on to him.

唐吉老爹：隔天……原本躺在遗体怀里的它失踪了。
Tang Ji: The next day, the sword was gone.

唐吉老爹：……我看见你抱住它，在床上睡着了。
Tang Ji: And I saw you holding it in your arms, fast asleep in your bed.

唐吉老爹：孩子……离它远一些，不是你找到了它。
Tang Ji: Stay away from it, kid. You may not have chosen it.

唐吉老爹：……
Tang Ji: ...

唐吉老爹：是它找到了你。
Tang Ji: But it has chosen you.

J：呼……抱歉了，唐吉老爹。
J: *deep breath* Sorry, Mr. Tang.

他睁开眼。
At last, he opens his eyes.

一圈，又一圈，犹如层层覆盖在伤口之上的裹布，缓缓被解开。
Layer by layer, like bandages being slowly unwrapped from a wound, the blade is revealed.

一道澄澈的光，宛如宝石般嵌入他的眼眸。
It shines like crystal in the glimmering moonlight.

J：老伙计，别来无恙。
J: Long time no see, buddy.

J：呃……咳咳……霍利克！
J: *coughs* Ugh. Hollick!

随着颤抖和呼吸，鲜血正潺潺地流出来，濡湿裤腰。
Blood is flowing steadily from him now, soaking his waist.

遍体鳞伤的两人，如手足无措的羔羊般伫立。
The two battered figures stand around helplessly.

而固执的伙计，正趴伏着拽住她。
Meanwhile, stubborn Hollick lies prone, gripping her tightly.

J：把手放下，乖乖趴在那儿，别再动了！
J: Let go. Just stay where you are!

J：把自己藏起来……
J: Hide yourself!

在红雾的影响下，J 的力量业已流失殆尽。
The red mist has nearly drained the last of J's strength.

树枝贯穿他的小腿，沾着鲜血插入土壤，令他动弹不得。
The branch pierces his calf, pinning him to the ground.

???：喂，好好听他的劝告不行吗？我也不想浪费多余的气力……
???: Just listen to him, will you? This is starting to become bothersome.

她蹲下来，看向脚边的胖子。
She crouches down, looking at the fat man at her feet.

肩膀血肉模糊的男人，以笨重的身躯拖住了她的脚。
Despite his mangled shoulder, he throws his full weight into her to keep hold of her foot.

霍利克：不，如果不这样做的话……
Hollick: No, no, no. I have to do this.

霍利克：J……咳咳，这次你要告诉贝克特，你要告诉他……我可没有溜走，也没有把事搞砸。
Hollick: J ... *coughs* Tell Becket that I didn't, I didn't run away or cause any trouble this time.

霍利克：……我比他说的，可机灵多了。对吗，老大……？
Hollick: I'm more useful than he thinks. Right, boss?

霍利克：他再也不能笑我了……哈、哈哈……
Hollick: He'll never make fun of me again. Hahaha.

耗尽最后的气力，胖子将手中的东西丢掷到了半空。
Exhausting his last bit of strength, Hollick throws the object he is holding into the air.

“呲——”
swoosh

一股腥甜的味觉开始充斥着霍利克的喉头。
A sickly-sweet taste fills Hollick's throat.

霍利克：呃……！
Hollick: Urgh!

J：该死，该死！
J: Damn it! Damn it!!

尖刺贯穿喉咙，那双向上挥动的充满油渍的手，终于软塌塌地放了下去。
A sharp spike has pierced through his throat, and his oil-stained hands fall limp.

霍利克：火……
Hollick: Fire ...

J：……！
J: ...!

一道不言而喻的灵光，从他的脑海中窜过。
A new idea flashes through his mind.

他执起了剑，重重挥下——
He grasps his sword and brings it down with force—

剑刃戳穿瓶罐，紧接着——火色席卷。
The blade punctures the canister, and immediately, flames erupt around it.

装满汽油的罐装物爆裂而开，火焰溅射四散。
The canister has burst open, spewing licks of flame everywhere.

火舌迸发而出，舔舐起了周围的树木。
In the dry woods, the fires quickly spread into an inferno.

烈焰缠绕树枝、草丛……木枝断裂，群鸟惊起。
The blazing fire scours over trees and underbrush.

红雾与灰烟混杂在一起，四周的景象愈加迷离。
The red mist mingles with dark gray smoke, forming a deep haze.

玛蒂尔达：这是……?!
Matilda: Are you going to ...?!

J: 咳、咳……霍利克……
J: *coughs* Ugh. Hollick ...

J: 这是唯一的办法了，总会有其他人看到的……
J: It's the only way. Someone's gotta see the smoke.

绒丝带
Velvet Ribbon FT-19

保利娜: 够了，我才不在乎你说什么！
Paulina: Enough, J. I really don't give a crap about what you've learned "on the streets." I don't want to hear it.

保利娜: 我宁愿死在外面，也不要在这里发臭！
Paulina: I'd rather take my chances and die out there than stay here and never live at all.

门被狠狠踹出一个洞，打了开来。
J kicks the door hard, smashing a hole straight through it.

J: 你就想跟那帮政府的老爷搭上伙，是吗？嗯？你以为他们会拿正眼瞧你吗？
J: You really think you're gonna build connections with the government? Rub shoulders with the upper class? You think they'll take you seriously?

J: 他们会把你当作最底层、最微不足道的“填线兵”，放到远比街头厮杀更不择手段的斗争里！
J: You're no different from any of the "cannon fodder" at the bottom of their system! You're gonna be fighting a battle even tougher than the one on Haight Street!

他气势汹汹地走过去，就像一位不容置疑的父亲。
He stomps forward with a domineering presence, playing every bit the role of a stern father.

J: 你以为我拦住那群狗腿子找到你，都是为了什么？
J: Why do you think I kept those government suckups from finding you in the first place?

J: 你呆在这儿，或者呆在任何除了圣洛夫基金会以外的任何地方，我都举一万双手同意！
J: Listen. It doesn't matter where you go, as long as it's not the St. Pavlov Foundation!

J: 只要你不去那儿，不管是大学、公司、医院……你能比任何人都过得更好！
J: You could go to college, join a company, a hospital. You'd live a better life than anyone else!

她合上行李箱，突然发自内心地笑了。
She closes the suitcase, then looks up at him with a smile of genuine warmth.

保利娜: “能比任何人都过得更好”，瞧瞧你，哥哥，多么令人发笑的愿景？
Paulina: Hah. "A better life than anyone else," huh? Listen to yourself. That's ridiculous!

保利娜: 你终于把你的心底话说出来了，是吗？助人为乐、济困扶危，好邻居，好老大——J？
Paulina: You finally said what you really think, didn't you, J? Our righteous boss and kindhearted neighbor.

保利娜: 你把我看得太低了！我才没有兴趣把我的利益置于别人的苟延残喘之上，我有远比你、我，整条海特街，都更高的理想。
Paulina: But you know what? I'm not interested in comparing myself to anyone else! I actually want to do something meaningful with my life. Something beyond you, beyond myself, beyond the whole of Haight Street!

保利娜: 它不会因为任何人而消磨、折损。
Paulina: And there is nothing you can do that is going to stop me from pursuing my dream.

他冷笑着。
He sneers.

J：可等你深陷危险，谁又会来搭救你？那帮愣头愣脑的白袍子吗？把心肝卖给所谓理想，而非身边的挚友、亲人的圣洛夫基金会职员？
J: But who's gonna help you when you're in danger? Those idiots in white robes? How can you entrust your life to the Foundation and not your family or friends? And all because of some dream you're not even sure you can realize?

J：我打赌，总有一天，你会哭哭啼啼地回来，告诉我原来外面的世界并不是那么回事。
J: You know, one day, you'll come crawling home and cry about how the world is nothing like you imagined.

J：等到那时候，就轮到我捧腹大笑了！
J: And I'll just laugh and say I told you so.

她望向了他。
She looks at him coldly.

保利娜：笑吧，笑吧……J。
Paulina: Fine, then laugh, J.

保利娜：人是愿意忍受痛苦，人也是愿意死的。
Paulina: Some people are willing to deal with pain, even willing to sacrifice themselves if they have to.

保利娜：如果我会死，那是出于我的选择。
Paulina: If I die out there, it'll be because I chose to.

保利娜：到那时候，我所保护的就是所有人，而那也是我应该付出的代价。
Paulina: If that's the price I'll pay to protect everyone, then so be it.

J：……
J: ...

他的面容不再戏谑，靠在墙上，深长地叹了一口气。
His mocking expression falls away; he leans up against the wall and lets out a long, deep sigh.

J：我们到底是什么时候走出了两条路的，妹妹。
J: What happened, sis? Since when did we walk such different paths?

保利娜：从你把那个欺骗了我的巫毒师……揍得沿街乞讨开始，就因为他嘲笑我是人类。
Paulina: Ever since you beat up that voodooist who tricked me and laughed because I was a human, that's when. You beat him to a pulp, Joe. You forced him to beg on the street.

保利娜：……这是一场困局，哥哥。第一个人折磨第二个人，第二个人教予第三个人……无休无止。
Paulina: Everyone here is stuck in a vicious cycle. One person tortures another, then he tortures someone else, and so on and so on. It never ends!

保利娜：我找到了我的答案，而我现在准备试错……你或许能阻拦一场酒后斗殴，一次危机，但你知道你阻止不了我的意志。
Paulina: Well, I think I've found a way to break the cycle, and I'm going to try it, even if I make mistakes. I know you think you can stop anything—bar fights, arguments—but you can't stop me.

她推开被踹出破洞的门。
She pushes open the door.

J：我的摩托车坏了。
J: Bike's broken.

保利娜： 我可以坐灰狗巴士。
Paulina: I'll take the Greyhound.

J： 我说，今天他们不开张。
J: They're not running today.

保利娜： 那我就走过去。
Paulina: Then I'll walk.

保利娜： 走到我的目的地为止。
Paulina: I'll walk until I get there.

“咚……”
"Thud ..."

J： 咳、咳……噗……
J: *coughs and vomits*

玛蒂尔达挡在他的身前，岿然不动。
Matilda stands in front of him, resolute and unshakable.

黏稠的血从牙缝里流出来，淌到地上。
The taste of blood and vomit mingles in his mouth, trickling out from behind his teeth.

他感觉到每动弹一下，深入骨髓的疼痛就蹿过全身。
Throbbing agony sears through him from each movement.

???: 好了，这个高傲的金发小妞……你准备好当标本了吗?
???: Alright, blondie. Ready for a formalin bath?

玛蒂尔达： ……
Matilda: ...

手无寸铁的恐惧，正在缓缓爬上身体。
She realizes in a moment of terror that she is completely unarmed.

玛蒂尔达： 作为圣洛夫基金会的特派调查员玛蒂尔达·布翁尼，我有义务保护所有的普通人，即便需要以我的生命为代价！
Matilda: As an investigator of the St. Pavlov Foundation, I, Matilda Bouanich, have a duty to protect the people, even at the cost of my life!

她的声音在打颤，她的双脚在发软。
Her voice wavers, and her legs buckle—barely holding.

这是第一防线学校曾在课堂上教予过她的责任。
This is the responsibility that the SPDM has taught her.

Z： 玛蒂尔达，当你真正面对他们的时候……告诉我，你是否有与死亡站在同一侧的勇气?
Z: Tell me, Matilda. When you confront the Manus, are you certain that you'll have the courage to come face-to-face with death?

Z： 你真的准备好，作为外派调查员，加入基金会了吗?
Z: Are you sure you're ready to serve as a field investigator?

玛蒂尔达： 我会倾尽所有的力量保护所有人。
Matilda: I will do everything I can to protect everyone.

玛蒂尔达： 我不会辱没千百年来布翁尼家族的荣誉与尊严。
Matilda: With honor and dignity, I will make the Bouanich family proud.

眼皮犹如挂上了锁链，将他的意识往下拉。
J's eyelids feel chained down, dragging his consciousness downward with them.

他的余光，瞥见尖锐的蛇尾，于半空中挥舞、摆动……
In his periphery, a jagged snake tail writhes and twists in the air.

单薄的小身躯，矗立在他身前。
A slender figure stands before him.

他好像又看见那条蓝丝带，从他眼前飘过。
It is as if he sees that blue ribbon fluttering past his eyes again.

他从肺腑中，发出了最后的呐喊。
He lets out a final deep cry.

J：快点走，傻家伙……我不需要你挡在我面前，更不需要你把命搭在这儿！
J: Run, you idiot. I don't need you to protect me! I don't need your sacrifice!

J：我才不在乎你们基金会的那套使命，那套冠冕堂皇的价值观——我**不在乎！
J: I don't care about your duty or whatever the Foundation says! I don't f*****g care!

J：你不明白，如果你真的死了，像霍利克一样死在这里……那这一切……你所经历的一切，就真的……没有了。
J: You don't get it, do you?! If you die like Hollick back there, everything you have—everything you've been through—will be gone for good.

J：咳、咳……去跟你的上头汇报，说这一切只是一个不遵守保密协定的家伙自讨苦吃。
J: *coughs* Tell your boss that I got in trouble because I didn't follow the confidentiality agreement. Tell her I deserved it.

J：告诉他们，是那个顽固不化的傻大个站错了队。
J: And tell her that stupid big guy over there picked the wrong side and got himself killed.

J：你完成了你理应要做的事情，没有谁有资格责怪你……
J: You've done your job. No one can blame you.

玛蒂尔达：我不接受你的提议……
Matilda: No. I decline your offer.

玛蒂尔达：——我会站在这里，直到支援到来为止！
Matilda: I will stand and fight until the reinforcements arrive!

她瑟瑟发抖的手，紧紧握成了拳头。
Her hand steadies and tightens into a fist.

J：只要逃跑就好了，咳、咳……
J: Just run ... *coughs*

J：别管任何人就好了。
J: Forget about us. Save yourself.

保利娜：人是愿意忍受痛苦，人也是愿意死的。
Paulina: Some people are willing to deal with pain, even willing to sacrifice themselves if they have to.

保利娜：如果我会死，那是出于我的选择。
Paulina: If I die out there, it'll be because I chose to.

保利娜：……而那也是我应该付出的代价。
Paulina: If that's the price I'll pay to protect everyone, then so be it.

J：如果有选择的话，我希望你成为另一个人。
J: I wish you could've lived a different life.

J：我希望你从来不是生在一个支离破碎的家庭。
J: I wish you'd been born into a happy family.

J: 我希望你拥有一张舒适的床榻，有一个更加温馨且奢侈的屋子。
J: That you'd had your own room with a huge bed and lived in a beautiful, fancy house.

J: 我希望你成为另一个被父母珍爱的、笨手笨脚的富家女孩，所有人都以你为傲。
J: I wish you'd been a rich girl. I wish you'd been cherished by your parents and that everyone had been proud of you.

J: 我希望你不用管世界上的贫穷与苦痛，疾病与战争……
J: I wish you'd never known about the poverty, disease, and war in the real world.

J: 我希望你的窗户永远不会破损，暖炉的火焰一直烧到天亮。
J: I wish you could've slept in a room without a broken window and with a fireplace that kept you warm at night.

J: 我希望你从不住在我为你布置的破狗窝里，我希望你从不会有受人嘲笑的破旧衣裳。
J: I wish you didn't have to live in that run-down room I set up for you. I wish you could've worn new clothes that no one laughed at.

J: 我希望你身边永远是大方而忠诚的朋友。
J: I wish you could've been surrounded by kind and loyal friends.

J: 我希望……
J: I wish ...

J: 我从来不是你的哥哥。
J: ... we'd never met.

???: 他们在这里！
???: There they are!

信鸽
Letter Home FT-20

未署名者: 我并不想提笔写这封信。
Anonymous Writer: I don't want to write this letter.

未署名者: 但我曾经保证过，如果有朝一日，当我们能平起平坐，我会说服你接受我所选择的道路。
Anonymous Writer: But I promised myself that, once we could talk as equals, I would persuade you to accept my decision.

J: 咳、咳……真够呛人的。
J: *coughs* Sure is dusty in here.

J: 这里可得好好打扫一番。
J: I gotta clean up.

地面的灰尘在阳光下，熠熠生辉。
Dust on the ground shimmers in the sunlight.

未署名者: 我以为，当我站在与你同样高的地方，我便会拥有与你正面对峙的勇气。
Anonymous Writer: I thought I would have the courage to confront you, then.

未署名者: 当我的脚掌能踏到你未曾涉足的土地，当我的双眼看见了你所看不见的前方，我以为我能让你认识到你的愚钝与自私，你也许会以我为傲……
Anonymous Writer: I thought I could tell you how foolish and selfish you were. I thought I could make you proud of me by going to places you've never been and seeing what you've never seen.

未署名者： 但此刻，当我真正面对一个有着生命威胁的任务时，我觉察到我并非如我所说的那样勇敢。
Anonymous Writer: But now, when faced with a mission that could put my life at risk, I realize that I'm not as brave as I thought.

未署名者： 我的笔在打颤，我知道我想要逃走，我不想面对危险，亦不想失去手中的拥有。
Anonymous Writer: My hands are trembling. My body wants to run. I don't want to lose everything I have.

未署名者： 我不想死得默默无闻，更不想死在美好的结局到来的前一秒。
Anonymous Writer: I don't want to die nameless, especially now that I'm so close to the life I've always wanted.

J： 噢？这个破洞待在这儿多久了……老伙计，那时候可真抱歉。
J: Hmm? When did you get this hole? Ah, sorry, buddy.

J： 我真不该拿靴子踹你。
J: I shouldn't have kicked you.

未署名者： 于是我想起，我跟你说过：“人是愿意死的。”
Anonymous Writer: I keep thinking about what I told you that day. About how some people would sacrifice themselves if they had to.

未署名者： 我想起你听到这句话时，第一次露出了害怕的表情，啊……那时候的我感到自豪。
Anonymous Writer: I remember the scared look on your face when you heard that. I was so proud of myself at the time.

未署名者： “我总算是吓到这个大个子了。”
Anonymous Writer: I thought, "Finally, I managed to scare him."

未署名者： 如今，我却想咒骂当时的自己，因为这并不光荣，打败你并不光荣。
Anonymous Writer: But now I wish I could go back and stop myself. I know that scaring you is nothing to be proud of.

未署名者： 因为，我明明知道——这仅仅是因为，我是这个世界上唯一能伤害你的人。
Anonymous Writer: I only did it because I knew I was the only one in the world who could hurt you.

未署名者： ……
Anonymous Writer: ...

“咚咚咚……”
"Knock, knock, knock ..."

未署名者： 我的职位已足够令我能与你平起平坐，我们一样高了，哥哥。
Anonymous Writer: And now that I've established myself, I can talk to you as an equal.

未署名者： 可是……我突然后悔了，外派调查任务的同行职员，现在正在敲响我的门扉。
Anonymous Writer: But I've found myself doubting my decision. When my colleague knocked on my door, urging me to prepare for our field mission ...

未署名者： 他大声喊叫着：“保利娜！保利娜！”
Anonymous Writer: And he called out my name, "Paulina! Paulina!"

未署名者： 我多想，我多想现在在外面敲门的人是你。
Anonymous Writer: How I wished he were you.

未署名者： 我希望你敲开门，拦住我。
Anonymous Writer: How I wished for you to open that door and protect me.

未署名者： 可那仅仅是，一瞬间……一瞬间的念头，我明白我的恐惧，正如此时我也明白了你当时第一次害怕的面孔。
Anonymous Writer: But that thought only lasted for a moment. Then I understood where my fear came from, and why you were so scared when I talked about sacrifice.

未署名者： 我明白，此时此刻，还有无数的平民在受到折磨与煎熬，敌人又割开了基金会同袍的喉咙，一个家庭溃散，一栋楼宇倒塌，有孩子无家可归，同样有人痛彻心扉。
Anonymous Writer: I realized that even though countless people are suffering out there, even though my colleagues have sacrificed their lives, even though more and more children have become homeless ...

未署名者： 而我并不勇敢。
Anonymous Writer: I'm not as brave as I want to be.

J： 呼……终于修好了，老伙计，现在你的气色看起来好多了。
J: Phew. All fixed, finally. You're looking much better now, buddy.

门上久远的破洞，已被木板弥合。
The old hole in the door has been patched with wooden planks.

斯普特尼克： J 先生……您真的要转让这家餐馆的管理权吗?
Sputnik: Mr. J, are you really selling the restaurant?

J： 别担心，女士，会有新的阔绰的家伙来接手的。
J: Don't worry about it. A new, even better guy will take over.

未署名者： 但我明白，在这场时代的悲剧之中，总要有人伸出手，否则我们将分崩离析，否则恸哭会传遍世界上的每一个角落。
Anonymous Writer: But I also understand that someone has to step forward and stop this tragedy. Otherwise, our world will fall apart, leaving nothing but sadness and pain.

未署名者： 世界上不存在只有一滴水的海，也不存在只流一滴血的战争，也从未有过——仅有一片瓦片的屋顶。
Anonymous Writer: A single drop of water can't form an ocean, a single piece of tile can't build a roof, nor can a single person put an end to a war.

未署名者： 人类、神秘学家……我们各执己见，各司其职……
Anonymous Writer: For a long time, humans and arcanists have been on opposite ends of the spectrum.

未署名者： 如果没有凝聚，我们都将沦为一片乌有。
Anonymous Writer: Faced with this catastrophic event, we may all perish unless we stick together.

未署名者： 我是一场时代洪流中，最微不足道的一块挡石，随时会被冲走，随时会被遗忘。
Anonymous Writer: But in the grand scheme of things, I'm just a blip on the radar.

未署名者： 我是一个怯弱、胆小的人类。
Anonymous Writer: Yes, I'm just a weak, cowardly human.

未署名者： 但我也是圣洛夫基金会的一员。
Anonymous Writer: But I'm also a member of the St. Pavlov Foundation.

未署名者： 如今，时过境迁，我意识到，我才刚刚真正获得了当初说出那句话的勇气。
Anonymous Writer: I can finally truly say those words with conviction.

未署名者： “人是愿意忍受痛苦，人也是愿意死的。”
Anonymous Writer: "Some people are willing to deal with pain, even willing to sacrifice themselves if they have to."

J：正好……
J: This is a good spot.

未署名者：砖石会筑成围墙，雨迟早会有停下的一天。
Anonymous Writer: Piece by piece, we'll build a shelter. And one day, the rain will stop.

未署名者：逝去的人儿不再，但新的时代终将来临……
Anonymous Writer: We can't save those we've lost, but I believe that one day we'll reach a new era.

门外正有人招手。
Someone waves from outside the door.

莱格斯：该走了，J。
Legers: We should go, J.

J：……
J: ...

他将照片摘下，接着把信纸对折，抚平——
He takes down the photo, folds the letter, and smooths it out.

一齐收入了胸膛的口袋。
Then, he slips both into his chest pocket.

像她当初那样，走出了门扉。
And just as she had once, he pushes the door open to leave.

旱鸭子
Landlubber FT-21

拉普拉斯康复中心病房
Ward, Laplace Rehab Center

猫眼维森：呜哇……！头儿，圣洛夫基金会到底有什么好的?！你明明知道那里都是一帮扯谎的混球……
Cateye Wisen: *cries* Boss! What's in it for you to join the Foundation?! You know they're all liars!

猫眼维森：那群高高在上的家伙嘴里从没有半句实话，总是欺骗咱们这样的人。
Cateye Wisen: Those, those holier-than-thou officials, they never tell us what's really going on.

猫眼维森：而且……而且，餐馆要是交给了莱格斯……
Cateye Wisen: Besides, if Legers is taking over the restaurant—

他抓扯着 J 的衣服，不愿意松手。
He clutches at J's clothes, unwilling to let go.

“剃刀”小队队员 II：放尊重点儿，小鬼！如果不是我们及时赶到，你亲爱的头儿就要被插成马蜂窝了！
"Razor" Soldier II: Hey, watch your mouth, kid! Your boss would've been hacked to pieces if it weren't for us!

J 蹲坐下来，将双手搭在孩子的肩膀上。
J bends down and places his hands on the boy's shoulders.

J：把鼻涕抹干净，小子……我向你打包票，莱格斯还算个不错的家伙。
J: Wipe your nose, kid. Legers will be a good boss. Promise.

J：他会替我，帮你们把乌七八糟的海特街重新收拾起来……到时候，救济所的人会为你们找所学校。
J: He'll clean up the mess on Haight Street. And after that, the poorhouse staff will get you into school.

J：还有……霍利克的摩托车，以后就是你的了。
J: And Hollick's bike ... It's yours now.

所有人都陷入了静默。
Everyone falls quiet.

猫眼维森：唔……那你呢?
Cateye Wisen: So, what're you gonna do now?

J：我?
J: Me?

J：我打算跳进海里，张开手……游一趟试试。
J: I'm gonna jump into the sea and try to swim.

猫眼维森：唔，那是什么意思？头儿，你不是……旱鸭子吗?
Cateye Wisen: What do you mean, boss? I thought you didn't know how to swim.

旁边的床铺，露出了另一个熟悉的面孔。
An all-too-familiar face emerges on the bed beside them.

贝克特：吵死了！混小子，你又在搞什么？让我安心睡会儿觉不行吗?
Becket: Shut up, you noisy bastards! I'm trying to sleep here!

杰洛：最该闭嘴的是你，你这条呼噜能响破灯泡的野猪！
Gio: You shut up! Your snoring could cause a freaking earthquake!

两个打着石膏的男人，额头互相顶撞着。
The two men with their heads bandaged bump foreheads.

“咚！”由莱格斯送的花束，被打翻在地。
"Thud!" The bouquet sent by Legers is knocked to the ground.

护士：闭嘴！你们要是再在病房叫嚣，我保证给你们打上一剂麻醉药，插上尿管和呼吸机，让你们老老实实睡到下个月！
Nurse: Everyone shut up! Make any more noise, and I swear I'll anesthetize you so you sleep for the entire month!

众人：……
All: ...

他们灰溜溜地钻回了被窝。
They sheepishly retreat under their covers.

J 向另一位职员伸出了手掌。
J extends his hand toward another Foundation staff member.

J：这次我欠你个人情，“剃刀”。
J: I owe you one, "Razor."

“剃刀”：不，这是那名梅克卢女士的功劳，要不是她为我们指路，打开那扇门……我们也没法及时赶到，一起制止那名神秘的少女。
"Razor": No, you owe Maich one. If she hadn't led us to the door, we wouldn't have been able to stop that girl in time.

商贩梅克卢：到最后……环状水星还是绕过所有人，走在了前面。
Maich the Peddler: As it turns out, Mercuria foresaw the whole thing and took action before anyone realized what was going on.

商贩梅克卢：她总是这样让自己陷进去，将自己的命运置之度外……
Maich the Peddler: She always does this. Once she's fixed on a goal, she never considers her own safety.

商贩梅克卢：一步步自毁，最后像一位殉道者让自己遍体鳞伤……
Maich the Peddler: But, despite her courage, she's still a living person who can get hurt.

商贩梅克卢：你们得向我保证，把她带回来……
Maich the Peddler: Please, promise me you'll bring her back.

“剃刀”：……
"Razor": ...

“剃刀”：可惜的是，由于事发突然，我们没能做好充足的准备将那名少女截留下来……
"Razor": It's a shame we couldn't arrest that girl. If only we'd had a little more time to prepare.

J：……别丧气，你们好歹还截留下了我这条命，不是吗？因此赚到了整条海特街最值钱的人情。
J: Cheer up, man! You saved my life, didn't you? That'll get you pretty far on Haight Street.

J：对了，那个小家伙，玛蒂尔达去哪儿了？她今天不是应该来接我加入圣洛夫基金会吗？
J: By the way, where's Matilda? She's supposed to take me to the Foundation today.

“剃刀”：……
"Razor": ...

他欲言又止。
He hesitates over his response.

“剃刀”小队队员 II：她已经被紧急传唤回去了，估计还要搞几份调查报告吧。
"Razor" Soldier II: She's been summoned to report on the operation, I guess.

“剃刀”小队队员 II：不过，这次的事情可不好收场啊。涉及太多普通民众了，而且她没有按照计划行事，也差点丢失了与我们的联系……
"Razor" Soldier II: It's gonna be rough. There were a lot of civilians involved, and she didn't follow her commands.

“剃刀”小队队员 II：往最坏的可能去联想，她一直引以为傲的职级可就要保不住了。
"Razor" Soldier II: She might even have her position revoked.

J：什么？她可是解决这次事件最大的——
J: What? But we wouldn't have gotten anywhere without her!

一双手再次将他拦住了。
A pair of hands come up again to stop him.

先驱者：J……这是他们的规矩，如果你确认加入他们，那你也得接受这样的规矩。
Pioneer: J, that's how things work over there. If you're really planning on joining them, you'll have to learn to follow their rules.

J：……
J: ...

J：她现在在哪？
J: Where's she now?

“剃刀”：我们无权知晓……
"Razor": We're not authorized to request that information.

圣洛夫基金会·办公室
Office, St. Pavlov Foundation

玛蒂尔达：啊嚏！我的鼻子……真奇怪，这可还没到换季的时候……
Matilda: Achoo! Ugh. What's wrong with my nose? This isn't even allergy season yet.

伯纳德：你还好吗？玛蒂尔达。
Bernard: Ms. Bouanich, are you alright?

临时委派任务的上司，正站在眼前。
She stands before her temporary supervisor, preparing herself for the debrief.

玛蒂尔达：不，没事……请您继续！
Matilda: Oh, I'm fine. Please, continue!

伯纳德：我昨晚读了你的调查报告……我必须说，你的献身为我们取得了相当重要的情报。
Bernard: I read your report last night. I must say that your judgment has given us some very important information.

伯纳德：根据你的报告，那批失踪的资产包括最重要的“封藏品”，经由温妮弗雷德，最终落到了重塑之手的手上……
Bernard: According to your report, the missing assets are in the possession of Eternity, aside from the most important one, which is now in the hands of Manus Vindictae.

伯纳德：所幸，那名重塑之手成员，是他们渺不足道的众多“信徒”之一，他对那名神秘少女的控制暂且有限……这对我们来说，至少是一个好消息。
Bernard: Luckily, the man in control of the girl is one of their insignificant "believers." For the time being, there's a limit to what he can do with her. This, at least, is good news.

伯纳德：你让圣洛夫基金会的那些高层，都记住了你的名字，玛蒂尔达小姐。
Bernard: You've caused quite a stir among senior management, Ms. Bouanich. It seems you're starting to make a name for yourself.

玛蒂尔达：嘿嘿，谢谢夸奖，伯纳德先生！
Matilda: *chuckles* Thank you, Mr. Bernard!

玛蒂尔达：对了，趁着这次任务结束的休假……我还想向您提出一项申请……
Matilda: By the way, I would like to apply to leave the Foundation during my vacation.

玛蒂尔达：我希望能去妈妈的安全屋一趟，确认她的安危……
Matilda: I want to go visit my mother in her safety house.

玛蒂尔达：——在与那位名叫温妮弗雷德的商人以及那群商贩接触时，他们都多次提及了我的妈妈……
Matilda: That merchant, Eternity, and the peddlers in that lair mentioned her name several times.

玛蒂尔达：在休假的这段时间里……我希望能去看看她。
Matilda: I deem it necessary to confirm her safety.

伯纳德：当然，把申请书留在这里，我会为你安排的。
Bernard: No problem. Give me the application form. I'll arrange it for you.

玛蒂尔达：谢谢您，伯纳德先生！
Matilda: Oh, thank you!

她就要兴奋地迈开脚步——
She takes an excited step forward.

伯纳德：等等……
Bernard: Oh, wait.

他将女孩的兴奋按捺了下来。
His tone dampens the girl's excitement.

伯纳德：有人嘱托我，说你把这件东西给忘在了旧金山。
Bernard: Someone told me to give this to you. He said you left it in San Francisco.

玛蒂尔达：奇怪……我应该没有忘记任何东西啊？
Matilda: That's odd. I don't remember leaving anything.

伯纳德拉开抽屉，将东西交到她的手掌心。
Bernard opens the drawer and places the item into her hand.

伯纳德：他说，这是你的升职证明。
Bernard: He said that it's proof of your promotion.

森林深处
Depths, Forest

???：呃，您的意思是——您没有把我收回去的打算？
???: So, what you're saying is that you're not going to turn me back into a toy?

???：那么——我、我是否可以自己去找吃的？不论是什么都可以？
???: Hmmm. Does that mean I can go hunting by myself? And I can choose my own prey?

驻守的信徒：ㄌㄨˋ——！杀……杀死！
Cellar Guardian: *roars* Kill ... Kill!

回应她的只有前言不搭后语的句子。
There is no sense in his words and as such; no clarity to her purpose.

???：不，我是说——
???: Oh, no, I mean ...

但她忽然意识到了什么。
But she realizes something.

???：……能请您稍稍坐下来一会儿吗？请放心，您只需要回答“是”与“否”就好了！
???: Could you sit down for a moment? Don't worry. All you have to do is say "yes" or "no."

驻守的信徒：ㄌㄨˋ——！
Cellar Guardian: *roars*

???：是，或否？
???: Yes or no?

驻守的信徒：ㄌㄨˋ——杀死！
Cellar Guardian: *roars* Kill!

信徒如同一只高傲的野鹅，挥舞着锤子。
The brutish believer swings his hammer wildly.

从森林一侧，跑到另一侧，东奔又西跑——乐此不疲。
He runs from one side of the forest to the other, racing east and west with manic energy.

???：……好的，好的！太好了，我明白您的需要了！
???: Okay, okay! I get it! I know what you need. This is great!

她的眼神逐渐亮起来了。
Her eyes brighten with clarity.

不需要正常的回应，在那愣头愣脑的回答里，她终于嗅到了从门缝溜进来的自由的气味。
She doesn't need a sensible response; in fact, she doesn't want one. There is a crack in the window; a path to freedom through his madness.

???：遵循您的意见，您想让谁去死，都由您说了算！
???: I'll kill whoever you want! As you wish!

???：我们可以先找找下一个目的地，对吗？
???: Let's decide on our next destination first, shall we?

驻守的信徒：ㄌㄨˋ——！
Cellar Guardian: *roars*

???：明白了，明白了！
???: I see, I see!

她殷勤地点头，荒谬地回答着这些胡言乱语。
She nods eagerly, responding earnestly to his meaningless roars.

她明白，这将是她前所未有的一次新生。
She knows that this is a chance for a new beginning.

???: 我们这就出发，去您想去的地方！
???: Then, let's go where you want to go!

驻守的信徒: 歹——！
Cellar Guardian: *roars*

她拿起树枝，自顾自地当作缰绳牵引着信徒，去往他的“想去的地方”。
She picks up a long, curved branch, using it as makeshift reins to guide the believer to his "desired destination."

余光时不时回望，试图在他身上寻见玩具的所在……
From time to time, she glances back, trying to spot the toy on him ...

“新纪元集市事件”述职报告
"New Age Market Incident" Report 小径

“新纪元集市事件”述职报告
"New Age Market Incident" Report

简中
依托于新纪元集市内普通民众梅克卢女士的帮助，支援小队顺利进入“地下集市”。调查途中，距“地下集市”1.3 英里外的森林突然升起火光与黑烟。我们在该处发现了一位受伤的基金会调查员（玛蒂尔达·布翁尼）、一名生命垂危的成年男性神秘学家（乔·布朗）、一具男性人类尸体（哈维·霍利克），以及一名疑似隶属于重塑之手的敌对女性（确切身份未知）。

这名女性的神秘术能力远超于我们的预估，其所使用的术法具有极高危险度、难以琢磨，我们陷入了前所未有的苦战……所幸，我们尚可以确定，与玛蒂尔达·布翁尼、乔·布朗等一行人的战斗已极大消耗了她的体力，否则我们极有可能面临一场生死未卜的惨战……经过二次的消耗战，她所施展的术法变得衰微，并且得益于乔·布朗所招集人员的帮助，我们取得初步优势。我们打算实施可行的擒获计划，以进一步套取关于重塑之手的重要信息。但重塑之手的撤退速度远甚于以往，他们留下的少数失去神志的信徒阻挠了我们的计划，且碍于迷雾以及未确定的罕见术法，我们事先准备的追踪神秘术也在该地失去了效用 ……

……

“剃刀”小队
述职者：陶德·史密斯

English
Relying on the help of Ms. Maich, a citizen of the New Age Market, the support team successfully entered the "Underground Market." During the investigation, smoke from a fire suddenly rose from a forest 1.3 miles away from there. At the site, we found an injured Foundation investigator (Matilda Bouanich), a critically injured adult male arcanist (Joe Brown), a male human corpse (Harvey Hollick), and a female enemy suspected of belonging to Manus Vindictae (identity unknown).

This woman's mystical abilities far exceeded our expectations. The spells she used were extremely dangerous and difficult to understand. We were engaged in an unprecedentedly fierce battle ... Fortunately, we can confirm that the battle with Matilda Bouanich, Joe Brown, and their group had significantly drained her energy; otherwise, we might have faced a deadly confrontation ... After a second round of attrition, her arcane skills weakened, and with the

help of the people summoned by Joe Brown, we gained an initial advantage. We planned to carry out a feasible capture plan to extract important information about Manus Vindictae. However, Manus Vindictae retreated much faster than usual, leaving behind a few mindless followers who hindered our plan. Additionally, due to the fog and some unknown rare incantations, the tracking arcane skills we had prepared in advance were rendered ineffective at the site ...

"Razor" Squad

Reporter: Todd Smith

门前足音
Unanswered Door FT-22

废墟
Ruins

废墟之前，一个身影驻足已久。
A figure stands before the ruins.

勿忘我：……
Forget Me Not: ...

仿若沉默的墓碑，他将所有一切拒之门外。
He is silent as a gravestone, keeping all else at bay.

足音从背后响起。
Footsteps echo up from behind.

???：勿忘我先生，您果然在这……
???: Mr. Forget Me Not, there you are.

???：引导之人说过，她不希望您再回来这片……庄园。
???: The Guiding One said she didn't want you to come back to this manor.

背影仍旧沉默。
The figure remains silent.

???：圣洛夫基金会又清理掉了位于旧金山的一个“密勿之地”。
???: The St. Pavlov Foundation has destroyed another hidden outpost in San Francisco.

???：您不想……亲自去一趟吗？让那些白袍子见见血。
???: Don't you want to go there yourself? Let those white robes see blood?

远处的背影，缓缓转了过来。
In the distance, the figure turns slowly.

可他的眼中没有丝毫渴盼，只是空洞，一片空洞，犹如吞掉光的深井。
There is no trace of longing in his eyes, only emptiness—a dark abyss that swallows up the sky.

勿忘我：你能看见吗？最早时，那是一片荒芜。
Forget Me Not: Can you see it? It was once a deserted land.

???：什么？
???: What?

勿忘我：接着，不可计数的神秘学家，以数百代、数千代的子嗣的遗骨与鲜血，才筑造了通向它的道路。
Forget Me Not: Then countless arcanists—thousands of generations of them—sacrificed their blood and bones to build the tunnel.

勿忘我：他们狂喜，以头颅亲吻大地——
Forget Me Not: When it was complete, they were ecstatic. They kissed the earth in their jubilation.

勿忘我：最终却发现，在那尽头空无一物。
Forget Me Not: Yet, in the end, they found nothing.

这时，她才发现执于他手中的那本古旧泛黄的书籍。
She notices the old, yellowed book in his hand.

但书籍之名已无法辨认。
But the title is no longer discernible.

???: 我……不明白您的话。
???: I ... I'm not sure what you're talking about.

勿忘我：……
Forget Me Not: ...

他恍然之间意识到了什么。
He turns his attention to something new—

这时女孩颤颤巍巍的身影，才算映进了他的眼中。
The trembling figure of the girl.

勿忘我：罢了……
Forget Me Not: Never mind.

勿忘我：……我知道你想说什么，传道者下达了使命，需要我们尽快回去。
Forget Me Not: I know what you're going to say. The Preacher has ordered us to return.

勿忘我：她听到了新的神谕。
Forget Me Not: She has received a new oracle.

远处的女孩受宠若惊一般，连连颔首。
In the distance, the girl nods dumbstruck.

勿忘我：该走了。
Forget Me Not: Let's go.

他们离开这片寂静之地，直到将要迈出门扉——
They are leaving the quiet place.

他又停下来，回首望向这片废墟。
He stops again, returning his eyes to the ruins.

这是最后一次。
For the last time.

司机：……动起来，动起来啊，宝贝儿！这鸟不拉屎的地方，拖车公司可会把我这条肥羔羊宰死！
Driver: Ah, come on, baby, move! We're in the middle of nowhere! The towing fee will cost an arm and a leg!

司机：该死，为了几张破钞票，这下我跟我的宝贝儿都要折在这了……呜呜呜。
Driver: Ahh! Damn it, my baby's gonna be stuck here forever! And all for a bit of cash. *sobs*

玛蒂尔达：轮胎塌陷在泥巴当中，寸步难行。
Matilda: The tires sink into the mud, spinning helplessly.

玛蒂尔达：男人瘫坐在座位上，丝毫没有心情理会后座忧心忡忡的乘客。
Matilda: The man slumps back in his seat, completely indifferent to the anxious passenger in the back.

玛蒂尔达：唔……根据基金会给我的地图，这里离妈妈的安全屋还有好一段距离……
Matilda: Hmm. The map says it's still a fair distance from the safety house.

玛蒂尔达：唉……最后还是必须得靠伟大的玛蒂尔达自己。
Matilda: *sighs* Looks like the Great Matilda must count on herself once again.

司机：嘿，等、等——小姐，你还没把钱付给我！
Driver: Hey, wait, Miss! You haven't paid me!

他慌张得就要从车窗蹿出去。
He climbs halfway out the window to reach out to her.

玛蒂尔达：三张、五张、八张……二十张——喏，这是尊贵的玛蒂尔达小姐给你的小费，希望能弥补一些你的损失。
Matilda: Three, five, eight ... twenty! And here's a tip, too. I hope it can make up for your loss, at least to some extent.

玛蒂尔达：哼哼，你要知道，像我这样尊贵又慷慨的客人可不多见。
Matilda: Hmph. A distinguished and generous passenger such as me must be a rarity!

玛蒂尔达：接下来我会自己徒步过去，不过你要守在这里，大方的玛蒂尔达回来后会再慷慨一次！
Matilda: I will walk the rest of the way. If you stay here and wait for me, I will show you my generosity again when I return!

司机：好、好的，小姐！
Driver: S-sure, Miss!

他激动地舔着手指，数着钞票，顿时忘记了所有烦忧。
He licks his fingers as he counts the bills, momentarily forgetting his worries.

玛蒂尔达提着箱子，一摇一晃地离去了。
Matilda retrieves her suitcase, swaying with its weight as she departs.

循着深入森林的小径，她的背影渐渐消失在了幽暗的枝丫之间……
Following the narrow path into the forest, her silhouette vanishes beneath the dark branches.

理所当然，司机始终没有察觉到她刻意施展在引擎上的术式。
Naturally, the driver remains entirely unaware of the incantation she had cast on the engine.

玛蒂尔达：圣洛夫基金会安全屋的选址向来属于保密信息，一切都是为了防患于未然……
Matilda: The location of the safety house is classified. I must be very careful.

玛蒂尔达：藏踪匿迹！
Matilda: Vestigium Vanish!

玛蒂尔达：这下就能把足迹隐藏起来了。
Matilda: Alright. Now I won't leave any footprints behind.

玛蒂尔达：唉，这时候如果十四——如果有个得力助手在身边就好了……还能跟我一块去见妈妈，顺带帮我提提箱子，我的手都要累酸了。
Matilda: *sighs* If only I had an assistant with me. Then I wouldn't have to carry this suitcase all by myself. It would be even better if it were Sonet—Heh ... Mama would be happy to meet her.

小小的身影嘀咕着，一步一个脚印。
She mutters to herself as she steps forward, leaving a trail of deep footprints.

玛蒂尔达：我……一点儿也感知不到妈妈的术式。
Matilda: Hmm. I can't feel Mama's incantation at all.

玛蒂尔达：不过，如果按照拉普拉斯科算中心的那群家伙信誓旦旦说的……就连鼻子最灵敏的格拉瓦库斯，也找不见哪怕一根她的发丝……
Matilda: I suppose that makes sense. The Laplace staff swore that this place was so hidden that not even a Glawackus could find it.

玛蒂尔达：希望妈妈一切平安……
Matilda: I hope she's doing well.

她加紧了脚步，拨开丛密的叶子——
She quickens her pace, pushing aside the thick growth.

一间屋子携着希望之光，显现于眼前。
A house appears before her. To her eyes, it seems to glow with hope.

玛蒂尔达：那是……！哼哼，我就知道！重塑之手那群笨家伙怎么可能抓得住妈妈，作为首屈一指的占卜导师兼举世闻名的水晶疗愈师，她早就做好了准备。
Matilda: There it is! Hmph, I knew it! Those stupid Manus followers could never find her. She's one of the best diviners and crystal healers in the world! She must have foreseen all the possible circumstances and prepared for them.

山腰上的光带走了黑暗，也一齐带走了她的不安。
The light shining over the mountainside chases away the darkness, carrying her worries away with it.

玛蒂尔达：哼哼，等她待会看见优秀的女儿久违拜访，肯定会大吃一惊！
Matilda: Humph, but she will certainly be surprised when she sees that this visitor is her own outstanding daughter! It's been so long!

玛蒂尔达：第一防线学校的食堂对法国菜一窍不通，我都快怀念死了妈妈做的正宗普罗旺斯菜肴……
Matilda: The SPDM canteen knows nothing about French cuisine. I can't wait to eat Mama's cooking again.

玛蒂尔达：而且最要紧的是，得让妈妈重新给我挑选一个水晶球……唉，这道占卜时出现的裂痕，连最优秀的水晶修复师也说无能为力……
Matilda: Most importantly, I need to have Mama pick a new orbuculum for me. *sighs* Not even the best crystal craftsman could do anything to repair the cracks in mine.

远处，木屋的灯光摇摇晃晃，仿若悬在一片漆黑之中。
In the distance, a light from the wooden cabin flickers.

门虚掩着，似乎早已预知了将要到访的客人。
The door has been left slightly ajar, as if anticipating the arrival of a visitor.

玛蒂尔达：哼哼……尊敬的布翁尼女士，快来看看是谁来——
Matilda: Hmph. Dear Mrs. Bouanich, come and see who's here.

门扇被轻轻推开了。
She pushes the door open gently.

死寂笼罩着这个空间。
Silence dominates the space.

风肆无忌惮地穿梭，撕扯着窗帘。
The wind roams in behind her recklessly, tearing at the curtains.

数十颗、数百颗——水晶球滚落在地，犹如被扯断线的珍珠项链。
Dozens, even hundreds of crystal spheres scatter to the floor, like pearls from a broken necklace.

它们堆满屋子，无一不布满了网状的裂痕。
They fill the room, each one marred by a web of cracks.

玛蒂尔达：……妈妈?
Matilda: Mama?!